Iran Marketing Technology (MarTech) Report 2024

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Insight

Report Partners: ابزارک SMARTECH

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Preface: Collective Impact

TechRasa Insight, as a social enterprise, publishes comprehensive reports on Iran's digital economy to address the lack of accessible data in this field. The first report by TechRasa Insight has been prepared in the field of Marketing Technologies (MarTech). MarTech refers to software and tools that enable businesses to optimize marketing strategies and advertising campaigns, analyze data, manage customer experience, and ultimately increase sales and revenue.

In challenging economic conditions, MarTech can play a key role in cost reduction and resource optimization. MarTech tools provide businesses with automation solutions, data analytics, communication, and artificial intelligence, helping them streamline their marketing processes and achieve maximum efficiency and productivity with significantly lower costs. This is especially crucial in a market facing sanctions and limited access to external resources.

This report, developed with the collaboration of over 100 specialists, founders, chief marketing officers, and investors, includes an extensive study and analysis of the MarTech industry in Iran and globally. The report is structured into 24 chapters, initially providing an overview of MarTech in Iran and the world, followed by an in-depth analysis of 20 key industries in Iran. The final chapters are dedicated to exploring the investment landscape and research methodology. The goal of this comprehensive structure is to offer a clear view of the potentials, opportunities, and challenges facing MarTech, assisting stakeholders in making data-driven decisions for development and growth in the current environment.

This research would not have started without the valuable support of Mazdak Pakzad, co-founder and CEO of Smartech; would not have continued without the support of Ardavan Sharifi, CEO of Kavenegar; and could not have been completed with this breadth and accuracy without the help of data partners. This report is the result of the collective collaboration of individuals and companies with the shared goal of identifying potentials and fostering the growth of the MarTech industry in Iran.

Mohammadreza Azali
Founder of TechRasa Insight

Acknowledgments to Our Report Partners

We sincerely appreciate the valuable participation and support of the report partners and industry data partners in the preparation of this report, without whom the "Iran MarTech Report 2024" would not have been completed with such breadth and comprehensiveness. Without the vision of Smartech, Kavenegar, and other partners, this report could not have been made freely accessible to all. We are grateful for their support.

Report Partners

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Porsline

inTrack

Jetseo

Athena

Pixy

Khodnevis

Nemoudar

Decom

Adtrace

Metrix

Zebline

Iran's Digital and Economic Landscape – 2023

Digital economy accounts for 7.9% of Iran's GDP

Economic Indicators

GDP	GDP Growth (Calculated in Tomans)	Inflation Rate	Dollar–Rial Exchange Rate
14.3 trillion tomans	37%	46.5%	520,000

Digital Economy's Share of GDP	E-commerce Penetration Rate	Total Electronic Card Payment Volume	Total Electronic Card Transactions
7.9%	6%	12.3 trillion tomans	49.3 billion

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Digital Infrastructure and Connectivity

Mobile Subscription Rate	Smartphone Usage Rate	Fixed Broadband Penetration Rate
179%	74%	13%

Mobile Broadband Penetration Rate	Average Fixed Broadband Speed	Average Mobile Broadband Speed
132%	13.6 MBps	32.8 MBps

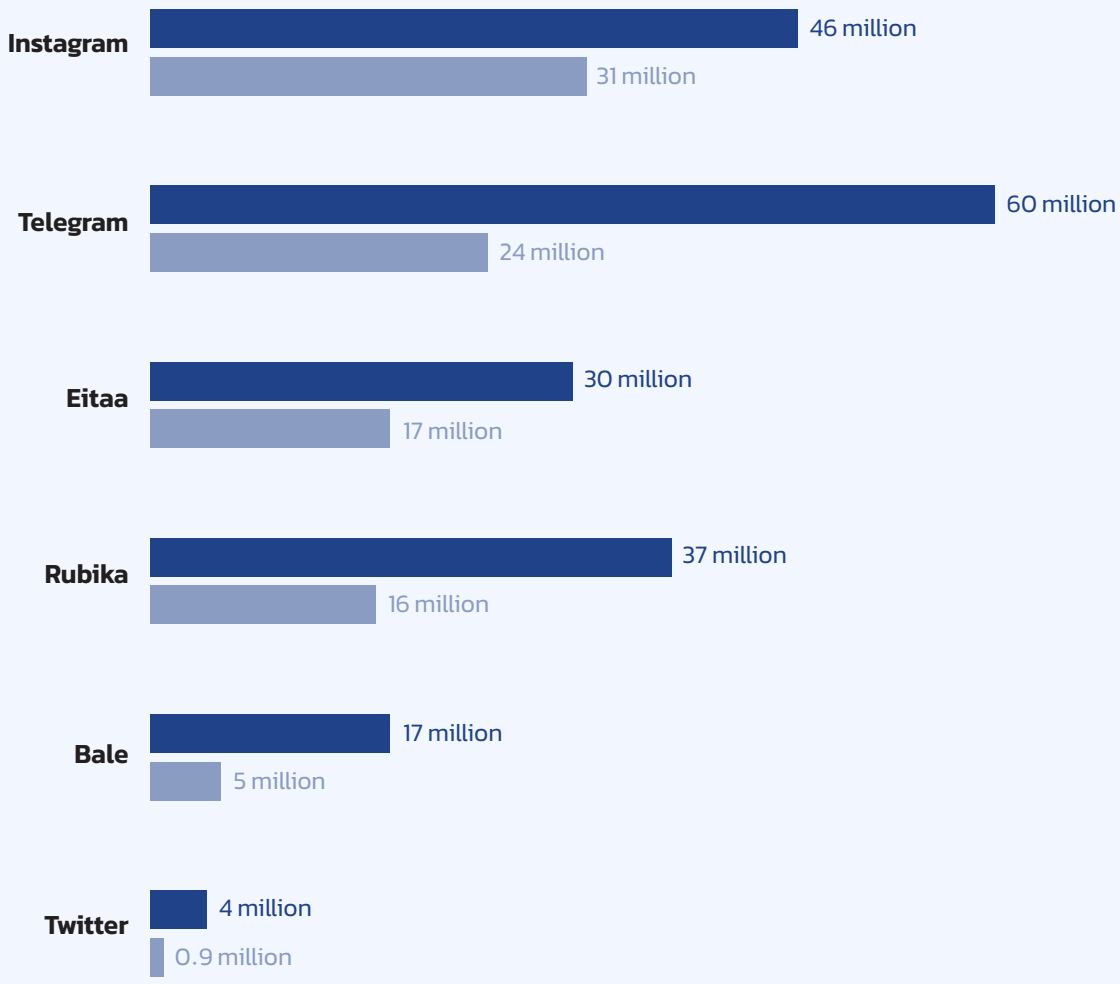
Iran's Digital and Economic Landscape – 2023

Over 46 million registered Instagram users in Iran

Demographics and Consumer Behavior

Population Size	Social Media & Messaging App Penetration Rate	Average Daily Internet Usage
85 million	82%	4 Hours

Registered and Active Users of Popular Social Media Platforms and Messaging Apps in Iran



Key Findings of the Report

Direct employment for over 5,000 people

Marketing Technology in Iran at a Glance – 2023

Number of Identified Players	Market Size	Annual Growth Rate	Direct Employment
Over 400 players	2,400 billion tomans	109%	Over 5,000 people

Classification of Iran's Marketing Technology Industries at a Glance – 2023

	Data	Commerce & Sales	Social & Relationships	Content & Experience
Number of Identified Players	50	4	245	109
Market Size	400 billion tomans	–	1,700 billion tomans	300 billion tomans

Marketing Technology Investment Landscape in Iran – 2021 to 2023

Number of Active Investors (at least one investment in the past 3 years)	Number of Investments	Number of Mergers and Acquisitions	Number of Subsidiaries (investment in subsidiary companies)
10	14	3	6

Key Macro Factors Influencing the Growth or Decline of Marketing Technologies

Decline Factors				Growth Factors
Capital Shortage	Sanctions	Shortage of Expert Human Resources	Economic Recession	Growth of the Digital Economy

1

Overview of Marketing Technology (MarTech) in the World and Iran

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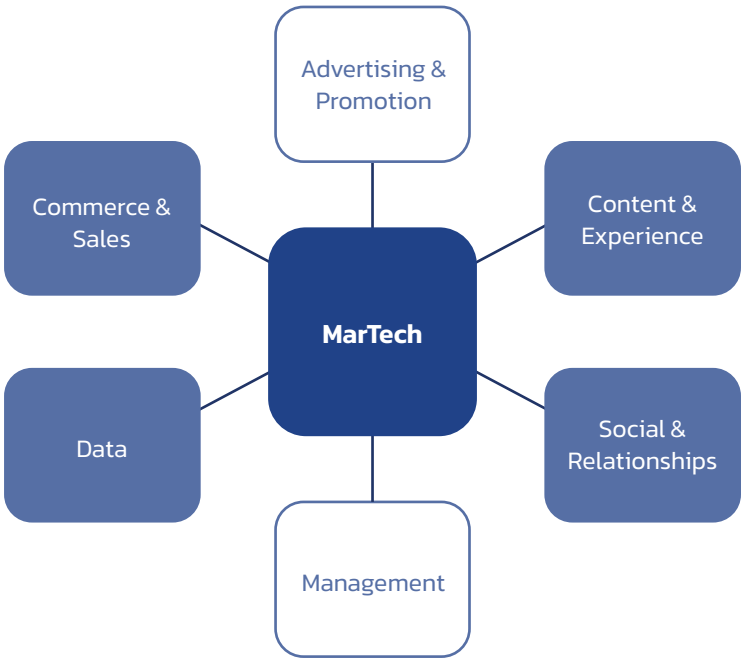
Definition of Marketing Technology (MarTech)

Software and platforms used in marketing, advertising, and sales

MarTech (or Marketing Technology) includes software and platforms utilized for marketing purposes. Although some definitions may not consider sales and advertising as part of MarTech, this report encompasses a wide range of solutions that cover **marketing**, **advertising**, and **sales**.

These technology-driven solutions automate, simplify, and optimize the work of marketing and sales teams (from customer data analysis to acquisition and retention) to help them achieve their marketing goals.

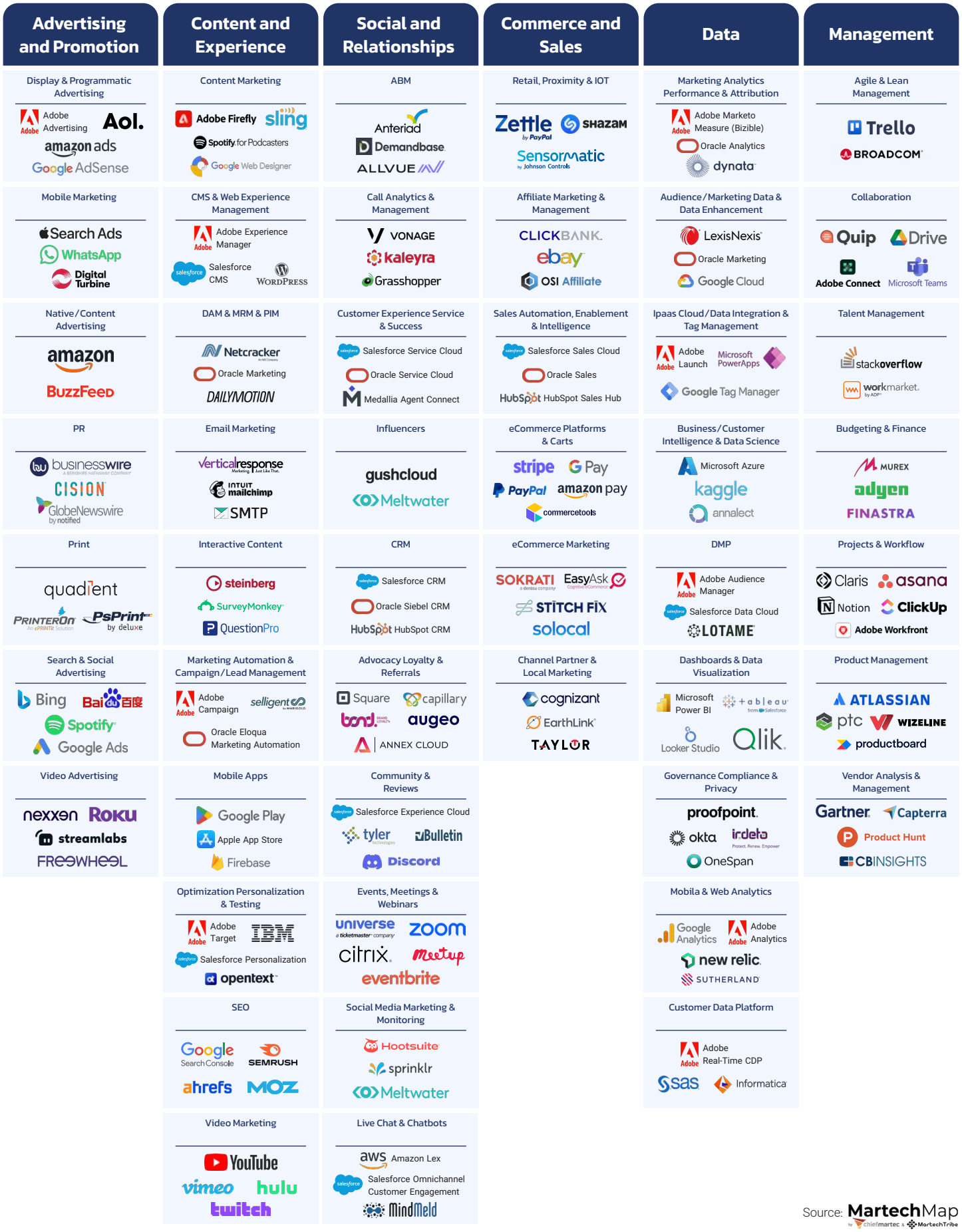
Marketing and sales teams use these software and platforms for researching, planning, executing, managing, organizing, and measuring the performance of content, campaigns, and customer experiences.



This report focuses on four areas: "Content & Experience," "Social & Relationships," "Data," and "Commerce & Sales."

Global Marketing Technology (MarTech) Landscape – 2024

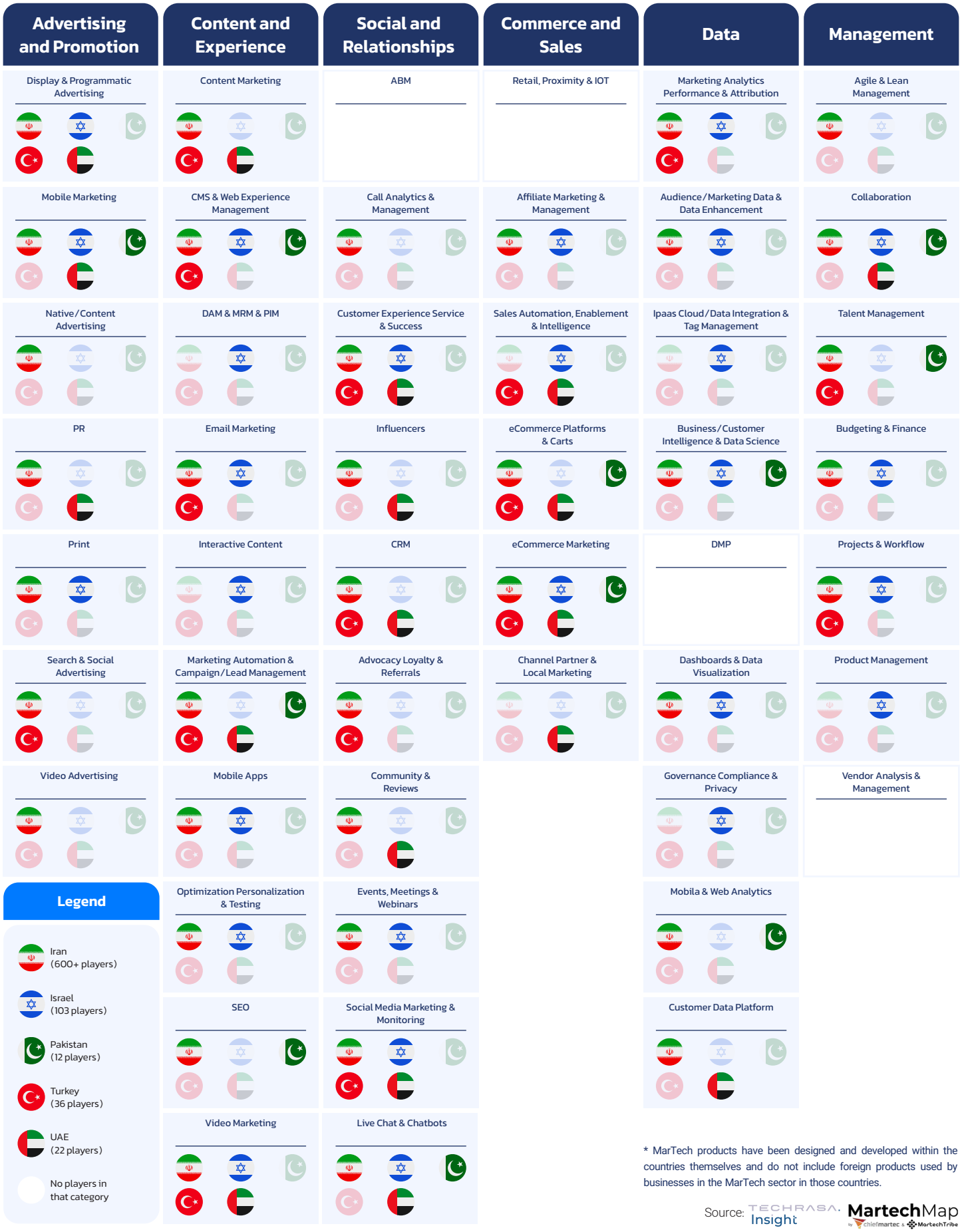
Over 14,000 MarTech tools have been identified globally in 2024



Source: MartechMap by chiefmartec & MartechTribe

MarTech Landscape of Four Countries – 2024 (Iran, Israel, Turkey, UAE, Pakistan)

Iran has the largest share of MarTech players among the selected countries



* MarTech products have been designed and developed within the countries themselves and do not include foreign products used by businesses in the MarTech sector in those countries.

Source: TECHRASA. Insight, MartechMap by chiefmartec & MartechTribe

Iran MarTech Landscape – 2023 (Based on the Global Landscape)

In this report, 15 industries have been selected for in-depth analysis

Advertising and Promotion	Content and Experience	Social and Relationships	Commerce and Sales	Data	Management
Display & Programmatic Advertising	Content Marketing	ABM	Retail, Proximity & IOT	Marketing Analytics Performance & Attribution	Agile & Lean Management
Mobile Marketing	CMS & Web Experience Management	Call Analytics & Management	Affiliate Marketing & Management	Audience/ Marketing Data & Data Enhancement	Collaboration
Native/Content Advertising	DAM & MRM & PIM	Customer Experience Service & Success	Sales Automation, Enablement & Intelligence	Ipaas Cloud/ Data Integration & Tag Management	Talent Management
PR	Email Marketing	Influencers	eCommerce Platforms & Carts	Business/ Customer Intelligence & Data Science	Budgeting & Finance
Print	Interactive Content	CRM	eCommerce Marketing	DMP	Projects & Workflow
Search & Social Advertising	Marketing Automation & Campaign/Lead Management	Advocacy Loyalty & Referrals	Channel Partner & Local Marketing	Dashboards & Data Visualization	Product Management
Video Advertising	Mobile Apps	Community & Reviews		Governance Compliance & Privacy	Vendor Analysis & Management
	Optimization Personalization & Testing	Events, Meetings & Webinars		Mobila & Web Analytics	
	SEO	Social Media Marketing & Monitoring		Customer Data Platform	
	Video Marketing	Live Chat & Chatbots			

Selected Industries

Criteria for Selecting MarTech Industries in Iran – 2023

In this report, the **number of active players**, **market size**, and **emerging technologies** were considered the three main criteria for selecting industries.

Due to the scope and breadth of the "**Customer Relationship Management (CRM)**" and "**Advertising and Promotion**" industries, they were **not included** in this report and require separate reports.

Given that "**Management**" tools are used by multiple departments and are not limited to marketing, they have not been examined in this report.

Based on the research conducted by TechRasa's market research team, the categories of "**Influencers**" and "**Affiliate Marketing & Management**" fall under the advertising sector and, therefore, **will not be covered** in this report.

Iran Marketing Technology (MarTech) Landscape – 2023

20 MarTech industries have been identified in Iran

Content & Experience	Social & Relationships	Commerce & Sales	Data
Text & Image Generation Tool	Cloud–Based Call Center	Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform	Business Intelligence Software
Multimedia Content Creation Tool	Online Form Builder and Survey Software		Marketing Automation Platform
Website Builder Platform	A2P SMS		Mobile Analytics Platform
Landing Page Design Tool	Live Chat & Chatbot		Web Analytics Platform
URL Shortener Tool	Email Marketing Platform		
SEO Tool	Push Notification		
	Media Monitoring & Social Listening Platform		
	Social Media Analytics & Management Platform		
	Customer Loyalty Program Software		

What changes have been made to the Iran MarTech Landscape compared to the Global Landscape?

Some industries in the Iran MarTech Landscape have been repositioned; "**Marketing Automation**" and "**Email Marketing**" were moved from "**Content and Experience**" to "**Data**" and "**Social & Relationships**," respectively.

Some industries absent in the global MarTech landscape have been added to Iran's due to active local players, such as "**A2P SMS**" and "**Push Notification**." Additionally, certain global MarTech industries have been subdivided; for instance, "**CMS & Web Experience Management**" is split into "**Website Builder Platform**," "**Landing Page Design Tool**," and "**URL Shortener Tool,"** and "**Content Marketing**" into "**Text and Image Generation Tool**" and "**Multimedia Content Creation Tool**."

Some global MarTech industries have not fully developed in Iran and are still in their early growth stages. For example, **Customer Experience Service & Success** platforms have not yet taken shape in Iran. However, forms and surveys are used for assessing and managing customer experience. As a result, the "**Online Form Builder & Survey Software**" industry has been included in the Iran MarTech Landscape.

Timeline and Milestones of MarTech in the World and Iran

The 1980s saw the emergence of the first marketing technology tools in Iran

World **Iran**

Before 1990s

- Marketing through mailing to target audiences
- Businesses began using mainframe computers to store and analyze customer data
- Emergence of customer segmentation and personalized communications concepts
- Development of the first Customer Relationship Management (CRM) software (often customized for large companies)

2000s

- Emergence of software for creating brochures, newsletters, catalogs, etc.
- Development of the first marketing automation tools for large organizations
- Beginning of email marketing
- Birth of major CRM giants like Oracle and Salesforce
- Start of search engine marketing (SEO) with the rise of Google
- Growth of marketing automation with the emergence of companies like Eloqua and Marketo

Mid 2000s

- Increase in internet penetration
- Posting classified ads online for brand awareness
- Growth in the number of Iranian websites, especially with the emergence of WordPress
- Start of search engine marketing
- Birth of Iranian SEO tools

Late 2000s

- Increase in mobile penetration
- Development of Iranian app stores like Cafe Bazaar
- Establishment of advertising networks such as Saba Idea and Anetwork
- Expansion of banner and pay-per-click campaigns
- Introduction of the first SMS marketing

2010s

- The advent of social media marketing (via Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn, etc.)
- Emergence of mobile marketing with the rise in smartphone and app penetration
- Development of MarTech tools on cloud platforms and with the SaaS model
- Publication of the first global MarTech landscape by Scott Brinker
- Emergence of thousands of specialized tools, software, and platforms in marketing

Early 2010s

- Increase in app penetration among Iranian users
- Strong focus by businesses on user acquisition and app installations
- Growing need for businesses to analyze campaigns and identify website traffic sources
- Businesses starting to use Google Analytics as a website analysis tool
- Initiation of email marketing
- Development of the first Iranian customer loyalty tools

Late 2010s

- Intensification of sanctions following the U.S. withdrawal from the JCPOA
- Discontinuation of services by foreign providers for Iranian businesses
- Start of developing Iranian MarTech tools
- Emergence of Iranian push notification tools
- Emergence of Iranian social media management and analytics tools
- Emergence of Iranian email marketing tools
- Emergence of Iranian live chat
- Emergence of Iranian marketing automation tools

2020s

- Increase in the dollar–rial exchange rate and economic recession
- Rising user acquisition costs
- Shift in business focus toward retention
- Filtering of Instagram and WhatsApp
- Cessation and shutdown of some active social media players
- Increased use of Iranian attribution tools by businesses
- Launch of the first Iranian chatbot tools

Mid 2010s

- Adoption of foreign social media management and analytics tools by Iranian businesses
  Growing need for app analytics tools
- Emergence of attribution tools for analyzing app acquisition and installation sources
- Saturation of the digital advertising market with an increase in the number and variety of ads
- Political easing in Iran and the growth of internet businesses
- Increased importance of data usage for major marketplaces
- Start of using foreign marketing automation tools
- Emergence of the first cloud–based call center providers
- Development of Iranian social listening tools
- Growth of landing page builder tools due to the lack of agility in programming teams
- Reduced attractiveness of user acquisition and app installation for large businesses
- Increased interest by large businesses in running customer retention campaigns and boosting engagement rates

2020s

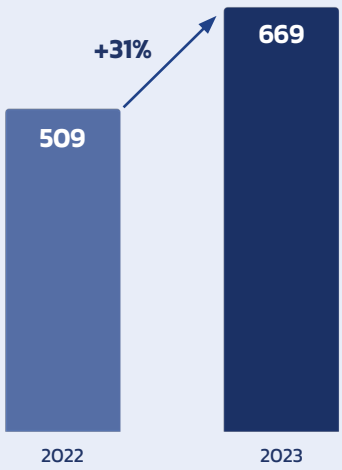
- Intense need for businesses to use data analytics platforms
- Emergence of AI–based tools for content creation, predictive analytics, and personalized recommendations
- Adoption of account–based marketing (ABM)
- Focus on data security and privacy regulations

Marketing Technology (MarTech) Market Size in the World and Iran

Iran's market size of 2,400 billion Tomans, growing over 100% from last year

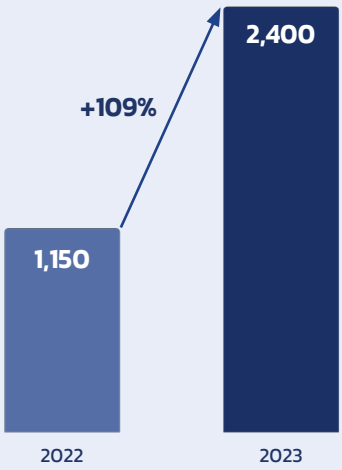
MarTech Market Size in the World and Iran

Global Market Size (Billion Dollars)



These figures include the market size for marketing and sales technologies.

Iran Market Size (Billion Tomans)*



1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

The market size for Iran does not include "**Advertising and Promotion**," "**Customer Relationship Management (CRM)**," "**Influencers**," and "**Affiliate Marketing & Management**." Therefore, comparing the market size of Iran and the global market based on the above figures is not feasible.

Inflation–driven price hikes have significantly influenced Iran's market size

Over 70% of the disparity between Iran's market growth rate and the global market stems from price inflation, alongside increased demand. With **inflation surpassing 40%** and **depreciation of the rial**, rising operational costs have forced industry players to **raise prices**.

Significant impact of 145% market size growth of A2P SMS on MarTech market growth

With a **100% increase in SMS prices** in 2023, the **market size** of A2P SMS grew by **145%**. Given that A2P SMS account for **50% of the MarTech market size,** this has had a substantial impact on overall market growth.

Marketing Budget Allocation in the World and Iran

Large Iranian online businesses allocate 4% to 6% of their sales to marketing budgets

Marketing Budget as a Percentage of Sales in the World and Iran

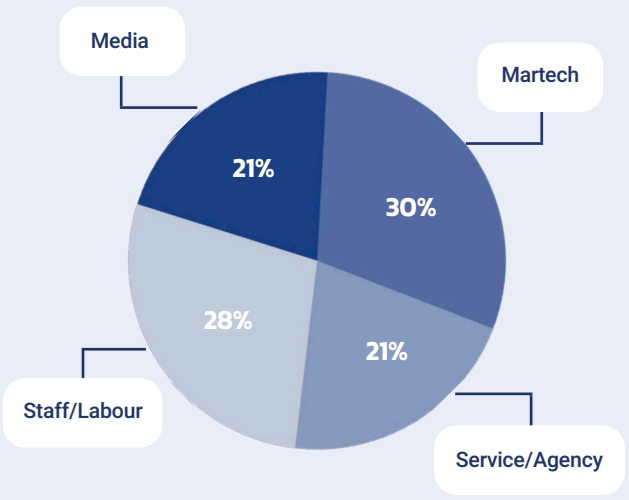
Marketing Budget Share from Sales of Businesses Worldwide – 2023	Marketing Budget Share from Sales of "Large Online Businesses" in Iran – 2023
9% to 11%	4% to 6%

Marketing Budget Spending in the World and Iran

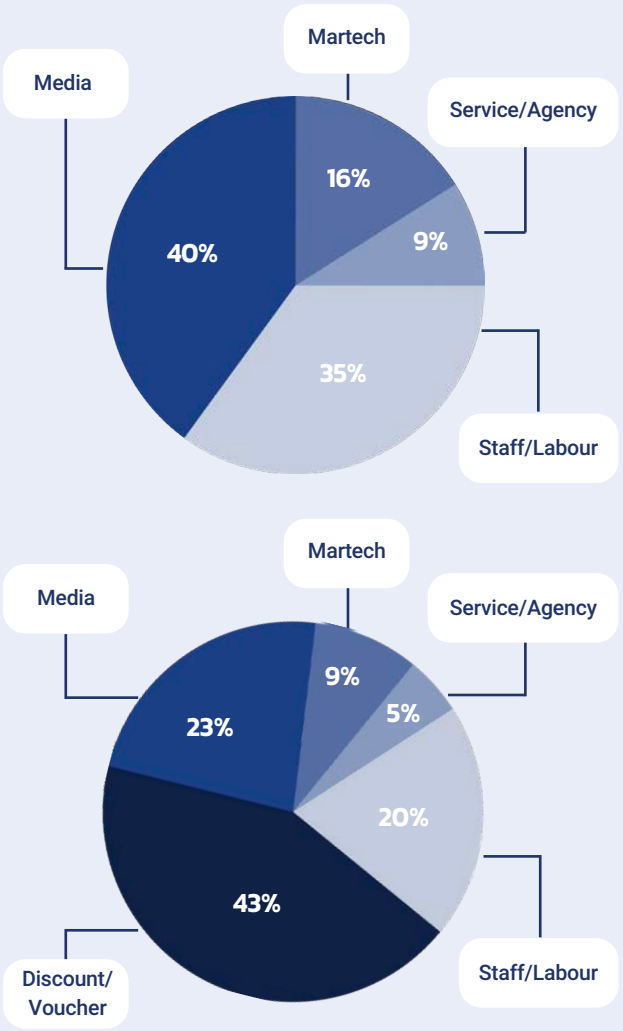
Over 80% of large online businesses' marketing budget is spent on discounts, media, and salaries

Marketing Budget Distribution of Businesses in the World and Iran

Marketing Budget Distribution of "Businesses" in the World – 2023



Marketing Budget Distribution of "Large Online Businesses" in Iran – 1402 (2023)



Media: Costs related to purchasing offline and online advertising space

Staff/Labour: Includes salary, benefits, and recruitment costs for marketing department personnel

MarTech Tools: Costs of purchasing marketing technology tools and platforms

Discount/Voucher: Costs related to special offers, discount, vouchers, etc.

Service/Agency: Payments to to third-party agencies, freelancers, and consultants for specialized services in strategic planning, branding, content creation, etc.



Ahmad Ali Farhoodi

Co-Founder and CEO of SabaCell

Inflation and reduced purchasing power have made users more price-sensitive, driving them towards discount. Consequently, discounts account for a significant share of the marketing budget for Iranian businesses across most industries.

Marketing Technology (MarTech) Trends in the World and Iran

AI is one of the key MarTech trends in both the world and Iran

MarTech Trends in the World and Iran

Global

AI-Powered Personalization at Scale
he use of generative AI for content creation and personalized experiences at scale, along with other AI applications in MarTech tools, has significantly contributed to MarTech's growth.

Cloud Data Warehouses
Marketing teams use cloud data warehouses as centralized hubs for customer insights, enabling targeted campaigns and providing an integrated view of the customer journey

Importance of Ecosystems and Communities
The ability to integrate and collaborate among tool providers through ecosystems has become a priority for businesses, aiming to create a seamless and cohesive user experience.

Increased Use of No-code by Creators
Marketers and MarTech tool users are now empowered to create applications, websites, campaigns, and more through low-code/no-code platforms without the need for deep technical knowledge.

Iran

Adoption of AI
The use of AI to streamline content creation and creative activities, as well as its application in tools like chatbots and enhancing marketing automation tools or ECRMs, is a trend in Iran.

Personalization
Creating personalized experiences and advanced recommendation tools tailored for customers (using various methods such as AI, etc.), which initially require a CDP (Customer Data Platform).



Tohid Aliashrafi

CEO of Alibaba Travels & Former Vice President of Marketing at Alibaba Group

The ideal for any marketer is to create personalized connections with their customers, and this is where technology can serve marketing, enabling this ideal to happen on a large scale.

Marketing Technology (MarTech) Trends in the World and Iran

Online and offline integration is a MarTech trend in Iran

Development and Use of Customer Data Platforms (CDP)
The move towards developing CDPs and consolidating all customer data from various sources, especially to enhance personalized customer interactions, is a trend in Iran.



Sobhan Foroughi

Co-Founder and CEO of Tapsell

In the Iranian market, the main focus is currently on the customer journey and related actions. While CDP and DMP data collection isn't a major priority now, the importance of data is expected to increase in the future.



Jeiran Tabei

Head of Marketing at Danone

The existing data analytics tools in the Iranian market are not easily generalizable to the entire market, and the data is not unified or consolidated.

First Party Data*
Businesses are striving to collect first-party data directly from their customers and audiences through various interactions, as this data is more accurate, higher quality, and more relevant compared to second-party data.

Online and Offline Integration
New tools are emerging for offline businesses to support customer retention marketing and integrate their online and offline channels.



Maysam Keihani

CMO at OzoneEcosystem

Lower user acquisition costs and the larger market size of offline spaces compared to online have drawn the attention of holdings and large businesses to the O2O (online-to-offline) sector. There is a growing demand from these businesses for MarTech tools tailored to this industry's needs, which remains unmet.

*Zero-Party Data: Information intentionally and proactively shared by individuals with a business.

First-Party Data: Data collected directly by a business through interactions with its customers and users.

Second-Party Data: Data collected by a trusted partner or another business and shared with the business.

Third-Party Data: Data aggregated and sold by a third-party data collection company.

2

In-Depth Analysis of Marketing Technology (MarTech) in Iran

Report Partners: SMARTECH

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Iran Marketing Technology (MarTech) Landscape – 2023

More than 400 Iranian players have been identified in 20 industries

Social & Relationships

Cloud-Based Call Center

Navatel, Telina, Daftareshoma, Workano — 20+

A2P SMS

Kavenegar, Mediana, SMS.ir, Melipayamak, Candoo SMS, Faraz SMS, Amoot SMS — 100+

Media Monitoring & Social Listening Platform

Zelkaa, Dataak, Lifeweb, 8tag — 20+

Social Media Analytics & Management Platform

NovinHub, CoCo — 5+

Online Form Builder & Survey Software

Porsline, Ucheck, ePoll — 15+

Live Chat & Chatbot

Raychat, Goftino, Gapify, FlowChat, muchat, Danabot, NovinHub, Directam, Inboxino — 5+

Push Notification

Najva — 5+

Customer Loyalty Program Software

Philia, Direct, Smart X, Dobare, Dayatek — 15+

Email Marketing Platform

MailerEver, Pakat, Najva, MailerLite — 7+

Content & Experience

Text & Image Generation Tool

Khodnevis, Athena, Pixy, Aval, Mann-E, Fibonacci — 24+

SEO Tool

Jetseo, Moz, Semrush, Mizfa Tools, Keywordchi, Scout — 25+

Landing Page Design Tool

Landin, Zilink, Cartino — 11+

URL Shortener Tool

B2n — 12+

Website Builder Platform

Webzi, Portal, See5, Iran Server, Hostiran — 6+

Multimedia Content Creation Tool

Lenoos, Vidiwood — 6+

Data

Marketing Automation Platform

inTrack, Zebline, Metrix, WebEngage — 3+

Mobile Analytics Platform

Metrix, Adtrace, AppMetrica — 2+

Business Intelligence Software

Decom, Nemoudar, Power BI, Winiro, Hooshayand, Tart — 24+

Web Analytics Platform

Google Analytics — 7+

Commerce & Sales

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform

Markito, SellerYar, ZiTRON, Taamito

Key Indicators of Marketing Technology (MarTech) in Iran

2,400 billion tomans market size of MarTech in Iran

Key Indicators of MarTech in Iran

Market Size	Annual Growth Rate	Share of GDP
2,400 billion tomans	109%	0.02%

Total Number of Identified Players	Direct Employment	Adoption Rate of MarTech Tools*
More than 400 players	Over 5,000 people	30% to 40%

The above key indicators do not include the "**Advertising and Promotion**," "**Customer Relationship Management (CRM)**," "**Influencers**," and "**Affiliate Marketing & Management**" industries.

* The adoption rate of MarTech tools refers to the extent of use by potential customers of MarTech tools.

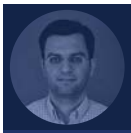
1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Marketing Budget Spending in Iran – 2023

Large Iranian businesses allocate 4% to 6% of their sales to marketing budgets

Marketing Budget Share from Sales of "Large Iranian Businesses" by Industry – 2023

Total	Classified Ads	Online Retail of FMCG and Food
4% to 6%	3% to 6%	5% to 10%
HealthTech	**Online Retail**	**Mobile Telecom**
4% to 5%	1% to 3%	2%
O2O E-commerce	**Internet Service Providers (ISP)**	**Fashion & Lifestyle**
20% to 35%	7% to 15%	3% to 6%



Ali Rasouli
CMO at Divar

In the early stages, businesses allocate a larger share of their revenue and sales to marketing budgets due to the need for rapid growth and competition. However, as businesses mature and competition levels decrease in the industry, the share of marketing budgets from sales gradually decreases over time.

Marketing Budget Spending in Iran – 2023

The high share of discounts and media in the marketing budget spending of large Iranian businesses

Ranking of Marketing Budget Spending Allocation of "Large Iranian Businesses" by Industry – 2023

Industry \ Spending Ranking	First Rank	Second Rank	Third Rank	Fourth Rank	Fifth Rank
Total	Discount/Voucher	Media	Staff/Labour	MarTech Tools	Service/Agency
Online Retail	Discount/Voucher	Media	Staff/Labour	MarTech Tools	Service/Agency
Online Retail of FMCG and Food	Discount/Voucher	Staff/Labour	MarTech Tools	Media	Service/Agency
Ride-Hailing	Media	Discount/Voucher	Staff/Labour	Service/Agency	MarTech Tools
Mobile Telecom	Media	Staff/Labour	Discount/Voucher	Service/Agency	MarTech Tools
Online Tourism	Media	Staff/Labour	Discount/Voucher	MarTech Tools	Service/Agency
Internet Service Providers (ISP)	Media	Staff/Labour	Discount/Voucher	MarTech Tools	Service/Agency
Fashion & Lifestyle	Media	Service/Agency	Discount/Voucher	Staff/Labour	MarTech Tools
Classified Ads	Media	Service/Agency	Discount/Voucher	Staff/Labour	MarTech Tools
O2O E-commerce	Discount/Voucher	Staff/Labour	MarTech Tools	Media	Service/Agency

Media: Costs related to purchasing offline and online advertising space

Staff/Labour: Includes salary, benefits, and recruitment costs for marketing department personnel

MarTech Tools: Costs of purchasing marketing technology tools and platforms

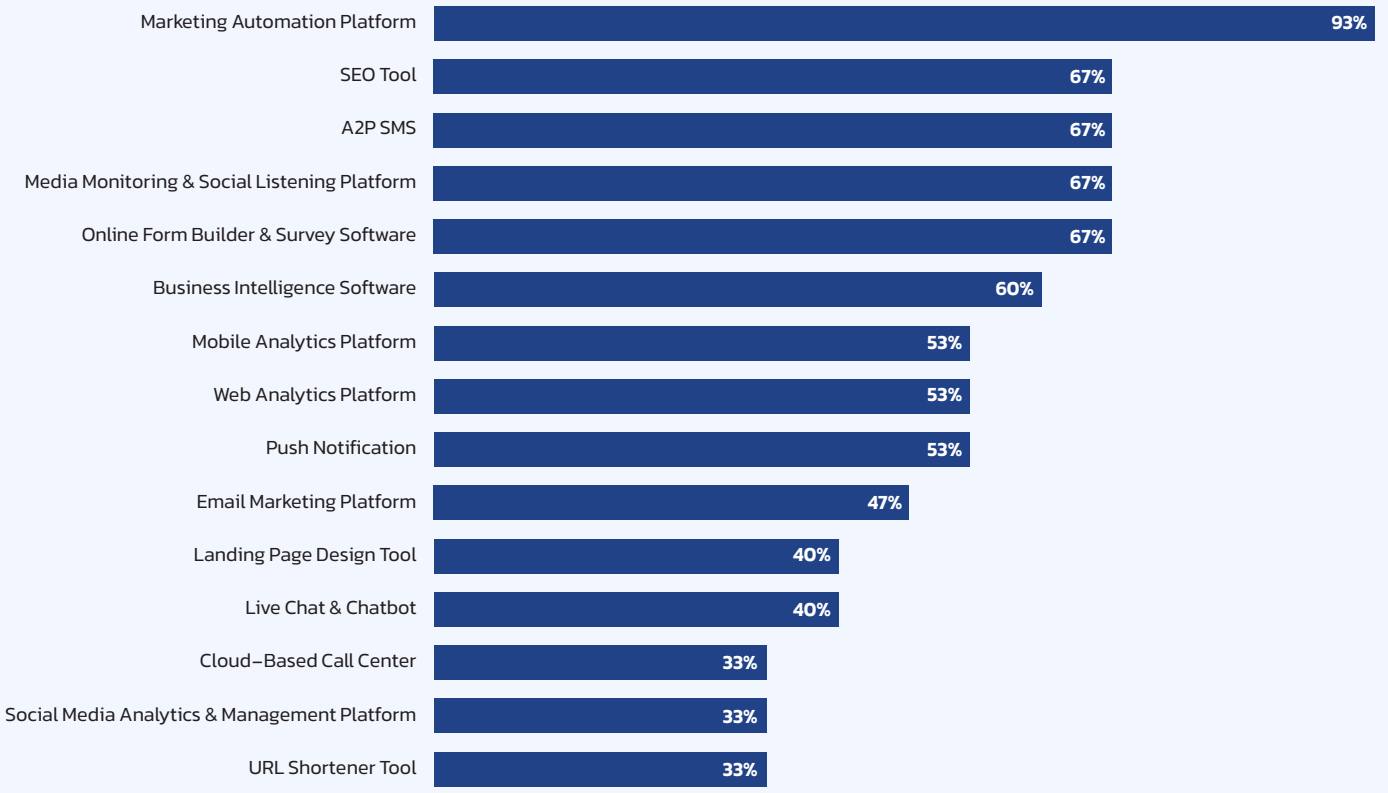
Discount/Voucher: Costs related to special offers, discoun, vouchers, etc.

Service/Agency: Payments to third-party agencies, freelancers, and consultants for specialized services in strategic planning, branding, content creation, etc.

Adoption and Spending on Marketing Technology Tools in Iran

Over 80% of MarTech spending goes to marketing automation platforms and A2P SMS

Adoption of MarTech Tools by "Large Iranian Online Businesses" – 2023



MarTech Tool Spending by "Large Iranian Online Businesses" – 2023

First Rank	A2P SMS
Second Rank	Marketing Automation Platform
Third Rank	Media Monitoring & Social Listening Platform
Fourth Rank	SEO Tool
Fifth Rank	Online Form Builder & Survey Software
Sixth Rank	Email Marketing Platform

Insight

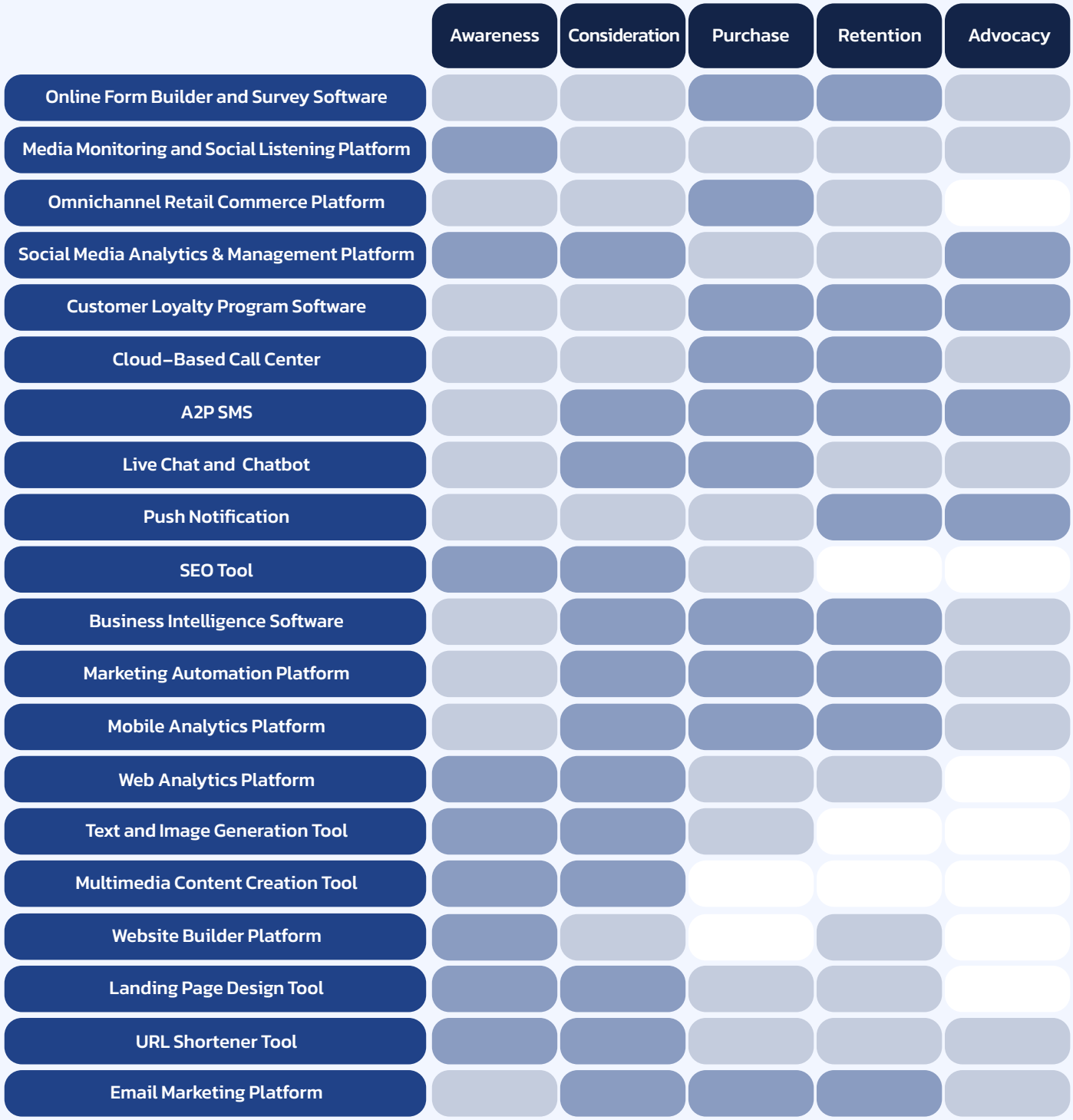
Over 80% of online businesses' **MarTech spending** is dedicated to **A2P SMS** and **marketing automation**.

Depending on marketing strategies and the specifics of their business domain, the spending rank of A2P SMS and marketing automation shifts between first and second position for some businesses.

Application of MarTech Industries in the Marketing Funnel

MarTech industries, based on their nature, are utilized at various stages of the marketing funnel

Application of Various MarTech Industries in the Marketing Funnel



High Application and Impact

Moderate Application and Impact

CMOs' Needs for Marketing Technology Tools in Iran

In medium and large businesses, a CDP is one of the key foundational needs for CMOs

CMOs' Needs for MarTech Tools

Integration and Tool Connectivity
The ability to integrate and exchange data between MarTech tools is a key need for CMOs in Iran.

Customer Data Platform (CDP)
Medium and large businesses with a significant user base require a CDP to make data-driven decisions. It is also essential that this tool is provided by an independent entity, not tied to a large corporation.

Advanced Reporting and Analytics
Tools for reporting and analyzing branding campaigns, measuring the effectiveness of MarTech activities, and enhancing app analytics are key needs for marketing managers.

B2B Marketing Tools
Currently, most MarTech tools are designed for B2C markets and activities. Marketing managers need MarTech tools that are customized for the specific needs and activities of B2B marketing.

Customization of Behavior Analysis and Customer Segmentation Tools for Different Industries
Industries like fashion, lifestyle, and fintech require different metrics to understand and analyze customer behavior. These metrics are either absent in existing tools or need to be optimized.



Mahmoudreza Chamani

Marketing Manager at Dorsa Group

In the fashion industry, personalized customer communication requires different criteria, such as understanding lifestyle and trends, to better analyze customer behavior. Currently, many existing tools lack the ability to track and provide these insights, making them unsuitable for this sector.



Mohamad Hasan Farazmand

Vice President Marketing at Digipay

Landtech platforms offering credit can achieve high growth and profitability if users fully utilize the credit provided. To achieve this, these platforms urgently need customer behavior analysis tools to predict actions and deliver personalized purchase suggestions using AI and real-time data analytics.



Mahdi Habibi

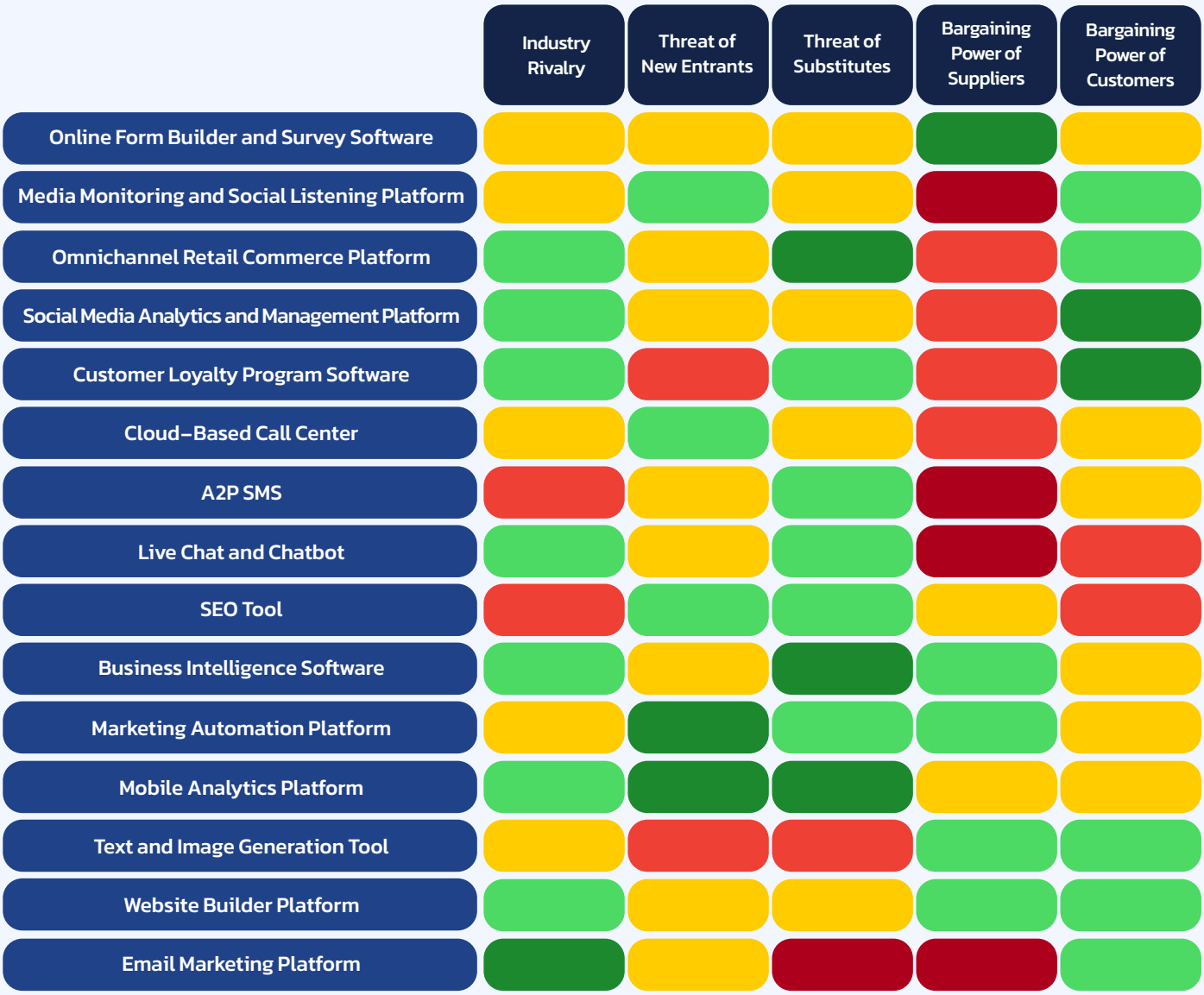
CMO at Snappfood

MarTech development varies between mature and emerging markets. In the acquisition phase, the focus is on the top of the marketing funnel, while in mature markets, it shifts to customer retention and loyalty. Each phase requires specific MarTech tools.

Competitive Analysis and Attractiveness of MarTech Industries – 2023

The highest competition intensity is in the SEO and A2P SMS industries

Competitive Analysis and Attractiveness of MarTech Industries – 2023



The information in this table is based on expert opinions. Industries such as push notifications, website analytics, multimedia content creation, landing page design, and URL shortening are not included due to the lack of data.

Very Low | Low | Medium | High | Very High

Macro Factors Impacting MarTech Market Growth or Decline – 1402

Lack of investment and sanctions are the main barriers to MarTech market growth



Low Investment Interest



Amir Pasha

CEO at Carmood and Former CMO at Digikala

MarTech products are typically complex due to their technology-driven nature, making investment in this industry challenging and high-risk. Investors in this sector are often corporate investors seeking to enhance their value chain.

Sanctions and lack of international connections



Meysam Mollasharify

CMO at Snapp Group

MarTech tool providers in Iran face challenges entering international markets, limiting their operations to the domestic market. As a result, they cannot benefit from economies of scale.

Shortage of skilled workforce



Alireza Borzabadi

CMO at Nobitex

The main reason for the slow growth of the MarTech industry in Iran is the lack of skilled workforce.

Growth of the digital economy in Iran



Hirmand Lashkari

Data Marketing Consultant

The primary customers of MarTech tools are tech-driven businesses. As a result, the growth of the digital economy will drive the expansion of the MarTech market.

Macro Factors Impacting MarTech Market Growth or Decline – 1402

Limited awareness of MarTech)s applications and benefits hinders its growth



Weak data protection and customer data privacy laws



Ahmad Ali Farhoodi

Co–Founder and CEO of SabaCell

Iranian businesses, especially large ones in highly competitive industries, have low trust in using Iranian tools due to concerns about data leaks or sharing with competitors. Expanding into global markets and serving foreign businesses could help build trust among Iranian businesses.

Economic recession



Mazdak Pakzad

Co–Founder and CEO of Smartech

Many MarTech tools are designed to drive business growth. Consequently, businesses focused primarily on survival show little interest in using them.

Slow growth in awareness of MarTech tools' benefits



Mahbod Mortazavi

Co–Founder and CMO of SnappShop

One of the main reasons businesses are not using Iranian tools is the lack of familiarity among marketing managers and the tools' inability to effectively reach their target audience, including marketing managers and businesses. Additionally, service quality remains a challenge compared to foreign alternatives.

Macro Factors Impacting MarTech Market Growth or Decline – 1402

Currency fluctuations have increased the willingness to use Iranian tools



Currency exchange rate fluctuations



Ahmad Ali Farhoodi

Co–Founder and CEO of SabaCell

Changes in dollar-rial exchange rate have increased costs for businesses using foreign tools for their marketing. This rise in costs has led to a greater interest in using Iranian tools or developing in-house tools.

Complexity of integrating tools



Bahrad Zari

Founder and Former CEO of Chabok

The complexity of integrating MarTech tools with other software has led to a poor experience for businesses. In such cases, businesses are unable to consolidate their data in a single platform, and the tools operate in silos.

Tax regulations' mismatch with innovative businesses



Tohid Aliashrafi

CEO of Alibaba Travels and Former Vice President of Marketing at Alibaba Group

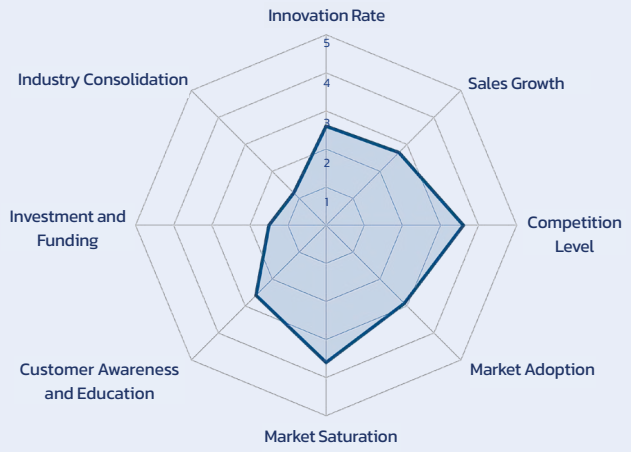
Many players in the MarTech industry operate with very slim profit margins. When proper tax regulations are not in place, the taxes they pay turn their profits into losses, causing these businesses to fail and close down.

Life Cycle of Marketing Technology (MarTech) in Iran

MarTech has significant growth potential in Iran

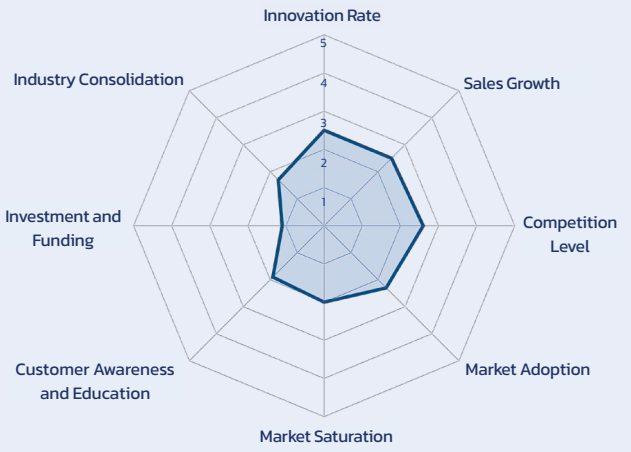
Life Cycle of MarTech in Iran

From the Perspective of Industry Players



*These numbers were derived by calculating the weighted average of the industry life cycles of MarTech industries.

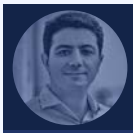
From the Perspective of CMOs, Experts, and Investors





Farzin Fardiss
CEO of Sarava

In the current state of the MarTech industry in Iran, mergers and acquisitions are essential strategies. Many tools, especially those with similar features and no unique differentiators, could capture a larger market share and be more successful if they collaborate or merge, rather than competing against each other.



Hamid Mohammadi
Co-Founder and Chairman of the Board of Digikala Group

The decrease in investment in the digital economy has led businesses in this sector, which were the main advertisers and marketers, to adopt a more conservative approach. Additionally, competition among these businesses has decreased, resulting in slower growth for the MarTech industry.



Mazdak Pakzad
Co-Founder and CEO of Smartech

Due to limited capital and the size of the existing market, MarTech industry growth requires collaboration among its players.



Hadi Moradi
Founder of DM Board

The U.S. withdrawal from the JCPOA and intensified sanctions increased demand for MarTech tools in Iran, as businesses could no longer use foreign options.

3

Cloud-Based Call Center

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဆောဖ်ဝဲ

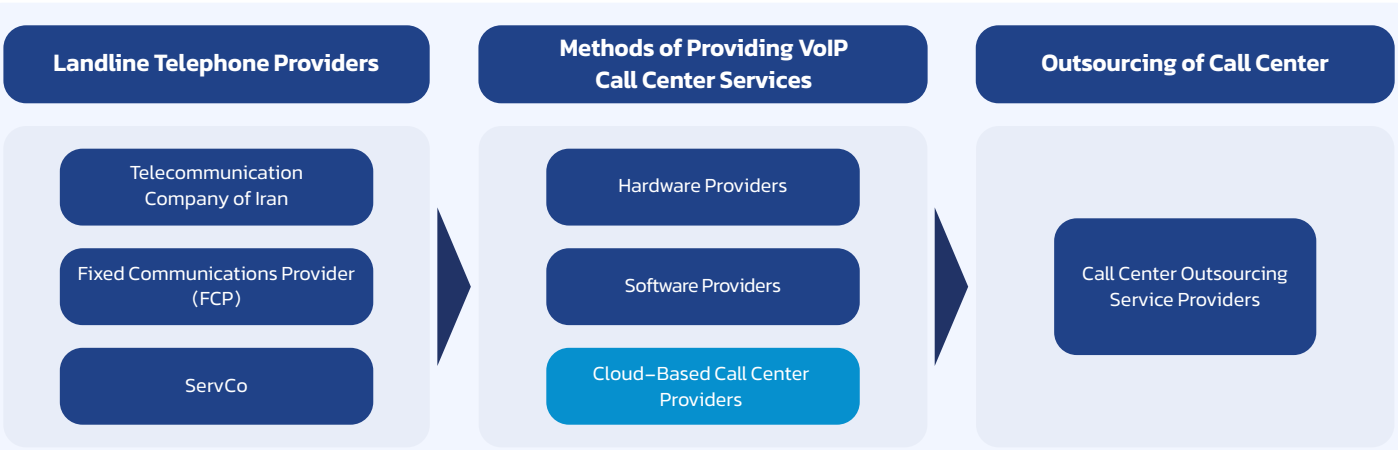
TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Cloud–Based Call Center

Making inbound and outbound calls anytime, anywhere, without hardware or specialist

A cloud-based call center is essentially the same as a VoIP call center, offered by service providers over the internet to businesses. Businesses do not need to install or maintain physical equipment on-site and can benefit from features such as scalability, flexibility, and reduced costs without needing VoIP Specialist.

VoIP Call Center Value Chain in Iran



Insight

The VoIP call center market is divided into three categories: **hardware**, **software**, and **cloud-based call center**. Currently, players in the **hardware** and **open-source software** domains hold a major share of the VoIP call center market in Iran.

FCP	These companies are licensed by the Communications Regulatory Authority, possess independent number ranges, and are capable of offering fixed telephone lines (analog and SIP trunk). The largest provider of fixed telephone lines is the Telecommunications Company of Iran.
ServCo	Similar to FCPs, they are licensed to offer fixed telephone lines, but with the distinction that they must utilize FCP infrastructures for call routing systems.
Hardware Providers	These are importers and distributors of foreign VoIP hardware brands in Iran (such as Panasonic, Grandstream, Sangoma, and New Rock). These hardware systems do not require server or gateway purchases, as capabilities are pre–installed in the devices.
Software Providers	These companies install software like Asterisk, Issabel, and FreePBX (which are open–source) on business servers, enabling the management of inbound and outbound calls.
Cloud–Based Call Center Providers (Hosted PBX)	They use cloud and internet infrastructures to manage and conduct calls. Businesses benefit from panel features on a monthly or yearly subscription basis, without the need for physical equipment installation or maintenance.
Call Center Outsourcing Service Providers	Companies (usually those with high call volumes) outsource their entire call center operations to these providers without needing to set up a call center or hire operators.

Cloud-Based Call Center Providers – 2023

15 Iranian cloud-based call center providers have been identified in the Iranian market

Cloud-Based Call Center Providers

Companies that host and manage calls over the internet.



DaftareShoma



Telina


Navatel



Telefonchy



Nexfon


Hamkaran



Javantel



Alo 021


Metama



Astel



Workano


Avval Office



Telbama



voffice



Zhicall

10+

The order of the players in the landscape is based on the results of a survey conducted with industry players, considering three criteria: "market share," "innovation," and "market presence tenure." The ranking of the players does not necessarily reflect their market share.

Given that the cloud-based call center market in Iran is changing due to regulatory factors, players have provided various ways for businesses to make remote calls without the need for a physical location. Some players set up virtual servers for each business and install the call center software on each server, while others use a shared, centralized version due to the nature of the software they use. Additionally, some players offer non-cloud methods (such as call forwarding) to enable businesses to make calls.

Insight

In addition to cloud-based call center providers, mobile operators are entering the cloud-based call center market.

Types of Cloud–Based Call Center Providers

Some cloud–based call center providers transforming into UCaaS and CCaaS platforms

The Difference Between UCaaS and CCaaS Platforms

Most cloud-based call center providers have primarily focused on phone calls. However, some, such as "Navatel," "Metama," and "Workano," have begun transitioning into UCaaS and CCaaS platforms. These platforms help businesses enhance both internal and external communications.

What is UCaaS (Unified Communications as a Service)?

These platforms are designed for "internal communications" and provide a unified dashboard with diverse internal communication tools like "voice," "video," "chat," and "team management." The goal of these platforms is to enhance productivity and team collaboration within companies.

What is CCaaS (Contact Center as a Service)?

These platforms are designed for "external communications" and offer a unified dashboard integrating various customer communication channels such as "voice," "social media," "chat," and "SMS." The goal of these platforms is to improve customer experience and boost sales.

Although these two platforms are designed for different purposes, they complement each other. The boundaries between the two platforms are becoming blurred, and they are conceptually and business model-wise converging.

Applications of Cloud–Based Call Centers in the Marketing Funnel

Cloud–based call centers are more commonly used in the post–purchase stages



- Conducting surveys to measure customer satisfaction and the likelihood of recommending the brand to others

- Contacting customers for feedback after the purchase stage (Happy Call)
- Informing customers about special and exclusive offers
- Storing customer information and details to offer personalized support and recommendations via CRM integration

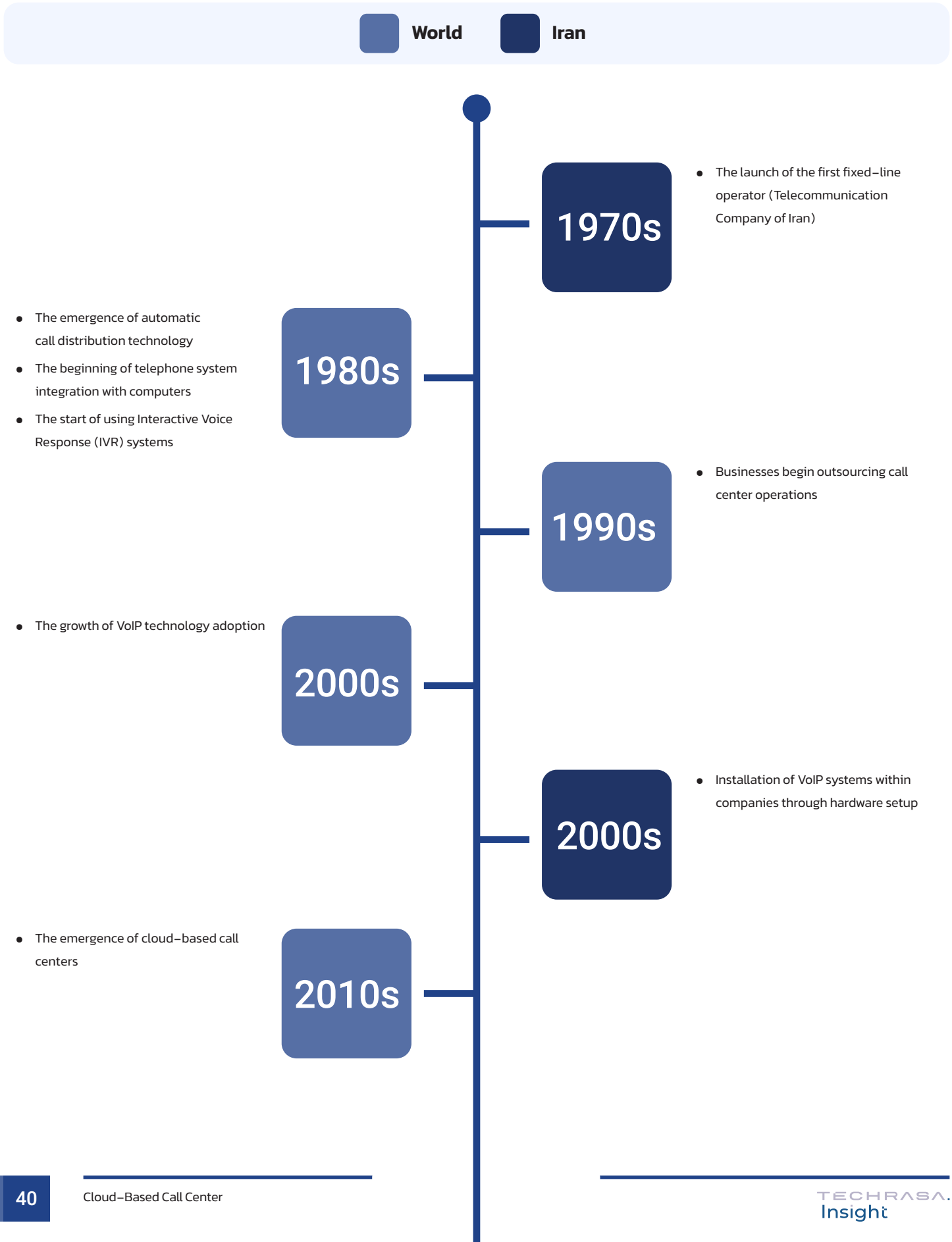
- Providing quick responses to customers facing issues during the purchase process
- Automated calls to customers who have abandoned their shopping cart
- Connecting to CRM to track lead status

- Advanced routing and intelligent distribution of calls for managing responses to inquiries
- Interactive Voice Response (IVR)
- Call recording and voicemail for tracking calls

- Automated mass voice messaging
- Integration with email, SMS, and social media for broader audience reach

Timeline and Milestones of Cloud-Based Call Centers in Iran and the World

The mid-2010s marked the emergence of the first cloud-based call center providers in Iran



Early 2010s

- The start of the second fixed-line operator (Alo Iran)
- The launch of the first VoIP service operator (Alo Iran)
- The possibility of providing phone lines over SIP infrastructure
- Issuance of FCP licenses by the Communications Regulatory Authority
- Emergence of next-generation operators providing services over SIP

Mid 2010s

- Increased use of telephones by businesses
- The possibility of automated voice messaging
- The emergence of the first cloud-based call center providers
- Regulatory requirement for the uniformity of the telephone line provider and the bandwidth provider

Late 2010s

- Raspinta became the first operator to offer cloud-based call center under the Nexfon brand
- The ability to send faxes over the internet
- COVID-19 and the rise of remote work
- Growth in the number of online business
- Broader adoption of VoIP by businesses
- Growing interest in open-source solutions among cloud-based call center players

Early 2020s

- Growth of integrated communication platforms UCaaS and CCaaS

Early 2020s

- Nexfon's restriction from providing phone services over the internet
- Fixed-line penetration rate reaches 34.7%

Products and Features of Cloud–Based Call Center Providers

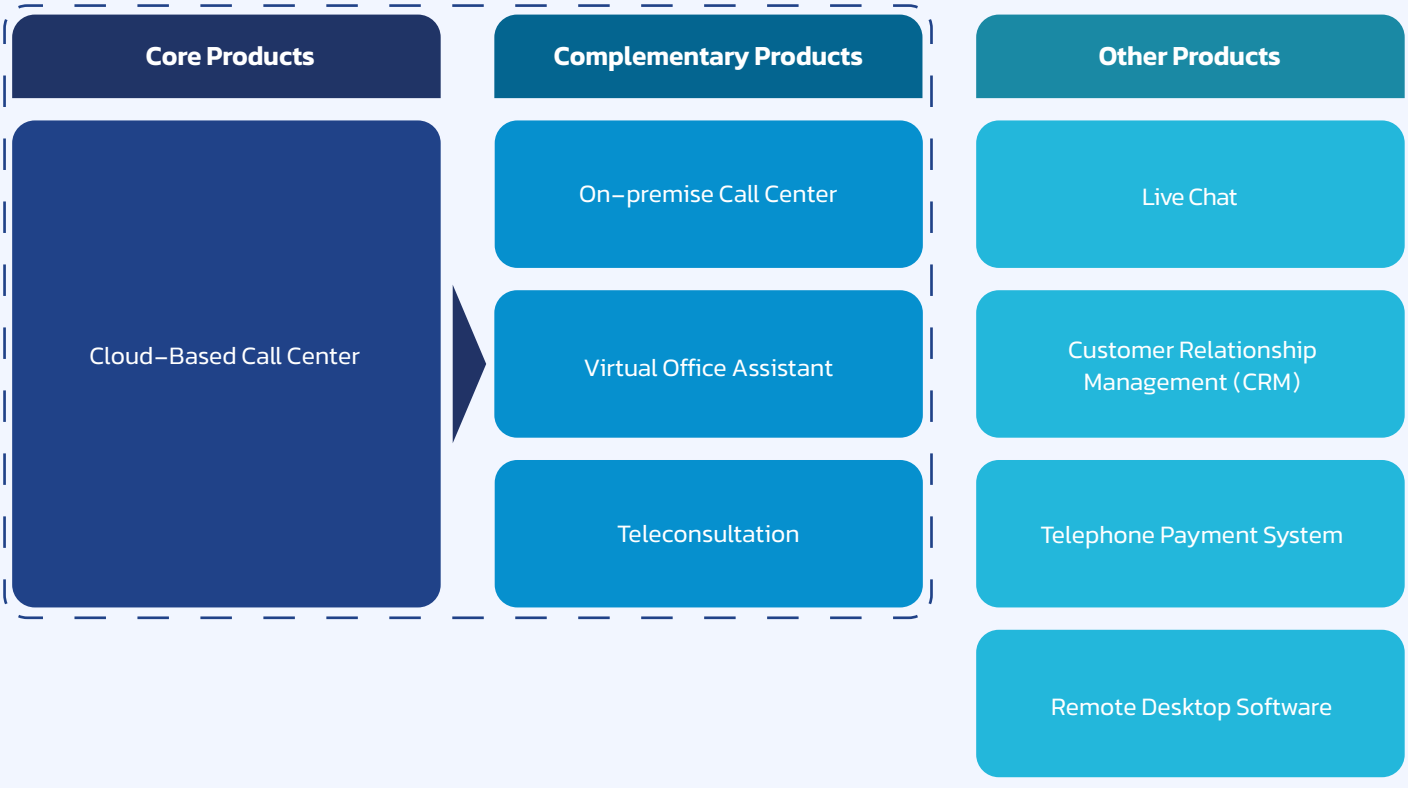
Cloud–based call center is the core business of the providers in this industry

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the cloud-based call center industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Insight

Some cloud-based call center providers offer "call center outsourcing services" to businesses with low call volumes.

Insight

While it seems that all players have the capability to integrate with customer relationship management (CRM) software, some players have developed their own proprietary CRM to create a seamless experience for businesses.

Products and Features of Cloud–Based Call Center Providers

Call center agents can respond to calls using various tools anytime and anywhere

Core Products and Key Features				
Cloud–Based Call Center	Web–based Admin Panel	Operator Management Panel	Defining and Assigning Extensions	Creating a Phonebook
	Automated Response	Creating Call Groups	Defining Call Queues	Call Reporting
	Creating Audio Conference	Voicemail	Recording and Downloading Calls	Interactive Voice Response (IVR)
	Making and Receiving Calls via Application	WebFax	Surveying Agent Response Quality	Web Service and CRM Integration
	Workplace Chat	Call Forwarding, Hold, and Call Transfer	Internal File Sharing	VoIP Phone Line

Businesses' call center agents (operators) can handle calls anytime and anywhere using the following tools:

- **Call Forwarding:** Call forwarding to a mobile or landline number, allowing the operator to answer calls from any location via mobile or landline.
- **Application:** Installed on mobile devices, enabling features like voice and video calls, call forwarding, and voicemail management without time or location restrictions.
- **Web:** Allows control, making, and responding to VoIP calls via a web browser without needing software installation.
- **Chrome Extention:** An extension added to the Google Chrome browser that facilitates making calls, often used to ease calling and integrate with CRM in work environments.
- **Desktop:** A software installed on computer operating systems (Windows, Mac, or Linux), requiring no direct access to hardware for operation.
- **IP Phone:** Digital phones connected to VoIP networks via the internet (IP), enabling calls, phone conferencing, and cloud-based features.

Products and Features of Cloud–Based Call Center Providers

The variety of complementary products sets cloud–based call center providers apart

Complementary Products and Key Features				
On–premise Call Center	Interactive Voice Response (IVR)	Advanced Routing and Distribution	Call Recording and Live Call Monitoring	Creating Voicemail
	Live Monitoring of Calls and Users	Analytical Tools and Advanced Reporting	Defining Call Queues	Sending Voice Messages
	WebRTC	Phone Surveys	Integration with Other Software	Multi–party Phone Conferencing
	Number Masking	Call Center Dashboard		
Virtual Office Assistant	Dedicated Phone Numbers	Call Recording	Assigning Operator Teams	Call Handling
	Call Forwarding	Online Instruction Management for Secretary	Call Reporting	
Teleconsultation	Defining Consultants and Commission Percentage	Setting Consultants' Working Hours	Handling Multiple Calls Simultaneously	Forwarding Calls to the Consultant's Mobile
	Purchasing Recharge Cards by Customers	Web Services	Reporting	

Insight

The "on-premise call center" solution is a is landline organizational solution based on SIP trunk technology, where voice transmission occurs over IP. Unlike cloud-based call center solutions, this system requires businesses to have servers and equipment physically installed and set up on-site.

Comparison of Key Cloud–Based Call Center Providers

A dedicated application is one of the key differentiators among providers

Comparison of Key Cloud–Based Call Center Providers Based on Product Variety

	Core Products		Complementary Products		
	Cloud–Based Call Center	Application*	On–premise Call Center	Virtual Office Assistant	Teleconsultation
DaftareShoma	**	✓	✗	✓	✗
Telina	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Navatel	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Telefonchy	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Nexfon	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗
Hamkaran	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Javantel	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Metama	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓
Workano	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓

The players on this list have been selected based on expert consensus.

*The applications provided by the players differ in terms of features and capabilities:

- "**Navatel**" and "**Workano**" have developed their own dedicated applications that, in addition to managing inbound and outbound calls, offer other features such as voice and video calls, video conferencing, chat, and more.
- "**Telina**" and "**Javantel**" enable voice and video calls via Zoiper on mobile or desktop.
- The "**DaftareShoma**" application is used only for outbound calls. Incoming calls are handled via call forwarding, without requiring an application.

**"DaftareShoma" does not provide calls over IP; instead, it handles them via call forwarding.

7 Key Criteria for Choosing a Cloud–Based Call Center From the Customer's Perspective

- Service Quality and Stability (Sound quality, no interruptions, no delays)
- Variety of Services and Products
- Not Being Limited to a Single Internet Provider
- Integration Capability with Other Software (Accounting and CRM)
- Ease of Use
- Connection to Various Fixed Landline Telephone
- Customer Support

Cloud–Based Call Center Providers Market – 2023

Currently, only a few businesses use cloud–based call centers

Cloud–Based Call Center Providers Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	20 to 80 billion tomans	17%
Global	5.18 billion dollars (2023)	–

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran



Due to the lack of accurate, transparent, and reliable data on the cloud-based call center market in Iran, the estimated market size is between 20 to 80 billion toman, with 10 to 15 thousand businesses using cloud-based call centers.

Cloud–Based Call Center Providers Market Structure – 2023

Given the nascent and emerging nature of this market, along with its complex structure, it is currently not possible to definitively discuss the market structure or the market share of cloud-based call center players. However, according to experts, a significant portion of the market share appears to be held by Navatel, Telina, DaftareShoma, Hamkaran, Telephonchy, and Javantel.

Cloud–Based Call Center Providers Market – 2023

Small and medium–sized businesses are the primary users of cloud–based call centers

Which Businesses Use Cloud–Based Call Centers the Most?



Ali Dashti

Founder and CEO of DaftarShoma

Typically, medium and small-sized companies are interested in setting up cloud-based call centers.

Businesses with these characteristics are cloud-based call center customers:

- Geographically distributed
- Looking to manage overhead costs
- Have no concerns about data or information disclosure
- 5 to 10-person businesses interested in flexible locations or remote work

- Small and Emerging Online Businesses
- Small Trading Companies
- Small Healthcare Centers (Cosmetic Clinics)
- Small Travel and Aviation Agencies
- Small Insurance Offices
- Small Educational Institutions

Insight

Since the cloud-based call center market still faces regulatory complexities, lacks transparency, and deviates from global standards, large businesses avoid using cloud-based call centers to mitigate risk. They prefer to install call center software on-site to ensure data security and service stability.



Hamid Forouzande

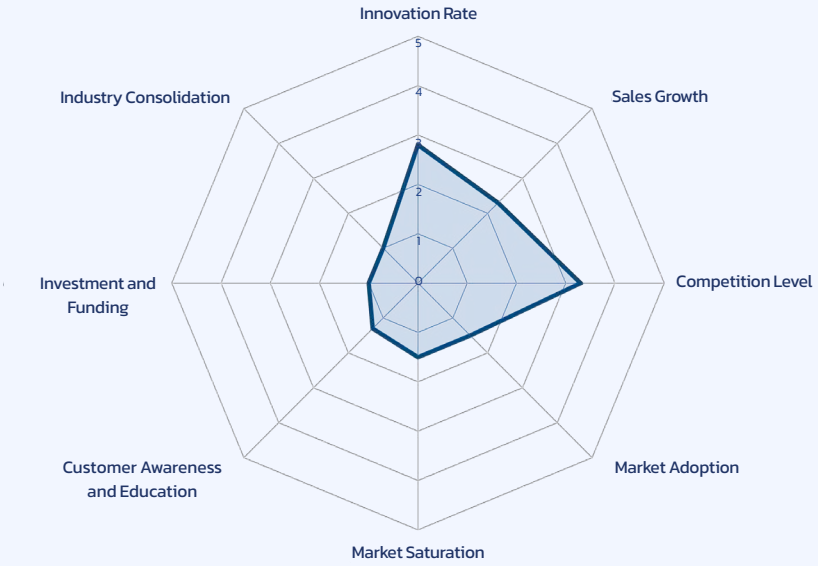
Founder and CEO of Navatel

Given the investments made, the advantages and appeal of cloud-based call centers, and the entry of major players like "Telecommunication Company of Iran" into this field, this solution has attracted significant attention and adoption from large businesses.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Cloud–Based Call Center Industry – 2023

The level of competition in this industry is moderate

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Cloud–Based Call Center Industry – 2023





Hamid Forouzande

Founder and CEO of Navatel

The complexity of product development, the lengthy process of obtaining licenses, and the entry of large competitors (such as mobile operators and telecommunications companies) have increased the investment risk in this market, resulting in a lack of investor interest.



Milad Razban

Founder and CEO of Workano

The complexity and lack of transparency in regulation have created access for some players to specific licenses and privileges, leading to an unhealthy competitive environment in this market.

Insight

Monopolistic tendencies, complexity, lack of regulatory transparency, and restrictions imposed by the regulator have increased investment risks, hindered growth, and stifled innovation in the cloud-based call center market.

Cloud–Based Call Center Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

AI and integration are key trends in this industry, both in Iran and globally

Cloud–Based Call Center Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Cloud solutions replacing on–premise installations for businesses due to greater flexibility and efficiency	Using AI capabilities to respond to calls
Integrating all customer communication channels (voice, email, chat, social media) into a single platform (CCaaS and UCaaS)	Shifting market trends from hardware– and software–based call centers to cloud–based call centers
Using AI capabilities to manage high call volumes and automate repetitive tasks	Integrating all customer communication channels (voice, email, chat, etc.) into a single platform (CCaaS and UCaaS)
Providing advanced analytics and reporting tools to businesses for assessing call center metrics	Increased adoption of remote and hybrid work models by businesses
Integration with CRM and other business software	Emergence of AI–based call centers
Offering features to enhance operator experience and performance, such as easy–to–use interfaces, gamification, and AI assistants	The capability to offer cloud–based call center to businesses without internet limitations
	Offering video solutions



Sajad Sabri

Co–founder of Nasim Telecom

Cloud-based call center, like other cloud solutions, is gaining traction in the country's communications market due to its standout advantages. Companies that insist on on-premise solutions risk losing out in this competition.

4

A2P SMS

Industry Data Partners:

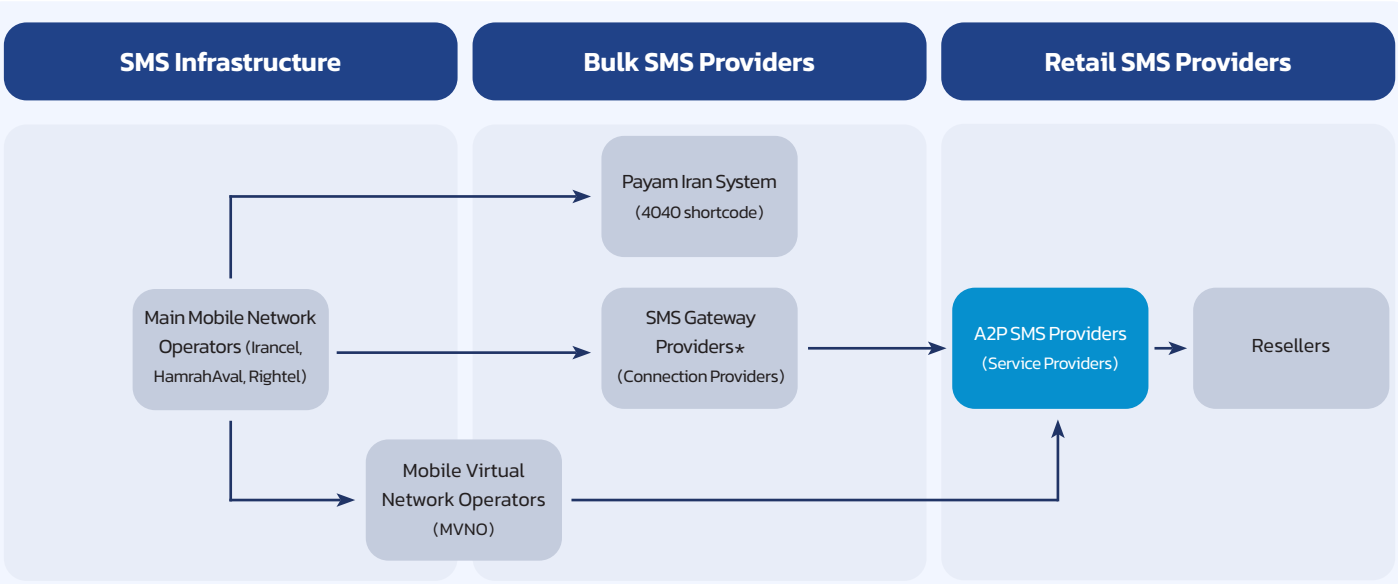
Report Partners:

Definition of A2P SMS

A2P SMS Providers are positioned at the end of the SMS industry chain

Companies that provide platforms (web-based software) and APIs to facilitate marketing SMS, transactional SMS, OTP SMS, and other types of SMS for businesses.

The SMS Industry Chain in Iran



In Iran, CP stands for Content Provider, as they are recognized by the regulator as media and get their license from the Ministry of Culture and Islamic Guidance. However, in this report, the term Connection Providers is used due to the relevance of their activities.

Main Mobile Network Operators	Operators that provide the SMS infrastructure for the subsequent layers of the chain.
Mobile Virtual Network Operators (MVNO)	Operators similar to main operators, but they use the infrastructure and physical network of the main operators.
Payam Iran System (4040 shortcode)	It focuses on facilitating message exchanges between government executive agencies and the public. Government executive agencies are required to use this system for sending SMS.
SMS Gateway Providers	Companies that buy SMS services in bulk from main operators and distribute it.
A2P SMS Providers	Web-based software that enables the sending and receiving of SMS from various numbers through contracts with mobile virtual network operators and SMS gateway providers.
Resellers	Using the software infrastructure of A2P SMS providers, they offer SMS services to businesses under their own brand.

Insight

A2P SMS are also provided by SMS gateway providers. These companies typically offer SMS services directly to businesses (especially large businesses) and usually through an SMS API.

SMS Industry Players – 2023

More than 100 Iranian A2P SMS providers have been identified in Iran's market

Although SMS gateway providers have the infrastructure for A2P SMS, they differ from A2P SMS providers. SMS gateway providers offer panels with their own shortcode, whereas A2P SMS providers provide businesses with access to various shortcodes. Therefore, this report takes a closer look at A2P SMS providers.

SMS Industry Players

Mobile Virtual Network Operators (MVNO)*

Providing SMS infrastructure for subsequent layers of the SMS chain

Target Market: Private Businesses | A2P SMS Providers

AriaTel | SamanTel | Shatel Mobile | Asiatech | LotusTel

Other mobile virtual network operators have not yet commercially entered the SMS market.

SMS Gateway Providers

Bulk purchase of SMS from main operators and its distribution

Target Market: Banks | A2P SMS Providers | Private Businesses

Atieh Dade Pardaz	Magfa	Rahyab Rayaneh Gostar	Rahyab Payam Gostaran	Pishgam Rayan	Peyk Asa	Armaghan Rahe Talaie
Short Code 2000	Short Code 3000	Short Code 1000	Short Code 50001–50009	Short Code 50003	Short Code 021	Short Code 50004 & 50002

One distinguishing factor between SMS gateway providers and A2P SMS providers is the offering of an SMS Gateway product. This product allows connection to various operators.
Large businesses or those prioritizing data confidentiality prefer to use this product.

Payam Iran System

Enabling SMS for government executive agencies

Target Market: Government Executive Agencies

Payam Iran System

SMS Industry Players – 2023

More than 100 Iranian A2P SMS providers have been identified in the Iranian market

SMS Industry Players

A2P SMS Providers

Web-based software offering SMS services with various shortcodes.

Target Market:

- Private Businesses
- Public Sector Clients

Kavenegar | Mediana | Melipayamak | Faraz SMS | Nik SMS | Payam Resan | Raygan SMS | Farapayamak

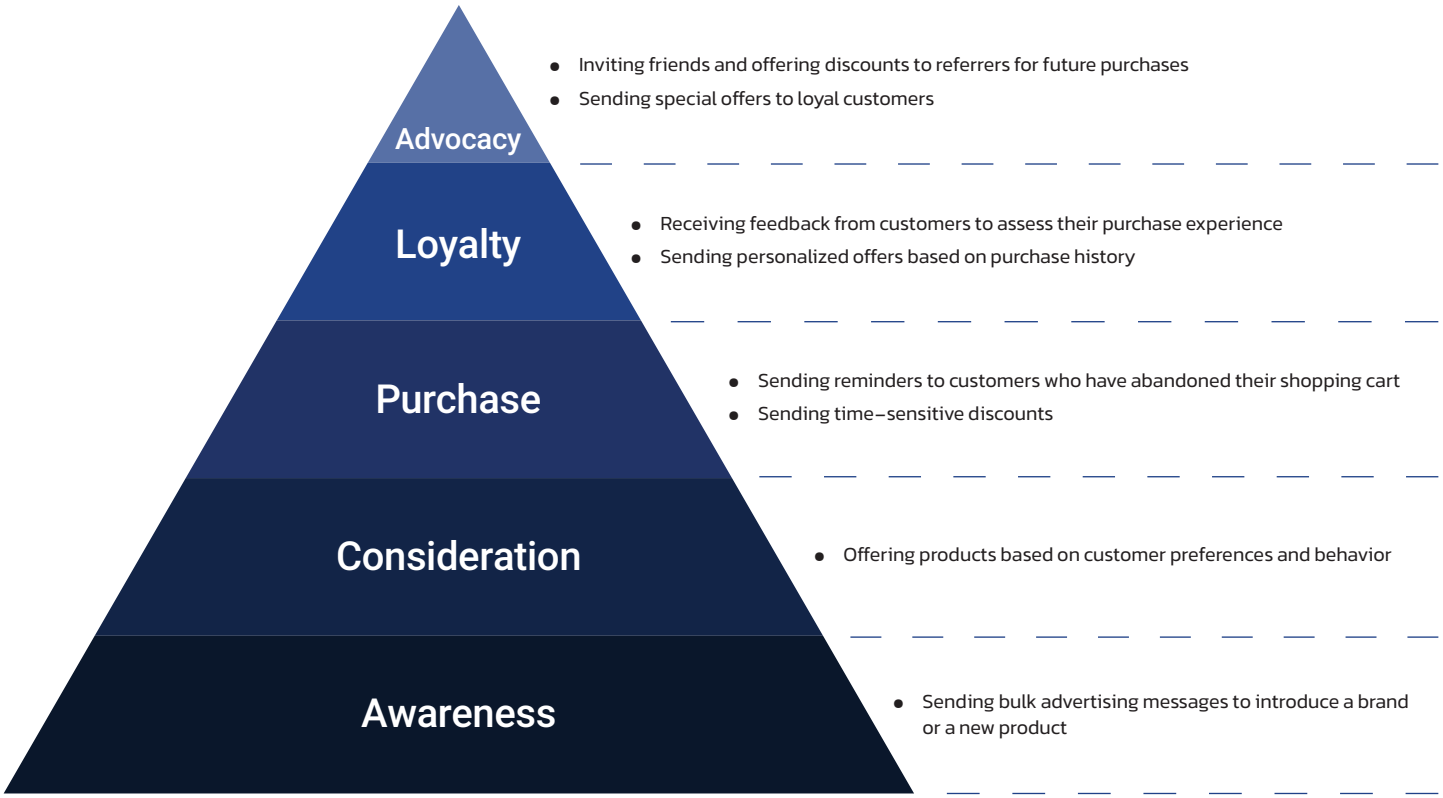
SMS.ir | Modir Payamak | Amoot SMS | Najva | Ghasedak | Candoo | Web One SMS | +100

Some of the players mentioned above are resellers and use the software infrastructure of A2P SMS providers.

Applications of A2P SMS in the Marketing Funnel

A2P SMS can be used at all stages of the marketing funnel

SMS has various applications and is recognized as one of the most important methods for user authentication. However, in this section, only its marketing applications are considered.



Timeline and Milestones of SMS in Iran and the World

Transitioning from promotional SMS to marketing, Transactional, and OTP SMS

World **Iran**

1990s – 2000s

- The first SMS sent
- Bulk SMS sent by businesses for product marketing
- Increased penetration of smartphones
- Growth of SMS compared to phone calls

Early 2000s

- The first SMS sent
- Installation of SMS service for one million mobile subscribers
- Granting licenses for SMS services to three companies: Rahyab, Atieh Dadeh Pardaz, and Magfa
- Bulk SMS services provided to businesses
- Focus of SMS on bulk advertising without targeting

Mid 2010s

- All mobile subscribers gained access to SMS services
- Sending 8 billion SMS annually

Late 2000s

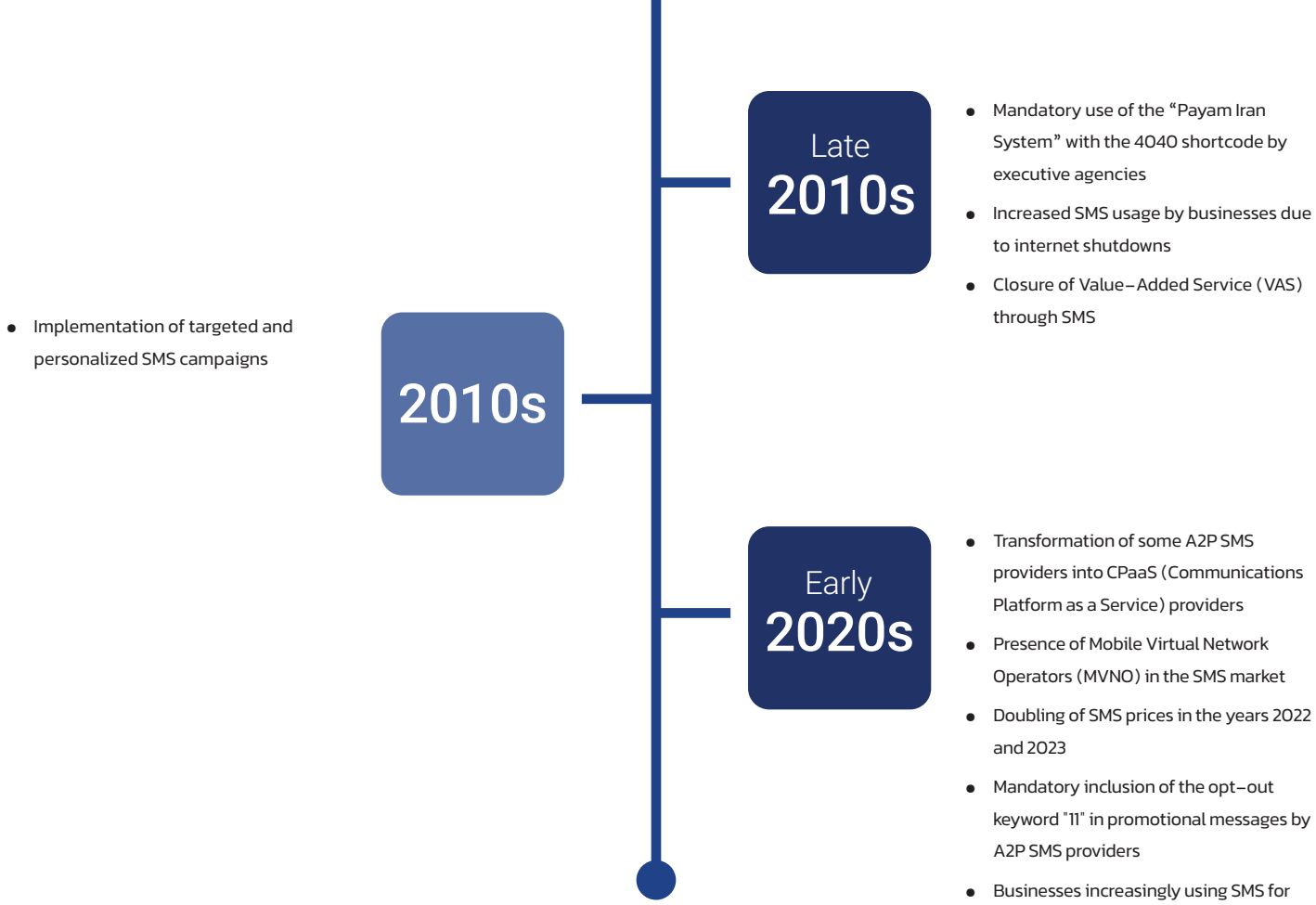
- Sending SMS with business names (Mask)
- SMS Surveys initiated by Atieh Dadeh Pardaz in the “90” TV program
- The first A2P SMS providers began operations

Early 2010s

- Increase in the number of A2P SMS providers
- Introduction of Value-Added Services (VAS) through SMS
- Decrease in SMS usage due to the popularity of Telegram

Mid 2010s

- Increased public dissatisfaction with advertising SMS
- Decrease in SMS demand due to the ability for mobile users to block advertising messages
- Growth of transactional SMS due to the rise of applications
- Widespread use of SMS for identity verification, authentication, and one-time passwords (OTP)


2010s
Implementation of targeted and personalized SMS campaigns
Late 2010s
Mandatory use of the “Payam Iran System” with the 4040 shortcode by executive agencies
Increased SMS usage by businesses due to internet shutdowns
Closure of Value-Added Service (VAS) through SMS
Early 2020s
Transformation of some A2P SMS providers into CPaaS (Communications Platform as a Service) providers
Presence of Mobile Virtual Network Operators (MVNO) in the SMS market
Doubling of SMS prices in the years 2022 and 2023
Mandatory inclusion of the opt-out keyword "11" in promotional messages by A2P SMS providers
Businesses increasingly using SMS for customer retention and loyalty

Products and Features of A2P SMS Providers

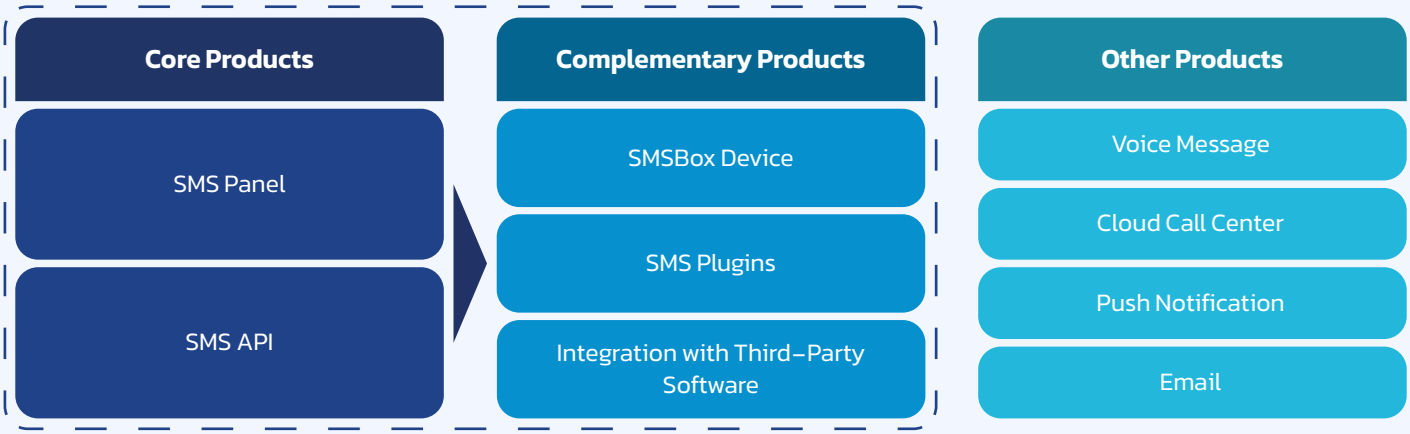
SMS panel and SMS web service are the main products offered by A2P SMS providers

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the A2P SMS industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



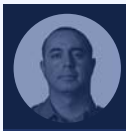
Core Products and Key Features

SMS Panel	Bulk SMS Sending (Location, City, Profession)	Geo-Targeted SMS	Surveys and Lottery	Executing A/B Test Campaigns
	Smart and Targeted SMS Sending	Group SMS Sending from Contact List	SMS Auto-Responder	Reporting
	International SMS Sending	Link Shortener	Managing Inbound SMS	
SMS API	Sending Verification and Membership Codes (OTP)	Transactional SMS Sending	Group SMS Sending	Contact Book creation
	Reporting			

The features offered in the SMS panel can also be provided to businesses as an SMS API.

Insight

Usually, large businesses prefer to receive SMS services through API.



Ardavan Sharifi

Co-Founder and CEO of Kavenegar

A significant portion of the SMS traffic in the market is sent through API infrastructure.

Products and Features of A2P SMS Providers

Some A2P SMS providers focus on integrating customer communication channels

Complementary Products and Key Features

SMSBox Device	Collecting in-person Customer Information	Connection to the SMS Panel	Connection via Wi-Fi	Launching Customer Loyalty Programs
SMS Plugins	Sending SMS through integration with open-source platforms (WordPress, WooCommerce, PrestaShop, OpenCart, etc.)			
Integration with Third-Party Software	Integration with financial and accounting software, CRM, logistics, e-commerce, and more via API.			

Insight

Some players are focusing on the brick-and-mortar market (stores) and have added an SMS-Box device to their product offerings. This device connects to the SMS panel, allowing the stored numbers to be transferred to the panel.

Other Products

Voice Message	Scheduled Sending	Voice Message Sending Up to 60 Seconds	Group Sending from Contact List	API
	Reporting	Sending One-time Passwords	Sending to Fixed Telephone Line Numbers	
Cloud Call Center	Call Grouping	Advanced Queue Management	Call Monitoring and Whispering	Dedicated Operator Panel
	Call Recording	Setting Response Time	Surveying	Reporting
Push Notification	Segmentation	Personalized Suggestions	API	
	Reporting	Scheduled Sending		
Email	Segmentation	Email Template Design and Editor Tools	Automated and Bulk Sending	Scheduled Sending
	Membership Form Builder	UTM connection	Reporting	

Insight

- Currently, SMS, cloud call center, and push notifications are not offered integrated and together by providers.
- Some providers receive other products on a white-label basis from another supplier.
- It appears that some A2P SMS providers are moving towards developing an integrated communication platform as part of their development strategy.

Comparison of Key A2P SMS Providers

The focus of development is a key differentiator for A2P SMS providers

Comparison of Key A2P SMS Providers Based on Product Variety

	Core Products		Complementary Products		Other Products			
	SMS Panel	SMS API	SMSBox Device	SMS Plugins	Voice Message	Cloud Call Center	Push Notification	Email
Mediana	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Faraz SMS	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Modir Payamak	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Kavenegar	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗
Melipayamak	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Amoot SMS	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Kandoo	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Web One SMS	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Farapayamak	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
SMS.ir	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Nik SMS	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Payam Resan	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Ghasedak	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Najva	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓
Raygan SMS	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗

*The key players listed in the table also include resellers. These players have been selected based on Google's first-page results and expert opinions.



Vahid Khosravi

Founder and CEO of SMS.ir

Some players have entered new markets and products (such as phone calls, email, push notifications, etc.) with the goal of integrating communications. Others have focused on adding new and advanced features to their SMS panels.

Comparison of Key A2P SMS Providers

Price is the most important factor for A2P SMS providers for large businesses

6 Key Criteria for Choosing an A2P SMS Provider from the Customer's Perspective

Quality of SMS Service (Speed, Uptime, Stability)	Diversity of Services and Products	Customer Support
SMS Delivery Status Report	SMS Panel Capabilities	Price of Panel and SMS



Mahbod Mortazavi

Co-founder and CMO of SnappShop

SMS price is a key factor for large businesses when choosing A2P SMS providers.

SMS Market – 2023

An 8 trillion toman SMS market in Iran

SMS Market Size – 2023

	Iran	Global*
Market Size (Actual)	8 trillion tomans (2023) (Equivalent to 160 billion SMS sent)	69.96 billion dollars (2023)

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans / 1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Size (A2P SMS): Messages automatically sent from software to mobile phones. These messages are not limited to marketing and advertising; they also include transactional SMS, OTP SMS, and more.

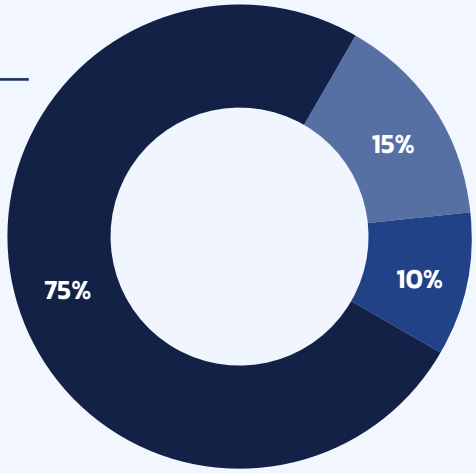
SMS Industry Structure in Iran Based on Target Market and Providers – 2023

Target Market: Banks

Providers:
- SMS Gateway Providers
- Mobile Virtual Network Operators

Insight

Banks have had the largest share of SMS sent in 2023.

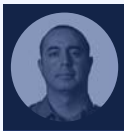


Target Market: Private Businesses (Large, Medium, and Small)

Providers:
- SMS Gateway Providers
- Mobile Virtual Network Operators
- A2P SMS Providers

Target Market: Public Sector

Providers:
- SMS Gateway Providers
- A2P SMS Providers
- Payam Iran System



Ardavan Sharifi
Co–Founder and CEO of Kavenegar

According to the Central Bank's regulations, banks are only permitted to procure SMS services from SMS gateway providers.

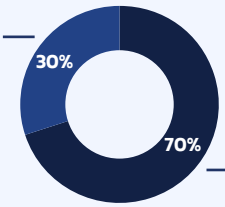
Share of Marketing and Promotional SMS from Total SMS Sent *– 2023



Sadegh Mohammadi
Co–Founder and CEO of Mediana

Compliance with Law 11 on SMS opt-out has led A2P SMS providers to shift towards sending authentication, transactional, OTP SMS, and more.

Marketing and Promotional SMS



Authentication, transactional, OTP SMS, and more

*Total SMS sent refers to the sum of SMS from banks, public sector, and private businesses.

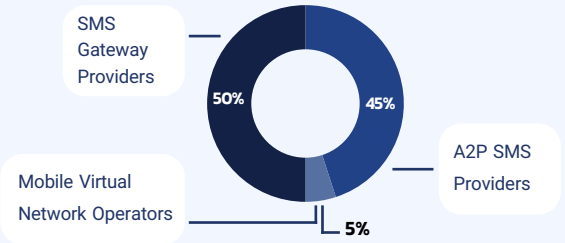
A2P SMS Providers Market in Iran – 2023

1.2 trillion toman market of A2P SMS providers

Share of Providers From Private Businesses Market (large, medium, and small), accounting for 15% of total SMS – 2023

Insight

According to experts, 45% of the SMS sent in 2023 in the private business market were handled by A2P SMS providers.



Insight

The majority of A2P SMS providers' customers are small and medium businesses.

*The share of providers is based on the number of SMS sent in 2023.

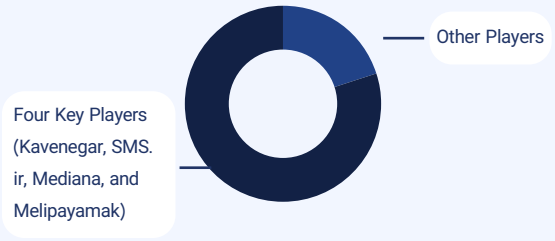
A2P SMS Market Size – 2023

Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate (2022–2023)	Market Penetration Rate in Iran
1.2 trillion toman	117%	Very Low / Low / Medium / **High** / Very High

A2P SMS Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of SMS Sent

According to experts, it appears that a significant portion (more than 70%) of the SMS sent in the A2P SMS market is handled by Kavenegar, Mediana, and Melipayamak, as well as SMS.ir.



Insight

- Mediana, Farapayamak, and Meli Payamak are major players or SMS resellers in Iran.
- Kavenegar has focused most of its efforts on the SMS web service (API).
- SMS.ir has focused on diversifying the capabilities within its SMS panel service.

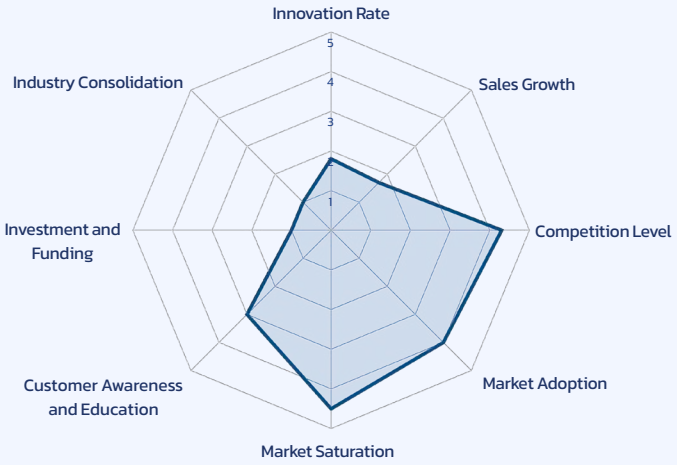
Which Businesses Use A2P SMS the Most?

Online Stores	SaaS	Stock Brokerages	Fast-Moving Consumer Goods (FMCG)	HealthTech
Educational and research institutes	Fintech	Logistics	Clinics and Medical Centers	Restaurants and Cafes

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the A2P SMS Industry – 2023

Intense competition among A2P SMS providers

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the A2P SMS Industry – 2023





Sadegh Mohammadi

Co–Founder and CEO of Mediana

The financial turnover of A2P SMS providers has always been positive due to their business model, and marketers have not yet required additional investment.



Ardavan Sharifi

Co–Founder and CEO of Kavenegar

The shrinking size of the SMS market and the presence of a large number of active competitors have led to reduced profit margins for players, creating intense competition for market share. Moreover, this has hindered the entry of new players into the market and resulted in a decline in innovation.

A2P SMS Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

Growth of targeted and personalized SMS in the near future

A2P SMS Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Sending personalized and targeted SMS using artificial intelligence	Replacement of bulk promotional SMS with personalized and targeted SMS
Increased use of SMS for receiving customer feedback	Increased use of SMS for customer loyalty and engagement
Increased use of SMS for Authentication	The ability to evaluate and measure SMS results
Increased demand from dusinesses to use SMS for customer communication as mobile penetration grows	The emergence of API providers for customer communication, including SMS, push notifications, etc.
Integration with other communication platforms like databases, messaging apps, social networks, etc.	Integration with other communication platforms like databases, messaging apps, social networks, call centers, etc.
Using Images, videos, voice, and interactive options in SMS content	Sending real-time and location-based SMS
	Change in revenue model and the ability for SMS recipients to benefit from promotional SMS
	Using artificial intelligence to generate SMS content
	Increased use of SMS for Authentication



Faramarz Saberi

CEO of Atieh Dadeh Pardaz

Location-Based SMS, recently introduced by mobile operators (Hamrah-e-Aval & Irancel), are now available but are priced higher than regular SMS.



Mehdi Dadkhah

Senior Marketing and Growth Manager at Tapsi

Measuring the efficiency and effectiveness of SMS panel data is one of the needs of business marketing teams.

Data Partners in the A2P SMS Industry

Kavenegar: A Comprehensive Platform for Effective Communication

19%
Growth in active users (2022 to 2023)

25%
Annual revenue growth (2022 to 2023)

97%
SMS delivery rate (2023)

57
Total workforce (2023)

Customer Segmentation Based on Usage

- Education
- E-commerce
- Entertainment
- Finance
- Healthcare and Medical
- Apparel
- Logistics
- Cryptocurrency
- نرم‌افزار مدیریتی

Kavenegar Introduction Link

Atieh Dadeh Pardaz: Empowering Businesses with Innovative and Digital Solutions

20+ billion
Total SMS sent (2023)

15x
Revenue growth over the past 10 years

3,000+
Total corporate clients (2002–2024)

99
Total workforce (2023)

Key Capabilities and Features

- Development of a native platform for SMS sending and receiving
- Integration and management of customer communication services
- Utilizing advanced security protocols to protect data and ensure stable performance
- Providing powerful APIs for developers

Atieh Dadeh Pardaz Introduction Link

Data Partners in the A2P SMS Industry

SMS.ir: A2P SMS provider for Businesses

45%
Growth in active users (2022 to 2023)

51%
Annual revenue growth (2022 to 2023)

97%
SMS delivery rate (2023)

91%
SMS open rate (2023)

65%
use SMS API (2023)

36
Total workforce (2023)

Notable Clients

- Snapp
- Kalleh
- Snowa
- Mashhad Leather
- Behshahr Industries Development Company
- Palladium Mall

SMS.ir Introduction Link

5

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platform

Industry Data Partner:

دیتاک
DATAAK.COM

Report Partners: SMARTECH

TECHRASA. Insight

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms – 2023

14 Iranian media monitoring and social listening platforms have been identified in the Iranian market

Companies that leverage big data and artificial intelligence to collect, process, and analyze data from online and offline media (newspapers, social media, websites, etc.). By providing statistics, charts, and infographics, they identify public and customer perceptions of brands and various topics.

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms

Tools for monitoring, collecting, processing, and quickly analyzing news, information, and content published in the media

Zelkaa | Dataak | 8tag | Lifeweb | Newsbox | Newshub | TagMiner

Trenda | Datawer | PorseshPR | Mahta | Data Maat | Netbina Telescope | PartoTech

Insight

Overall, players in media monitoring and social listening are divided into three categories: some focus on **news monitoring and analytics**, others provide **social listening** tools, and some offer both tools to businesses.

Applications of Media Monitoring and Social Listening in the Marketing Funnel

Brand awareness is one of the key applications of media monitoring and social listening



- Identifying and monitoring brand advocates who constantly promote the brand

- Monitoring and analyzing customer satisfaction by reviewing their opinions and reactions on social media

- Analyzing the customer journey and identifying touchpoints that influence the purchase stage
- Collecting and analyzing product-related feedback on social media
- Measuring the effectiveness of advertising campaigns
- Real-time response to customer issues and questions

- Identifying key influencers
- Analyzing audience sentiments and identifying their demographic and behavioral traits
- Identifying effective content through performance analysis of brand-generated content

- Brand monitoring by tracking brand mentions across social media platforms
- Identifying and analyzing trending topics and hashtags relevant to the brand's industry
- Competitor analysis to understand market positioning

Timeline and Milestones of Media Monitoring and Social Listening in Iran and the World

The 2010s marked the peak of media monitoring and social listening development in Iran



Products and Features of Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms

Platform have added social media management tools to their products

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the media monitoring and social listening platforms industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Core Products and Key Features

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Tools	Bulletin Maker for Online and Offline Media	Monitoring the Front Pages of Newspapers and Magazines	Real–Time Monitoring of Media and Social Media	Analytical Reporting Tool
	Media Crisis Management	Comparing Brand Profile Performance with Competitors	Identifying & Monitoring Influencers	Alert
	Audience Demographic Analysis Tool (Age Groups, Etc.)	Monitoring Hot Posts & Breaking News	Audience Sentiment Analysis Tool	Campaign Design And Analysis Tool

Complementary Products and Key Features

Social Media Management Tools	Reply to Comments	Build a Library of Content Ideas
	Admin Performance Evaluation	Content Scheduling and Publishing

Comparison of Key Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms

Most players cover both online and offline channels

Comparison of Key Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms by Channels

	Instagram	Twitter	Telegram	YouTube	Newspapers	News Websites	Radio and Television	Domestic Messaging Platforms (e.g., Eitaa, Bale, etc.)
Zelkaa	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Dataak	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
8tag	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Lifeweb	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✓
Newsbox	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✓
Newshub	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗

*Key players have been selected based on Google first-page results and expert opinions.

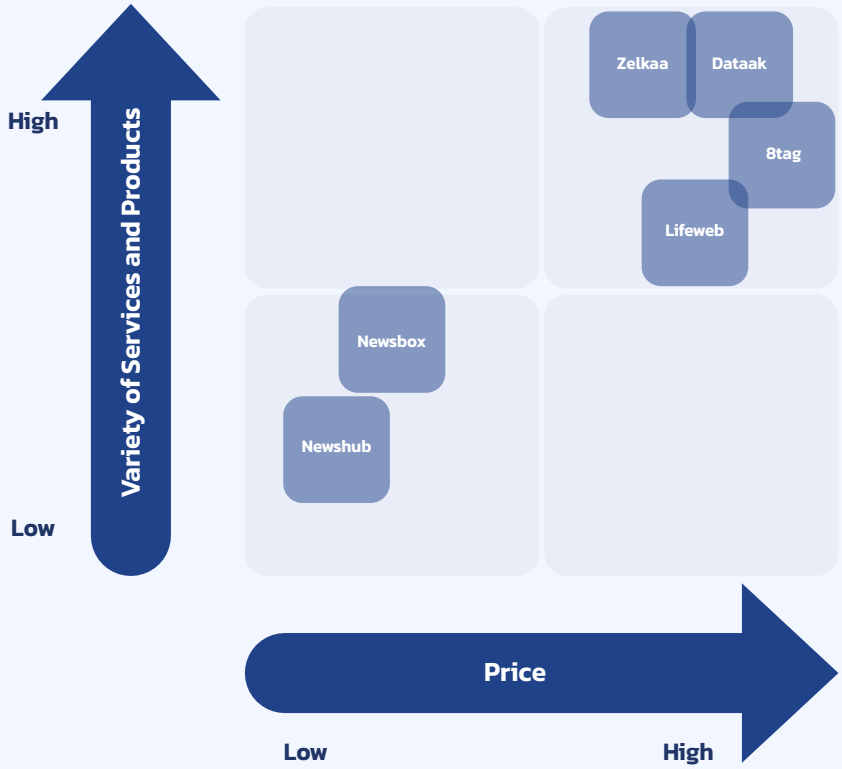
Comparison of Key Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms

The volume and depth of data are key factors that distinguish platforms

4 Key Criteria for Choosing a Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platform from the Customer's Perspective

- Number of Channels Covered
- Data Volume and Depth
- Variety of Services and Products
- Ease of Use

Comparison of Key Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms – 2023



Insight

Zelka focuses on marketing teams, while **Dataak**, **Lifeweb**, and **8tag** focus on public relations for large and public sector organizations.

Insight

NewsHub focuses on news monitoring, while other players also offer social listening.

Insight

Some players focus on small businesses, while others target large and public sector.



Amir Hossein Asgari

Co-founder and CEO of Dataak

Players in this field differ based on data depth (the volume of data they analyze) and AI-driven analytical tools.

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Market – 2023

4 players hold 80% of the media monitoring and social listening market

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	70–80 billion tomans	25%
Global*	4.6 billion dollars (2023)	17%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

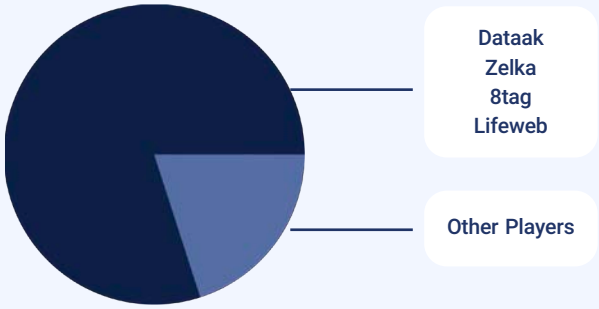
Very Low | Low | Medium | High | Very High

*Since Iranian players cover a wide range of media (both offline and online), media monitoring tools have been considered in calculating the global market size.

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Customers

In this market, the structure is such that four players hold 80% of the market, and the rest is distributed among other players.



Which Businesses Use Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms the Most?

- Public Sector
- Online Businesses
- Major Brands
- Steel, Oil, and Petrochemical
- Advertising Agencies
- Universities and Research Institutes



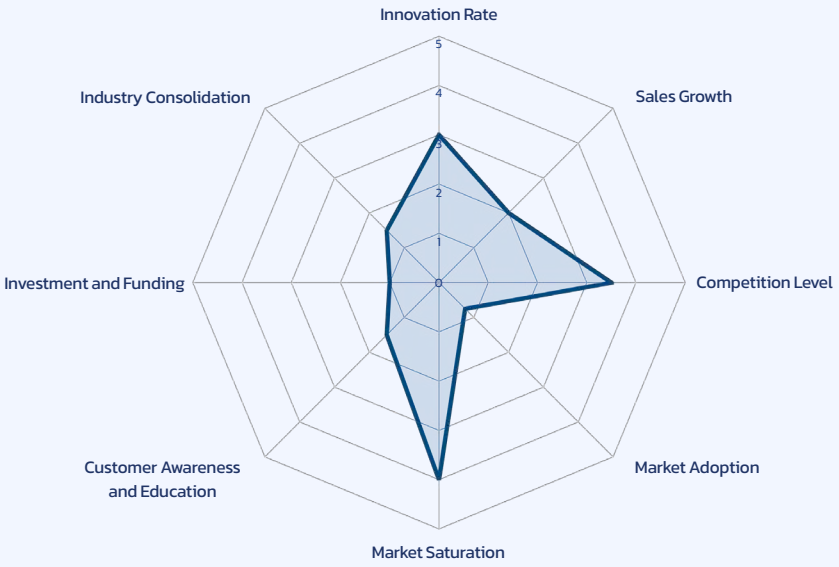
Sina Masihpour
Co-founder and CEO of Zelkaa

Medium and small companies typically do not use media monitoring and social listening tools. Large B2C companies use these tools for market research.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Industry – 2023

The small market size has led to increased competition among existing players

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Industry – 2023





Sina Masihpour

Co-founder and CEO of Zelkaa

The market for media monitoring and social listening tools is highly dependent on major brands' advertising. Typically, large businesses use these tools to analyze brand awareness and measure advertising effectiveness. As a result, the more prominent the advertising market, the higher the demand for these tools.

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

Providing customized analyses of the most important trends in this industry in Iran and globally

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Utilizing advanced tools for social media analysis	Leveraging AI and machine learning to enhance usability
Utilizing AI and machine learning technologies	Providing personalized reports to users and reducing the need for data analysts in businesses
Providing multilingual monitoring capabilities, especially for businesses aiming to enter global markets	Utilizing advanced analytical and predictive tools
Providing visual content recognition capabilities for analyzing non-text-based content	
Offering customized dashboards and real-time reports	
Focus on influencer monitoring and analysis	



Meysam Mollasharify

CMO at Snapp Group

Providing customized reports is one of the key business needs for using social listening tools.

Data Partner in the Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platforms Industry

Dataak: A Media Monitoring and Social Listening Tool

The Importance of Social Listening Tools

4,500+ billion
Total content impressions on social media (2023)

24+ billion
Total impressions of content related to Iranian brands (2023)

Dataak Capabilities

- Extensive coverage in content aggregation
- AI-powered analytical insights optimized for Persian language
- Design and delivery of tailored solutions for marketing, public relations, and sentiment analysis

Dataak's Future Outlook

Creating a Unique Experience by Adding AI-Powered Features

- Aspect-based Sentiment Analysis
- Content Juicer
- Dataak Assistant

Dataak Introduction Link

6

Social Media Analytics and Management Platform

Industry Data Partner:

نوین‌هاب

Report Partners: SMARTECH قاصدک

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Social Media Analytics and Management Platform

Cost and time savings for businesses through social media analytics and management tools

These tools allow businesses to organize social media accounts in a single dashboard, offering features such as content creation, scheduling and publishing, responding to comments, managing admins, and analyzing social media pages.

Which Players Provide Social Media Analytics and Management Tools in Iran?

Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms

Players in this category specifically focus on social media management and analytics tools. Some of them cover all social media, while others focus on a single social media.

Media Monitoring and Social Listening Platform

Players in this category offer social media management and analytics tools as one of their features to businesses.

This chapter of the report will provide a deeper analysis of social media management and analytics platforms. The other category will be discussed in a separate chapter.

Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms – 2023

6 Iranian and 3 foreign social media analytics and management platforms have been identified in the Iranian market

Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms

Organizing social media accounts in a single dashboard with a variety of features

Social Media Analytics and Management Tools for All Social Media

Iranian Tools

- NovinHub
- Modirhub
- Behinhub

Foreign Tools Used in the Iranian Market

- Buffer
- Hootsuite

Instagram Analysis Tools

Iranian Tools

- Sanjab
- Coco
- wefollow

Foreign Tools Used in the Iranian Market

- Not Just Analytics

Insight

Despite the high potential of Iran's social media market, few players are active. Social media filtering in recent years, particularly Instagram in 2022, has caused many businesses to close, increasing the risk for new entrants.

Applications of Social Media Analytics and Management in the Marketing Funnel

Social media analytics and management platforms are mainly used in awareness and consideration stages



Timeline and Milestones of Social Media Analytics and Management in Iran and the World

In the late 2010s, Iranian Social media analytics and management tools began to be adopted by businesses

World **Iran**

2000s

- The need for social media management with the rise of Facebook, YouTube, and Twitter
- The emergence of the first social media management tools focusing on post scheduling and planning
- The launch of the first comprehensive social media management tool (Hootsuite)
- The ability to manage multiple social media platforms from a single dashboard

Late 2010s

- The growth of social media management and analytics tools
- The launch of Buffer aimed at simplifying content scheduling and publishing
- The beginning of integration with other tools and software

Mid 2010s

- The widespread adoption of Telegram
- The initial development of Iranian social media management tools
- The launch of "Toolgram" as a Telegram management tool

Late 2010s

- The emergence of the first Iranian social media management tools (like Novinhub
- The launch of the first social media analytics tool (Neolyze)
- Neolyze raising investment from the NovinTech accelerator
- Novinhub raising investment from Yektanet
- The launch of Tagrowlyze
- Toolgram acquired by Tapsell

Early 2020s

- Adoption of AI and machine learning
- Transformation of social media management tools into comprehensive platforms

Early 2020s

- Novinhub's second round of investment from Yektanet and Bahman Capital
- Filtering of Instagram and WhatsApp in Iran
- Shutdown of numerous social media tools (including Neolyze, Tagrowlyze, and Tike Abi)
- Introduction of automated response features to social media management and analytics tools

Products and Features of Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms

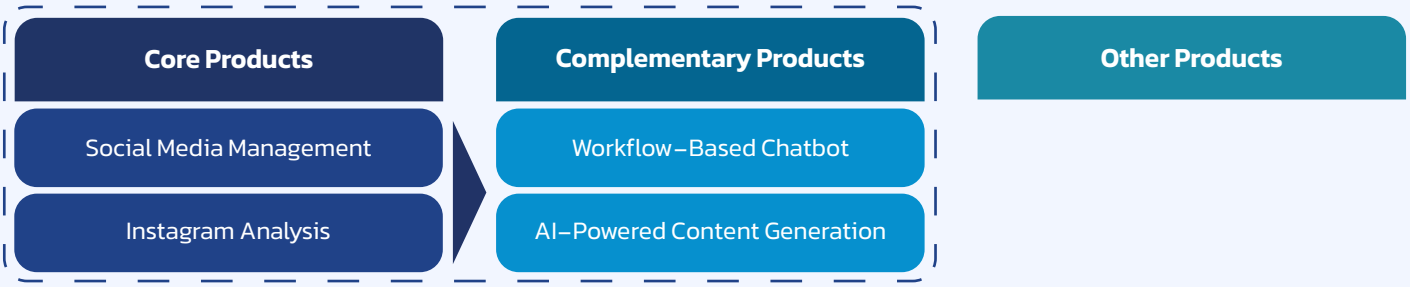
The use of artificial intelligence by social media analytics and management platforms

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the social media analytics and management platforms industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Insight

Players focus exclusively on enhancing their tools rather than expanding into other industries.

Core Products and Key Features

Social Media Management	Content Scheduling and Publishing	Downloading All Comments	Team Collaboration Features
	Automated Responses	Social Media Analytics	
Instagram Analysis	Key Metrics Analysis	Search and Filter Influencers	
	Analyzing Competitors	Page and Hashtag Search	

Complementary Products and Key Features

Workflow–Based Chatbot	Automated Responses	Product Showcase Link	Form Builder	Reminder Messages
	Menu Creation	Follow Rules	Data Export	
AI–Powered Content Generation	Automated Caption Generation	Text Refining	Automated Hashtag Generation	Automated Responses
	Quote Generation	List of Pros and Cons	Tone Selection	Multilingual Captions

Comparison of Key Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms

Categorizing social media analytics and management platforms into two types

Comparison of Key Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms Based on Product Variety

		Core Products		Complementary Products	
		Social Media Management	Instagram Analysis	Workflow–Based Chatbot	AI–Powered Content Generation
Tools for Managing and Analyzing All Social Media Platforms	NovinHub	✓	✗	✓	✓
	Modirhub	✓	✗	✗	✗
	Behinhab	✓	✗	✗	✗
Tools for Instagram Analysis	Sanjab	✗	✓	✗	✗
	Wefollow	✗	✓	✗	✗
	CoCo	✗	✓	✗	✓

Insight

NovinHub covers all domestic and international social media platforms. Sanjab, Wefollow, and CoCo are focused on Instagram.

6 Key Criteria for Choosing a Social Media Analytics and Management Platform from the Customer's Perspective

- Ease of use
- Coverage of All Social Media Platforms
- Variety of Services and Features
- Integration with Other Software
- Customer Support
- Price

Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms Market – 2023

The 35 billion toman market for social media analytics and management platforms in Iran

Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	35 billion tomans	-*
Global	23.5 billion dollars (2023)	21%

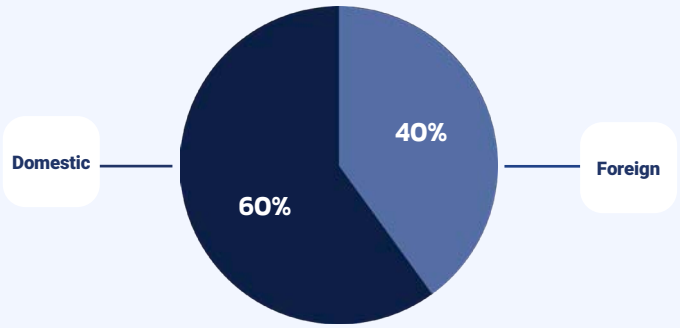
1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran



*Due to the small number of players, it is not possible to discuss the annual growth rate of the social media analytics and management market. Additionally, some of the social media analytics and management platforms are moving towards chatbots, driving change and transformation in this market.

Share of Domestic and Foreign Platforms Usage in Iran



Which Businesses Use Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms the Most?

News Media	Social Commerce	Construction	Advertising Agencies
Public Sector	Bloggers	Brands	Startups

Data Partner in the Social Media Analytics and Management Platforms Industry

NovinHub: A Comprehensive Tool for Managing All Social Media from One Dashboard

3+ million
Published content (2023)

100,000+
Accounts linked to the platform (2023)

13
Supported social media platforms and messaging apps (local & international)

Notable Clients

Mobinnet | ZarinPal | Divar | Digikala

Key Features and Capabilities

- Content Scheduling and Publishing
- Message and Comment Management
- Instagram and Telegram Automated Responses
- Social Media Analytics
- AI-Powered Content Generation
- Team Management

NovinHub Introduction Link

7

Online Form Builder and Survey Software

Industry Data Partner:

Porsline

Report Partners: SMARTECH ibuaqb

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Definition of Online Form Builder and Survey Software

Many tools and software offer a form builder as a feature

Form builders are tools that enable the creation of **various forms** online without **technical knowledge.** These forms are typically used to collect data and information from different internal and external stakeholders.

Which Players Provide Form Builders in Iran?

Live Chat, Chatbots, and Smart Direct Messaging	Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) Software	Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Software	Human Resources Software	Advertising Networks (Lead Generation)
Restaurant Management Software	E-commerce Platforms and Website Builders	Financial and Accounting Software	Distribution Management Software	Marketing Automation Platforms
Office Automation Software	WordPress Plugins	Customer Service Management Software (Help Desk)	Online Form Builder and Survey Software	

Many of the players and software mentioned above, along with other tools, offer form builders as **one of their features**.

This chapter focuses on players that **independently** offer online form builder tools. Independent **online quiz makers** and **invoice generators** have also **not been included** in the analysis.

Insight

Globally, form builders are used as tools for **interactive content**. They are also among the features utilized in customer experience management tools. However, since **customer experience management** tools do not exist in Iran, form builders are also considered tools for managing customer experience.

Online Form Builder and Survey Software Providers– 2023

17 Iranian and 3 foreign online form builders have been identified in the Iranian market

Online Form Builder and Survey Software Providers

Provider of online form-building tools without the need for programming knowledge

Foreign Online Form Builders and Survey Software Used in the Iranian Market

- Question Pro
- Typeform
- Google Forms

Iranian Online Form Builders and Survey Software

- Porsline
- Ucheck
- Avalform
- ePoll
- Porsall
- Formafzar
- DigiSurvey
- Pendargan
- Digiform
- Fomool
- Nazarban
- Upkook
- Porsa
- Online Forms
- VForm
- Porseshname Online
- Sanjup

Applications of Online Form Builder and Survey Software in the Marketing Funnel

Form builders can be used at all stages of the marketing funnel

Form builders are general tools that all individuals and companies can use for applications such as human resources, research, etc. In this section, only their marketing applications have been considered.





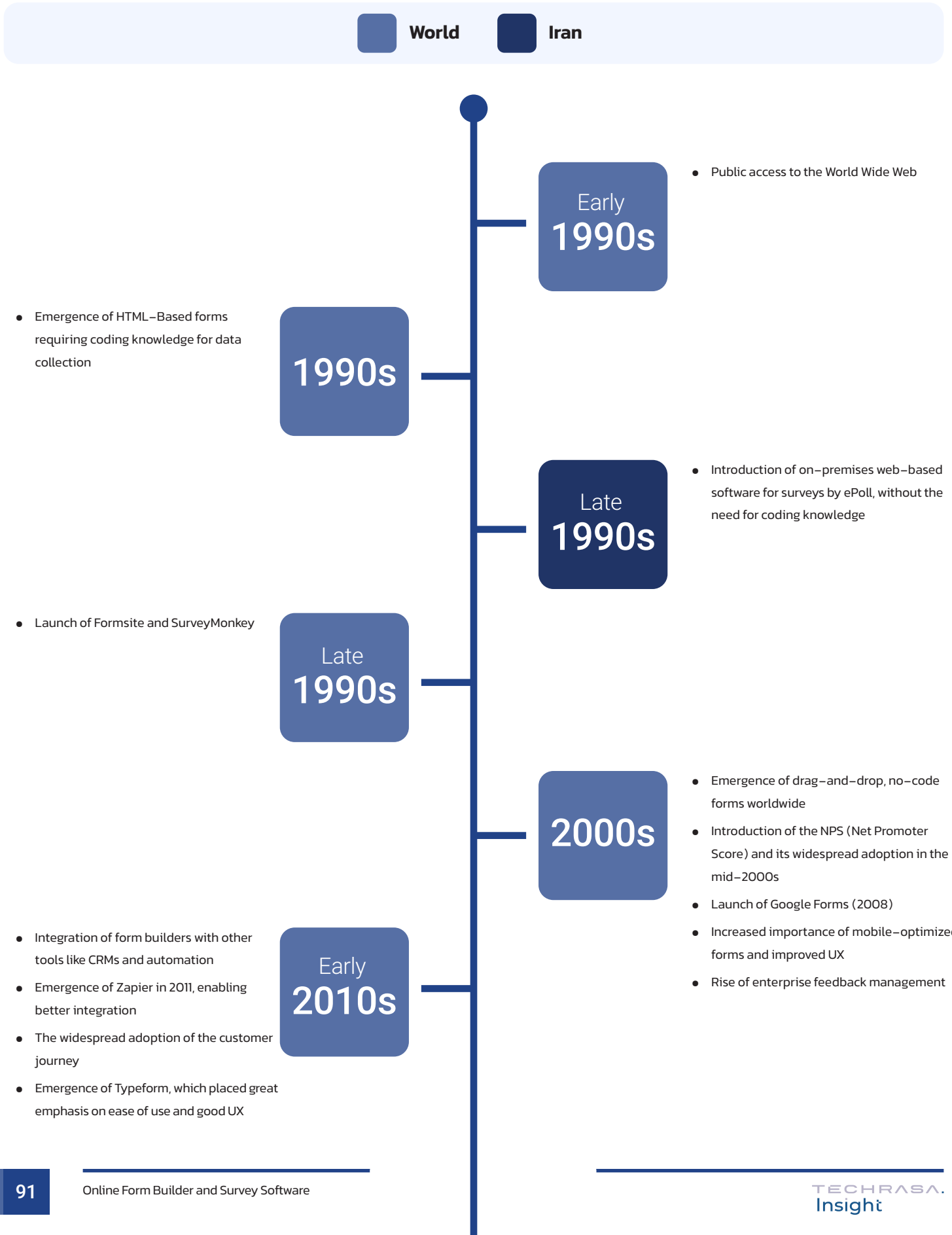
Tohid Aliashrafi

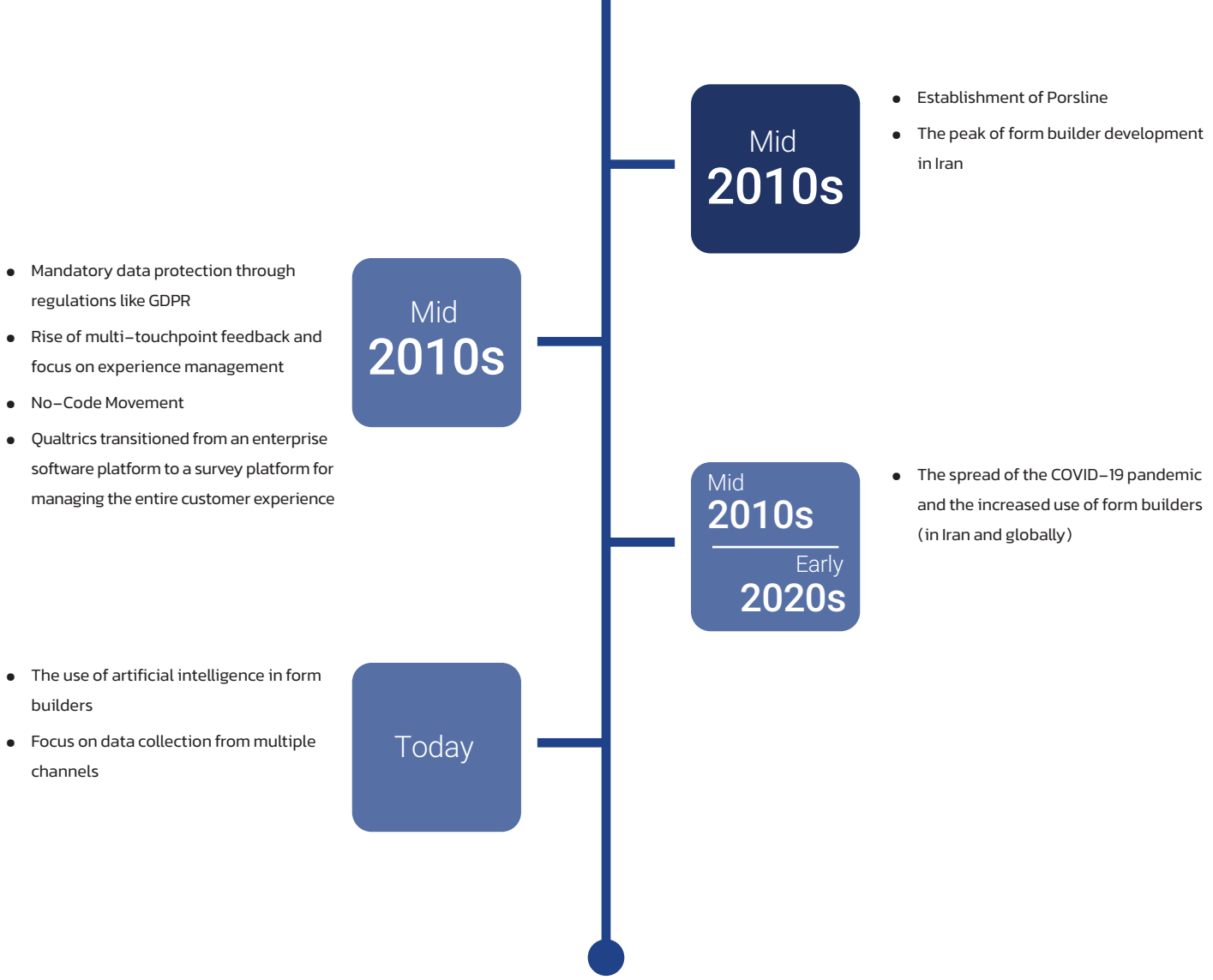
CEO of Alibaba Travels & Former Vice President of Marketing at Alibaba Group

One of my recommendations to all marketers is that your most frequently used tool should be the form builder because it helps you throughout the entire marketing and sales process to identify your target audience, their preferences, satisfaction levels, and areas for improvement, allowing you to enhance and optimize your work.

Timeline and Milestones of Online Form Builder and Survey Software in Iran and the World

The mid-2010s marked the peak of form builders' emergence in Iran




Mid
2010s
Establishment of Porsline
The peak of form builder development in Iran
Mid
2010s
Mandatory data protection through regulations like GDPR
Rise of multi-touchpoint feedback and focus on experience management
No-Code Movement
Qualtrics transitioned from an enterprise software platform to a survey platform for managing the entire customer experience
Mid
2010s
Early
2020s
The spread of the COVID-19 pandemic and the increased use of form builders (in Iran and globally)
Today
The use of artificial intelligence in form builders
Focus on data collection from multiple channels

Products and Features of Online Form Builder and Survey Software Providers

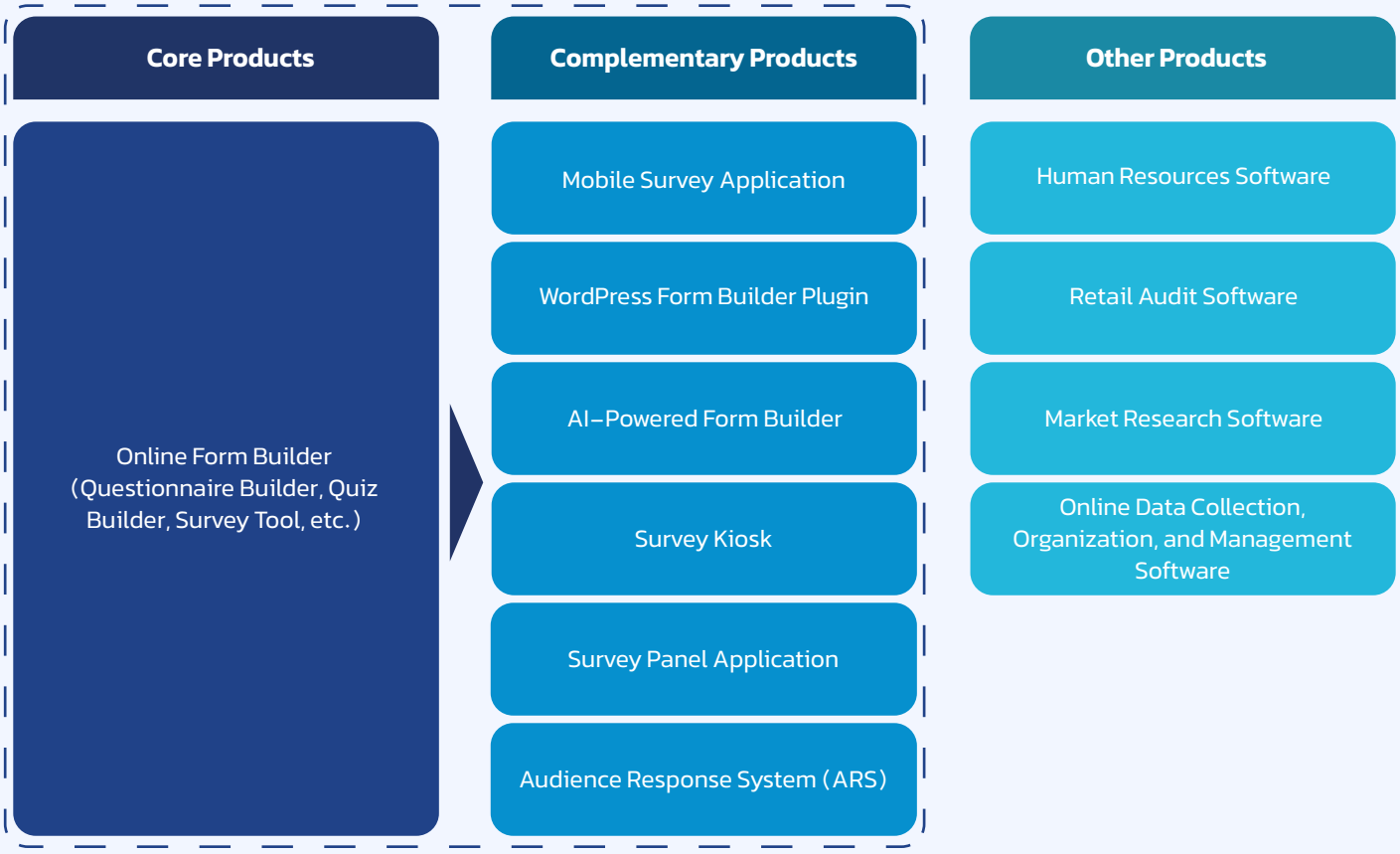
The online form builder is the core product in this industry

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the online form builder and survey software industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



* After creating a questionnaire, users can define their target audience for survey responses, and the questionnaire will be distributed among individuals with the selected characteristics.

Some players have **differentiated form builders** based on their various applications, giving names such as questionnaire builder, quiz builder, invoice generator, etc. However, since the mechanism for all these tools is **the same** and they are accessible through a **single dashboard**, they are considered a single product here.

Products and Features of Online Form Builder and Survey Software Providers

Variety of complementary products sets form-building industry players apart

Core Products and Key Features

Online Form Builder (Questionnaire Builder, Quiz Builder, Survey Tool, etc.)	Form Creation (Various Question Types, Themes, Settings, etc.)	Form Distribution (Various Methods Such as Links, etc.)
	Reporting (Analytics and Visual Reports, etc.)	Integration (With Zapier and Other Marketing Tools)

The form builder product's features are categorized generally, without delving into details.

Complementary Products and Key Features

Mobile Survey Application	Offline Data Collection	Field Agent Location Tracking	Field Agent Management	Integration With Survey Software
	Multi-Form Publishing on a Single App	Cloud Data Storage	Multi-Device Compatibility (Mobile, Tablet, and Kiosk)	
WordPress Form Builder Plugin	Creating and Managing Forms Within WordPress			
AI-Powered Form Builder	Building Questionnaires Using AI	Data Analysis and Processing Using AI		
	Text Classification	Text Sentiment Analysis Using AI		
Survey Kiosk	Offline Data Collection	Portable Design		
	Compatible With 10-Inch Tablets	No Operator Required		
Survey Panel Application	Target Group Selection for Form Distribution			
	Response Accuracy Validation			
Audience Response System (ARS)	Live Display of Responses and Submitted Answers	Ability to Display and Upload Questions From Microsoft PowerPoint		
	Real-Time Display of Connected Users	Ability to Manage Questions by the Host		

Some players also offer complementary services such as data analysis and conducting surveys.

Comparison of Online Form Builder and Survey Software Providers

Complementary products and different markets are key differentiators for form builders

Comparison of Online Form Builders and Survey Software Providers Based on Product Variety

	Online Form Builder	Mobile Survey Application	WordPress Form Builder Plugin	AI-Powered Form Builder	Survey Panel Application	Survey Kiosk	Audience Response System (ARS)
Porsline	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Formafzar	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Formool	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Digiform	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Avalform	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
DigiSurvey	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
ePoll	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Ucheck	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗
Nazarban	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Upkook	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Pendargan	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Porsall	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Porsa	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Sanjup	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
VForm	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Online Forms	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Porseshname Online	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗

Players in this field have little differentiation in their core product. Therefore, their complementary products or services, or their focus on a specific market or application, are what can set them apart.

Insight

Some players focus on increasing the variety of complementary products and services, while others prioritize enhancing and developing the core product.

Comparison of Online Form Builder and Survey Software Providers

Complementary products and different markets are key differentiators for form builders

Insight

- Among the reviewed players, **Porsline** holds the largest market share based on the number of users, making it the market leader. It has also expanded its operations to other countries.
- Globally, **online survey software** and **survey panel providers** are two complementary business types that often work together. In Iran, Sanjup provides both a form builder and a survey panel, enabling the distribution of questionnaires to target audiences, and has taken steps to manage the distribution process itself.
- Ucheck has added AI features to its product and also offers survey kiosk.
- Formafzar is another product from Farsicom Information Technology Company, which also provides CRM software and interactive voice response (IVR) systems.
- Additionally, ePoll and Pendargan focus more on field market research, and Porsa focuses on scientific research. Furthermore, ePoll is one of the oldest players in this field, offering on-premises form builder services since 1998.

6 Key Criteria for Choosing an Online Form Builder and Survey Software from the Customer's Perspective



Online Form Builders and Survey Software Providers Market – 2023

All online and offline businesses are potential markets for form builders

Online Form Builders and Survey Software Providers Market Size – 2023

	Market size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	30 to 50 billion tomans	60% to 80% (Revenue Growth Rate)
Global	3.46 billion dollars (2023)	–

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

Potential Market for Online Form Builders and Survey Software

- Small Businesses and Trade Units
- Digital Businesses (E-commerce)
- Instagram Shops (Social Commerce)
- Healthcare Centers
- Tourism
- Educational Centers (Universities, Schools, etc.), Students, and Professors
- Factories and Manufacturing Businesses



Javad Boroujerdi
CEO at ePoll

Due to the availability of free tools like Google Forms and the adoption of the freemium business model by most form builders, many customers do not pay for this product. Therefore, part of the revenue for form builders comes from other services and products, customized and enterprise plans, or providing on-premises solutions.

Online Form Builders and Survey Software Providers Market – 2023

All online and offline businesses are potential markets for form builders

Online Form Builders and Survey Software Providers Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Three-Month Website Visits

* Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	Porsline with more than 60% market share
Challenger	
Follower	FormAfzar, DigiForm, and DigiSurvey
Nicher	ePoll

Some players in this industry focus on offering on-premises solutions. However, in this section, the market structure is based solely on website visits and online products, and on-premises solutions have not been considered.

What Are the Main Use Cases of Online Form Builders and Survey Software?

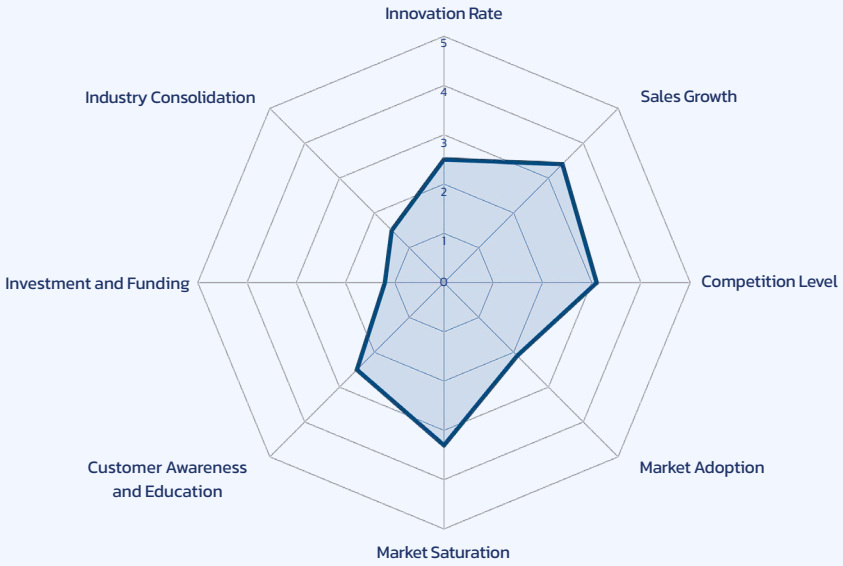
- Human Resources
- Marketing
- Market Research
- Distribution and Logistics
- Scientific Research
- Customer Management
- Public and Cultural Relations
- Examinations

Online form builders, due to their diverse applications, can be used across all industries and company sizes.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Online Form Builders and Survey Software Industry – 2023

The level of competition in this industry is moderate

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Online Form Builders and Survey Software Industry – 2023





Farokh Shahabi

Co–Founder and CEO of Formaloo

For growth and development, online form builders can pursue vertical expansion by enhancing their products and services, such as offering data analytics. Alternatively, they can expand horizontally by broadening their offerings to include tools like CRM systems.

Insight

Entering the online form builder industry does not involve significant **technological** complexity or high costs. However, the **small market size**, **product similarity**, **competitive intensity**, and **market structure** leave no reason for new entrants to enter this market unless their product offers a unique value proposition.

Outlook for the Online Form Builders and Survey Software Industry

Shifting focus from data collection to experience management

For decades, forms and surveys have been used to measure and manage **customer experience**. While surveys remain a reliable tool for gathering customer insights, they are no longer sufficient or suitable as a standalone method for measuring **customer experience (CX) performance** and identifying and acting on CX opportunities.

Improving customer experience by collecting data from various sources and touchpoints

Today, with access to diverse customer data and its analysis, along with **feedback** and criticisms gathered from **various sources** and the monitoring of **different channels**, customer experience can be measured more accurately. Based on this, various strategies can be developed to enhance the customer experience.

The Difference Between Survey Software and Customer Experience Management Platforms (CXM)

	Survey Software	Customer Experience Management (CXM)
Goal	Collecting data from a wide range of respondents	Managing and reviewing all aspects of customer interactions with the business
Application	Wide range of applications, including customer satisfaction, tests, market research, etc	Improving customer journey and increasing satisfaction and loyalty
Core Features	Form and survey design, sharing capabilities, pre-built campaigns, basic-level analysis	Customer journey analysis, customer feedback monitoring, personalized strategies
Integration Level	Low integration capabilities	High integration capabilities with numerous tools and software
Focus	Data collection	Improving customer experience
Target Audience	Wide range of audiences, including businesses, researchers, educational institutions, etc	Medium and large businesses
Examples	Google Forms, Typeform	qualtrics XM, ORACLE CUSTOMER EXPERIENCE CLOUD



Hamidreza Nazari
Founder of Porsline

Globally, the need for customer experience management has arisen from the market. In Iran, this need is somewhat observed, but given Iran's economy and the relatively small number of very large organizations, customer experience platforms are not as needed or prioritized in Iran as they are globally.

Online Form Builders and Survey Software Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

AI and integration are among the most important trends in this industry in Iran and globally

Online Form Builders and Survey Software Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Low-code and no-code platforms for creating complex forms without the need for programming knowledge	Integration with other software and tools such as CRM
Advanced data analysis and real-time, personalized reporting	Using AI to create forms and generate reports with greater speed and accuracy
Integration with other software and tools such as CRM, email marketing, etc.	Low-code and no-code platforms for creating complex forms without the need for programming knowledge
Using AI to enhance user experience, improve accuracy, and automate processes	
Interactive form builders that allow multiple users in an organization to work on a form simultaneously	
Human-centered and personalized interaction through data collection using video forms	
Mobile-optimized forms that simplify both form creation and responses via mobile	
Customization and alignment of form builders with customer branding	
Focus on improving user experience with simple and functional design for both customers and respondents	

Data Partner in the Online Form Builder and Survey Software Industry

Porsline: Online Form Builder and Survey Software

300,000+
Daily responses from customer audiences

50,000+
Customers

1.5+ million
Users across the Middle East, including Iran, Saudi Arabia, Turkey, UAE, Oman, Egypt, and Iraq

Available Languages

- Persian
- English
- Turkish
- Arabic

Notable Clients

- Hamrah e Aval
- Tapsi
- Digikala

45 million
people in Iran have responded to forms built with Porsline

Porsline Introduction Link

8

Live Chat and Chatbot

Industry Data Partners:

raychat

گپیفای

نوین‌هاب

Report Partners:

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Definition of Live Chat and Chatbot

Text-based chat tool for sales and customer service

These players help businesses respond to potential customers' questions through text-based conversations (chat) at any time of day and instantly, converting them into customers.

Which Players Offer Live Chat and Chatbot in Iran?

AI-Based Companies | Call Center Providers | Live Chat Providers | Chatbot Providers

*Main focus of this report is on the players offering live chat and chatbots, and other players are not examined.

AI-Based Companies	They use deep learning and AI technologies to design and develop products like chatbots, image processing, text generation, etc. These companies focus on large organizations. Examples include: Amer Andish Houshmand, Roshan, Artin, Part Artificial Intelligence Research Center, Asre Gooyesh Pardaz, Ahd, Dadeh Kavan Sharif, Gata, and more.
Call Center Providers	Call center providers that have added live chat to their product offerings. It appears that some have developed live chat in-house, while others offer this service through integration with live chat tools. Examples include Navatel, TelSi, Viping, Hamkal, and others.
Live Chat Providers	Businesses' support staff can have live, real-time conversations with their users and customers. The conversation happens between the operator and the user.
Chatbot Providers	Businesses can respond to user and customer inquiries automatically without the need for support staff (operator). The conversation occurs between the bot and the user.

Insight

Large B2B companies tend to prefer using call center providers' services to implement their live chat solutions. Additionally, these companies often opt for on-premises solutions to ensure data security and service stability.

Live Chat and Chatbot Providers – 2023

15 Iranian and 5 foreign live chat and chatbot providers have been identified in the Iranian market

Live Chat Providers

Live and instant responses to user inquiries through support staff (operator).

Iranian Providers

Goftino, Raychat, Livechatify, Injaneb, Gapify, HiHelp, FlowChat

Foreign Providers Used in the Iranian Market

Crisp, Tidio, Smartsupp, Tawk

Insight

Some businesses do not use live chat and chatbot on their websites. Instead, they directly integrate their Telegram and WhatsApp accounts into their websites to interact with customers.

Chatbot Providers

Fast and instant responses to user inquiries without the need for support staff (operator).

Iranian Providers

Muchat, FlowChat, Yarabot, Gapify, Danabot, Chaata, Directam, Inibots, Inboxino, NovinHub, Raychat, HiHelp

*This map includes players with a distinct brand and does not include companies that provide AI infrastructure.

Foreign Providers Used in the Iranian Market

Manychat**

** Iranian businesses use Manychat to respond automatically to every message.

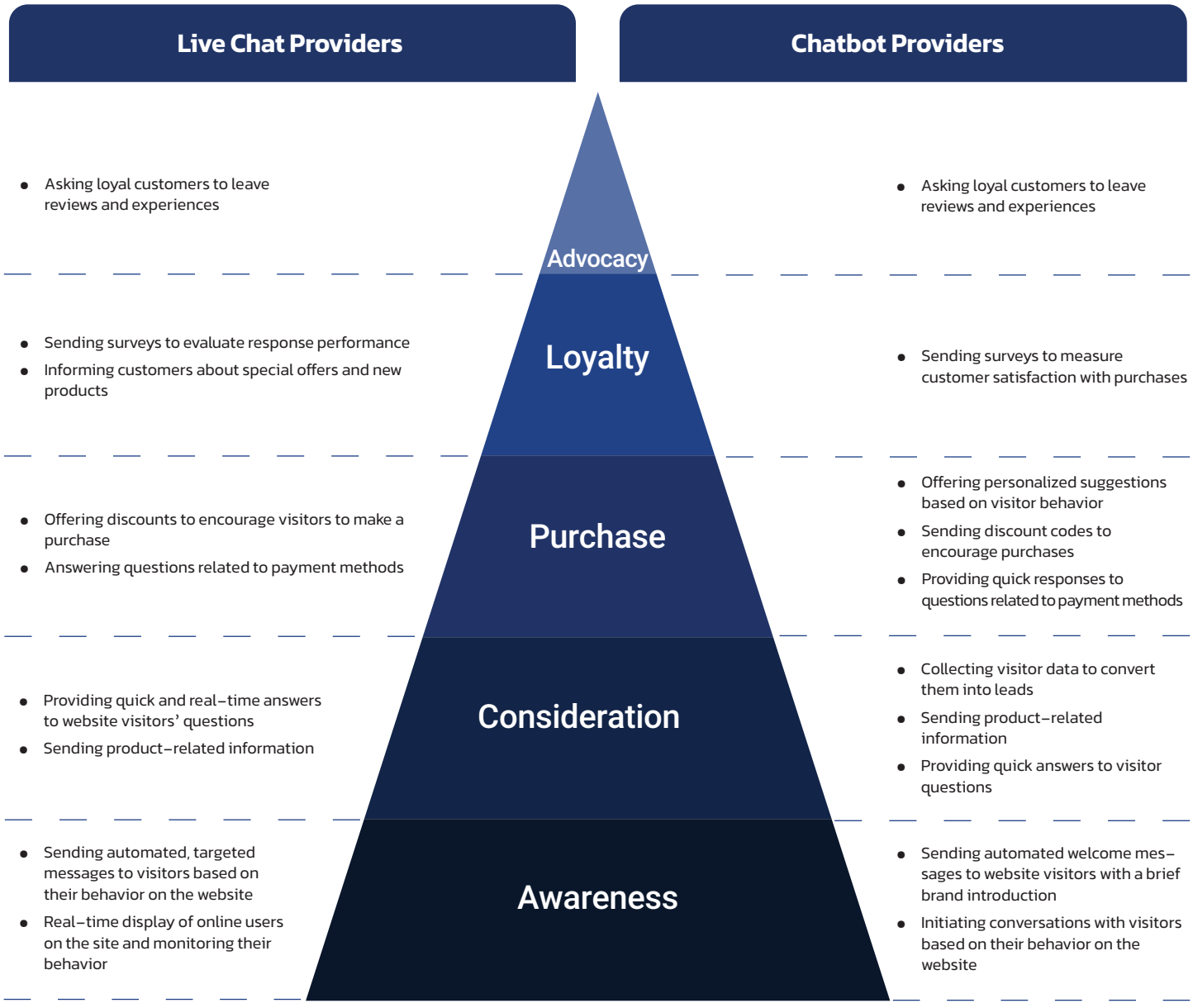
Insight

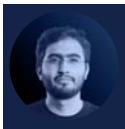
Some chatbots enable users to connect with human operators by integrating with live chat. However, others (such as Raychat, Gapify, HiHelp, and FlowChat) have developed their own live chat.

Applications of Live Chat and Chatbots in the Marketing Funnel

Sales and customer support are the key applications of live chat and chatbots

Live chat is not just a tool for customer service; it also aids sales by leveraging data collected from customers. Chatbots, in addition to supporting customer service and sales, can be utilized wherever there is a need for question-and-answer interactions, such as in human resources.





Mohammad Javad Aboutalebi
Co-founder of Gapify

Although chatbots are mainly used for customer service in various industries like e-commerce and fintech, in the future, we expect to see their use in the early stages of the marketing funnel (especially in sales). In fact, businesses are inclined to use chatbots as sales assistants.

Timeline and Milestones of Live Chat and Chatbot in Iran and the World

The first Iranian chat tools began operating in the mid-2010s

World Iran

2000s

- Emergence of the first live chats
- The need for businesses to have real-time communication with customers
- Integration of live chats into business websites
- Growth in the use of live chats by businesses
- Introduction of advanced features by live chats, such as chat history, file sharing, and more

Early 2010s

- Adoption of foreign live chat tools by Iranian businesses, such as Crisp and JivoChat

Mid 2010s

- Launch of the first Iranian live chat tools
- Ritin live chat raising investment from the Avatech accelerator

Late 2010s

- Addition of behavior-based messaging features to live chats
- Growth of the live chat market due to the strong presence of businesses online
- Addition of the form builder feature to live chats

2010s

- Entry of AI-based chatbots into the market
- Answering simple customer questions by chatbots
- Enhanced chatbot capabilities in understanding, processing questions, and providing accurate responses

Early 2020s

- Integration of chatbots with popular messaging platforms like Facebook and Slack
- Integration with other customer communication channels (such as email, social media, etc.)

Early 2020s

- Ritin Shutdown
- Integration of Telegram and WhatsApp with live chats
- Enabling automated responses by live chats
- Launch of the first Iranian chatbot tools
- FlowChat raising seed investment from Diginext
- Launch of the first automated response tools for Instagram (Directem and NovinHub)
- Filtering of Instagram and WhatsApp
- Mochat raising seed investment
- NovinHub unveiling automated response for Telegram

Products and Features of Live Chat and Chatbot Providers

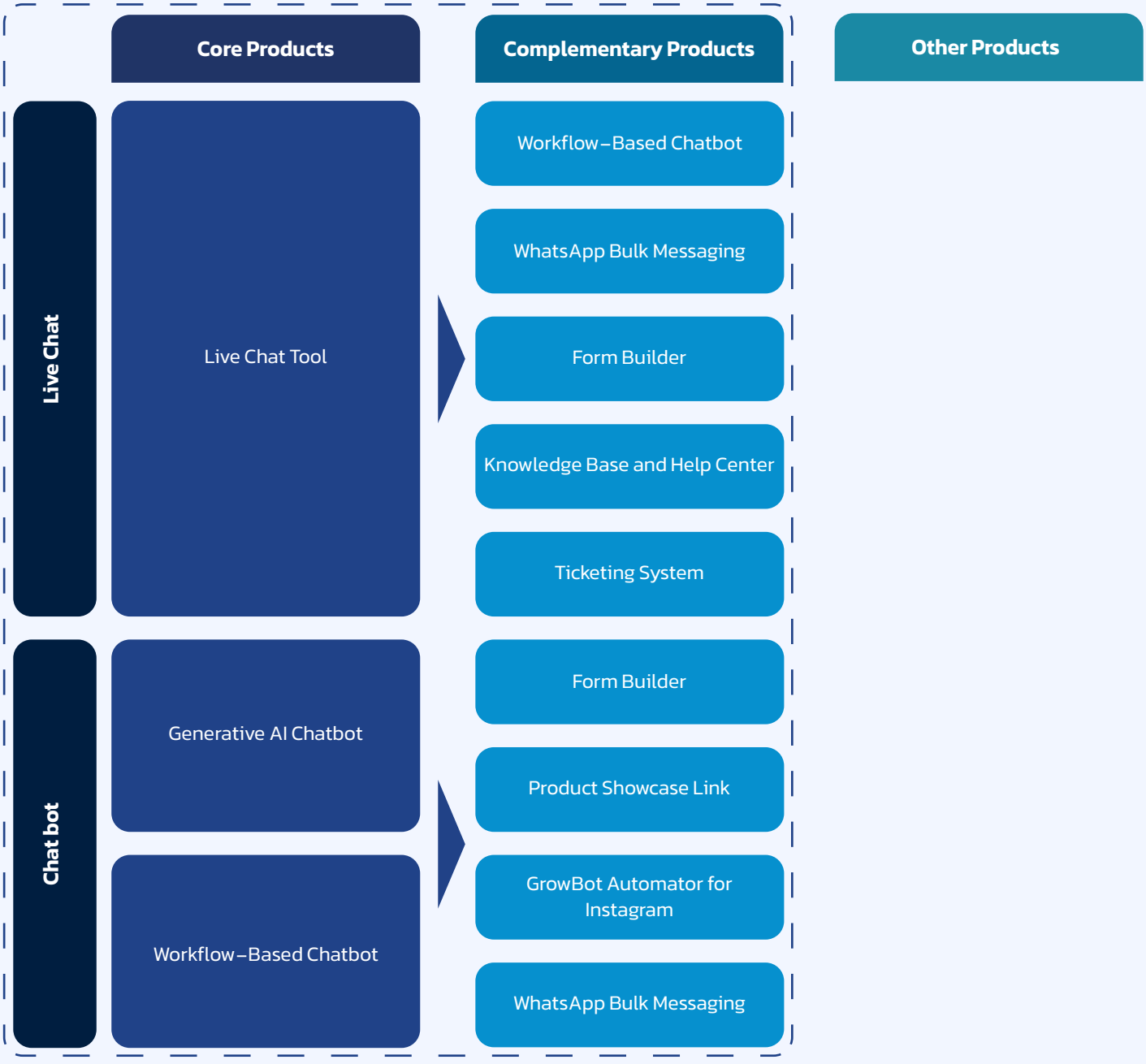
Live chat systems and automated responses are the main products and features of live chat and chatbots

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the live chat and chatbot industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Products and Features of Live Chat Providers

Live chats are moving toward automated responses

Core Products and Key Features

Live Chat Tool	Visitor Tracking	Operator Management and Coordination	Customization of Chat Widgets	Canned Responses
	File Sharing	Chat Transfer	Dedicated Chat Pages Without the Need for a Website	Providing API and plugins for WordPress, Joomla, Drupal, and WHMCS
	Business Hours Setting	Sending Responses to User Email	Chat Analytics and Reporting	Contact Management
	Automated Triggers	Integration with Social Media	Automation of Repeated Tasks	SDK

Insight

The live chat tool allows business operators to respond to messages from the website, WhatsApp, and email through a single panel.

Complementary Products and Key Features

Workflow-Based Chatbot	WhatsApp Bulk Messaging	Form Builder	Knowledge Base and Help Center	Ticketing System
Enabling automated responses to user inquiries without the need for support staff	Enabling automated message sending to WhatsApp based on the contact list	Enabling the creation of pre-chat forms and lead collection	Enabling the creation of FAQ pages and help articles	Enabling the acceptance, handling, response, and management of user request

Insight

Some live chat players have added automated response to their features, which answer user inquiries on websites based on workflow.

Products and Features of Chatbot Providers

Chatbots offer a variety of products based on the channels they cover

Core Products and Key Features

Generative AI Chatbot	Providing Control Panel	Dedicated Chat Page	Sending Multimedia Messages	Integration With Website and Telegram
	Live Chat Handoff	Support for Various Tones	Integration With Live Chat Tools	Plugins for WordPress, Joomla, Drupal, and WHMCS
	Form Builder	Providing API and Integration With Software Like CRM	Integration With Speech-to-Text and Text-to-Speech Services	Canned Responses & FAQ Automation
Workflow-Based Chatbot	Automated Responses	Sending Multimedia Messages	Sending Messages to Users Immediately After Follow	
	Canned Responses	Sending Reminder Messages	Scheduled Message Sending	



Salah Asadi

Chief Product Officer of Danabot

One of the distinguishing features of generative AI chatbots is their use of an internal language model (independent of OpenAI). This is particularly valuable for companies looking to reduce their reliance on third-party services. Moreover, issues like sanctions or network disruptions do not affect business operations.

Complementary Products and Key Features

Form Builder	Surveys	Conducting Tests	Registering User Information in the Panel	Exporting User Information to Excel
Product Showcase Link	Displaying Product and Service	Adding Images and Descriptions	Adding Buttons and Links	
SMS Panel	Sending Bulk Messages	Sending Personalized SMS	Exporting Phone Numbers to Excel	Saving Follower Numbers in the Panel
GrowBot Automator for Instagram	Canned Responses	Follow Conditions		
WhatsApp Bulk Messaging	Admin Panel	Creating Contact Lists	Contact Grouping	Simultaneous Use by Multiple Operators
	Sending Targeted Messages	Sending Multimedia Messages	Scheduled Message Sending	Reporting

Insight

The complementary products are exclusively provided by chatbots that focus on Instagram and messaging platforms and respond based on workflow.

Comparison of Key Live Chat Providers

All providers support website

Comparison of Key Live Chat Providers Based on Different Supported Channels*

*By different supported channels,' we mean that live chat players enable businesses to respond to user messages sent through the channels shown below, all from a single panel.

		Website	Telegram	WhatsApp	Email	Instagram
Live Chat	Goftino	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
	Raychat	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗
	Livechatify	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
	Injaneb	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
	Gapify	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗
	HiHelp	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗
	FlowChat	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓

Insight

Goftino and Raychat can integrate with Telegram. However, they use Telegram as a tool for receiving messages from 'website users' and for 'operator responses.' Operators can respond to website user inquiries via their Telegram accounts if they do not have access to the chat panel.

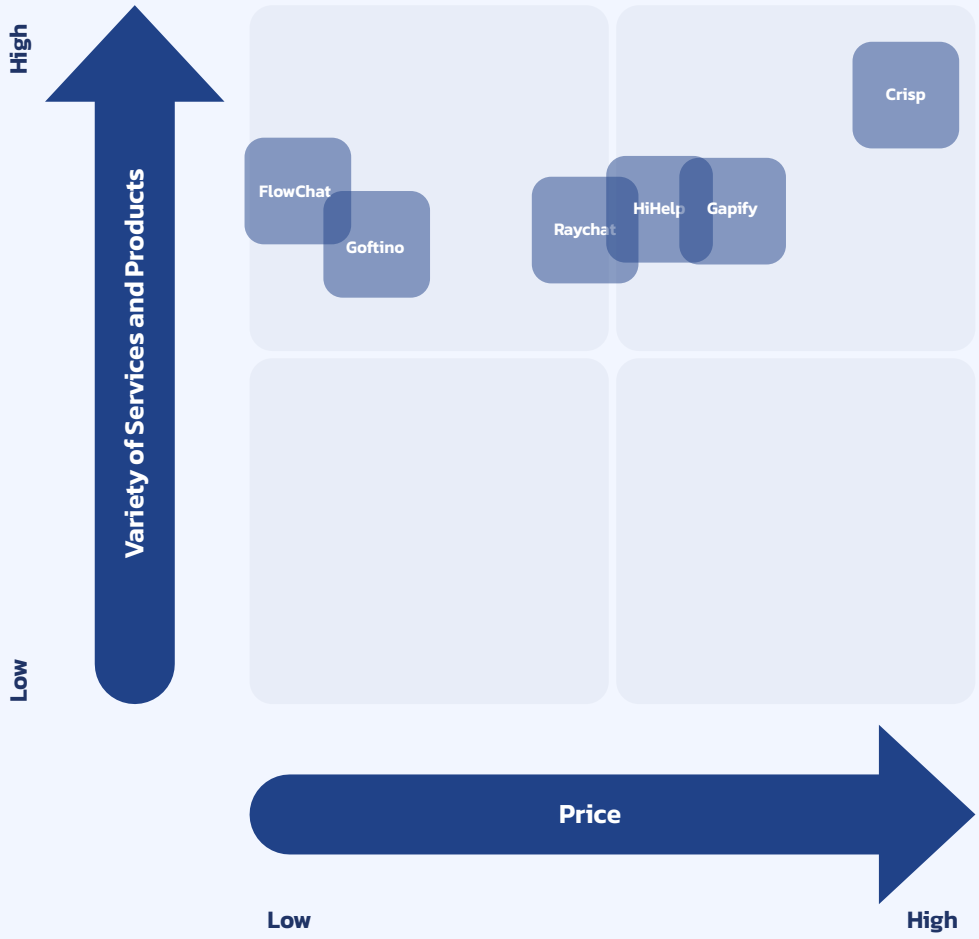
Comparison of Key Live Chat Providers

Pricing as a key differentiator among live chat providers

4 Key Criteria for Choosing a Live Chat Provider from the Customer's Perspective

- Technology / Innovation
- Variety of Services and Products
- Integration Capability
- Ease of Use

Comparison of Key Live Chat Providers



WordPress Live Chat Plugins

In addition to the players shown, WordPress plugins that enable live chat on WordPress are also available. They are generally suitable for small businesses and can be divided into two categories:

First: They offer limited features and are always free.

Second: They offer a wide range of features, with prices positioned between Iranian and international tools.

Insight

Considering that the price of Crisp (a foreign tool) is quite high, most Iranian businesses use the free version of this tool with more limited features.

Comparison of Key Chatbot Providers

Chatbot providers support a variety of channels

Comparison of Key Chatbot Providers Based on Different Supported Channels*

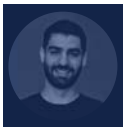
*By different supported channels,' we mean that live chat providers enable businesses to respond to user messages sent through the channels shown below, all from a single panel.

Chatbot	Website	Telegram	WhatsApp	Instagram
Muchat	✓	✓	✗	✗
Chaata	✓	✗	✗	✗
Danabot	✓	✗	✗	✗
Yarabot	✓	✗	✗	✗
Gapify	✓	✓	✗	✗
HiHelp	✓	✓	✓	✗
RayChat	✓	✗	✗	✗
Flowchat	✓	✓	✗	✓
NovinHub	✗	✓	✗	✓
Directam	✗	✗	✗	✓
Inboxino	✗	✗	✓	✗
Inibots	✗	✗	✗	✓

Some chatbot providers have obtained Facebook's official API to provide automated response features for Instagram and WhatsApp.

5 Key Criteria for Choosing a Chatbot Provider from the Customer's Perspective

Ease of Use | Variety of Services and Products | Scalability | Quality and Accuracy of Responses | Integration Cpability



Ali Naderi

Founder of Flowchat

Scalability is very important for large businesses.

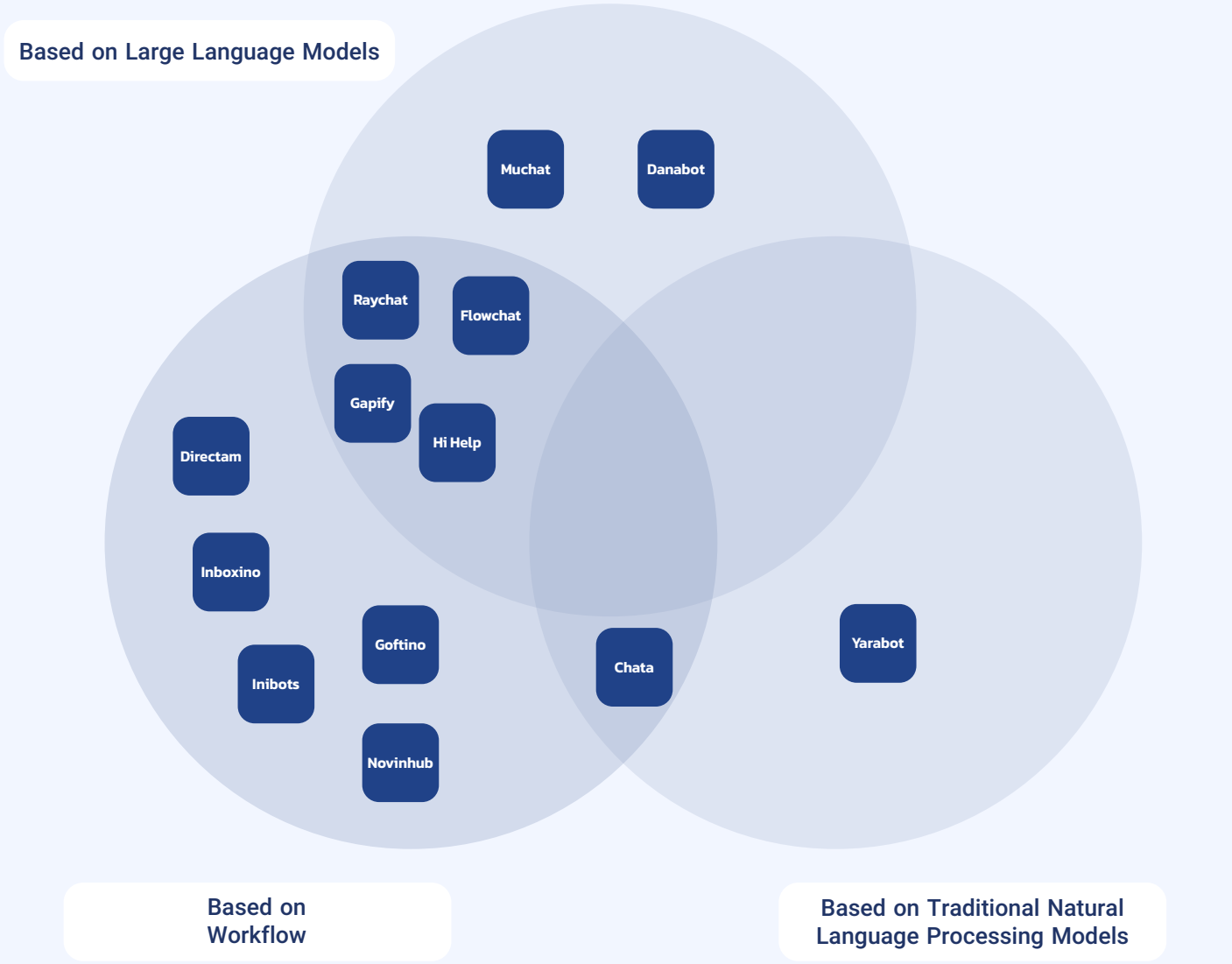
Comparison of Key Chatbot Providers

The method of responding to questions is a factor for categorizing chatbot providers

Iranian chatbot providers are divided into three categories based on their response methods:

Generative AI	In this method, by using Large Language Models (LLM) alongside other algorithms like data mining, attempts are made to produce more flexible and human-like outputs through chatbots.
Machine Learning and Traditional Natural Language Processing (NLP) Models	In this method, leveraging traditional technologies such as BERT, chatbots try to display more human-like behavior but with more limitations and lower costs.
Workflow	In this method, typically knowledge bases are used, and based on workflow, the chatbot answers customer questions.

Comparison of Key Chatbot Providers Based on Their Response Methods to User Inquiries



* This diagram has been created based on the opinions of experts and players in this field.

Live Chat Providers Market – 2023

Two Iranian live chat providers hold the highest market share

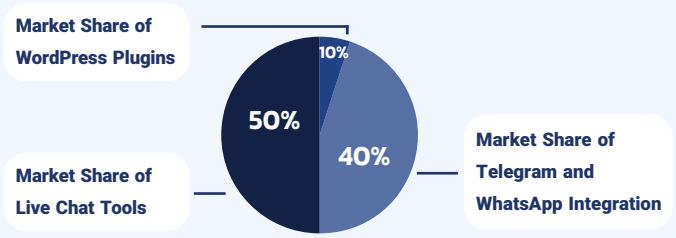
Live Chat Providers Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	30 billion tomans	200%
Global	1 billion dollars (2022)	9%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran





Insight

According to experts, on average, 20% of businesses using live chat tools are willing to pay for additional features. This figure has increased compared to last year due to growing awareness among businesses about the benefits of live chat.

Live Chat Providers Market Structure – 2023

Metric: The number of businesses using live chat tools, both free and paid

* Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	Raychat and Goftino, two players with the highest market share
Challenger	Crisp and WordPress plugins
Follower	Other foreign players
Nicher	

Crisp has the highest share of the Iranian market compared to other foreign players.

Which Businesses Use Live Chat the Most?

E-commerce	Healthcare	Finance	Education and Universities
Beauty and Personal Care	Tourism	Public Sector	

Chatbot Providers Market – 2023

The chatbot market in Iran is in its embryonic stage

Chatbot Providers Market Size– 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Global	5.7 billion dollars (2023)	21.5%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

Insight

Given that the chatbot market in Iran is still emerging, it is not possible to provide precise and reliable figures for this market. As the market grows and becomes more transparent, more comprehensive data will be presented in future reports.

Chatbot Providers Market Structure – 2023

The chatbot market in Iran is in its embryonic stage. Players using "Large Language Models (LLM)" and "traditional Natural Language Processing (NLP)" are at the beginning of their journey, seeking product-market fit. However, players using workflow, which focus on Instagram, have moved past the product-market fit stage and are now in the growth phase. "Directem," as one of the key players in this category, has captured a significant share of the chatbot market on Instagram.

Which Businesses Use Chatbots the Most?

- E-commerce
- Beauty
- Educational
- Finance, Stock Market, Insurance, and Banking
- Online Retail
- Social Commerce
- Logistics



Pooria Soluti
Co-founder of Directam

A significant portion of beauty businesses use automated response solutions to reply to comments and direct messages on Instagram.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Live Chat Industry – 2023

The presence of current players has made entering the live chat market difficult

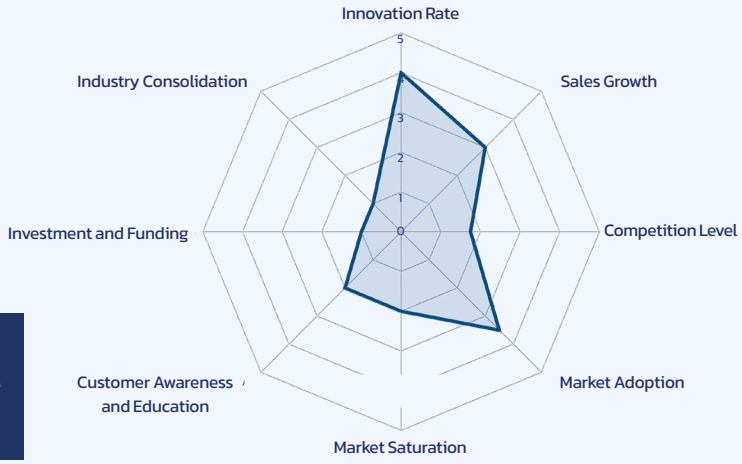
Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Live Chat Industry – 2023



Ali Rahimi

Founder of Goftino

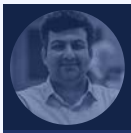
Currently, a significant portion of online businesses utilize live chat tools. However, they do not necessarily have sufficient awareness of all the features and benefits.



Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Chatbot Industry – 2023

The level of competition in the chatbot market is low

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Chatbot Industry – 2023



Saleh Ghane

CEO of Inboxino

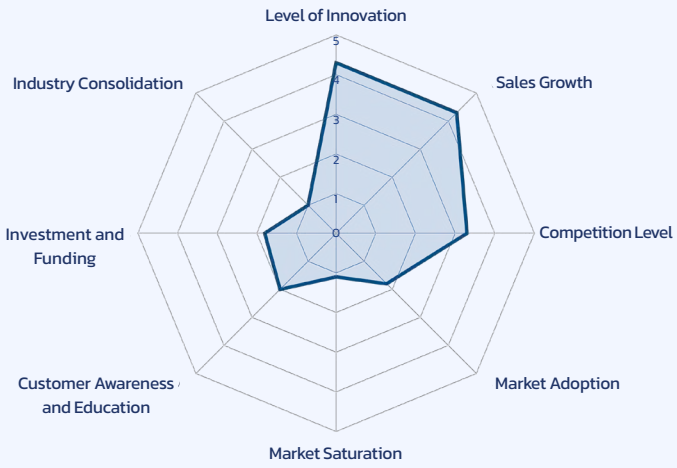
High risk and uncertainty in the chatbot market, especially in the social media platform, have discouraged investors from investing.



Saleh Asadi

Chief Product Officer of Danabot

This market is in the early stages. As a result, it has not yet reached saturation, and there is a significant opportunity for growth.

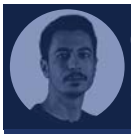


Live Chat and Chatbot Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

Artificial intelligence, integration, and personalized interactions are among the key trends in this industry

Live Chat and Chatbot Industry Trends – 2023

	Global	Iran
Live Chat	Using artificial intelligence for better and faster responses	Becoming an omnichannel solution to increase lead generation and conversion rates
	Integration with other customer communication channels such as social media, email, and phone	Using artificial intelligence for better and faster responses
	Providing personalized recommendations using customer data	Creating personalized interactions using customer data
	Offering voice and video chat features	Enabling user authentication
	Integration with customer relationship management (CRM) software	Connecting to SMS panels to follow up on user queries
	Using customer tracking and marketing automation features in live chats	Automating conversation routing
Chat Bot	Using predictive analytics	Growth of voice-based chatbots
	Growth of voice-based chatbots	Entry into the Instagram and WhatsApp market
	Creating personalized interactions using customer data	Creating personalized interactions using customer data
	Growth and development of multilingual chatbots	Adding customer loyalty program features to chatbots
	Integration with all customer communication channels (such as websites, social media, messaging apps, and applications)	Using chatbots for smaller and more personal tasks



Ghader Sadeghi

Co-Founder and CEO of Raychat

Iranian live chat providers now track customer events on websites, similar to foreign tools.

Data Partners in the Live Chat and Chatbot Industry

Raychat: An Advanced Live Chat Tool with AI Chatbot

100%
Growth in active customers (2022 to 2023)

2 billion
Total chats managed (2023)

46 million
Users receiving responses to their inquiries monthly (2023)

60%
Businesses utilizing automated responses

Geographical Market Reach

Iran | UAE | Turkey

Impact on Business Performance

200%
Increase in the number of high-quality leads

60% to 70%
Increase in sales

40%
Reduction in customer support costs

Raychat Introduction Link

Gapify: A Live Chat Platform with AI-Powered Automated Responses

70% Automated Responses
AI-powered automated customer interactions without human intervention

500,000 Chats
Total chats managed within six months of launch

Key Features and Capabilities

- Botify: AI-Powered Chatbot
- Advanced workflows
- Comprehensive chat features for operators
- AI Assistant for Operators
- Telegram support
- Advanced reporting

Gapify Introduction Link

Data Partners in the Live Chat and Chatbot Industry

NovinHub: An Automated Response Tool for Instagram and Telegram

35+ million
Average monthly automated responses sent on Instagram (2023)

200,000+ followers gained using the follow rule feature
A customer success story

Notable Clients

Snapp
Aparat
Mofid Securities
Yektanet

Key Features and Capabilities

- Automated responses to Instagram DMs and comments
- Automated responses to Telegram messages
- AI-powered storefront and form builder
- DM Contact Information Collection
- Instagram follow and Telegram join rules

NovinHub Automated Responder Product Introduction Link

9

Push Notification

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဘာသာရေး

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Push Notification

Push notification service is provided as a means of communication with customers by various players

They enable the delivery of push notifications on web and applications. Businesses can use push notifications to send messages containing images, titles, descriptions, and links to their target audience, converting them into customers or encouraging them to return.

Which Players Provide Push Notifications in Iran?

Marketing Automation Platforms	SMS Gateway and A2P SMS Providers	Push Notification Providers

*This report primarily focuses on push notification providers and does not include other players in the analysis.

Marketing Automation Platforms	These players enable businesses to send push notifications through integration with push notification providers (e.g., WebEngage, InTrack, Zebline, etc.).
SMS Gateway and A2P SMS Providers	These players, in addition to offering SMS services, have enabled push notifications for businesses (e.g., Rahyab Rayaneh Gostar, Najva, Kavenegar, etc.).
Push Notification Providers	These players specifically focus on providing push notification and enable the sending of push notifications via web or app platforms.

Push Notification Providers – 2023

6 Iranian push notification providers have been identified in the Iranian market

Push Notification Providers

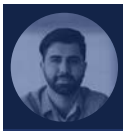
Enabling the sending of push notifications via web and app

Najva | Pushe⁎ | Push Pole | Pushame | Hamnotif | Push Notif

In 2023, Pushe joined Metrix, an attribution and automation platform in Iran, and will continue operating as one of its marketing and communication channels.

Insight

Some push notification providers offer the infrastructure for businesses to send push notifications. Others focus on advertising, delivering promotional push notifications to app users.



Meysam Mollasharify
CMO at Snapp Group

Large Iranian businesses use marketing automation platforms or Google Firebase to send web and mobile push notifications. However, smaller businesses tend to rely on push notification providers to avoid the complexity of setting up and managing the service in-house.

Applications of Push Notifications in the Marketing Funnel

Push notifications can be used in all stages of the marketing funnel



- Encouraging loyal customers to share their experiences
- Sending thank you messages to customers
- Encouraging customers to invite friends and family in exchange for rewards

- Sending personalized offers based on purchase history and customer behavior
- Reminding customers to use earned rewards and points

- Sending automated messages to users who abandoned their shopping cart
- Sending discount codes to customers
- Sending special offers and discounts to customers (such as free shipping on the first purchase)

- Sending product information along with a link and image
- Announcing time-limited discounts
- Sending reminder messages to users for actions such as completing a form or registration

- Informing potential customers about products and campaigns

Products and Features of Push Notification Providers

Push notification is the main product offered by push notification providers

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the push notification industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Insight

It seems that one of the reasons why push notification providers have not developed new products is the presence of major players in the marketing automation industry.



10

Customer Loyalty Program Software

Industry Data Partners:

Philia Digikala

Report Partners: SMARTECH Iboobab

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Customer Loyalty Program Software

One of the main goals of a loyalty program is customer retention and loyalty

They facilitate the creation of growth strategies and increased repeat purchases by collecting purchase data and customer activity histories, segmenting customers based on their behaviors, and leveraging features such as scoring, rewards, and gamification. Ultimately, they help retain existing customers and convert them into loyal advocates.

Which Players Are Present in the Customer Loyalty and Retention Market?

Enterprise Software Providers | CRM Software Providers | Marketing Automation Platforms | Cashback Service Providers | Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers

*The main focus of this report is on providers of customer loyalty program software, and other players are not examined.

Enterprise Software Providers	These companies offer customer loyalty programs either as a standalone product or as a software module. They vary based on their target market and core product. • Restaurant and cafe management software developers such as Mupra, Hami, Sepidz • Accounting software developers such as Mandegar, Parmis • ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning) software developers such as Rahkaran
CRM Software Providers	These companies primarily focus on customer relationship management (CRM) software and offer the customer loyalty program as one of their additional products. Examples include Didar, Ideal, Payam Gostar.
Marketing Automation Platforms	These companies do not offer customer loyalty program software but analyze customer behavior and transaction history to send appropriate messages at the right time and place, encouraging loyalty and retention.
Cashback Service Providers	Without the need for customer loyalty software, these platforms connect buyers with sellers. These platforms return a percentage of the purchase amount to the customer, encouraging repeat purchases. Examples of these platforms include Baman, ZarinPlus, DaapApp
Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers	There are companies whose core offering is customer loyalty program software, focusing solely on providing this software through cloud-based or on-premises deployments, such as SmartX, Dobare, Direct, Philia, and others.

Insight

According to experts, businesses with large sales teams do not opt for providers of customer loyalty program software. Instead, they use customer relationship management (CRM) software to retain customers.

Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers – 2023

20 Iranian customer loyalty program software providers have been identified in the Iranian market

Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers

Facilitating sales growth and customer return scenarios by collecting customer purchase histories and segmenting their behaviors

Philia

Shokolat

Dobare

Dayatek

Smart X

Direct

C Club

Win Coin

Loyalt

Belfy

Clubing

In-Box

Rokama

Webjar

Yek Be Yek

Dr CLubs

Narmafzaran (Mani Bon)

Lite Panel

These players provide hardware.

Sajac

Aria Pardaz

Insight

Overall, providers of customer loyalty program software can be categorized into three groups based on their target market. Some focus on the **brick-and-mortar sales** market, others on the **online sales** market, and the third group operates in **both** markets.

Applications of Customer Loyalty Program Software in the Marketing Funnel

Customer loyalty programs primarily focus on the purchase, loyalty, and brand advocacy stages



- Referral system for friends and family (earning points for referrals)
- Designing scenarios to turn customers into brand ambassadors
- Involving customers in the sales process
- Special offers for top-scoring customers

- Measuring customer satisfaction by sending survey invitations and analyzing the responses
- Customer complaint tracking system
- Creating various rewards such as discount codes, physical and digital gifts, gift cards, etc.
- Rewarding customers based on tier levels

- Using gamification to encourage purchases
- Sending reminder messages to customers who have abandoned their shopping cart
- Rewarding and giving credit to first-time buyers

- Helping potential customers make purchase decisions by encouraging loyal customers to submit reviews
- Providing incentive credits

- Customer loyalty program tools do not usually focus directly on this stage, but they can indirectly contribute to brand awareness and attracting new customers

Timeline and Milestones of Customer Loyalty Program Software in Iran and the World

Shift from selling products to training in software implementation and usage



Late 2010s

- The launch of Dayatek customer loyalty program
- SmartX entering the customer loyalty program market
- Customer loyalty players entering the restaurant and cafe market
- The emergence of SaaS-based players
- Shift from on-premises deployment to cloud-based customer loyalty solutions
- Introduction of SMSBox device tools
- Shift from selling products to training on implementation and software usage
- Direct entering the customer loyalty program market
- Development of customer complaint tracking systems by SmartX
- SmartX's strategic partnership with Sepidz
- Integration of POS systems with customer loyalty programs for the first time by SmartX

Early 2020s

- The launch of Dobare customer loyalty program
- Focus of customer loyalty providers on online businesses
- Development of smart reservation and booking system by SmartX
- Integration of customer loyalty programs with WordPress websites
- The launch of Philia customer retention and loyalty tool

Early 2020s

- Integration of loyalty programs with all customer communication channels (mobile, online, and offline)
- Incorporating gamification tools into loyalty programs

Products and Features of Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers

Customer loyalty program software is the core product of customer loyalty program software providers

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the customer loyalty program software industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.





Amir Navazi

Co-Founder & CIPO at Smart X

Loyalty cards are not used in fast-moving consumer goods (FMCG) businesses due to their high cost. Typically, loyalty cards are suitable for businesses operating in niche markets with a limited number of customers.

Products and Features of Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers

Variety of complementary products differentiates customer loyalty program software providers

Core Products and Key Features

Customer Loyalty Program Software	Admin Panel	Customer Panel (Club Members)	Customer Segmentation	Tier Management and Level–Based Rewards
	Campaign Management	Points–Based System	Reward System	Referral System
	Credit System (or Cashback)	Online Spin the Wheel Game	Mission Definition and Design	Form Builder Tool
	Feedback and Survey Tool	Reward Redemption Options	Customer Journey Design	Analytical Reporting
	Integration with POS		Loyalty Club Customization Features	
	Integration With Marketing Automation, CRM, Accounting, Online Stores, and Reservation Systems		Customer Interaction/Communication Management	

Insight

These features are not offered by all providers. Some players, like Philia, focus on personalization, gamification, and adding marketing automation capabilities to loyalty programs.

Complementary Products and Key Features

Online Survey	Connecting Customer Phone Numbers to Issued Invoices	Real–Time Alerts to Managers in Case of Customer Dissatisfaction	Admin Panel	Integration with POS Systems
	Customizable Survey Questions	Creating Diverse Questionnaires	Reporting	
Physical Loyalty Cards	Discount Card	Credit Card	Membership Card	
SMSBox Device	Customer Data Collection	Integration with Dedicated Customer Loyalty Panels	Connection via Wi–Fi	
POS Machine Integrated to Customer Loyalty Program	Customer Data Collection	Integration with Loyalty Club	Connection via Wi–Fi or SIM Card	
Customer Loyalty Program Plugin	Credit	Feedback and Survey Tool	Customer Segmentation	Customer Interaction/ Communication Management

*Businesses can access customer loyalty program features by installing this plugin on their website.

Insight

The POS machine can collect the customer's phone number, turning their card into a membership card for the loyalty program, eliminating the need to enter their phone number in future purchases.

Comparison of Key Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers

Offering diverse products tailored to market needs

Comparison of Key Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers Based on Product Variety

	Core Products	Complementary Products				
	Customer Loyalty Program Software	Online Survey	SMSBox Device	POS Machine Integrated to Customer Loyalty Program	Physical Loyalty Cards	Customer Loyalty Program Plugin
Smart X	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗
Dobare	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Dayatek	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗
Direct	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Philia	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Shokolat	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓	✗
Clubing	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗
Win Coin	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
C CLub	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗

Key players were selected based on Google's first-page results and expert opinions.

Insight

- Some players, like Philia and Shokolat, provide a customer panel (club members) in addition to the admin panel. Through this panel, club members can view their points, rewards, and missions.
- Some players, like Direct, offer hardware (such as SMSBox devices and POS systems) alongside customer loyalty program software. These devices help store customer data in offline markets.
- Philia, in addition to offering customer loyalty program features, aims to enable users to transfer rewards, points, and bonuses between loyalty programs through integration.

Comparison of Key Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers

Price is a key factor for SMBs selecting customer loyalty program software

6 Key Criteria for Choosing a Customer Loyalty Program Software from the Customer's Perspective

Ease of Use	Variety of Services and Features	Integration With Other Software
Customer Support	Price	Data Security

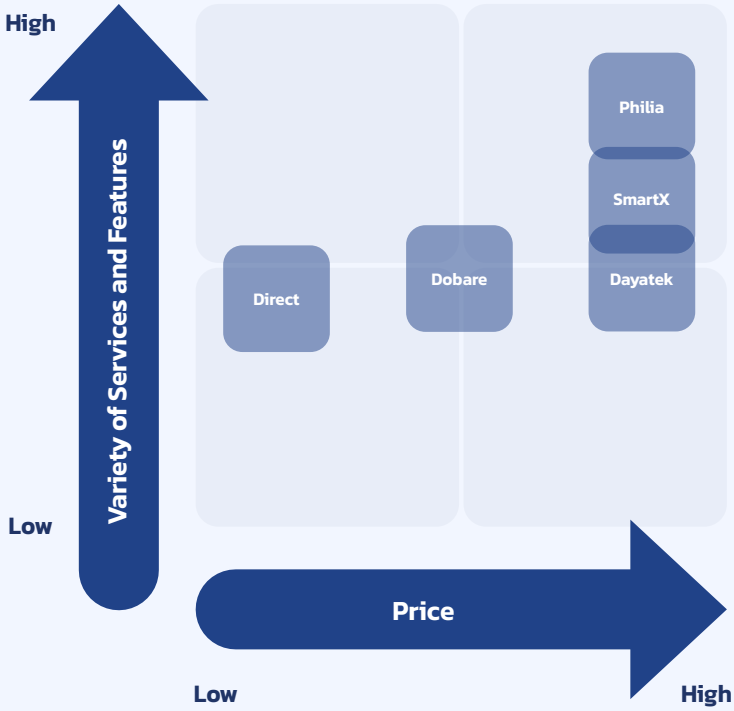
Insight

- Integration with POS systems in brick-and-mortar sales is a key criterion for customers when selecting customer loyalty program software.
- Large businesses typically prefer to either develop loyalty programs in-house or use on-premises solutions to ensure data security.



Yaser Yavari
CEO at Direct

A customer loyalty program is effective when it creates a simple and accessible channel for customer communication.



The customer loyalty market is vast, and each player has entered different markets based on their strategies. These players can be categorized based on various criteria:

Brick–and–Mortar Sales Market / Online Sales Market	For example, Direct and SmartX focus exclusively on the brick–and–mortar sales market, while Philia and Dobare operate in both brick–and–mortar and online markets, with the majority of their focus on the online sales market.
Vertical Market	For example, SmartX focuses exclusively on the restaurant and cafe market, specifically targeting these businesses.
Business Size Segmentation	For example, Philia focuses on medium and large online companies, while Dobare targets medium and small online companies.

Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers Market – 2023

A 220–billion–toman market for customer loyalty program software providers

Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	220 billion tomans*	175%
Global**	4 billion dollars (2024)	13%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans / 1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

*It includes both brick-and-mortar and online sales markets.

**The global market size includes customer loyalty program software, which helps businesses manage and analyze customer loyalty programs.

Customer Loyalty Program Software Providers Market Structure– 2023

Metric: Number of Customers (or Businesses Using Customer Loyalty Programs)

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

	Brick–and–Mortar Sales Market	Online Sales Market
Leader	Direct, with the largest market share	Given that customer loyalty program providers have recently entered this market, it is too early to discuss the market structure and market shares. However, it appears that Dobare and Philia have been more active compared to other providers.
Challenger	Dobare is competing with the market leader for market share	
Follower	Other players	
Nicher	SmartX as a niche player focusing on restaurants and cafes	

Which Businesses Use Customer Loyalty Program Software the Most?

Businesses with the following characteristics are customers of customer loyalty programs:

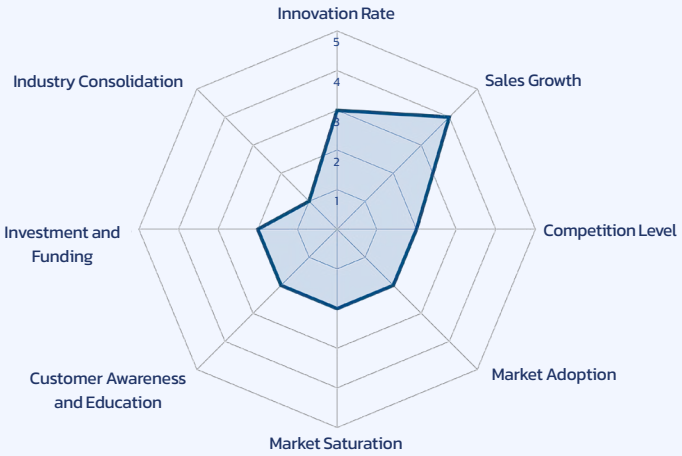
- Have a significant number of customers
- Experience repeat purchases
- Have a considerable customer basket value
- Maintain high profit margins

Restaurants and cafes	Beauty and Hair Salons
Local Retail Stores	Tourism (Tours, Travel, and Accommodation)
Online Businesses	Chain Stores and Butcheries
Clothing Stores	Jewelry and Accessories Stores

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Customer Loyalty Program Software Industry – 2023

The blue ocean market of customer loyalty program software

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Customer Loyalty Program Software Industry – 2023





Amir Navazi

Co-Founder & CIPO at Smart X

The shrinking market due to reduced purchasing power leads to increased competition among businesses. As a result, businesses are showing greater interest in using customer loyalty program tools.

Insight

The customer loyalty program software market is in the early stages of growth. As the advertising market and competition among businesses grow, this market will expand further.

Insight

The low competition among customer loyalty program software providers indicates that this market is a blue ocean. However, the entry of accounting software and POS systems into the loyalty program market could intensify competition.

Customer Loyalty Program Software Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

AI, integration, and personalized recommendations are trends in Iran and globally

Customer Loyalty Program Software Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Using AI for predicting customer behavior and personalized rewards	Simplifying the use of Customer Loyalty Program Software for businesses
Using blockchain for transparency and security in reward systems and point transfers	Using AI for predicting customer behavior and personalized recommendations
Connecting all customer communication channels (brick-and-mortar, online, mobile, social media, etc.)	Providing strategic analytics of customer behavior for businesses
Increasing the use of gamification tools in loyalty programs	Increasing the use of gamification tools in loyalty programs
Offering eco-friendly rewards	Advancing customer segmentation in loyalty programs
Integrating with voice assistants and chatbots	Integrating and unifying loyalty programs to transfer points and rewards among them
Focusing on building community	



Alireza Nakhjavani

Co-Founder of Dayatek and CEO at Sobhe Omid Management Consulting Firm

Players in this field are shifting from merely offering complex tools to businesses toward simplifying these tools, focusing on their usability and practical applications.

Data Partners in the Customer Loyalty Program Software Industry

Philia: A Platform for Customer Engagement, Retention, and Loyalty

1 million
Customer loyalty program members (2023)

100 million
Total points and rewards granted (2023)

380,000
Participants in loyalty programs (2023)

100
Total workforce (2023)

Key Features and Capabilities

- Point of sale (POS) system
- Powerful integration
- Advanced gamification
- Subscription-based customer loyalty program

Notable Clients

Noon Cafe Bakery

Pakshoo

ok exchange

Impact on Business Performance

50% reduction in marketing and advertising costs

Philia Introduction Link

Direct: A Customer Loyalty Program for Retail Stores

50,000+
Total customers (2023)

24+ million
Unique mobile numbers in the platform (2023)

1.5+ million
New members per month (2023)

70
Total workforce (2023)

Key Features and Capabilities

- Competitive hardware of Direct 3
- 20+ features to boost customer engagement
- Online booking capability for service industries
- The first location-based SMS service

Customer Segments

1,500+
Beauty salons

6,000+
Clothing stores

1,200+
Automotive service shops

Direct Introduction Link

11

Email Marketing Platform

Industry Data Partner:

Boostano mailerever

Report Partners: SMARTECH ბიბიგი

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Email Marketing Platform

Creating, implementing, managing, and analyzing email marketing campaigns

Email marketing platforms streamline **email creation**, **audience management and segmentation**, **automated bulk email sending**, as well as the **monitoring** and **optimization** of **email marketing campaigns** for businesses.

Which Players Provide Email Marketing?

Marketing Automation Platforms	Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Software	A2P SMS Providers	Email Marketing Platforms

The main focus of this report is on email marketing platforms, and other players are not covered.

Integrated Email Marketing Providers	Marketing Automation Platforms	These companies offer email sending as **one of their messaging capabilities** alongside other communication channels for businesses. Marketing automation platforms **enable email sending by leveraging commercial email infrastructure providers** (transactional email and SMTP services). Examples include WebEngage, inTrack, etc.
	Customer Relationship Management (CRM) Software	These companies provide email marketing as **one of the capabilities** of their **marketing software**, and obtaining email marketing platform services separately from them is not possible. Examples include Chitalk, Didar CRM, etc.
	A2P SMS Providers	SMS-focused players that offer email marketing platforms **separately** to complement their communication channels. Examples include Ghasedak
Dedicated Email Marketing Providers	Email Marketing Platforms	Companies whose **core business** is **providing email marketing platforms** and that have a strong focus on offering these platforms.

Insight

Email Sending Capability in Integrated Email Marketing Providers

"**Integrated Email Marketing Providers**" are active players in the **MarTech** space whose primary focus is not on offering dedicated email marketing platforms. However, they provide **email-sending capabilities** as one of the **features** of their software to businesses.

Email Marketing Platforms – 2023

The presence of 4 international and 7 Iranian platforms in the Iranian market

Email Marketing Platforms

Platforms for creating, implementing, managing, and analyzing email marketing campaigns



Independent Product Developer | Semi-Independent Product Developer | Resellers of Foreign Platforms

Insight

Categorization of email marketing platforms based on product development approach

1. **Independent Product Developers**: The **majority of the development** of email marketing platforms in this category is carried out **by the players** themselves.
2. **Semi-Independent Product Developers**: Platforms in this category are built by creating a **management dashboard** on top of **commercial** or **open-source** email infrastructure.
3. **Resellers of Foreign Platforms**: These players operate in the market by obtaining **reseller rights** for foreign platforms.

Insight

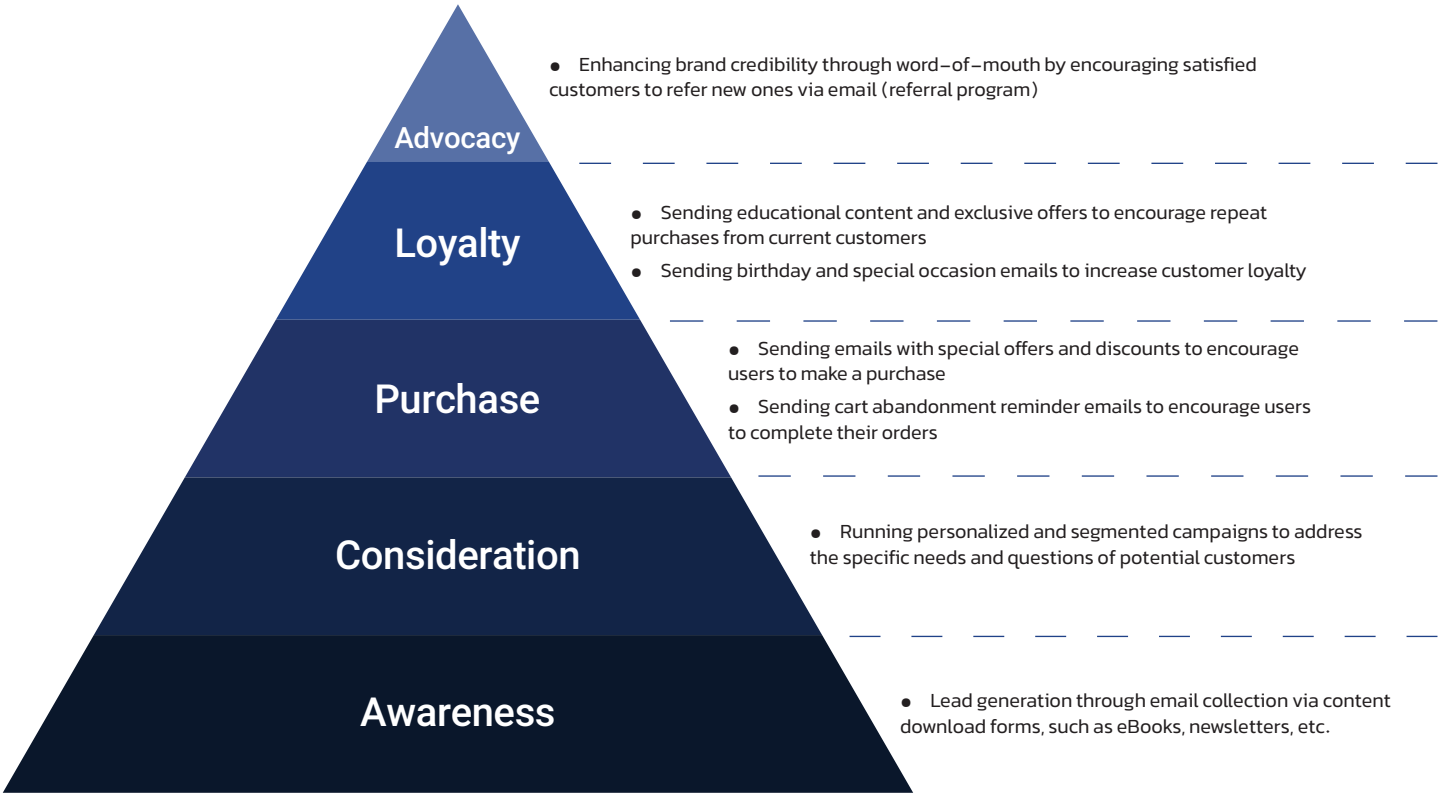
Obtaining reseller rights by prominent Iranian platforms

Najva and **Pakat** are two prominent platforms in this industry that provide **Brevo email marketing platform** through reseller rights. While it is possible to directly access services from international providers, challenges such as **lack of customer support** and the **risk of account suspension** due to **sanctions** remain significant barriers for Iranian businesses.

Applications of Email Marketing Platforms in the Marketing Funnel

Highly effective in the middle stages, focusing on nurturing leads and maintaining customer engagement

Email marketing platforms are tools designed to **build** and **maintain direct communication** with customers, playing a role across **various stages of the marketing funnel**. Their primary function is to deliver **personalized and targeted content** at the right time, aimed at **nurturing leads** and ensuring **consistent and lasting customer engagement**, with the greatest impact occurring in the **middle stages**.





Hamid Mahmoudzadeh

Founder and CEO of Didar CRM

One of the best strategies to increase the number of loyal customers is to send educational content to establish the business as an educational brand rather than a seller. For this reason, it is suggested that 80% of emails contain educational content, and only 20% offer purchase and sale proposals.

Timeline and Milestones of Email Marketing Platforms in Iran and the World

The launch of the first email marketing platforms in Iran in the late 2000s



Early 2010s

- Free bulk promotional email campaigns trending on Yahoo Groups
- Advocating targeted email marketing by sending to audience lists instead of bulk promotional emails
- Karzar obtaining a reseller rights for MailerLite

Mid 2010s

- The peak of email marketing with over 4,000 businesses using it and an annual revenue exceeding 1.5 billion tomans

Late 2010s

- Decline in email usage by Iranian businesses due to:
  - ⋆ Lack of high-quality solutions following MailerLite's suspension of services due to sanctions
  - ⋆ Users replacing email with mobile phone numbers when creating online accounts
  - ⋆ Growing popularity of social media and messaging apps
- Entry of Pakat and Najva as new Iranian players aiming to capture MailerLite's market share
- Introduction of email marketing automation capabilities by Iranian providers

Year 2021

- Sending 236 million emails to 40 million subscribers by Najva

Mid 2010s – Now

- Introduction of advanced tools for optimizing email marketing campaign effectiveness using AI by platforms like Mailchimp, ActiveCampaign, and Sendinblue
- Provision of high-delivery-rate transactional email services by SendGrid and Amazon SES



Hadi Farnoud

Founder of Pakat

With MailerLite's partial exit from the Iranian market and its limited direct service to a small number of Iranian businesses in the late 2010s, opportunities for growth and market entry emerged for Iranian players. Packet and Najva seized this opportunity, entering the market and successfully attracting a significant number of Iranian businesses.

Products and Features of Email Marketing Platforms

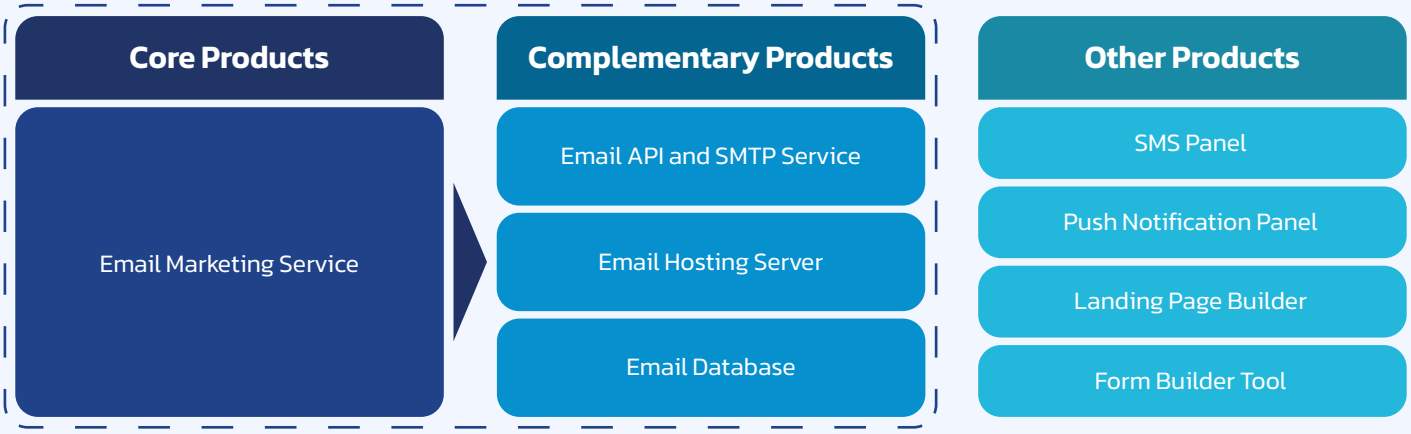
Expanding communication platforms by offering SMS panels and push notification services

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the email marketing platform industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Insight

Product and market expansion through communication channel diversification

Email marketing platforms have recently started offering **SMS and push notification panels** to create a **comprehensive communication platform** for businesses.



Hadi Farnoud
Founder of Pakat

The demand from businesses for messaging through diverse channels and the higher profit margins of channels such as SMS and push notification have drawn the attention of email marketing platforms to these areas.

Products and Features of Email Marketing Platforms

Core product applications in managing, analyzing, and optimizing email marketing campaigns

Core Products and Key Features

Email Marketing Service	Campaign Creation and Management	Email Template Design Tool	Reporting and Campaign Analysis
	Customer Segmentation	Subscriber List Management	Automated Email Sending

Complementary Products and Key Features

Email API and SMTP Service	High Delivery Rate	Transactional Email Sending	Reporting and Analysis
	Real–Time Tracking and Analysis	Integration with Marketing Tools (CRM, Marketing Automation, etc.)	Subscriber List Management
Email Hosting Server	Email Sending and Receiving	Custom Domain	Inbox Management
	Data Backup	Spam Filtering	HTML Editor
Email Database	Manufacturing and Industrial Email Database	Commercial and Trading Email Database	
	Email Database of Active Gmail and Yahoo Users	Email Database of Professors, Students, Educational Institutions, and Research Centers	

Insight

Sending bulk promotional emails using an email database

An email database is a collection of email addresses that enables businesses to send **promotional** and **non-targeted** messages. This database is suitable for **large-scale marketing campaigns**, helping businesses reach a **broader audience**, though it typically offers a **lower return on investment**.

Comparison of Key Email Marketing Platforms

Providing the complementary product of Email API and SMTP services by all key platforms

Comparison of Key Email Marketing Platforms Based on Product Variety

	Core Products	Complementary Products		
	Email Marketing Service	Email API and SMTP Service	Email Hosting Server	Email Database
MailerEver	✓	✓	✓	✗
Pakat	✓	✓	✗	✗
Najva	✓	✓	✗	✗
Mailerino	✓	✓	✗	✗
MailerLite	✓	✓	✗	✗

Key players are determined based on the volume of emails sent and the number of customers.

Insight

Developing an exclusive platform with complementary products

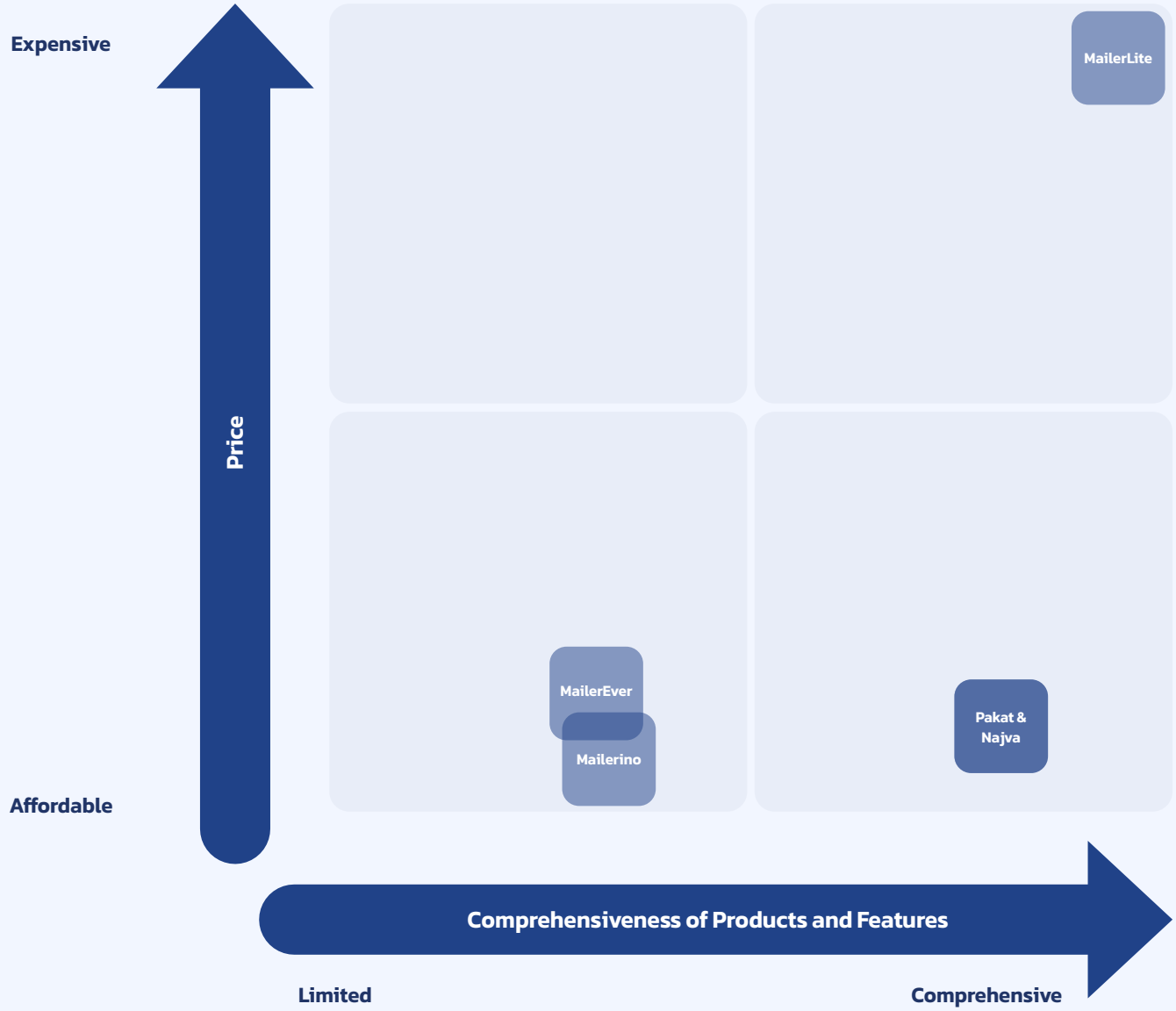
The **complementary products**, "Email Hosting Server" and "Email API and SMTP Service," enable businesses to **develop** their own **exclusive email marketing platform**. However, using these products requires **technical expertise**, which may not be suitable for all businesses.

Comparison of Key Email Marketing Platforms

Email delivery rate, key criteria for platform selection

5 Key Criteria for Choosing an Email Marketing Platform from the Customer's Perspective

Email Delivery Rate (Inbox Rate)	Specialized Customer Support	Price	Comprehensiveness of Products and Features	Integration Capability



Key players are identified based on the volume of emails sent and the number of customers.

Insight

Challenges in communication and support for Iranian businesses with international platforms

A key reason for **not directly purchasing subscriptions** from international platforms and opting for Iranian platforms is the challenge of **communication** and **adequate customer support** from them.

Email Marketing Platforms Market – 2023

Email marketing platforms market size: 30 to 35 billion tomans

Email Marketing Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	30 to 35 billion tomans	70%
Global	1.5 billion dollars	9.5%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran



Insight

Negative impact of dollar–rial exchange rate fluctuations and inflation on market growth

Given the significant **direct** and **indirect share of foreign players** in the Iranian market and the **dollar-based payments**, approximately **40% to 50% of market size growth** is attributed to cost increases in line with **currency exchange rates** and **inflation**.

Insight

Market share claim by integrated email marketing platforms

It is estimated that the **number of emails sent** via "**dedicated email marketing platforms**" is **equal** to that of "**integrated platforms**" (such as CRM and marketing automation platforms).



Majid Fathi

CEO at AvangEmail

The revenue model of email marketing platforms is typically based on charging fees per "number of emails sent" or "number of subscribers." Due to some Iranian players using Brevo's infrastructure, subscription sales based on the number of emails sent are more common in Iran.

Email Marketing Platforms Market – 2023

Foreign platforms hold over 70% of the market share

Email Marketing Platforms Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Emails Sent and Number of Customers

* Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	Najva with an estimated market share of at least 30%
Challenger	Pakat with an estimated market share of 15% to 30%
Follower	MailerLite, MailerEver, Sender, and Mailerino each with an estimated market share of less than 10%
Nicher	

Insight

Pakat, focusing on providing services to **large businesses**, is considered a challenger to the market leader. While it may not surpass Najva in the number of customers, it holds a significant market share due to the **high volume of emails sent** by large businesses.

Share of Foreign Players in the Email Marketing Platforms Market – 2023

Insight

Foreign players hold over 70% market share

More than 30% of businesses **directly purchase subscriptions** from **foreign players**. Considering the **market share of Pakat** and **Najva** as an **indirect share of foreign players**, the total share of foreign players is estimated to **exceed 70%**.

Market Share of Foreign Players by Number of Customers – 2023



Which Businesses Use Email Marketing Platforms the Most?

Enterprise Software	Online Retail	Financial Technology (FinTech)
Online Education	Trading	Tourism (Travel and Immigration)



Hadi Farnoud

Founder of Pakat

A key strategy to boost market growth involves established major companies in sectors such as FMCG, cosmetics, etc.., adopting email marketing platforms.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Email Marketing Platforms Industry – 2023

The high threat of SMS and push notification as alternatives to email

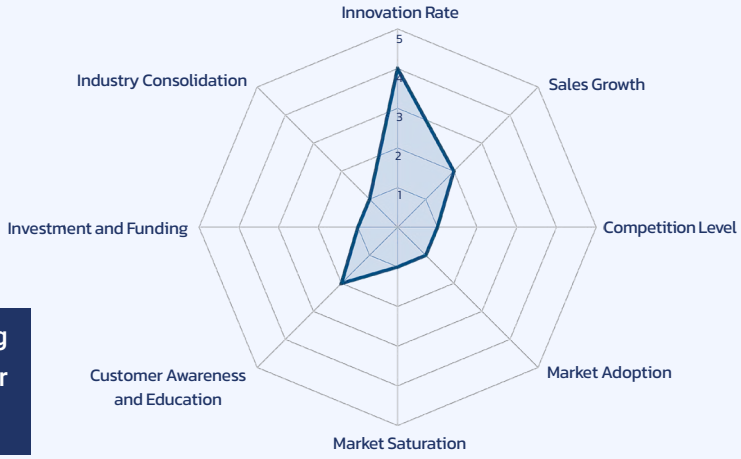
Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Email Marketing Platforms Industry – 2023



Hamid Mahmoudzadeh

Founder and CEO of CRM Didar

One of the attractive opportunities for email marketing platforms is to acquire or merge with customer relationship management (CRM) software.





Majid Fathi

CEO at AvangEmail

The shift from email to SMS and push notification poses a considerable risk to the email marketing platforms market due to the growing popularity of smartphones and apps. Additionally, marketing automation platforms, by attracting major clients, pose a significant threat to email marketing platforms.



Behrooz Mahdavi

CEO at MailFa

One of the main reasons for the market's stagnation is the reduced use of email by large businesses. The replacement of email with mobile phone numbers during user registration, driven by the growing use of smartphones and apps, has decreased reliance on email marketing platforms.

Email Marketing Platform Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

Offering SMS and push notification panels to diversify communication channels

Email Marketing Platform Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Sending emails with interactive content such as surveys, spin–the–wheel offers, interactive infographics, etc.	Sending emails with interactive content such as surveys, spin–the–wheel offers, interactive infographics, etc
Increasing the variety of communication channels by offering SMS and push notification panels	Increasing the variety of communication channels by offering SMS and push notification panels

Insight

The direct influence of global trends on iranian trends

One key aspect of Iranian trends is the likelihood of global **product development trends** occurring in Iran with **minimal delay**. This happens due to Iranian players utilizing **infrastructures** or obtaining **reseller rights** from foreign providers.

Data Partners in the Email Marketing Platform Industry

MailerEver: A Comprehensive Email Marketing Platform for the Global Market

5 million
Emails sent per day

1,750+
Total registered users

200+
Business customers (2024)

Notable Clients

Skyroom | Virgool | Sentrama | myBrightside

Key Features and Capabilities

BoostanoMTA
High-volume and scalable email sending service

Zharik Warmup
Email warm-up service

- Bulk email sending
- Transactional emails
- Email marketing
- Business email

Direct Link to the Website

12

Text and Image Generation Tool

Industry Data Partners:

Pixy

Report Partners: SMARTECH

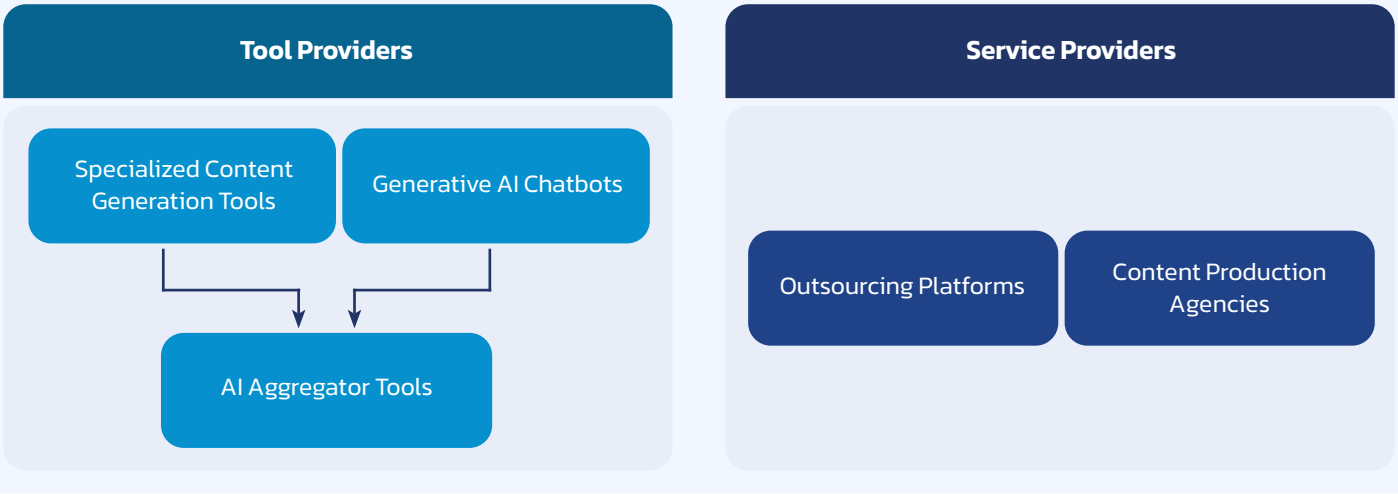
TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Text and Image Generation Tool

Providing content creation tools using artificial intelligence and pre-designed templates

Text and image generation tools enable businesses to efficiently **create tailored content** for **marketing**, significantly **reducing** both **time** and **expenses**.

Classification of the Text and Image Content Creation Industry Players



"**Tool providers**" enable image and text content creation by developing **technology-driven products** for users. "**Service providers**" play a **direct role** in the **content creation process** through **in-house teams at content production agencies** and **freelancers** on outsourcing platforms.

Given the report's focus on marketing technology tools, service providers will not be covered further.

Specialized Content Generation Tools	These players focus on providing image and text content creation tools by developing **proprietary large language models** or **library of pre-designed templatess**.
Generative AI Chatbots	**AI-powered chatbots** with **proprietary large language models** that serve **various purposes**, including content creation.
AI Aggregator Tools	Without proprietary large language models, these tools facilitate accessibility by **aggregating** and sometimes **integrating specialized tools** and **AI Chatbots** through **APIs**.

Insight

Offering content creation tools by a wide range of MarTech players

In addition to "content creation tool providers," players active in other MarTech domains, such as "**SEO tools**" and "**social media management and analytics platforms**," also offer content creation tools as one of their features, leveraging **AI**.

Text and Image Generation Tools – 2023

7 foreign and 23 Iranian tools are active in the Iranian market

Text and Image Generation Tools

Specialized Content Creation Tools

AI-Based Players

Text and Image Content Generation Tools with Proprietary Large Language Models

Foreign Players Used in the Iranian Market

- QuillBot
- ContentBot
- Midjourney
- Leonardo AI

Iranian Players

- Khodnevis
- Mann-E
- Mohtava Ba Man

Pre-Designed Templates Providers

Online Design Tools Using Pre-Designed Graphic Templates

- domingo
- Pendid

Players Offering Text Editing Tools

Persian Smart Error Detection and Editing Tools

- Firastar
- Paknevis
- Virastyar
- Virastaran
- PingoTeam
- Virastman

Generative AI Chatbots

AI-Powered Chatbots with Proprietary Large Language Models

Foreign Players Used in the Iranian Market

- ChatGPT
- Gemini
- Claude

Iranian Players

- Fibonacci
- Rakhshai

AI Aggregator Tools

Aggregators of Specialized Tools and AI Chatbots via API Access and Sometimes Integration

- Athena
- Pixy
- AvalAI
- Zigap
- Masna SEO
- Zirak
- GapGPT
- OneGPT
- Hoosheno
- Vira
- Roboo

Text Content Generation Tools

Text and Image Content Generation Tools

Image Content Generation Tools

Applications of Text and Image Generation Tools in the Marketing Funnel

Content generation tools are mainly used in early funnel stages: awareness and consideration

Content generation tools can be applied at all stages of the marketing funnel. However, their primary role in content production makes them highly impactful in the **awareness** and **consideration stages**, helping **generate leads**, **provide insights about products and services**, and **nurture leads**.



Timeline and Milestones of Text and Image Generation Tools in Iran and the World

The development of the first proprietary large language models in Iran began in the early 2020s

World **Iran**

Mid 1990s

- The first blogging platforms, such as Blogger and LiveJournal.
- The development and popularity of digital image editing tools like Adobe Photoshop

Late 1990s – Early 2000s

- An increase in content creators with the rise in popularity of blogging platforms
- The introduction of the first content management systems (CMS) like Drupal and Joomla

Mid 2000s

- User-generated sharing of text, image, and video content with the emergence of social media platforms like Twitter, Facebook, YouTube, and more
- The development of online photo editing and sharing tools like Picasa and Flickr

Late 2000s – Early 2010s

- The development of comprehensive content creation, distribution, and analytics tools like HubSpot and Marketo
- Content creation features offered by social media management tools like Buffer

Early 2010s – Mid 2010s

- The introduction of the first automated text editing software for Persian

Mid 2010s – Early 2020s

- Offering ready-made graphic templates, such as Adobe Spark
- Providing AI-powered content creation tools like Canva
- The emergence of AI chatbots with large language models (LLMs), such as OpenAI, capable of content creation

Early
2020s

- The development of the first Persian large language models
- The first AI-based image and text generation tools with proprietary language models
- The introduction of tools aggregating AI models
- Launch or development of AI tools by major companies and holdings like Tapsell, Part, and others
- Investment in Mann-E and Khodnevis by Diginext



Ehsan Azizi

Co-founder of AvalAI

The lack of support and low accuracy of foreign tools in Persian initially led some Iranian players to develop their own proprietary language models. However, with the emergence of GPT-4, the availability of APIs for various AI models, and improved accuracy in Persian, Iranian players shifted towards integrating with these platforms.

Products and Features of Text and Image Generation Tools

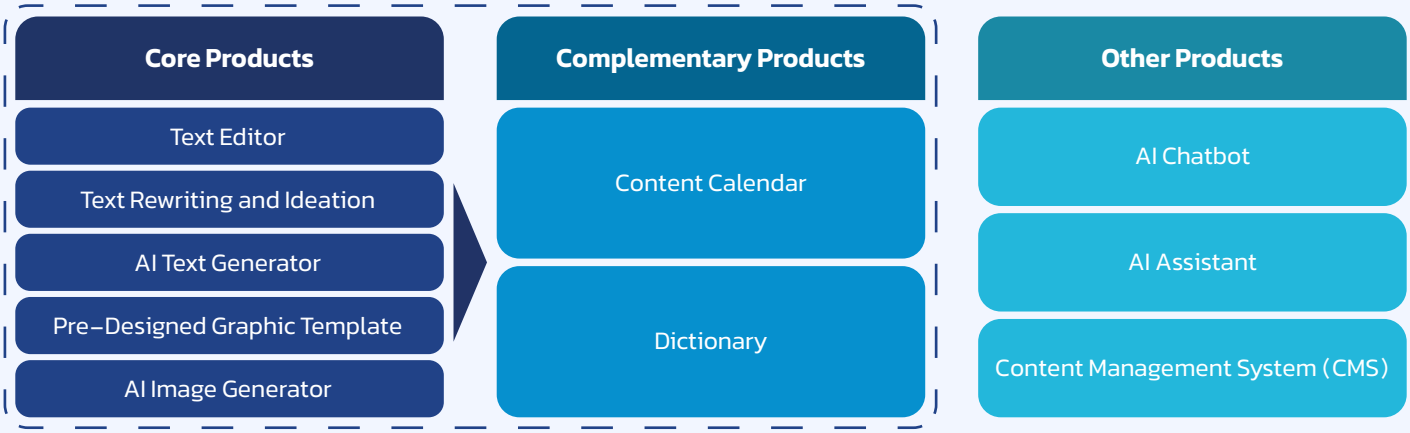
Enhancing Usability and Accessibility through AI Assistants and Chatbots

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the text and image generation tools industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Insight

Providing AI assistants without the need for prompt writing

Providers of "**AI aggregator tools**" offer "**AI assistants**" that eliminate the need for **prompt writing**, serving as alternatives to "**generative AI chatbots**". These assistants have **diverse applications** in content creation, programming, consulting, and more.

Insight

Facilitating access to generative AI chatbots

Due to **sanctions on Iranian businesses** and **internet filtering**, accessing AI chatbots like ChatGPT, Gemini, and others has become **challenging** for **Iranian users**. Providers of AI aggregator tools have enabled access **without the need for VPNs** by integrating APIs.



Amir Sharifzadeh
CEO at Athena

Some providers of AI aggregator tools not only offer direct services to users and businesses but have also expanded into providing B2B services. By aggregating multiple AI APIs, these players provide the infrastructure necessary for other businesses to develop AI-based products.

Products and Features of Text and Image Generation Tools

Completing the product portfolio by offering text and image generation tools together

Core Products and Key Features			
Text Rewriting and Ideation	Title and Headline	Product Name	Keyword
	Business Name	Hashtag	Summarization
Text Editor	Error Detection (Spelling, Editing, and Grammar)	Auto-completion of Words	Converting English and Arabic Numbers to Persian
	Transcription (Converting Conversational Text and Finglish to Persian)	Suggesting Alternatives to Terms Approved by the Academy of Persian Language and Literature	
AI Text Generator	Article	Advertisement	Email
	Social Media Post	Product Description	Text Translation
Pre-Designed Graphic Template	Post and Story	Business Card	Advertising Banner
	Logo	Brochure	Poster
AI Image Generator	Character Design	Environment Design	Vector Images
	Product Image	Post and Story	Logo

Insight

Iranian providers of "**AI text generator**" products have recently introduced **AI-powered image generation tools**, enabling users to produce both text and image content on a **comprehensive platform** without requiring new commands, significantly **saving time**.

Complementary Products and Key Features			
Content Calendar	Automated Content Publishing	Content Idea Suggestions	Keyword Research
Dictionary	Text Translation Engine	Thesaurus	Specialized Dictionary

Comparison of Key Text and Image Generation Tools

Product variety similar to comprehensive and specialized tools, with differences in usage methods

Comparison of Key Text and Image Generation Tools Based on Product Variety

		Core Products					Complementary Products	
		Text Rewriting and Ideation	Text Editor	AI Text Generator	Pre-Designed Graphic Template	AI Image Generator	Content Calendar	Dictionary
Comprehensive Tools	ChatGPT	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓
	Gemini	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓
	Athena	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓
	AvalAI	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓
	Vira	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓
	Zigap	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓
Specialized Image Content Creation Tools	Midjourney	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
	Leonardo AI	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Specialized Content Creation Tools	QuillBot	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
	ContentBot	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓
	Khodnevis	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓	✓	✓
	Mohtava Ba Man	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓

The identification of key players in the table has been based on the volume of content production.

Categorization of Players Based on Product Variety

1. **Comprehensive Tools**: Providers of **AI chatbots** and **assistants** designed for **content creation** and **various other applications**, such as programming, consulting, and more.
2. **Specialized Image Generation Tools**: Providers focused on generating **visual content**, often with **limited product variety**.
3. **Specialized Content Generation Tools**: Providers focused on **text content generation**, with some offering **image generation** capabilities. These tools often feature **high product variety** and generally **do not require prompting**.

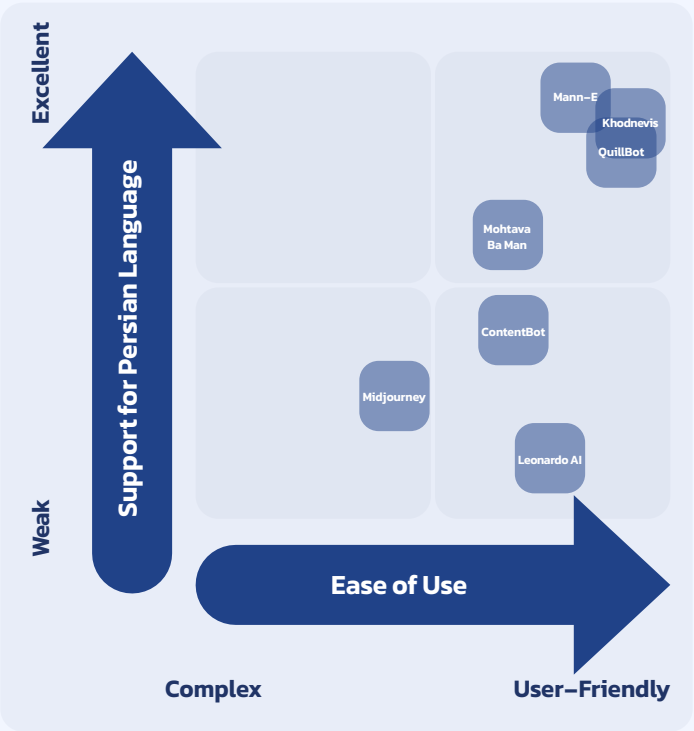
Comparison of Key Text and Image Generation Tools

Ease of access is crucial for customers due to filtering and sanctions

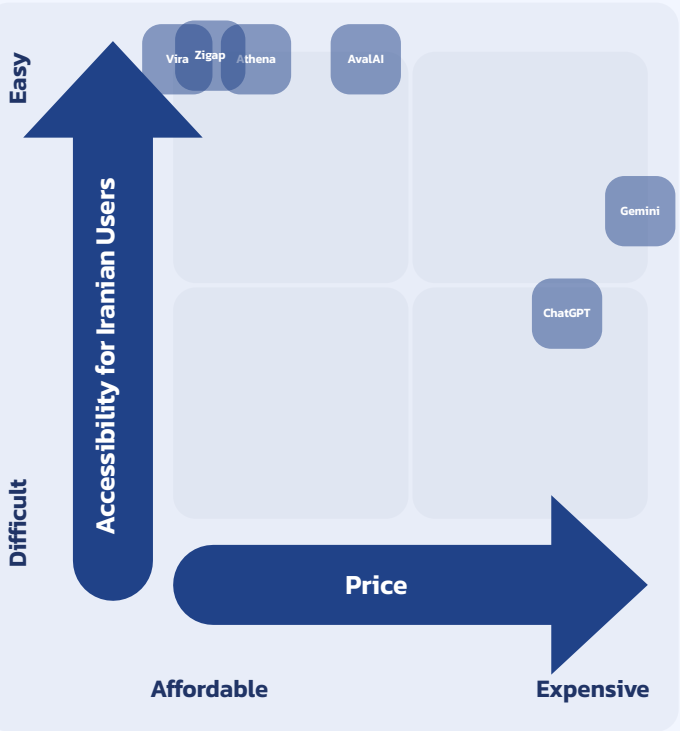
5 Key Criteria for Choosing a Text and Image Generation Tool from the Customer's Perspective

- Price
- Ease of Use
- Accessibility for Iranian Users
- Output Quality
- Support for Persian Language

Comparison of Key Specialized Text and Image Generation Tools – 2023



Comparison of Key Generative AI Chatbots and AI Aggregator Tools – 2023



The identification of key players has been based on content production volume.

The comparison of players was conducted through interviews with five players and experts.



Muhammadreza Haghiri

CEO and CTO of Mann-E

One of the weaknesses of foreign tools was their incompatibility with Iranian culture and the Persian language. As a result, several Iranian players attempted to develop models compatible with Iranian culture and the Persian language using text and image datasets from Microsoft, Meta, and others.

Text and Image Generation Tools Market – 2023

A market size of 160 to 175 billion tomans

Text and Image Generation Tools Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	160 to 175 billion tomans	30% to 40%
Global*	780 million dollars	17%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran



*Considering the service providers' market

Insight

Market size calculation complexity due to the diverse applications of foreign tools

A **significant portion** of the calculated **actual market size** is attributed to the purchase of **premium ChatGPT accounts**. The **diverse applications** of this tool in content creation, programming, education, and more have further **complicated** the calculation of the market size for text and image generation tools.

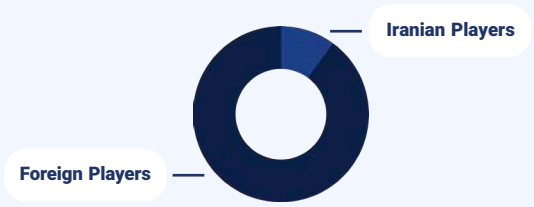
Share of Foreign Players in the Text and Image Generation Tools Market – 2023

Insight

High share of foreign players due to dollar-denominated costs

A large portion of users do not pay for content generation tools and mostly use **free versions**. However, due to **dollar-based payment** requirements, **foreign players** have secured **more than 90%** of the market size.

Share of Foreign Players in Market Size – 2023



Text and Image Generation Tools Market – 2023

Freelance content creators are the primary users of text and image generation tools

Text and Image Generation Tools Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Volume of Content Production

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	ChatGPT with an estimated market share of over 70%
Challenger	Gemini with an estimated market share of over 10%
Follower	• Specialized Tools: Four foreign players—Leonardo AI, Midjourney, QuillBot, and ContentBot—and two Iranian players—Khodnevis and Mohtava Ba Man • Aggregator Tools: Four Iranian players—Athena, AvalAI, Vira, and Zigap
Nicher	

Share of Foreign Players in the Text and Image Generation Tools Market – 2023

Insight

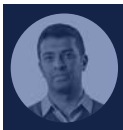
With **ChatGPT** as the **market leader** holding over **70% market share** and **five other foreign players**, it is estimated that **foreign players** account for over **85%** of the content production volume.

Share of Foreign Players in Terms of Content Production Volume – 2023



Which Businesses Use Text and Image Generation Tools the Most?

- Freelance Content Creators
- Content Production Agencies
- Online Retail
- Tourism



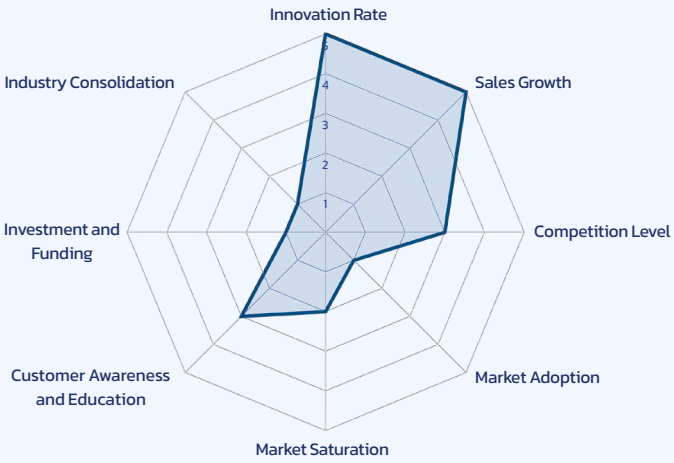
Pooya Behyad
Co-Founder of Khodnevis

Businesses' preference for hiring full-time staff or working with freelancers is one of the main reasons for the limited use of content generation tools. However, due to the high cost of skilled and high-quality professionals, the use of AI tools by small and medium-sized businesses is rapidly increasing. As these tools become more accurate and specialized, larger businesses are also expected to adopt them.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Text and Image Generation Tools Industry – 2023

Very high level of innovation due to access to tools or APIs from foreign players

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Text and Image Generation Tools Industry – 2023

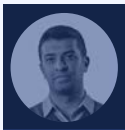




Amir Sharifzadeh

CEO of Athena

The utilization of foreign players APIs by domestic players, along with Iranian users' access to foreign tools like ChatGPT, is the main reason for the exceptionally high level of innovation in this industry in Iran.



Pooya Behyad

Co–Founder of Khodnevis

The development of proprietary language models had certain advantages, but the limited supply of GPUs increased the bargaining power of suppliers. However, with the release of GPT-4o mini, which offers APIs at a very low cost, developing proprietary models is no longer cost-effective due to the high expense of GPU procurement.

Text and Image Generation Tools Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

The development of AI assistants and integration with website builders are key trends in Iran

Text and Image Generation Tools Industry Trends – 2023

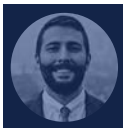
Global	Iran
Expanding the capabilities and applications of image generation tools across various industries, especially online retail	Developing AI assistants to simplify the content creation process for non-technical users without the need for prompting
Offering advanced customization features such as tone, style, and template settings	Increasing demand for editing and product visualization tools from the online retail industry
Integration of text generation tools with content management systems and website builders	Integration of text generation tools with content management systems and website builders
	Offering SEO tools



Amirhossein Mehrdoust

Founder of Fibonacci

The development of customized AI assistants with specialized applications in SEO, caption writing, copywriting, and more will shape the future of Iranian players. Enhancing user-friendliness through predefined commands and integration with diverse AI models could become a key strength for Iranian players.



Reza Chamani

Marketing Manager at Dorsa Brand Group

In the fashion and lifestyle industry, AI-powered image generation tools could soon replace traditional photography. Small businesses unable to afford the high costs of professional photography can greatly benefit from these tools.

Data Partners in the Text and Image Generation Tools Industry

Khodnevis: Automating Content Creation and Management Workflow With AI

28,000
Total registered users

1.1 million words
Text-based content generated daily

73%
Average quarterly revenue growth rate (H1 2024)

Proprietary Large Language Model (LLM)

- 4 text models & 1 image model
- Supports Persian and English
- **90%** Reduction in content production costs
- **95%** Time savings in content creation

Content Marketing Strategy Product

- Keyword research tool
- Keyword gap analysis
- Automated content publishing
- Competitor content analysis

Direct Link to the Website

Athena: A Platform for Specialized AI Bots and General Chatbots

60,000+
Total registered users

1,500
Daily active users

25%
Average monthly revenue growth rate (H1 2024)

30,000
User chats with specialized content generation bots (H1 2024)

Specialized Text and Image Generation Bots

- Summarization and translation
- Text editing
- Conversation response
- Instagram captions
- LinkedIn post

Athena Exploration Page (Web)

Data Partners in the Text and Image Generation Tools Industry

Pixy: AI-Powered Advertising Content Generation Tool in Under 5 Minutes

750+
Ad campaigns created (since early 2023)

370,000+
Advertising words written (since early 2023)

11,000+
Creative ad assets generated (since early 2023)

Key Features and Capabilities

Analyzing Brand-Related Content
By extracting brand insights and identity

Generating Ad Headlines and Images
Tailored to campaign objectives

Creating Ad Banners
Customized based on brand and campaign

Supporting Persian, English, and Arabic
With the option to add more languages

Variety of AI Models

- 5 AI models for image generation
- 3 AI models for video generation
- 8 AI models for text generation
- 10 AI tools for image processing

Direct Link to the Website

13

SEO Tool

Industry Data Partner:

jetseo.ir

Report Partners: SMARTECH ابزارک

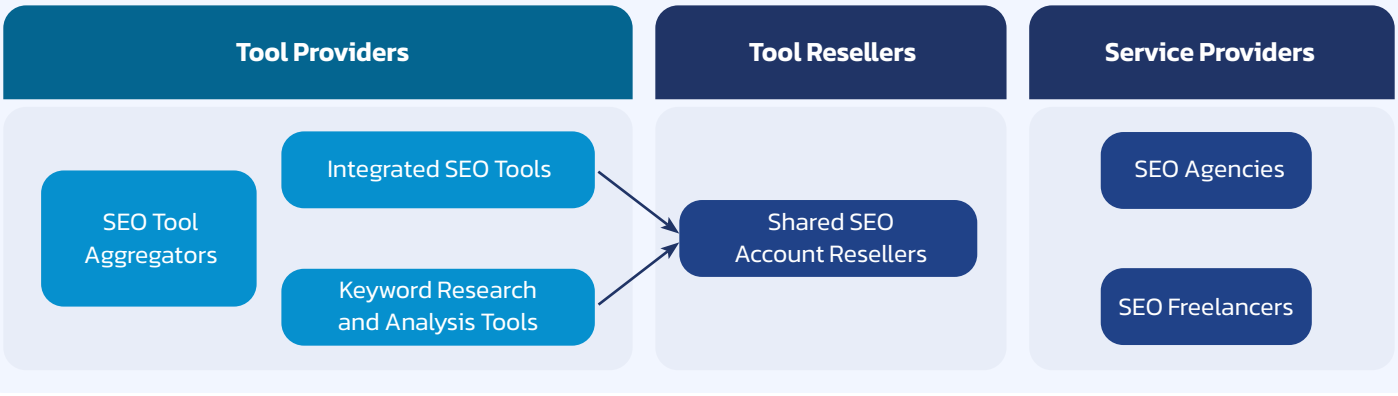
TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of SEO Tool

Providing SEO analysis tools to achieve top rankings in search engine results

SEO tool providers empower businesses to identify and implement strategies to achieve **top rankings in search engine results** through tools such as **keyword research**, **content and on-page optimization**, **technical SEO and site audits**, and more.

Classification of SEO Industry Players



"**Tool providers**" facilitate access to SEO tools for users and businesses by **developing their proprietary tools**, while "**tool resellers**" enable access by **selling accounts of foreign providers**. "**Service providers**" are a **target market** for both **tool providers** and **resellers**, utilizing these tools to **deliver SEO services to businesses**.

Given the report's focus on marketing technology tools, the areas of tool vendors and service providers will not be further examined.

Integrated SEO Tools	Providers of **various SEO tools** in a **unified platform** and **dashboard**, facilitating the monitoring and analysis of website SEO across different time periods
SEO Tool Aggregators	Providers of **various SEO tools** with the ability to analyze and review SEO in each tool **separately**, but **without the capability to monitor results and data over time** due to the **lack of an integrated dashboard**
Keyword Research and Analysis Tools	Players focused on providing specialized tools for **keyword research and analysis**



Arman Safayi

Co-founder and CEO of Triboon

Due to the high cost and limited accessibility of foreign tools, businesses have arisen that procure accounts of foreign providers and resell them to experts in various fields. On one hand, this has made foreign providers more accessible to Iranian specialists, but on the other hand, it has hindered the development of a market for Iranian providers.

SEO Tools – 2023

Active presence of more than 10 foreign tools in the Iranian market

SEO Tools

Integrated SEO Tools

Providers of various SEO tools offered through an integrated platform

Foreign Tools Used in the Iranian Market

- Semrush
- Moz
- Screaming Frog
- Ahrefs
- Google Search Console
- SEO PowerSuite
- Majestic
- Nightwatch
- cognitiveSEO

Iranian Tools

- Jetseo
- Mizfa Tools
- Scout
- KWRank
- Maxeo
- Rotbe Kalame
- Rankfind
- SEO Signal

Keyword Research and Analysis Tools

Providers focused on specialized tools for keyword research and analysis

Foreign Tools Used in the Iranian Market

- Keyword Tool
- KWFinder

Iranian Tools (Focused on Search Engines)

- Keywordchi
- Diffrank
- Keyword Rank
- Websima

Iranian Tools (Focused on Social Media)

- Keywordchi
- Hashtag Khoone
- Insta Hashtag
- Hashtag Haye Bartar
- Hashtag Saaz

SEO Tool Aggregators

Providers and aggregators of various SEO tools offered separately

- G-ADS
- Upseo
- Checkup Tools

Insight

Despite **sanctions** on Iranian businesses, **internet filtering**, and the **high cost of dollar-based subscriptions**, numerous foreign players are active in Iran. The availability of shared accounts for foreign tools by "tool resellers" has facilitated **affordable access** and **increased demand** for foreign tools.

Applications of SEO Tools in the Marketing Funnel

Mainly used in awareness and consideration stages to attract potential customers via search engines

SEO tools are designed to achieve **top rankings** in **search engine results** and **increase traffic** by showcasing **high-quality, relevant content** that addresses users' needs and issues. Therefore, their primary use and impact lie in the **awareness** and **consideration** stages.



- Conducting keyword research related to users' purchasing behavior
- Performing technical and content analysis of product pages

- Optimizing website content to address the specific questions and needs of potential users
- Improving site structure and internal links to enhance user experience and increase engagement

- Identifying keywords searched by users for content creation
- Optimizing website content to achieve higher rankings in search engines results



Pouria Ariafar
Founder and CEO of Mizfa Tools

SEO tools are directly utilized in the awareness and consideration stages and indirectly in the purchase, loyalty, and advocacy stages. More importantly, user behavior during the last three steps has a profound impact on a website's SEO and branding, which SEO specialists must consider.

Timeline and Milestones of SEO Tools in Iran and the World

SEO services started in the mid–2000s, with the first Iranian tools emerging in the early 2010s

World **Iran**

Late 1980s – Mid 1990s

- The emergence of SEO with the creation of the first search engines like Yahoo and WebCrawler (now Google)
- The first generation of SEO tools focused on keyword analysis and optimization

Late 1990s – Early 2000s

- Improving website ranking processes on Google with an emphasis on content quality and backlinks
- Development of tools for backlink analysis, website rank monitoring, and keyword rank tracking

Mid 2000s

- Google's focus on content quality and proper link–building with the Penguin and Panda algorithms
- The rise of integrated SEO platforms like Moz and Semrush

Mid 2000s

- Providing SEO services in Iran alongside website design and development services

Late 2000s – Early 2010s

- Google's shift in site ranking priorities based on site speed and mobile web usability
- Introduction of tools for mobile optimization, site speed analysis, and local SEO

Early 2010s

- Promoting the use of SEO services by separating them from website design and development services
- The emergence of the first Iranian SEO tools with keyword rank tracking capabilities

Mid 2010s

- Rising demand for SEO services as businesses shift strategies from Google Ads to SEO in response to the escalating dollar–rial exchange rate

Mid 2010s – Early 2020s

- The integration of AI and machine learning into Google's search algorithms
- Introduction of advanced SEO tools focused on user behavior analysis, real–time data analysis, predictive analytics, and competitor analysis

Late 2010s

- Increased demand for SEO with the outbreak of the COVID–19 virus
- Launch of integrated Iranian SEO tools



Reza Shirazi

Founder and CEO of Jetseo

Freelancers have captured around 75% of the SEO services market, and the scalability challenges of SEO agency business models have led some agencies to shift toward tool development. There are several hundred SEO agencies in Iran, but fewer than 5% are prominent and generate significant revenue by handling large projects.

Products and Features of SEO Tools

SEO project management product for defining and prioritizing actions after SEO analysis

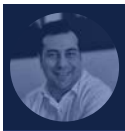
By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the seo tools industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.





Ali Hosseini

Founder and CEO of Seolaboratory

One of the weaknesses of SEO tools is leaving users unsupported after the website SEO analysis phase. The SEO project management product, by defining and prioritizing actions and tasks based on business goals, offers valuable support in the post-analysis stage, especially for inexperienced and beginner users.

Products and Features of SEO Tools

Offering a complementary AI–powered text content generation product

Core Products and Key Features

Keyword Research	Keyword Discovery	Long–Tail Keyword	
	Keyword Gap Analysis	Related Keyword Suggestion	
Keyword Analysis	Search Volume	Keyword Difficulty	
	Keyword Ranking	Keyword Conversion Rate	
SEO Audit & Optimization	Off–page SEO Analysis	Content and On–Page Optimization	
	Technical SEO and Site Audits		
Rank Tracking	Local Ranking	Website Score	
	Global Ranking	Website Status	
Competitor Analysis	Share of Voice (SOV) for Competitors	Competitor SEO Strategy Analysis	Competitors' Website Ranking
	Competitor Keyword Analysis	Competitors' Website Traffic Statistics	

Complementary Products and Key Features

AI Text Generator	Text Rewriting and Ideation	Article Writing	Post Caption Writing
Hashtag Finder			

With the emergence of **AI-powered content generation tools** and the increasing **integration of SEO with content creation**, a limited number of players in this field have introduced "**AI Text Generator**" products.

Comparison of Key SEO Tools

Semrush and Jetseo are the most comprehensive SEO tools in the Iranian market

Comparison of Key SEO Tools Based on Product Variety

	Core Products					Complementary Products	
	Keyword Research	Keyword Analysis	SEO Audit & Optimization	Rank Tracking	Competitor Analysis	AI Text Generator	Hashtag Finder
Semrush	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Jetseo	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Moz	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Ahrefs	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗
Mizfa Tools	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Seo Signal	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗
Keywordchi	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗
KWFinder	✗	Limited	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Keyword Tool	✓	Limited	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Screaming Frog	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗

The identification of key players in the table is based on the number of users.

Insight

Based on product variety, it can be said that **Semrush** and **JetSEO** are the **most comprehensive SEO tools** in the Iranian market. Their only distinction compared to other players lies in offering **AI text generator**. Recently, **Keywordchi** has introduced its own AI text generator. **Keywordchi**, **KWFinder,** and **Keyword Tool** are considered key players in the field of **keyword research and analysis**.

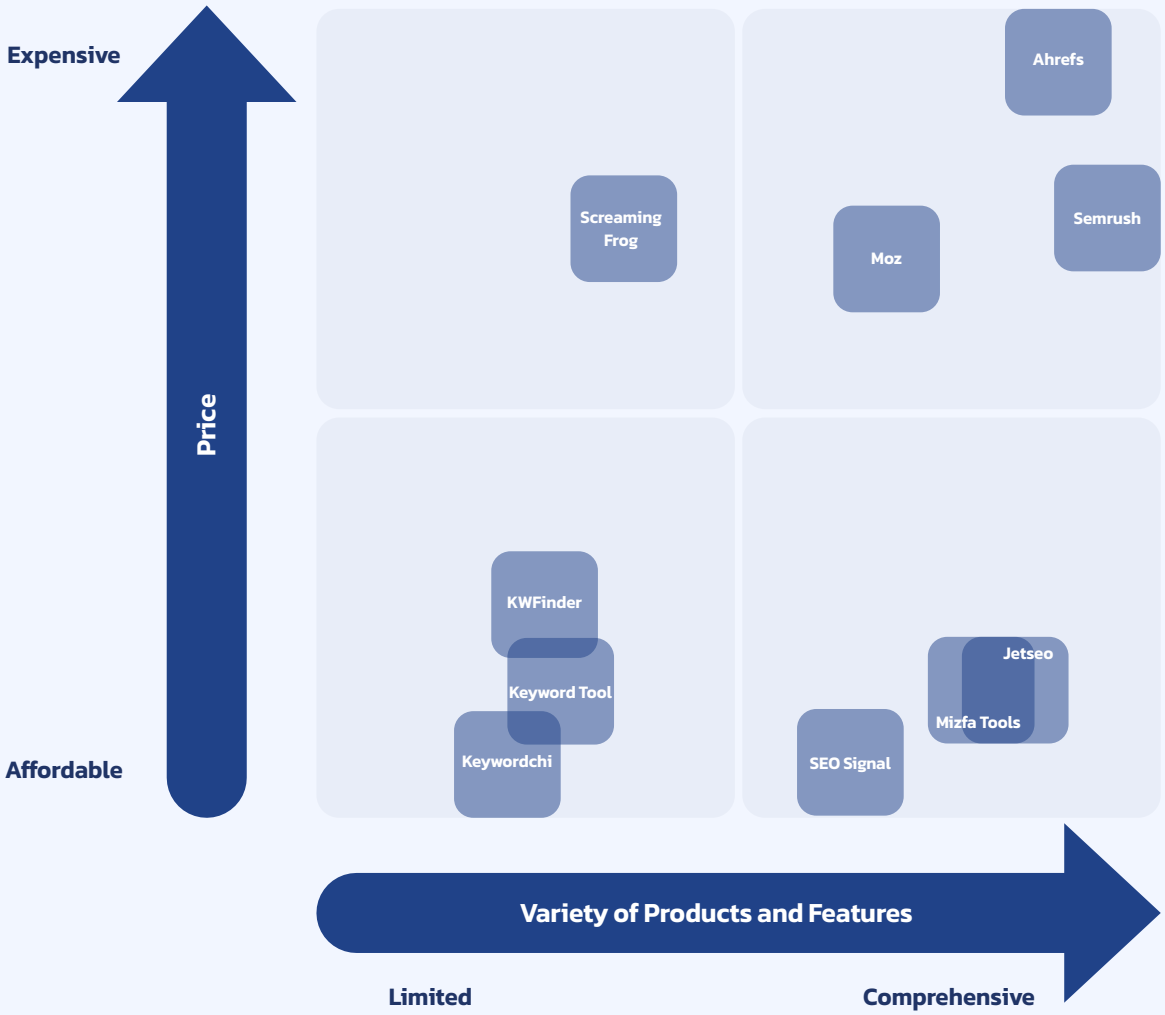
Comparison of Key SEO Tools

The level of accuracy in Persian is the top criterion for choosing an SEO tool

5 Key Criteria for Choosing an SEO Tool from the Customer's Perspective

- Accuracy in Persian
- Speed of Adapting to Google's Updates
- Variety of Products and Features
- Ease of Use
- Price

Comparison of Key SEO Tools – 2023



Key players have been identified based on the number of users.



Esmaeil Noormohammadi

Co–Founder of Keywordchi

One of the main challenges of SEO tools is the low accuracy and reliability of keyword search volume data in Persian. The only way to access this data is through the Google Ads API, which, despite supporting the Persian language, does not provide access to data from users located in Iran due to sanctions. While data is available for search volume conducted in Persian by users using VPNs or from outside Iran, it is inherently inaccurate and unreliable.

SEO Tools Market – 2023

The SEO tools market in Iran is valued at 35 to 45 billion tomans

SEO Market Size (Tools and Services) – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	700 to 900 billion tomans	40% to 55%
Global	82 billion dollars	10%

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

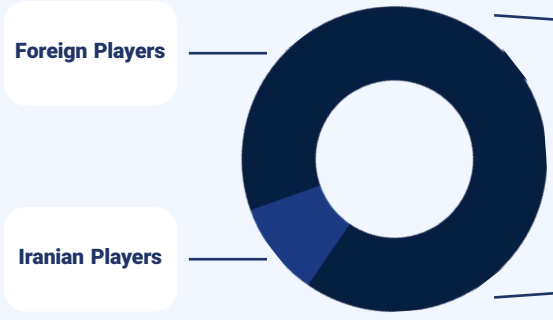
1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

SEO Tools Market Size – 2023

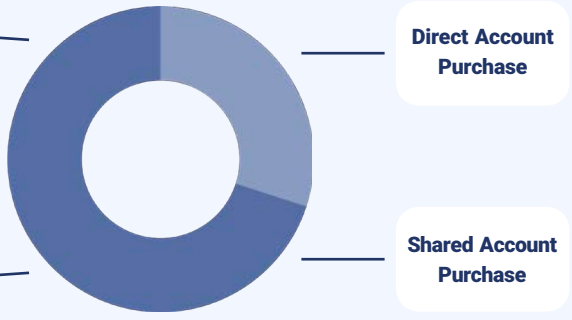
Monetary Share of Tools in Each SEO Project	Actual Market Size
5%	35 to 45 billion tomans

Share of Foreign Players in SEO Tools Market – 2023

The Share of Foreign Players in Market Size – 2023



How Iranian Users Purchase Foreign Tool Accounts – 2023



Insight

The monetary (rial) share of **foreign players** in the SEO tools market in Iran is estimated to **exceed 90%**. According to experts, **30% of customers** use foreign tools through **direct account purchases**, while **70%** rely on **shared account purchases** from "tool resellers".

SEO Tools Market – 2023

More than 80% of SEO tool users are attributed to foreign players

SEO Tools Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Users

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	Semrush and Moz are estimated to hold a combined share of over 50%
Challenger	Jetseo with an estimated market share of 20% to 30%
Follower	Mizfa Tools, SEO Signal, and Ahrefs each with an estimated market share of 10% to 20%
Nicher	KWFinder and Keyword Tool, leaders in keyword research and analysis Screaming Frog, leader in the technical SEO analysis

Insight

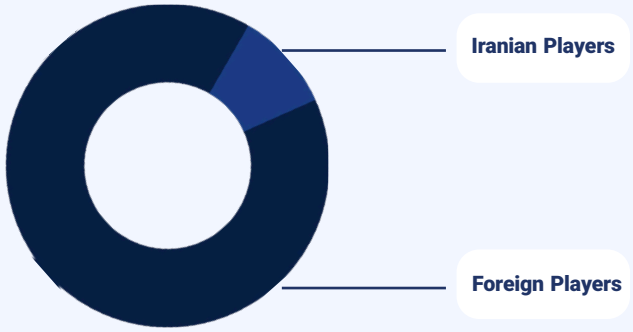
The **bundling of shared accounts** for multiple foreign tools in a **single package** has led several players to hold **over 50%** of the market share. The market share of tools like **KWFinder**, **Keyword Tool**, and **Screaming Frog**, which operate in niche markets, is also estimated to **exceed 50%**.

Share of Foreign Players in SEO Tools Market – 2023

Insight

According to experts, most **Iranian SEO professionals** use at least one **foreign tool**, with the majority purchasing **shared accounts** from "shared SEO account resellers". On average, Iranian freelancers handle **three projects** per year, with SEO tools playing a crucial role in executing these projects.

The Market Share of Foreign Players by Number of Users – 2023



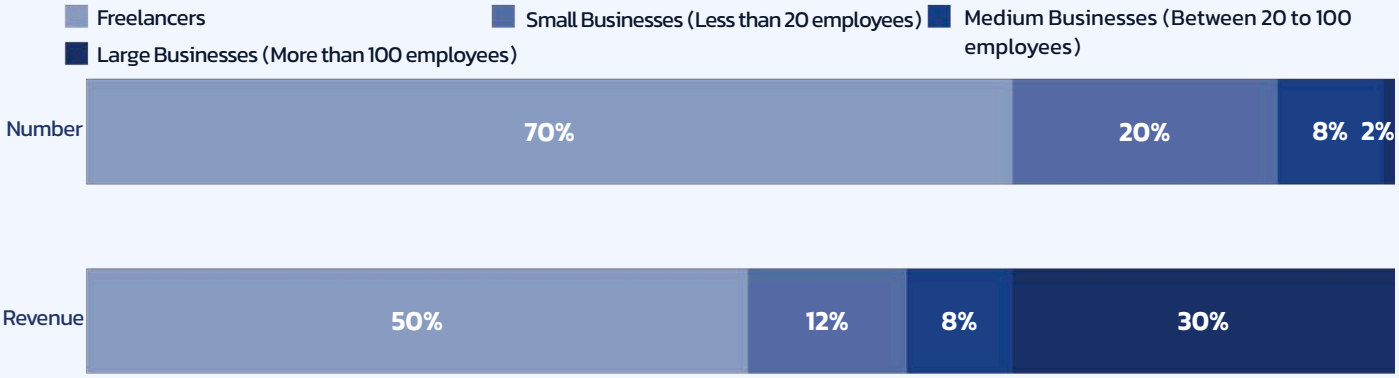
SEO Tools Market – 2023

SEO freelancers are the primary customers of SEO tools

Which Businesses Use SEO Tools the Most?

- SEO Specialists
- SEO Agencies
- Online Retail
- Tourism
- Financial Technology (FinTech)
- HealthTech

Revenue and Customer Distribution of SEO Tools by Business Size – 2023





Reza Shirazi

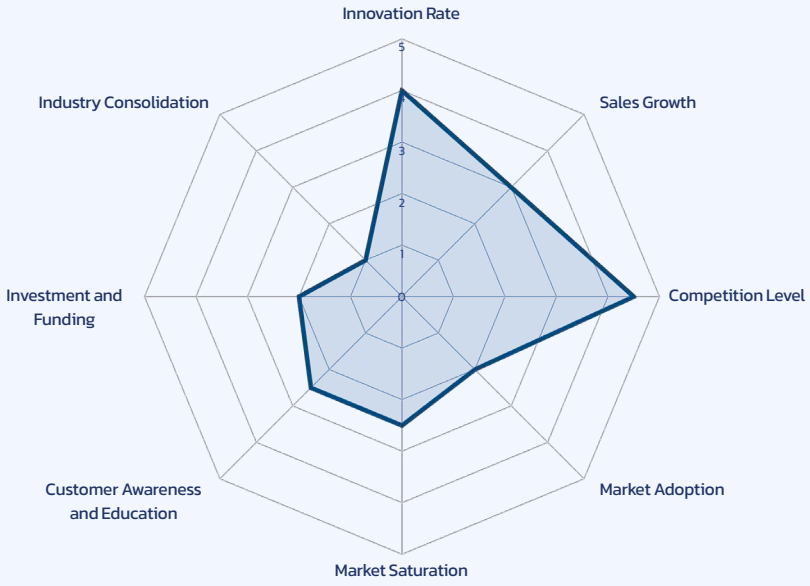
Founder and CEO of Jetseo

Small business managers, SEO freelancers, digital marketers, and content creators make up the majority of SEO tool users. The significant share of freelancers in both the number and revenue of SEO tool providers is due to their dominant presence in the SEO market and their need to purchase tools for executing projects on behalf of other businesses.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the SEO Tools Industry – 2023

Intense competition between SEO tool providers and shared account resellers for foreign tools

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the SEO Tools Industry – 2023





Ali Hosseini

Founder of Seolaboratory

The high level of innovation in this industry is driven by the presence and use of top-tier foreign tools, which themselves exhibit exceptional innovation.



Esmaeil Noormohammadi

Co-Founder of Keywordchi

Given their small market share and lack of trust from businesses, Iranian players face minimal competition among themselves. However, the availability of foreign tools at one-tenth of their original price through "shared account resellers" has significantly intensified competition and price wars between Iranian and foreign players.

SEO Tools Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

Using AI to provide SEO improvement suggestions and content creation

SEO Tools Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Focusing SEO tools on improving speed, usability, and mobile web readability due to the rise in mobile web searches	Development of AI-powered SEO analytics tools with the capability to suggest actions and strategies
Offering AI and machine learning-based SEO tools aimed at providing deep analysis and insights into search trends, user behavior, and content performance	The need to develop advanced SEO tools tailored to the algorithms of modern AI-based search engines
The need for SEO tools for multimedia content due to the growing popularity of image and video content	Providing AI-based content generation tools
Development of SEO tools specifically for voice assistants like Siri, Alexa, and others to address voice search queries	Providing tools for analyzing advertorials, such as monitoring external backlinks
	Increasing demand for SEO services and tools from offline service-oriented businesses

Data Partner in the SEO Tools Industry

Jetseo: Your Guide to Website SEO

42,000+
Total registered users

3,500+
Daily active users

85%
Growth in registered users (2022 to 2023)

99%
Revenue growth (2022 to 2023)

Notable Clients

Banimode

Bitpin

RTL-Theme

Bonmano

Key Features and Capabilities

- AI-powered SEO content generation tool
- Content structuring for SEO-optimized content creation
- Comprehensive free extension with 1,400+ active users

Sign-up link and free 7-day advanced subscription trial

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Landing Page Design Tool

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဆောဖ်ဝဲ

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Landing Page Design Tool

Building landing pages and bio links without the need for coding

Companies offering landing page design tools provide businesses with solutions for **creating landing pages without requiring technical expertise**, enabling them to **execute marketing campaigns** effectively. These companies also offer **link-in-bio tools** for I**nstagram pages**, allowing businesses to **aggregate information in their Instagram bio** and engage with followers outside the Instagram platform.

Classification of the Landing Page Design Industry Players

Tool Providers

- Landing Page Builders
- Link-in-Bio Tools
- Content Management Systems (CMS)

Service Providers

- Template Sellers
- Outsourcing Platforms
- Advertising Agencies

"**Tool providers**" supply **design** and **management** solutions for **landing pages** and **link-in-bio** functionalities, while "**service providers**" design landing pages through **programming** or by selling **pre-designed templates**.

Given the report's focus on MarTech tools, service providers will not be analyzed further. Additionally, content management systems (CMS) are excluded due to their foundational role and non-specialized use cases.

Landing Page Builders	Providers of **specialized no-code landing page design tools** for implementing various **marketing campaigns**, such as lead generation, product promotion, and more
Link-in-Bio Tools	Providers of link-in-bio tools that **aggregate information** such as contact details, text, and image content for **sharing on social media profiles**, aimed at directing followers to messaging platforms, websites, product pages, and more



Mahdi Zahiri

Founder and CEO of Landin

Among the three advertising campaigns, one is desgined utilizing landing page builders, one by in-house teams, and one outsourced to advertising agencies. While businesses use various methods to create landing pages, the preference for landing page builders is on the rise, driven by their rapid deployment and superior efficiency.

Landing Page Design Tools – 2023

11 Iranian and 3 foreign tools are active in the Iranian market

Landing Page Design Tools

Landing Page Builders

Providers of specialized landing page design tools for implementing marketing campaigns

Iranian Tools

- Landin
- Landik
- Webzi

Foreign Tools Used in the Iranian Market

- Unbounce
- Instapage
- Leadpages

Link-in-Bio Tools

Providers of tools that aggregate links and content into a single link for sharing on social media profiles

Iranian Tools

- ZiLink
- Yeklink
- Takl.ink
- OOVO
- Zaya
- REDlink
- Cartino
- bitn

Insight

Limited use of foreign landing page builders

The main reasons for the limited use of foreign landing page builders by Iranian businesses include **slow loading speeds** due to servers hosted abroad, **restrictions on cross-border payments**, and **incompatibility with the Persian language** and the **needs of the Iranian market**.

Insight

The absence of foreign players providing link-in-bio tools

The primary reasons for the lack of use of foreign link-in-bio tools in Iran are the **sanctions on Iranian businesses** by foreign players, **challenges with cross-border payments**, and the **high costs** of foreign tools priced in dollars.

Timeline and Milestones of Landing Page Design Tools in Iran and the World

The first landing page builder and link-in-bio tools in Iran began operating in the late 2010s



Late 1990s – Early 2000s

- The concept of landing pages emerged from the demand of businesses for dedicated web pages to generate leads

Late 2000s – Early 2010s

- The development of the first no-code landing page builder tools, such as Unbounce and Leadpages
- The introduction of advanced features like visitor analytics, conversion rate optimization, and more by Instapage and ClickFunnels

Mid 2010s

- Designing landing pages using website builders and WordPress

Late 2010s

- The launch of the first landing page builders and link-in-bio tools

Mid 2010s – Now

- The development of the first link-in-bio tools, such as Linktree and Shorby
- Integration of e-commerce features into landing page builders and link-in-bio tools
- Automation of landing page design using AI by tools like Carrd and Milkshake

Early 2020s

- A 70% decline in landing page creation on Landin due to the internet shutdown in 2022
- Zilink attracting 650,000 businesses
- Landin securing investment from Smartup Ventures
- Zilink acquired by TOSAN SOHA



Mostafa Alahyari

Founder of ZiLink and muchat

Contrary to the common belief that link-in-bio tools were only valuable for adding links, their true value lies in bridging social media users to the outside world.

Since 2022, Instagram's link aggregation in bios has reduced the value proposition of link-in-bio tools. However, their usage has grown rapidly as they now address broader user needs with features like contact info, forms, product lists, and more.

Applications of Landing Page Design Tools in the Marketing Funnel

Used in awareness to purchase for lead generation, information delivery, and boosting conversion rates

Landing page builders enable marketers to create **standalone web pages** for **marketing or advertising campaigns**. These tools are designed to **optimize customer conversion rates**, facilitating lead generation, product promotion, and encouraging user toward specific actions.

The primary use of link-in-bio tools is to overcome the **limitation of adding multiple links** in social media profiles by creating a **centralized link** that directs followers to various destinations. These tools are mainly used in the **awareness** to **purchase** stages to introduce social media users, products, and services to their followers.

Landing Page Builders	Link–in–Bio Tools
• Collecting customer feedback to measure satisfaction and identify areas for improvement • Landing pages for special offers and encouraging repeat purchases from existing customers	
• Dedicated order payment landing page to streamline the purchase process	• Sharing a direct payment link to complete the online purchase process
• Generating landing pages to highlight key benefits and features of products and services • Building product comparison pages to evaluate different options	• Providing educational content, such as guides, FAQs, and more, to nurture leads • Directing users to product or service detail pages
• Designing landing pages for advertising campaigns to attract potential customers • Providing sign–up forms to new audiences on event or webinar landing pages	• Sharing posts, contact information, and other resources on social media profiles to attract new audiences



Products and Features of Landing Page Design Tools

Entering the e–commerce and social commerce industries by offering an e–commerce platform

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the landing page design tools industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.

Core Products	Complementary Products	Other Products
Landing Page Builder		Website Builder
Link–in–Bio		E–commerce Platform
		Digital Business Card
		URL Shortener

Core Products and Key Features

Landing Page Builder	Customizable Templates	Custom Domain	QR Code Generator	URL Shortener
	Lead Management	Content Delivery Network (CDN)	Traffic Analytics	
Link–in–Bio	Adding Contact Methods (Social Media, Messaging Apps, Phone, Address, etc.)		Sign–Up Form	Custom Domain
	Uploading Text, Images, and Videos	Product Catalog	Order Placement Form	Traffic Analytics

Landing Page Design Tools Market – 2023

Landin, the market leader in landing page builders, holds a market share of over 50%

Landing Page Builders Market Structure – 2023

Metric:	Number of Users	*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method
Leader	Landin	

Insight

Landin, the market leader in landing page builders market

Landin, the **market leader** in landing page builders in Iran, is currently used by **30,000 businesses**. The **lack of interest from Iranian players** to **enter the market**, along with the **absence of significant foreign players**, has left the field without any notable challengers.

Landing Page Design Market Size (Services and Tools) – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	18 to 23 billion tomans	40% to 50%
Global	574 million dollars	17%

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Insight

Market size growth is driven solely by **price increases**, with minimal customer growth.

Share of Landing Page Builder Tools within the Landing Page Design Market – 2023

Insight

In addition to the **service providers** with **over 60% market share**, several **large Iranian businesses** have shifted to designing and implementing landing pages using their **in-house teams**. These factors have contributed to the **decline** of the landing page builder tools market.



Landing Page Design Tools Market – 2023

ZiLink, the market leader in link–in–bio tools, holds a market share of over 50%

Link–in–Bio Tools Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Users

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	ZiLink with an estimated market share of over 50%
Challenger	Yeklink with an estimated market share of at least 10%
Follower	Takl.ink, Cartino, and OVOO, each with an estimated market share of less than 10%
Nicher	

Insight

ZiLink, with **over 600,000 users**, is **by far the market leader** in link-in-bio tools in Iran. In **2023**, it was acquired by **TOSAN SOHA**.

Which Businesses Use Link–in–Bio Tools the Most?

- Instagram shops
- Influencers
- Freelancers
- Small Businesses and Trade Units



Mostafa Alahyari

Founder of ZiLink and muchat

Before the introduction of Link-in-bio tools, most Instagram-based businesses showed little interest in leveraging technology-driven tools. With over 70% of Instagram businesses adopting Link-in-bio, their demand for solutions such as online payment gateways, e-commerce platforms, and similar solutions increased, highlighting the necessity of incorporating these tools into bio links.

Landing Page Design Industry Outlook

Offering an e-commerce platform tailored for offline and Instagram-based businesses

Landing Page Builders Outlook

Insight

Decline in advertising campaigns as a factor in the downturn of the landing page builders market

The **landing page builder market's growth or decline** is **directly** tied to the **digital advertising market**. **Cost-cutting** during the **economic recession** shrank the **digital advertising market**, leading to **stagnation** in the landing page builders market.



Mahdi Zahiri

Founder and CEO of Landin

The future of landing page builders lies in simplifying the design process and enhancing user engagement with brands. As AI technology advances and these tools become more intelligent, more users with limited technical expertise will be able to craft professional landing pages tailored to their campaign needs.

Link-in-Bio Tools Outlook

Insight

Over 80% of the potential market uses link-in-bio tools

According to experts, **over 600,000 users**, equivalent to **80% of the potential market**, are currently using link-in-bio tools. **Most users** access these tools for **free**, which has **slowed** the **market's growth rate**, making rapid growth like in previous years unlikely.

Insight

Offering a highly user-friendly e-commerce platform tailored to a specific market segment

Link-in-bio tools have the opportunity to grow by offering online store builders with **easy setup** and **high usability**, targeting a significant segment of **Instagram shops** who **avoid complex tools**.



Amir Arsalan Cham Khorram

Founder and CEO of Cartino

Link-in-bio tools are entering the online retail industry by offering e-commerce platforms. Current players aim to attract offline businesses interested in online sales and Instagram stores by providing online payment and logistics services alongside simplifying the process of creating online stores.

15

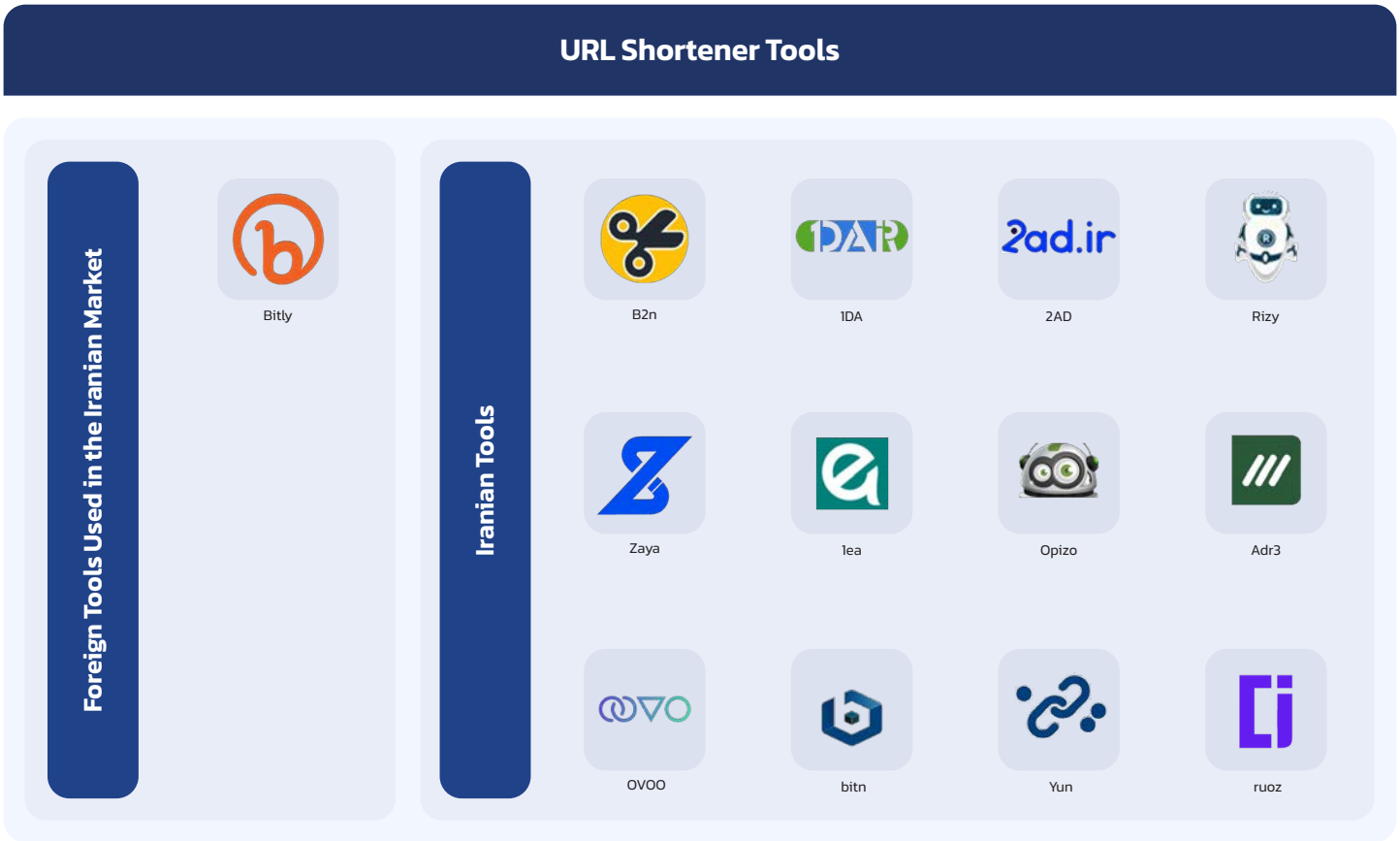
URL Shortener Tool

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဘာသာ TECHRASA. Insight

URL Shortener Tools – 2023

12 Iranian URL shortener tools have been identified

URL shortener tools convert **long links** into **shorter ones**. These tools address businesses' challenges in **sharing**, **organizing**, **tracking**, and **analyzing** links sent across various marketing channels.



The emergence of Iranian players since the early 2010s

The first Iranian URL shortener tools started their activities in the **early 2010s**, most of which were launched by individuals. Currently, these are **small companies** with a maximum of five employees. The time gap between the launch of **Iranian players** and their **global counterparts** is **less than a decade**.

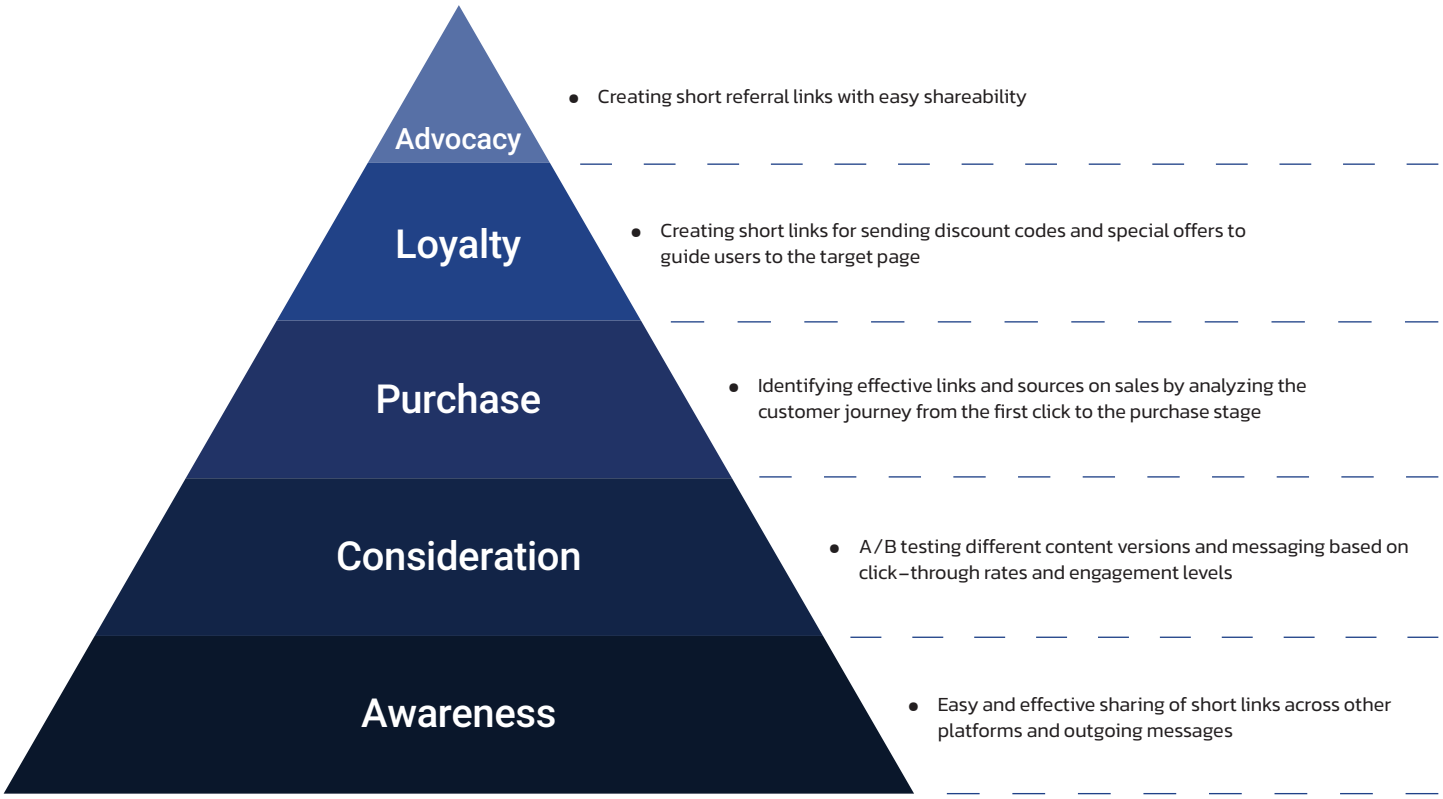
Bitly filtering in 2020

Bitly, which had been filtered for 24 hours in 2018, was blocked in **October 2020** and became **inaccessible** to **Iranian users**. As a result, some businesses turned to **Iranian alternatives**, while others **developed their own** URL shortener tools within their organizations to meet their needs.

Applications of URL Shortener Tools in the Marketing Funnel

Easy and effective sharing of short links across various marketing channels

A URL shortener may seem like a simple tool, but its strength lies in creating links with **high shareability** and **easy management**. These tools are used at **all stages of the marketing funnel** to improve **user experience**, increase **click-through rates**, and enhance **brand visibility**.



Products and Features of URL Shortener Tools

Product development incorporating link–in–bio as a complementary product

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the URL shortener tools industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Core Products and Key Features

URL Shortener	Creating Short Link	Creating QR Code	Creating Encrypted Link	Creating UTM
	Custom Domain	Link Analytics	Link Management	Bulk Link Shortener
	User Targeting (based on geographic location, platform, etc.)		A/B Testing	

Complementary Products and Key Features

Link–in–Bio	Adding Contact Information (social media, messenger, phone, address, etc.)		Sign–Up Form	Custom Domain
	Uploading Text, Images, and Videos	Product Catalog	Order Placement Form	Traffic Analytics

Offering link–in–bio as the product development path of URL shortener tool providers

Some players have introduced the "**link-in-bio**" product, allowing users to create **customized landing pages** for sharing with their audiences. This strategy aims to **increase the use of the URL shortener tool** within the social media.

Monetization through pay–per–click advertising

Given that URL shortener tools are offered for **free**, most players **monetize** through **pay-per-click advertising**. In this model, visitors clicking on shortened links are **shown an advertisement** for a **few seconds** before being redirected to the destination link.

16

Website Builder Platform

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဖြစ်ပျက်

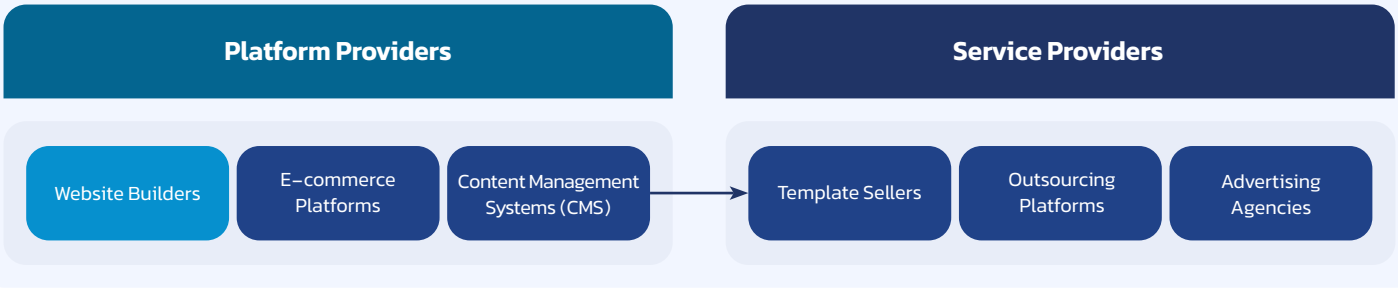
TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Website Builder Platform

Enabling businesses and individuals to establish an online presence without requiring technical knowledge

Website builder platforms offer the **infrastructure** that empowers **businesses and individuals** to establish their digital presence, requiring no technical expertise and incurring **minimal costs and time** investments.

Classification of the Website Design and Development Industry Players

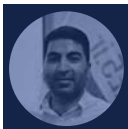


"**Platform providers**" offer **website design** and **management** tools that require **no technical knowledge**. "**Service providers**" deliver solutions via custom **programming**, **content management systems**, or **pre-designed templates**, tailored to users seeking **advanced** and **sophisticated** website functionalities.

Given the focus of this report on marketing technology tools, service providers will not be further analyzed.

Website Builders	Providers of **website design** and **management** tools that require **no coding**, using **customizable templates** and **drag-and-drop** features, are suitable for **individuals** and **small businesses** aiming to establish an **online presence**
E-commerce Platforms	Providers of **tools for creating and managing online stores** to **facilitate the process of selling** products and services on the web, such as Sazito, Digify, Wix, etc.
Content Management Systems (CMS)	Advanced platforms **requiring technical knowledge for creating, managing, and publishing digital content** on the web, such as WordPress, Joomla, etc.

Due to the foundational role and the primary focus of Iranian content management systems on media and entertainment, as well as the greater use of e-commerce platforms in the online retail industry, these platforms will not be further analyzed in this report.



Sajad Zare

Co-Founder and CEO of SEE5

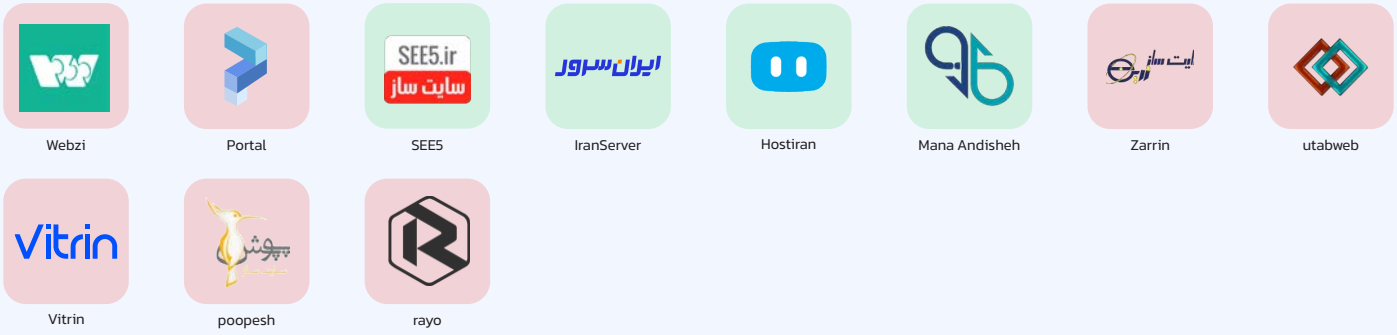
Some current platform providers, due to the high attractiveness of the service market and demand from small and medium-sized business managers who do not prefer to work with website builders, also offer website design and development services tailored to the needs and expectations of clients. One of the main advantages of "platform providers" is launching a website in less than 10 days at a lower cost.

Website Builder Platforms – 2023

The inactivity of foreign platforms in Iran due to cross-border payment issues and sanctions

Website Builder Platforms

Providers of website design and management tools without the need for coding



WordPress-based Platform Development

Proprietary Platform Development

Insight

WordPress site migration to WordPress-based platforms

One of the features of WordPress-based platforms is the capability to migrate **WordPress-designed sites** to **website builder platforms**, which can contribute to the **growth** of the website builder **market**.



Morteza Zarrinderafsh

CEO at Mana Andisheh

Offering diverse and advanced features along with easier setup compared to WordPress is a strength of "WordPress-based website builder platforms" compared to "proprietary platforms."

However, the lower complexity and ease of use of "proprietary platforms," due to their more limited features but alignment with customer needs, are considered their strengths from another perspective.

Applications of Website Builder Platforms in the Marketing Funnel

Primarily used in the awareness stage to quickly create a website for business introduction



- Providing customer support via FAQ and live chat
- Managing newsletter subscriptions by sending content to inform current users

- Creating product and service introduction pages to help potential customers evaluate options and make informed decisions
- Lead generation through building forms for content download, newsletter sign–up, etc.

- Quickly building a website to promote the business to a wide web audience by organic traffic generation
- Providing SEO tools to optimize the website for search engines



Mohsen Tabatabaei

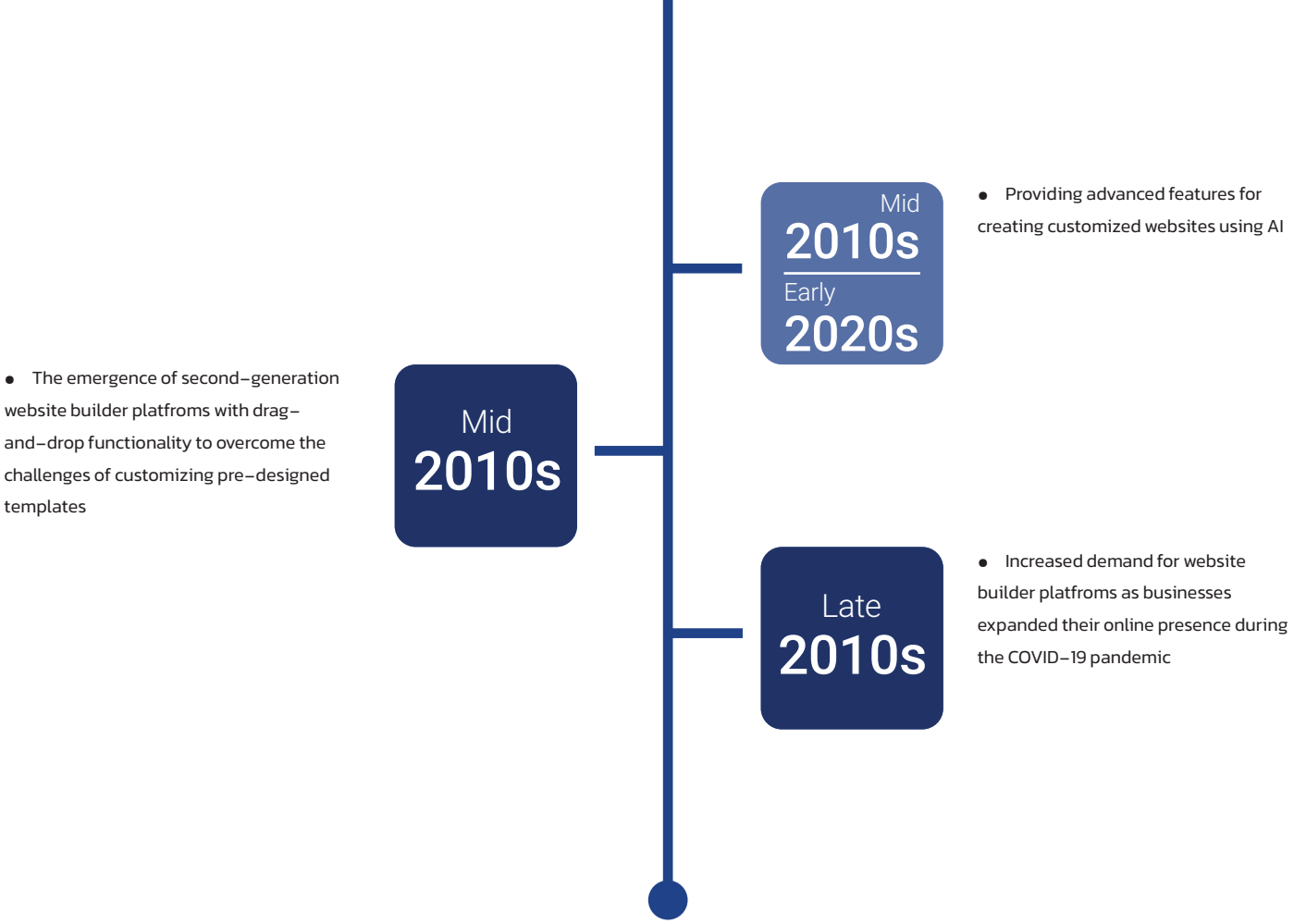
Co–Founder and CEO of Portal

Many freelancers use website builders for personal branding. On the other hand, a common and notable behavior among companies, especially in the B2B sector, is using website builders as an online catalog to showcase their services and products, while relying on e-commerce platforms for online sales.

Timeline and Milestones of Website Builder Platforms in Iran and the World

The launch of the first Iranian website builder platforms in the early 2010s




Mid
2010s
• The emergence of second-generation website builder platfroms with drag-and-drop functionality to overcome the challenges of customizing pre-designed templates
Mid
2010s
Early
2020s
• Providing advanced features for creating customized websites using AI
Late
2010s
• Increased demand for website builder platfroms as businesses expanded their online presence during the COVID-19 pandemic

Products and Features of Website Builder Platforms

Simultaneous offering of website builder and e-commerce platform by all platforms

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

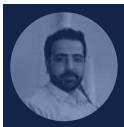
Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the website builder platforms industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.

Core Products	Complementary Products	Other Products
Website Builder	Online Booking Website Builder	Web Hosting and Domain Registration
E-Commerce Platform	Landing Page Builder	Email Hosting Server
		SMS Panel
		Content Delivery Network (CDN)

Core Products and Key Features

Website Builder	Customizable Template	Custom Domain	Form Builder	Business Email
	File Management System	Content Management System	Server and Hosting Management	Blog Builder
	Drag-and-Drop Editor	Lead Management Tool	Survey Builder	Traffic Analytics
E-Commerce Platform	Customizable Template	Custom Domain	Server and Hosting Management	Content Management System
	Business Email	Traffic Analytics	Order Management	Product Management
	Online Payment Gateway	Loyalty Program	PWA Application	Sales Analytics



Rasool Zare
Co-founder and CMO of SEE5

The low attractiveness of the website builder market led all players to offer e-commerce platforms. Businesses are increasingly creating dedicated sales channels and shifting from using company websites as catalogs to e-commerce sites for lead generation and sales, fueling the growth of e-commerce platforms.

Products and Features of Website Builder Platforms

Offering online booking website builder to businesses and individual service providers

Complementary Products and Key Features				
Online Booking Website Builder	Customizable Template	Custom Domain	Server and Hosting Management	Content Management System
	Business Email	Traffic Analytics	Online Booking System	Online Payment Gateway
	User Management	Online Meeting Tool		
Landing Page Builder	Customizable Template	Custom Domain	QR Code Generator	URL Shortener
	Lead Management	Content Delivery Network (CDN)	Traffic Analytics	

Insight

The **online booking website builder,** with features like calendar management, staff management, online payment gateways, and appointment scheduling systems, has simplified the process of **showcasing** and **selling services** for **doctors**, **beauty clinics**, **business consultants**, **fitness coaches**, **tourism accommodations**, **educational institutions**, and more.

Comparison of Key Website Builder Platforms

Key platforms differ slightly in offering complementary products

Comparison of Key Website Builder Platforms Based on Product Variety

	Core Products		Complementary Products	
	Website Builder	E-Commerce Platform	Landing Page Builder	Online Booking Website Builder
Webzi	✓	✓	✓	✓
Portal	✓	✓	✗	✗
SEE5	✓	✓	✓	✓

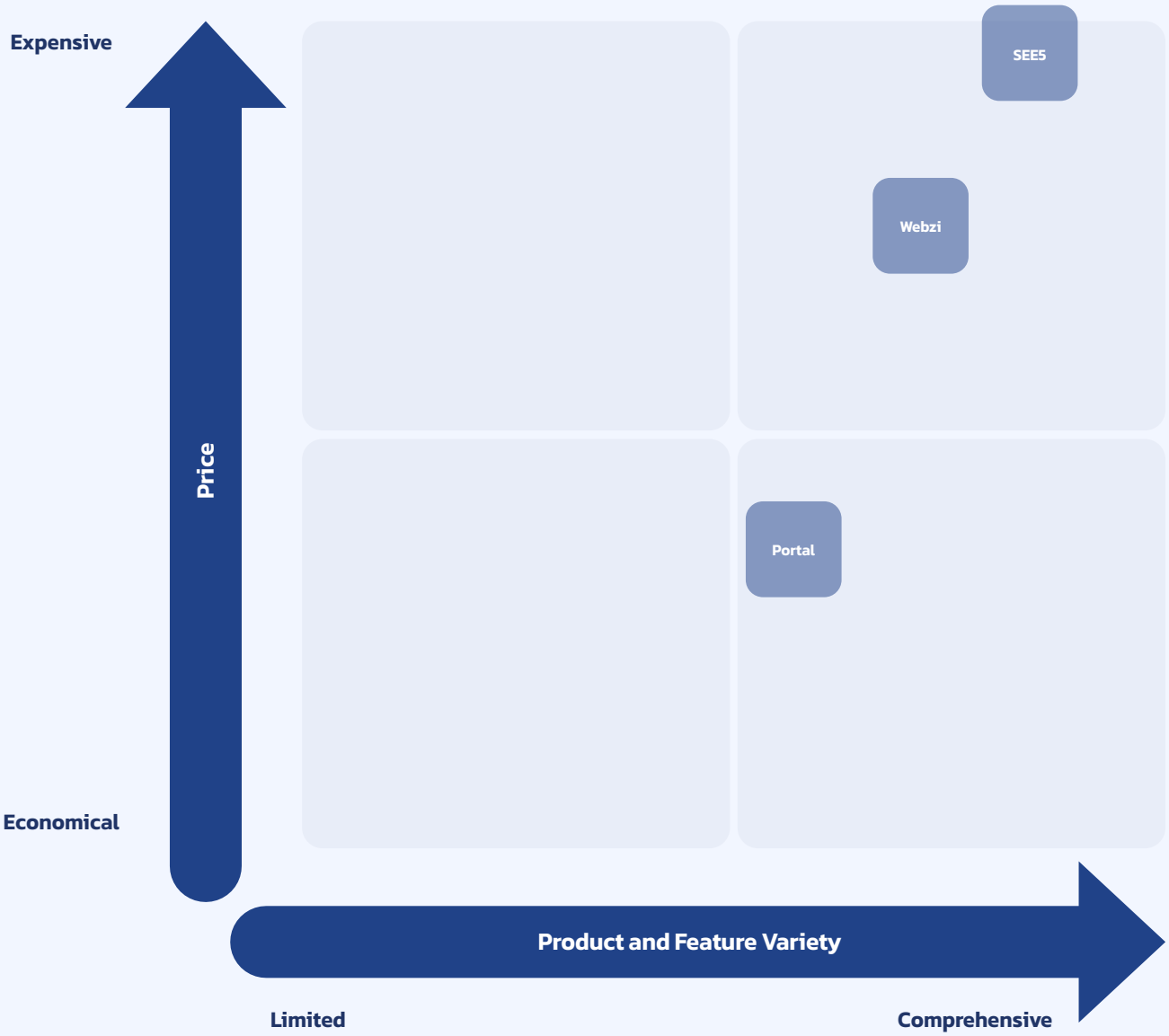
Key players in the table are determined based on the number of customers.

Comparison of Key Website Builder Platforms

The high importance of products and features diversity due to the wide range of customer activities

5 Key Criteria for Choosing a Website Builder Platform from the Customer's Perspective

Customer Support | Variety of Products and Features | Ease of Use | Scalability | Customization



Key players are determined based on the number of customers.



Morteza Zarrinderafsh
CEO of Mana Andisheh

The wide range of customer domains is the main reason for the high importance of product and feature variety. Website builder platforms continuously strive to develop and offer diverse functionalities and features tailored to the needs of each of their target markets, addressing the broad range of domains and vertical markets.

Website Builder Platforms Market – 2023

The website builder platforms market size is estimated between 60 to 75 billion tomans

Website Builder and E-commerce Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	350 to 400 billion tomans	80% to 100%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

Insight

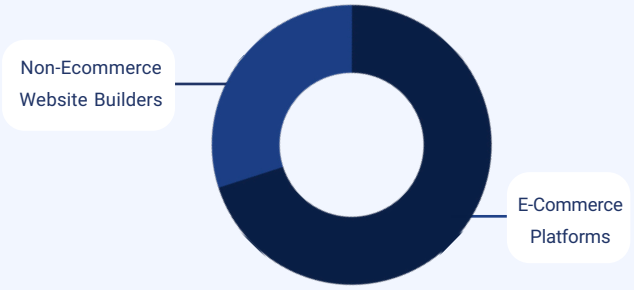
Approximately **30% to 40% of market size growth** is due to the annual subscription **price increase** in line with **inflation**. Around **40% to 50% of the growth** is driven by the increase in the **number of customers**.

Website Builder Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)
Iran	60 to 75 billion tomans

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Share of Non-Ecommerce Website Builder Platforms in the Total Market Size – 2023



In the website builder and e-commerce platforms market, **less than 30% are non-e-commerce websites**, which are built using **website builder platforms**.

Website Builder Platforms Market – 2023

More than 80% share of the non-ecommerce website builder platform market is held by 3 players

Website Builder Platforms Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Customers in the Non-E-commerce Website Market

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	Webzi and SEE5 with an estimated market share of over 30% each
Challenger	Portal with an estimated market share of 20% to 30%
Follower	
Nicher	

Insight

It is estimated that the three players, **Webzi**, **SEE5**, and **Portal**, account for **over 80%** of the non-e-commerce website market.

Which Businesses Use Website Builder Platforms the Most?

Freelancers	Services	Trading
Manufacturing	Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)	Professional Services (lawyers, doctors, etc.)

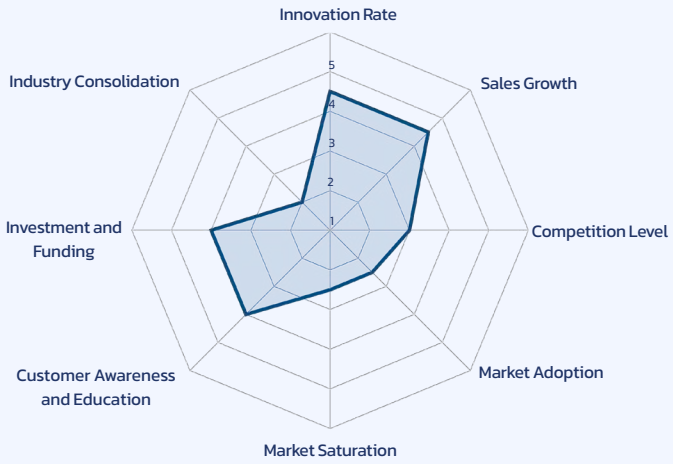
Insight

Individuals and **small businesses** account for **more than 80%** of website builder platforms customers. However, in recent years, interest from **medium and large businesses** in using website builders has been **growing**.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Website Builder Platforms Industry – 2023

Intense competition with WordPress as the main competitor to website builder platforms

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Website Builder Platforms Industry – 2023





Masoud Sabaghi

Co–Founder and CEO of Webzi

More than 95% of Iranian websites are developed using WordPress. Website builder platforms hold less than 5% market share, but they have the potential to grow sixfold, reaching approximately 30% in the future.

Insight

The **low competition level** among website builder platforms is primarily due to **intense competition** with **WordPress**, which holds a **dominant market share**. Additionally, domination of the market by a **handful of players**, and the **lack of new entrants,** due to its relatively **smaller market size** compared to e-commerce platform market, further contribute to the low competition level.

Website Builder Platforms Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

Using AI to simplify website design and content creation in Iran

Website Builder Industry Trends – 2023

Global

- Automating and simplifying the process of designing customized websites using AI
- Increasing customization and flexibility in website design by offering diverse design elements and coding options
- Integration with other marketing technologies like Web Analytics, CRM systems, etc.
- Providing advanced SEO tools, traffic analytics, and user behavior analysis

Iran

- Developing specialized products for specific niche target markets such as doctors, beauty clinics, tourism, etc.
- Automating and simplifying the process of designing customized websites using AI
- Providing AI–powered content generation tools



Masoud Sabaghi

Co–Founder and CEO of Webzi

Providing online booking website builder to beauty clinics and other appointment-based businesses is a current trend in Iran's market. Website builder platforms are expected to offer customized products for niches like tourism, education, and individuals such as business consultants and fitness coaches by identifying their needs.

17

Multimedia Content Creation Tool

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဆြေမြေ

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Multimedia Content Creation Tool

Providing video content creation tools and digital catalog design solutions

Multimedia content creation tools enable businesses to produce **video content** and design **digital catalogs** with **lower financial expenditures** and **time costs**.

Classification of the Multimedia Content Creation Industry Players

Tool Providers

- Video Content Creation Tools
- Digital Catalog Design Platforms

Service Providers

- Outsourcing Platforms
- Content Creation Agencies

"Tool providers" enable multimedia content creation by developing **technology-driven products** for users. **"Service providers"** play a **direct role** in the content creation process through **in-house teams** at **content creation agencies** and **freelancers** on **outsourcing platforms**.

Given the focus of this report on marketing technology tools, service providers will not be further analyzed.

Video Content Creation Tools	Players focused on providing **pre-designed video templates** with **features for editing and customizing** video content, including text, images, music, etc.
Digital Catalog Design Platforms	Providers of platforms for **designing**, **editing**, and **sharing** interactive digital catalogs and multimedia publications



Samira Marzban

Co-Founder & CEO of Lenoos

Until the late 2010s, digital catalog design was primarily carried out by service providers. The time-consuming process (taking at least a week, the high cost of 1 to 2 million tomans per page) and dependency of businesses on service providers for catalog edits paved the way for the emergence of digital catalog design platforms in Iran.

Multimedia Content Creation Tools – 2023

8 Iranian tools provide pre-designed video templates and digital catalog design platforms

Multimedia Content Creation Tools

Video Content Creation Tools

Providers of ready-to-use and customizable video templates

Vidiwood

Viditor

Clipam

Asanclip

Digital Catalog Design Platforms

Providers of drag-and-drop tools for digital catalog and multimedia publication design

Lenoos

Catgram

Smart Catalog

Cataloger

Insight

The emergence of video content creation tool providers began in the mid-2010s

By the **mid-2010s**, the **first players** offering video content creation tools entered the market. **Vidiwood**, a key player in this field, successfully raised **investment** from **DMOND accelerator** in 2017 and from **Smartup Ventures** in 2021.

Insight

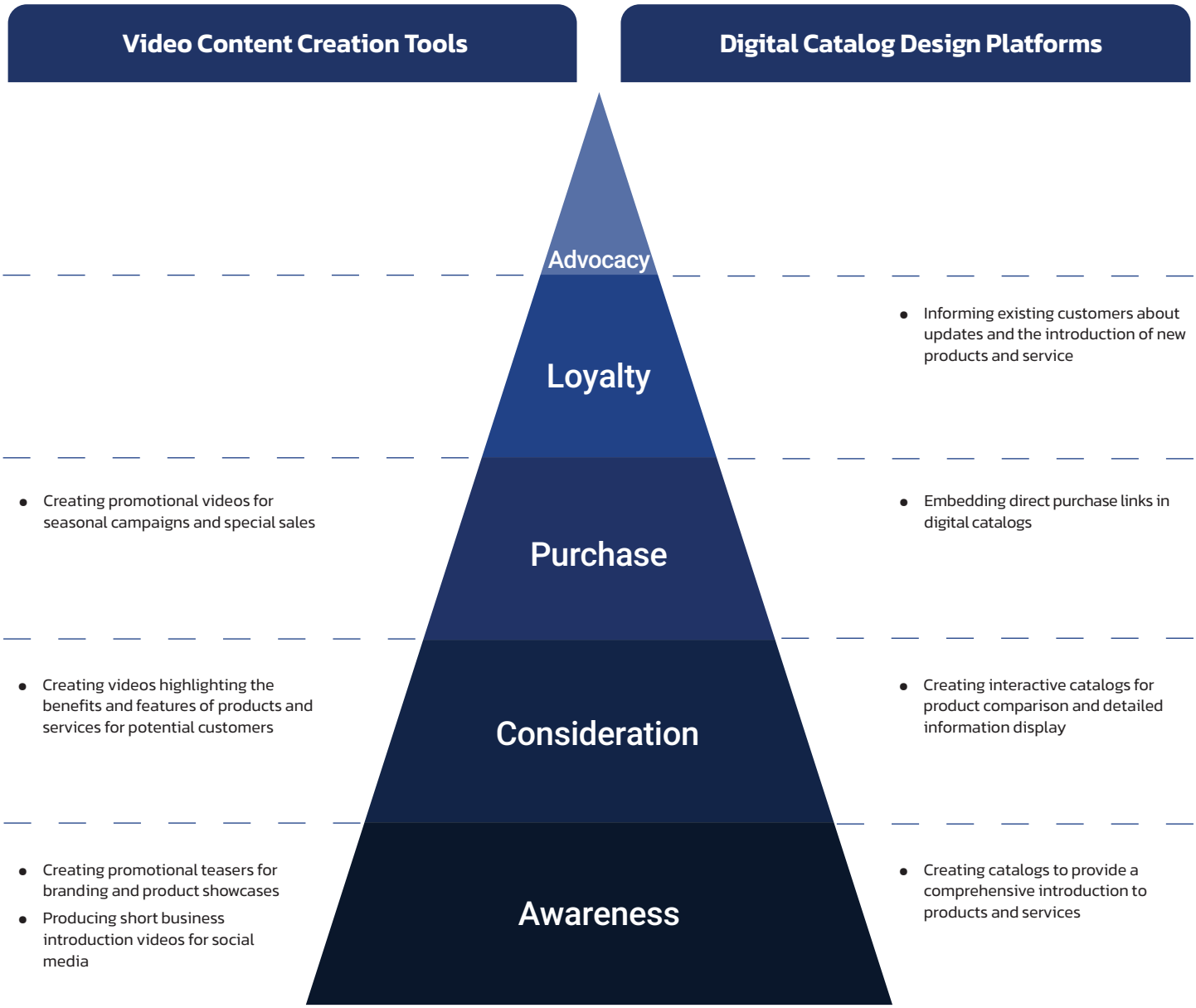
The launch of the first digital catalog design platforms coincided with the outbreak of COVID-19

In the **early 2020s**, the **first Iranian digital catalog platforms** emerged, coinciding with the **COVID-19 outbreak** and the rise of **digital adoption** and **presence** by businesses.

Applications of Multimedia Content Creation Tools in the Marketing Funnel

Creating engaging visual content to introduce businesses, products, and services

The primary use of these tools is for creating **dynamic** and **interactive content**, such as **videos**, **animations**, and **digital catalogs**. Businesses mainly use these tools to capture **audience attention** and **promote** their **products** or **services**.



Products and Features of Multimedia Content Creation Tools

Offering core products of pre-designed video templates and digital catalog design platforms

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the multimedia content creation tools industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Core Products and Key Features

Pre-Designed Video Template	Logo Motion	Slideshow	Motion Graphics	
	Story Motion	Post and Story	Promotion	
Digital Catalog Design Platform	Catalog Editor	Lead Generation	Custom Domain	Analytics and Reporting
	Add Pop-Ups	Add Contact Information and Social Media	Add Link	Add Text, Audio, Image, and Video

Insight

Integrating AI as the solution to reviving the video content creation tool market

Over seven years have passed since video content creation tools emerged in Iran, yet most players have **failed to grow**, and **no dominant player** has emerged. As **AI** rapidly transforms **content creation industry**, adopting this technology seems essential to **prevent further market decline**.

Insight

Interactive catalogs and content generation tools offered by digital catalog design platforms

Content is the most important element of digital catalogs, and these platforms are expected to **integrate AI-based content generation tools**.



Samira Marzban

Co-Foonder and CEO of Lenoos

The rising cost of printing catalogs has driven medium and large businesses to adopt digital catalog design platforms. Greater flexibility and scalability in design and editing provide a competitive edge and support multimedia content creation market growth.

18

Marketing Automation Platform

Industry Data Partners:

SMARTECH inTrack

Zebline

Metrix

Report Partners: SMARTECH

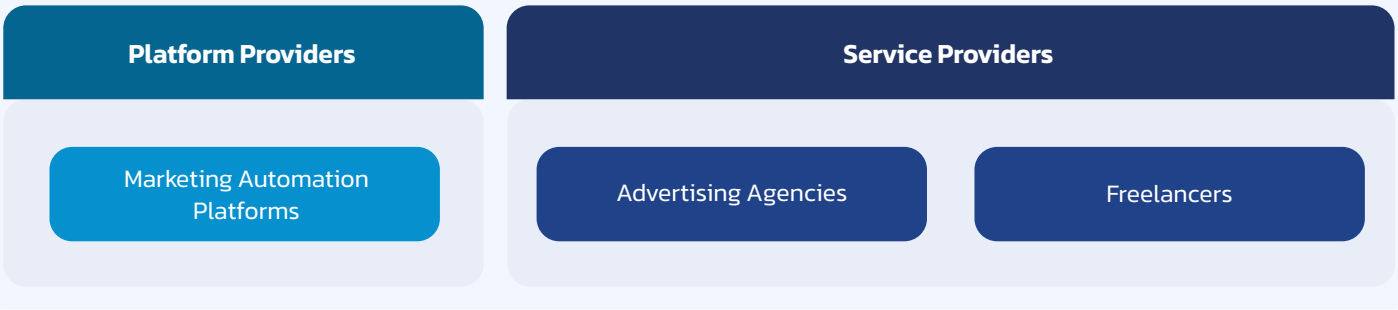
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Definition of Marketing Automation Platform

Execution, management, and automation of marketing processes and campaigns

Marketing automation platforms enable businesses to **execute**, **manage**, and **automate marketing processes and campaigns**, allowing them to nurture leads and retain customers by delivering **personalized content** across **various communication channels**.

Classification of Marketing Automation Industry Players



"**Platform providers**" focus on **developing** and **deploying their proprietary marketing automation platforms**. "**Service providers**", on the other hand, offer **implementation** and **support services** for marketing automation platforms to businesses. Most service providers act as **resellers and Implementation partners for foreign providers**.

Given the report's focus on marketing technology tools, service providers will not be explored further.

Insight

Facilitating marketing automation platforms implementation through service providers

One of the main challenges in adopting marketing automation platforms is **integrating** and **syncing** them with **multiple data sources**, such as CRM software, websites, applications, and more. Service providers, often operating as **advertising agencies**, **facilitate** the **implementation** of marketing automation platforms and address this challenge through **post-implementation support**.

Marketing Automation Platforms – 2023

Presence of 5 Iranian and 2 foreign platforms in the Iranian market

Marketing Automation Platforms

Platforms for managing and automating marketing processes and campaigns across multiple communication channels



Insight

Entry of Iranian players into the market began since early 2020s

The **rising costs** of using foreign providers due to **increased dollar-rial exchange rate** in recent years, along with the growing importance of **retention marketing strategies**, attracted the attention of **digital economy holdings and investors** to the marketing automation platform industry. These factors paved the way for the entry of **Iranian platforms** into the market in the **early 2020s**.

Insight

The presence of foreign players despite sanctions on Iranian businesses

Foreign players such as **WebEngage**, which have faced no restrictions in providing services to Iranian businesses, have managed to establish a foothold in the Iranian market by **attracting large businesses**. These players, by partnering with full-service resellers (service providers), have ensured that Iranian businesses face no concerns regarding **support**.



Mazdak Pakzad

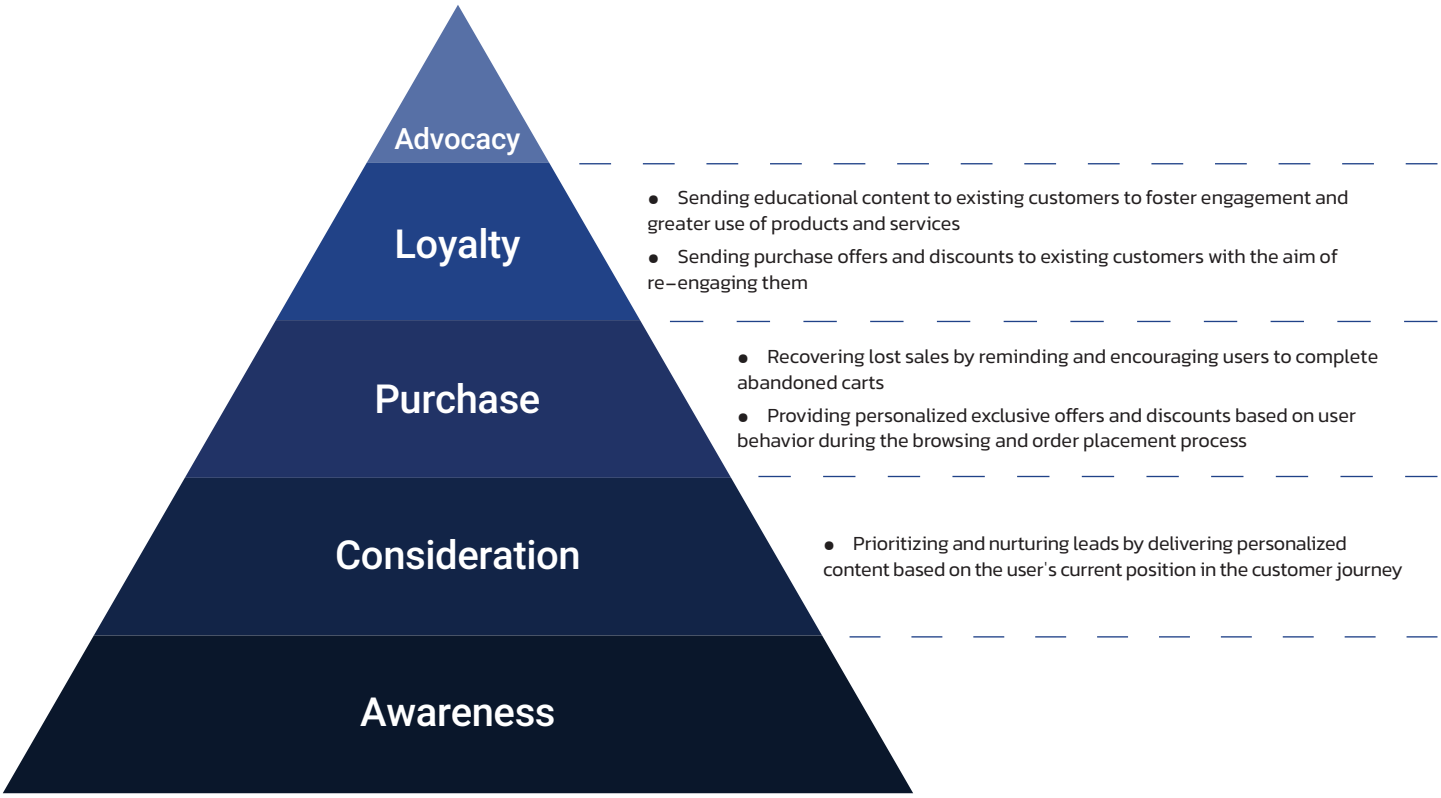
Co–Founder and Chairman of Smartech

Large online businesses in Iran began adopting foreign marketing automation platforms in the mid-2010s. The primary challenge with these platforms was the inability to integrate with other tools. Since the early 2020s, with the rise in dollar-rial exchange rate and the emergence of Iranian players, the adoption of Iranian platforms by businesses has increased.

Applications of Marketing Automation Platforms in the Marketing Funnel

Greater application of marketing automation in mid–stages, focusing on customer retention and loyalty

Marketing automation platforms enable marketers to **analyze customer data** from **multiple sources** and **orchestrate the customer journey**, ensuring **timely** marketing actions through the **appropriate channels**, tailored to customer needs and behaviors, particularly during the **mid-stages** of **consideration**, **purchase**, and **loyalty**.





Behzad Lotfi

Founder and CEO of Zebline

One of the key challenges businesses face in data analysis and extracting insights from marketing activities and expenditures lies in the complexity and fragmentation of marketing data across multiple tools and platforms. Marketing automation platforms address this by consolidating and analyzing data in a single interface, providing a holistic view of marketing and sales activities, and empowering senior managers to make data-driven decisions.

Timeline and Milestones of Marketing Automation Platforms in Iran and the World

The entry of marketing automation platforms into Iran since the mid-2010s



Late 2010s

- The adoption of WebEngage by Iranian businesses
- WebEngage representation acquired by Brandist and Daart agencies
- Growing demand for marketing automation platforms due to the growing awareness of customer retention and re-engagement is recognized
- Digikala E-Commerce Group's investment in Segmentino

Late 2020s

- The launch of Iranian platforms such as inTrack, Zebline, and Metrix
- Rising demand for Iranian platforms due to increased dollar-rial exchange rates and the inability to afford platforms priced in dollars
- Tapsell's acquisition of Pushe to integrate push notifications into the Metrix marketing automation platform
- Sabaldea's investment in Zebline



Mahdi Kafi

Co-founder of Daart Ads

In recent years, customer acquisition cost has gradually increased compared to retention cost. As a result, acquiring new users became less economically viable for businesses, leading to increased demand for marketing automation platforms aimed at customer retention and return.



Behrad Zari

Marketing Automation Expert

In the late 2010s, large digital businesses with tens of millions of users reached a saturation point in user acquisition. Consequently, their strategy shifted from user acquisition to customer retention and loyalty building through marketing automation platforms.

Currently, this strategy carries far less weight in monopolistic markets, where services are offered by a single dominant player, limiting competition in creating value for customers.

Capabilities and Features of Marketing Automation Platforms

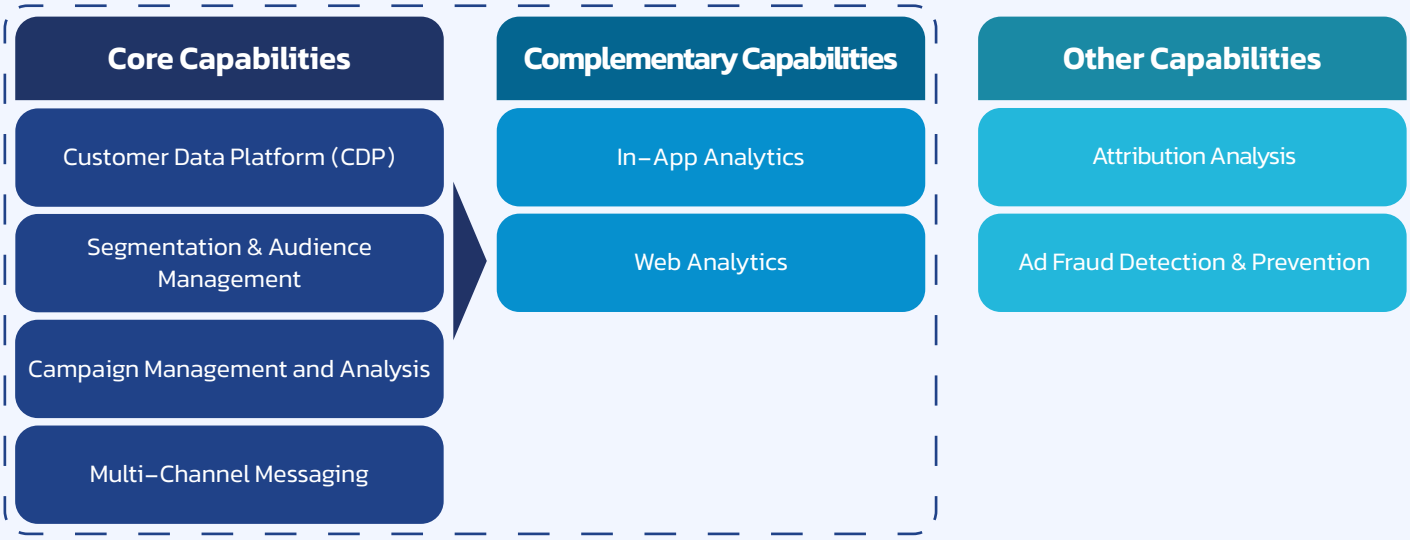
Data integration, segmentation, and campaign execution are core capabilities

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Capabilities: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Capabilities: Offered by some players, these capabilities add value and integrate with the core capabilities.

Other Capabilities: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core capabilities. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the marketing automation platforms industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.





Behzad Lotfi
Founder and CEO of Zebline

The capabilities of a comprehensive marketing automation solution encompass various layers, including data collection, integration, and management; seamless integration of omnichannel communication; customer journey orchestration; customer engagement analysis; and the automation and management of marketing activities.

Capabilities and Features of Marketing Automation Platforms

The entry of players from website and mobile analytics industries into the marketing automation industry

Core Capabilities and Key Features

Customer Data Platform (CDP)	Data Ingestion & Integration	Data Governance		
	Unified Customer Profiles	Real–Time Data Analysis		
Segmentation & Audience Management	Behavioral Segmentation	Demographic Segmentation		
	Device–based Segmentation			
Campaign Management and Analysis	Campaign Planning	A/B Testing	UTM Tracking	
	Conversion Rate Analysis	Campaign Performance Measurement		
Multi–Channel Messaging	SMS	Mobile Push Notification	Web Push Notification	Automated Workflows
	Email	On–Site Messaging	In–App Messaging	

Complementary Capabilities and Key Features

In–App Analytics	Event Tracking	Session Analysis	Conversion Rate Analysis	Analytics & Reporting
	App Install and Uninstall Tracking	Revenue & LTV Analysis	Funnel Analysis	Retention Analysis
Web Analytics	Traffic and Visit Analysis	Conversion Rate Analysis		
	Cohort Analysis	Analytics & Reporting Dashboard		

Insight

The entry of web and mobile analytics platforms into the marketing automation industry

Faced with a **saturated mobile analytics market** and the **dominance of Google Analytics** as the leader in website analytics market, several players in these two industries expanded into the marketing automation market by **developing marketing automation platforms** and **integrating** them with **web** and **mobile analytics** platforms. This strategic shift is **more commonly** observed among players in the **mobile analytics** industry.

Comparison of Key Marketing Automation Platforms

Two types of marketing automation platforms: dedicated and integrated, based on initial focus

Comparison of Key Dedicated Marketing Automation Platforms Based on Capability Variety

	Core Capabilities				Complementary Capabilities	
	Customer Data Platform (CDP)	Segmentation & Audience Management	Campaign Management and Analysis	Multi-Channel Messaging	Web Analytics	In-App Analytics
WebEngage	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
inTrack	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Zebline	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

The identification of key players in the table is based on the number of Monthly Active Users (MAU).

Insight

Categorization of marketing automation platforms based on feature variety

1. **Dedicated marketing automation platforms**: These players have focused on developing **marketing automation platforms** with **advanced** and **sophisticated** features **from the start**.
2. **Integrated marketing automation platforms**: These players began as **attribution platforms** and later **developed** and **integrated limited marketing automation features** into their platforms.

Comparison of Key Integrated Marketing Automation Platforms Based on Capability Variety

	Core Capabilities				Complementary Capabilities	
	Customer Data Platform (CDP)	Segmentation & Audience Management	Campaign Management and Analysis	Multi-Channel Messaging	Web Analytics	In-App Analytics
Chabok	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Metrix	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

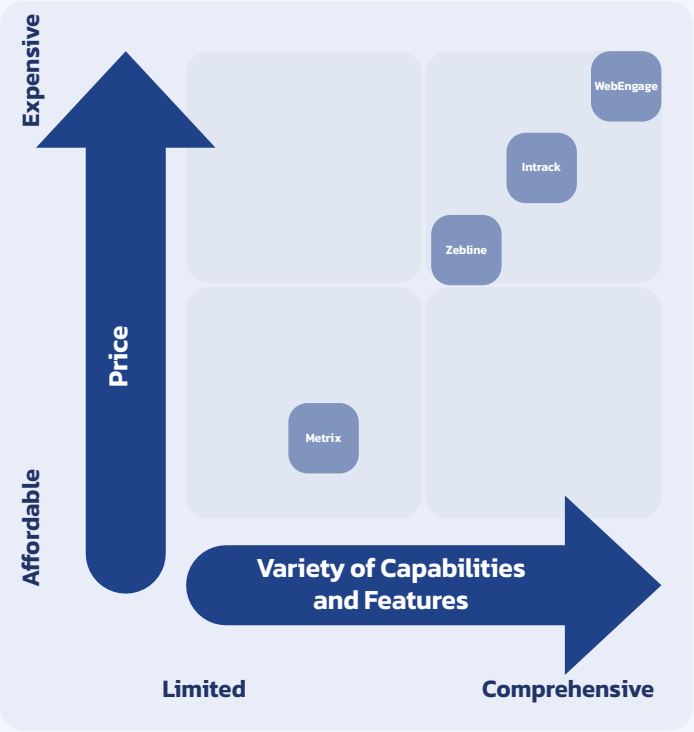
The identification of key players in the table is based on the number of Monthly Active Users (MAU).

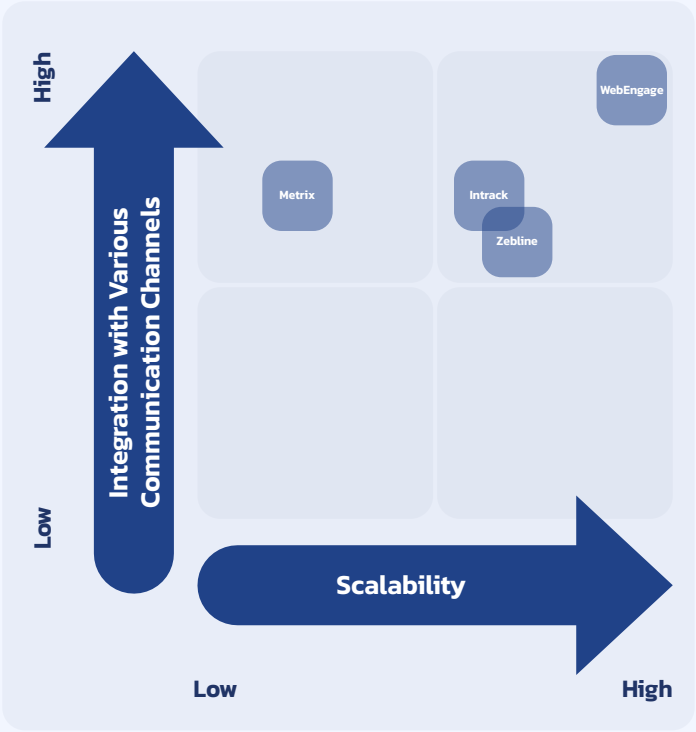
Comparison of Key Marketing Automation Platforms

The high importance of scalability in handling large data volumes for large businesses

5 Key Criteria for Choosing a Marketing Automation Platform from the Customer's Perspective

Variety of Capabilities and Features	Price	Scalability for Large Data Volumes	Real-Time Data Analysis and Execution	Integration with Various Communication Channels





The key players have been identified based on the number of Monthly Active Users (MAU).

The comparison of players was conducted through interviews with 5 players and experts.



Fatemeh Karami

Former MarTech Product Lead at Smartech

If large businesses are considered the sole target market for marketing automation platforms, WebEngage provides its services to some of them at a lower cost compared to Iranian players. Its advantages in economies of scale and localization enable WebEngage to offer services at reduced costs.

Marketing Automation Platforms Market – 2023

A 300 to 350 billion toman market for marketing automation platforms

Marketing Automation Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	300 to 350 billion tomans	60% to 70%
Global*	5.8 billion dollars	11%

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

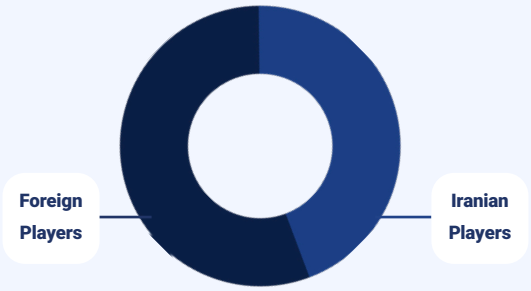
*Considering the service providers' market

Share of Foreign Players in the Marketing Automation Platforms Market – 2023

Insight

Given that **foreign players** hold **over 50%** of the Iranian market and **charging in dollars**, around **40% of the market size growth** is attributed to increased costs driven by **rising dollar-rial exchange rates**.

Market Share of Foreign Players from Total Market Size – 2023



Marketing Automation Platforms Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Monthly Active Users (MAU)

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	WebEngage with an estimated market share of over 50%
Challenger	inTrack And Zebline with an estimated market share of 15% to 25% each
Follower	Metrix and Chabok with a combined estimated market share of less than 10%
Nicher	

Marketing Automation Platforms Market – 2023

Large businesses account for 60% of the revenue generated by marketing automation platforms

Which Businesses Use Marketing Automation Platforms the Most?

- Online Retail
- Banking and Financial Services (Fintech)
- Transportation (Ride-Hailing)
- Online Tourism
- Media and Entertainment
- Healthtech
- Edtech

Insight

Banks are one of the target markets that, **if unlocked**, could drive **substantial growth** in the marketing automation platform **market size**. Due to the high **sensitivity of data security** and the **restrictions preventing banks from adopting foreign platforms**, **Iranian players** have an opportunity to increase their **market share**.

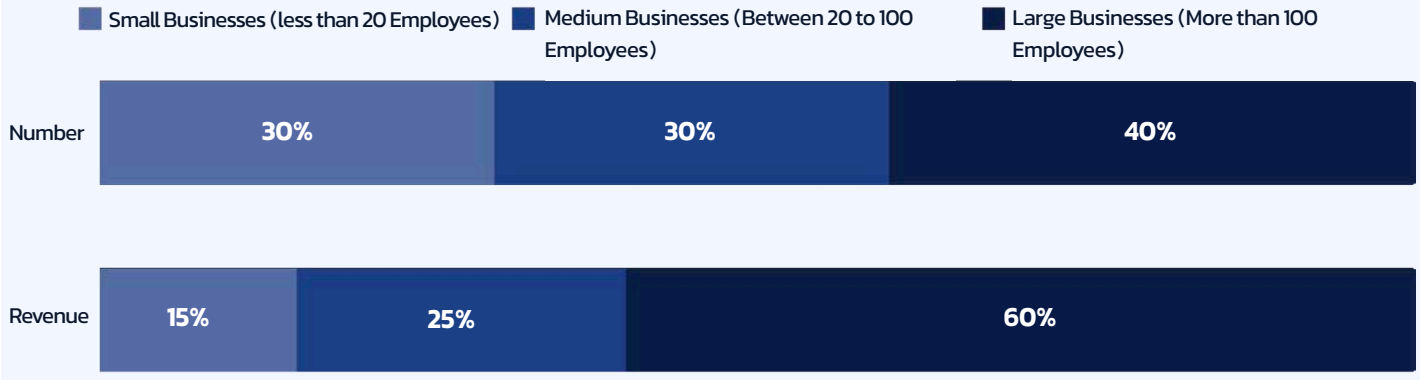


Saghar Rafiee

Sales and Marketing Manager at Metrix

Push notifications are particularly appealing to large businesses, such as banks, as they offer a cost-free alternative compared to SMS. By leveraging marketing automation platforms, banks can not only expand the variety of their communication channels but also engage with their customers more efficiently and cost-effectively.

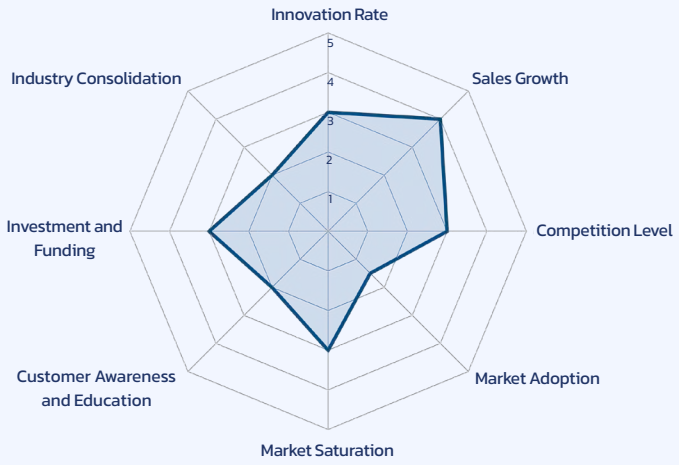
Revenue and Customer Distribution of Marketing Automation Platforms by Business Size – 2023



Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Marketing Automation Platforms Industry – 2023

Moderate competition level due to significant growth potential and a limited number of players

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Marketing Automation Platforms Industry – 2023



Insight

The **relatively large market size** and **high growth potential** of marketing automation have made this industry attractive for **investment**. The current **market growth rate** is estimated at **over 60%**, with the potential to reach up to **100%** as **target markets expand**.



Saghar Rafiee

Sales and Marketing Manager at Metrix

Beyond the complexities of implementing marketing automation platforms, the steep learning curve of their user interfaces and the shortage of skilled professionals proficient in these platforms are major barriers to customer migration to alternative platforms.



Ebrahim Ghane

Co–Founder and CPO of Paziresh24

The limited adoption of Iranian marketing automation platforms can be attributed to their misalignment with market and various industries' needs. Initially designed as customized solutions for large holding subsidiaries, these platforms were later offered to external clients. This approach has rendered their implementation and effective usage in other industries.



Fatemeh Karami

Former MarTech Product Lead at Smartech

Economic recession has had a dual impact on market growth and decline. Businesses' cost-cutting strategies and managers' perception of marketing automation platforms as non-essential and expensive tools have led to reduced demand. At the same time, the high return on investment in customer retention and re-engagement, an effective strategy in challenging economic conditions, has driven demand growth.

Marketing Automation Platforms Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

The trend of leveraging AI for big data analysis and generating practical insights in Iran

Marketing Automation Platforms Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Big data analysis, customer behavior prediction, and execution of targeted campaigns powered by AI and machine learning	Providing real-time and big data analytics capabilities powered by AI
Advanced personalization to tailor marketing messages and content to each user's preferences and behavior	Generating practical insights and recommendations to define effective actions and strategies
Integrating marketing tools and platforms like CRM, email marketing, and social media to deliver a seamless customer experience	More focus on personalized and targeted recommendations aligned with each user's interests, needs, and behavior
	Advanced personalization to align marketing messages and content with user preferences and behavior

Data Partner in the Marketing Automation Platforms Industry

InTrack: Inspiring Intelligence in Business

85+ million
Monthly active users (MAU)

65,000+
Campaigns created (since early 2021)

8,000
Workflows created (since early 2021)

2.4 billion
Push notifications sent (since early 2021)

1.2 billion
SMS messages sent (since early 2021)

215 million
Emails sent (since early 2021)

Notable Clients

Digikala, Digipay, Roja, Modiseh, Khodro45, Gapfilm

Key Features and Capabilities

- Supports 8 messaging channels
- Implementation and support by a dedicated team
- Real-time customer analysis and segmentation

Direct Link to the Website

Zebline: A Native Marketing Automation Platform for All Businesses

100+ million
Monthly active users (MAU)

40+
Corporate clients

45,000+
Campaigns created (2023)

320+ million
Messages sent (2023)

1+ billion
events tracked (2023)

431+ million
leads generated (2023)

Notable Clients

Tejarat Bank, Filimo, Achareh, Alopeyk, Asiatech, RighTel

Key Features and Capabilities

- The most cost-effective omnichannel platform
- Deployable on-premises in addition to cloud-based
- Diverse client base, including Iran's largest businesses

Direct Link to the Website

Data Partner in the Marketing Automation Platforms Industry

Metrix: Empowering Businesses in Marketing Budgeting and Retention Management

10+ million
Monthly active users (MAU)

Key Features and Capabilities

- Integration of attribution and automation platform
- Supports 7 messaging channels
- Real-time analytics
- Dedicated support

Notable Clients

Mehr Iran Bank | Nikan Hospital | 724 | Esam | drdr | Banket

Direct Link to the Website

19

Mobile Analytics Platform

Industry Data Partners:

Metrix

SMARTECH Adtrace

Report Partners: SMARTECH ایسوگ

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Mobile Analytics Platform

Boosting advertising campaign ROI through acquisition source analysis and ad fraud prevention

Mobile analytics platforms help businesses by offering tools for **user acquisition analysis**, **ad fraud detection and prevention**, and **user behavior tracking**. By leveraging these tools, businesses can pinpoint the **most efficient acquisition channels** and **maximize the ROI of advertising campaigns**.

Classification of Mobile Analytics Industry Players



"**Platform providers**" focus on **developing their proprietary mobile analytics platforms**. "**Service providers**", on the other hand, **represent foreign providers** and offer **implementation** and **customer support** services tailored to businesses.

Given the report's focus on marketing technology tools, service providers will not be further analyzed.

Mobile Analytics Platforms – 2023

5 platforms operate in the Iranian market, with Iranian platforms dominating in terms of market presence

Mobile Analytics Platforms

Platforms offering user acquisition analysis, ad fraud prevention, and app user behavior tracking

Iranian Platforms

- Metrix
- Adtrace
- Chabok
- Amaroid

Foreign Platforms Used in the Iranian Market

- AppMetrica

Insight

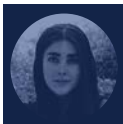
Iranian players taking over market share from foreign competitors due to sanctions

In the **mid-2010s**, foreign players like **Adjust** and **AppsFlyer** entered the Iranian market. However, **sanctions targeting Iranian businesses** forced them to **exit**, creating an **opportunity** for **Iranian players** to capture their **market share** and strengthen their position.

Insight

AppMetrica, the only foreign player

AppMetrica, a **Russian** platform, stands as the **only foreign player** operating in the Iranian market. **Despite sanctions**, it continues to provide **unrestricted services** to Iranian businesses, securing a **notable market share** by catering to **large businesses**.



Fatemeh Karami

Former MarTech Product Lead at Smartech

Concerns about data security or the risk of sharing it with competitors, the gap between domestic and foreign players in accuracy and detecting various types of ad fraud, conflicts of interest due to reliance of domestic players on ad networks, and free services offered by foreign players are key reasons why Iranian businesses prefer foreign platforms.

Applications of Mobile Analytics Platforms in the Marketing Funnel

Mediating between ad networks and advertisers to build trust



- Identifying the most effective marketing actions and channels for selling products and services
- Streamlining the purchase journey and improving conversion rates by addressing user pain points during the buying process

- Tracking and analyzing user engagement and behavior in the app to enhance the user experience

- Analyzing user acquisition sources to identify the most effective channels in terms of ROI
- Measuring the effectiveness and performance of advertising campaigns to optimize budget allocation



Saghar Rafiee

Sales and Marketing Manager at Metrix

The primary function of mobile analytics platforms is to act as an impartial third party between ad networks and advertisers, ensuring proper spending on app install campaigns. By mediating and resolving disputes, these platforms enable businesses to measure and maximize the ROI of their advertising campaigns.

Timeline and Milestones of Mobile Analytics Platforms in Iran and the World

The entry of mobile analytics platforms to Iran in the mid–2010s

World **Iran**

Mid 2000s

- The first mobile analytics platforms, such as Flurry, emerged with the growing popularity of smartphones, offering features like tracking app downloads, user sessions, and more

Late 2000s – Early 2010s

- The emergence of advanced platforms like Google Analytics and Mixpanel provided deeper insights into user behavior and app performance
- Attribution tools such as Adjust and AppsFlyer were introduced to track and analyze effectiveness of advertising campaigns

Mid 2010s

- The entry of foreign platforms like AppsFlyer, TUNE, and Adjust into Iran
- Adjust captured a significant share of the Iranian market
- Advertising agencies Daart and Tapsell became Adjust's official sales representatives

Late 2010s

- The entry of Iranian players such as Chabok, Adtrace, and Metrix into the market
- Adjust ceased collaboration with Iranian companies due to sanctions
- Large Iranian businesses migrated from Adjust to AppMetrica due to conflicts of interest between Iranian players and ad networks
- Foreign players held a 64% market share in Iran (2019)
- Chabok integrated limited marketing automation features, focusing on user segmentation and SMS messaging

Mid 2010s – Now

- Integration of marketing automation capabilities into mobile analytics platforms
- Introduction of advanced capabilities such as cohort analysis and user segmentation
- Provision of predictive analytics and real–time insights powered by AI and machine learning

Early 2020s

- Daart advertising agency became the official representative of AppMetrica
- Metrix entered the marketing automation industry
- Adtrace was acquired by Smartech



Mahdi Kafi

Co–founder of Daart Ads

Since the early 2010s, the growing internet penetration in Iran and businesses running banner and click-based campaigns highlighted the need for campaign analysis and identifying high-ROI channels. This drove demand for mobile analytics platforms and paved the way for the entry of foreign players into the Iranian market.

Products and Features of Mobile Analytics Platforms

The product development of Iranian platforms is shifting toward marketing automation platforms

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the mobile analytics platforms industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.

Core Products	Complementary Products	Other Products
Attribution Analysis		Web Analytics
Ad Fraud Detection & Prevention		Segmentation & Audience Management
In-App Analytics		Campaign Management and Analysis
		Multi-Channel Messaging

Core Products and Key Features

Attribution Analysis	Retargeting Measurement	Uninstall & Reinstall Tracking	Deep Link Tracking	CLTV Measurement
Ad Fraud Detection & Prevention	Click Capping	Click Injection	Wrong Signature	Suspicious Signature
	SDK Spoofing	Anonymous IP	Missing Signature	
In-App Analytics	Event Tracking	Session Analysis	Cohort Analysis	Analytics & Reporting Dashboard
	App Install and Uninstall Tracking	Revenue & LTV Analysis	Funnel Analysis	Retention Analysis

Insight

The entry of mobile analytics platforms into the marketing automation industry

With the **saturation** of the mobile analytics market and the **stagnation of its growth**, some players shifted to marketing automation by **integrating limited features** into their platforms. The other products listed in the table also align with **marketing automation platform capabilities**.

Comparison of Key Mobile Analytics Platforms

Offering marketing automation capabilities through development or integration

Comparison of Key Mobile Analytics Platforms Based on Product Variety

		Core Products			Other Products			
		Attribution Analysis	Ad Fraud Detection & Prevention	In-App Analytics	Web Analytics	Segmentation & Audience Management	Campaign Management and Analysis	Multi-Channel Messaging
Dedicated Platforms	Adtrace	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗
	AppMetrica	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Hybrid Platforms	Chabok	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Metrix	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Key players in the table are identified based on the number of customers and app install counts.

Insight

Classification of mobile analytics platforms based on product variety

1. **Dedicated Mobile Analytics Platforms**: Players focused on **developing** and **offering core** mobile analytics platform **products**.
2. **Hybrid Mobile Analytics Platforms**: Players **integrating limited marketing automation features** into mobile analytics platforms to provide an **advanced solution**.

Insight

Different strategies of players in developing or integrating with marketing automation platforms

Chabok and **Metrix** aim to evolve into a **marketing automation platforms**, although their **features** remain **more limited** compared to **dedicated** marketing automation platforms.

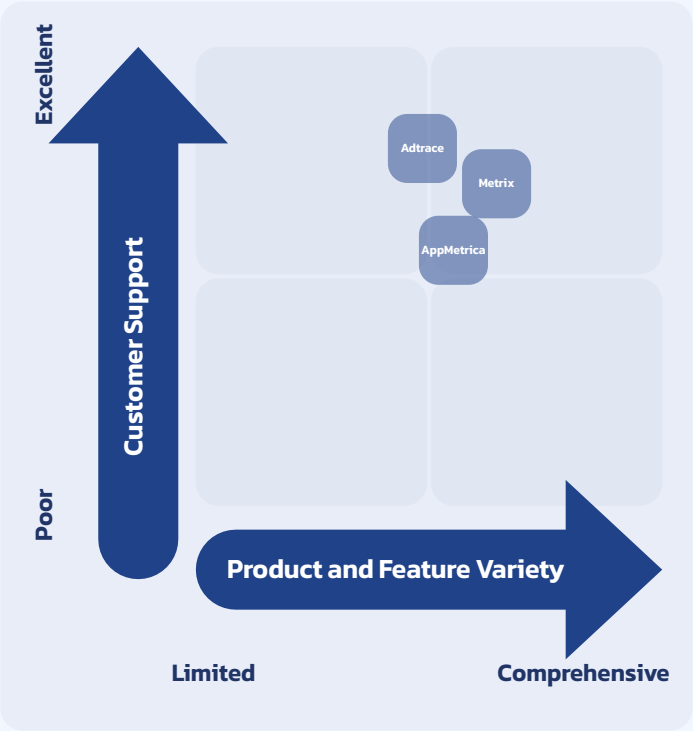
In contrast, **Adtrace** and **AppMetrica** offer features such as **user segmentation** and **campaign management** and analytics through **integration with marketing automation platforms** like WebEngage and inTrack.

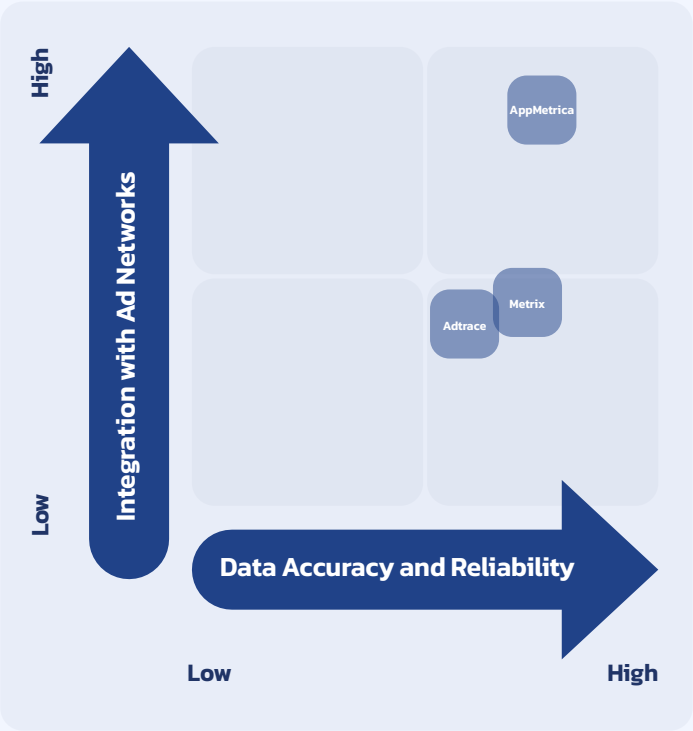
Comparison of Key Mobile Analytics Platforms

Product variety, along with data accuracy and reliability, are key criteria for selecting a platform

The 4 Key Criteria for Choosing a Mobile Analytics Platform from Customer's Perspective

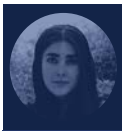
Product and Feature Variety | Data Accuracy and Reliability | Customer Support | Integration with Ad Networks





Key players are determined based on the number of customers and app install counts.

The comparison of players was conducted through interviews with 4 players and experts.



Fatemeh Karami

Former MarTech Product Lead at Smartech

Internet filtering has significantly impacted the accuracy and reliability of mobile analytics platforms. The widespread use of VPNs among Iranian users and the inability to detect their IP addresses have led to decreased accuracy in tracking and analyzing app acquisition sources.



Mahdi Kafi

Co-founder of Daart Ads

Sanctions have significantly hindered integration with international advertising channels for app install campaigns. This limitation has affected Iranian platforms and driven some businesses toward foreign alternatives.

Mobile Analytics Platforms Market – 2023

Over 80% market share held by Iranian platforms, led by Metrix

Mobile Analytics Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	20 to 25 billion tomans	30%
Global	5.9 billion dollars	24%

Market Penetration Rate in Iran



1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Insight

The **market size** of mobile analytics platforms has nearly reached its **saturation point**, with **annual growth** driven primarily by **price increases in line with inflation**.

Mobile Analytics Platforms Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Customers and App Install Counts

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

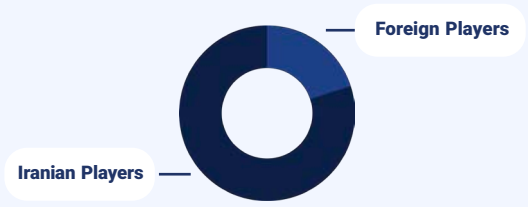
Leader	Metrix with an estimated market share of over 50%
Challenger	Adtrace and AppMetrica, each with an estimated market share of 15% to 30%
Follower	Chabok with an estimated market share of less than 10%
Nicher	

Share of Foreign Players in the Mobile Analytics Platforms Market – 2023

Insight

The market share of **foreign players** is estimated to be **less than 20%**, primarily held by the **Russian platform AppMetrica**. Despite having a **limited number of customers** in Iran, its success in acquiring **large businesses** has boosted its share.

Market Share of Foreign Players by Number of Customers – 2023



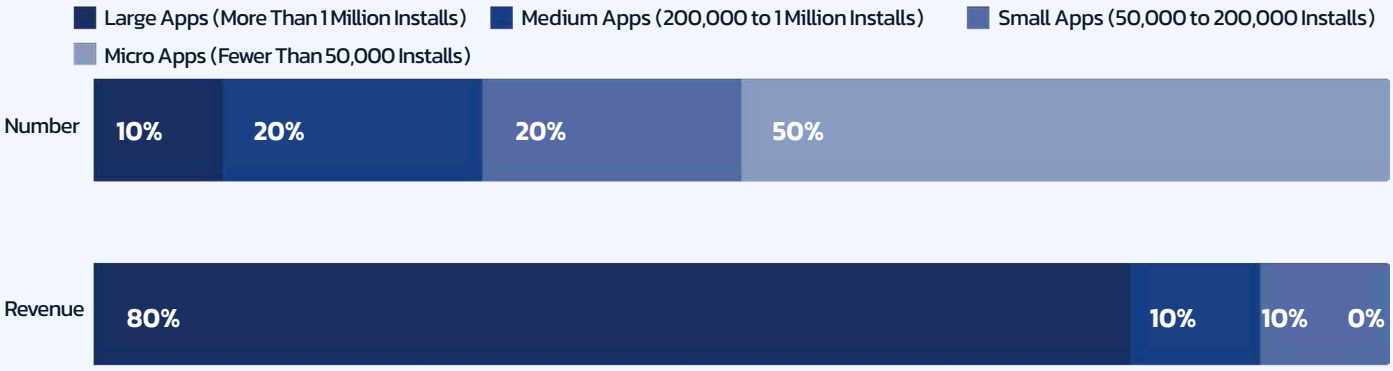
Mobile Analytics Platforms Market – 2023

80% of the revenue for mobile analytics platforms comes from large applications

Which Businesses Use Mobile Analytics Platforms the Most?

- Banking, Financial Services, and Insurance
- Tools
- Gaming and Entertainment
- Travel and Tourism
- Shopping
- Education
- Lifestyle

Revenue and Customer Distribution of Mobile Analytics Platforms by App Install Counts – 2023



Insight

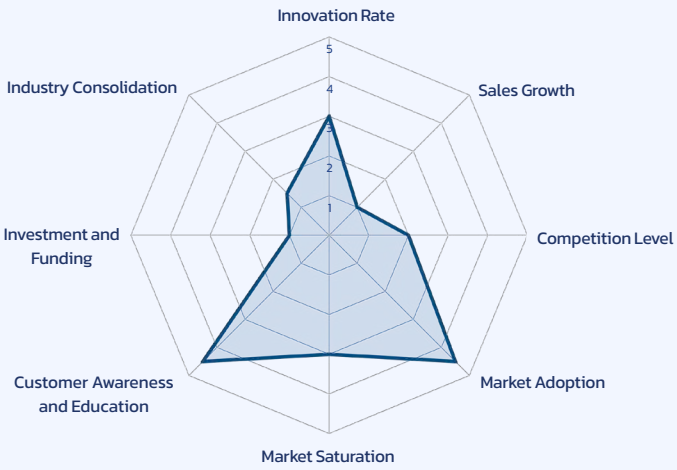
1,500 Iranian applications use mobile analytics platforms

According to experts, it is estimated that around **1,500 applications** use mobile analytics platforms. On average, **200 to 250** apps consistently utilize these platforms **monthly** and are considered as **active users**. Other applications use the platforms **seasonally**, primarily during **advertising campaigns**.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Mobile Analytics Platforms Industry – 2023

Low competition among players due to slow growth and a saturated market

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Mobile Analytics Platforms Industry – 2023





Saghar Rafiee

Sales and Marketing Manager at Metrix

The mobile analytics platform market has reached its saturation point. However, business data scattered across multiple platforms and the need to analyze the customer journey from ad display to the end of the marketing funnel highlight the demand for an integrated platform. Offering a comprehensive solution that eliminates the need for data migration could be a key differentiator for product and market development of mobile analytics platforms.

Mobile Analytics Platforms Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

The need for advanced fraud detection tools to tackle increasingly complex ad fraud

Mobile Analytics Platforms Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Providing advanced analytics such as predictive and real-time data analysis powered by AI	Product development and entry into the marketing automation platform industry
Developing advanced multi-touch models to track multiple user interactions across different channels	Developing advanced multi-touch models to track user interactions across diverse communication channels
Providing advanced fraud detection tools to identify unusual patterns and anomalies	Providing advanced fraud detection tools to identify unusual patterns and anomalies

Data Partner in the Mobile Analytics Platforms Industry

Metrix: A Platform for Real-Time, Precise Data to Enable Smart Decision-Making and Personalized Customer Engagement

1,450
Apps analyzed (2023)

176 million
Total installs tracked (2023)

20 billion
Total sessions tracked (2023)

374,000
Fraudulent installs detected (2023)

Key Features and Capabilities

- Integration of attribution and automation platform
- Powerful fraud detection service
- Dedicated support
- Protecting customer privacy

Notable Clients

724 · Tapsi · Wepod · Jabama

3+ billion tomans
Savings in advertising costs through fraud detection and prevention (2023)

Direct Link to the Website

Adtrace: An Attribution and Analytics Platform Bridging Apps and Advertisers

700+
Apps analyzed (by the end of 2023)

146+ million
Total installs tracked (2023)

11+ billion
Total sessions tracked (2023)

1+ million
Fraudulent installs detected (2023)

Key Features and Capabilities

- App user retargeting capability
- CTIT chart for fraud detection and prevention
- Support during and after implementation
- Providing 5 types of cohort analysis

Notable Clients

Blu Bank · TOP · Nobitex · Abank

5+ billion tomans
Savings in advertising costs through fraud detection and prevention (2023)

Direct Link to the Website

20

Business Intelligence Software

Industry Data Partners:

Decom

NEMOUDAR
DATA MANAGEMENT SOLUTIONS

Report Partners: SMARTECH

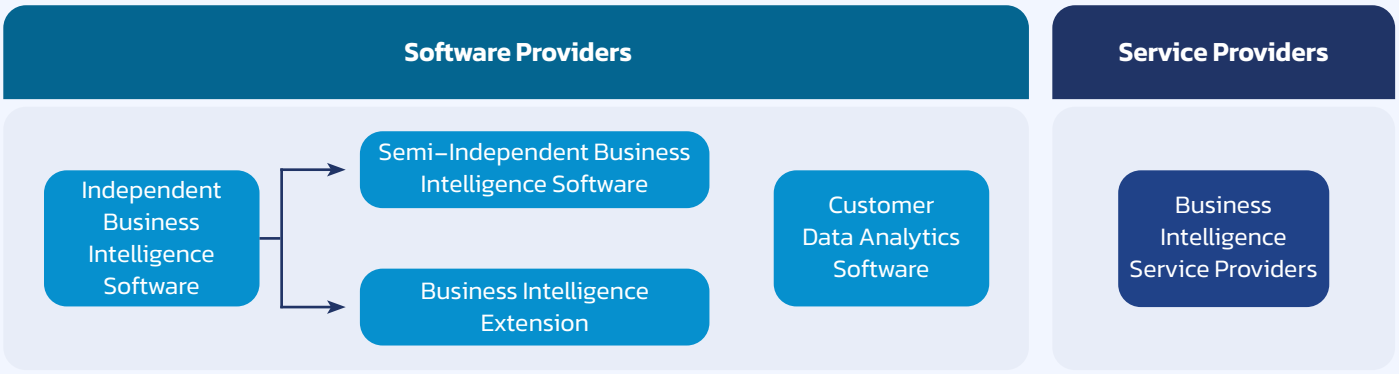
TECHRASA.
Insight

Definition of Business Intelligence Software

Data visualization, creating management dashboards, and analyzing business and customer data

Business intelligence software providers enable the extraction of meaningful insights by facilitating **data visualization**, **creating diverse management dashboards**, and **analyzing** business and customer-related data.

Classification of Business Intelligence Industry Players



"**Software providers**" focus on **developing business intelligence software** that enables the implementation of management dashboards and data analysis for **businesses**, as well as for "**consulting and implementation service providers**" in the field of business intelligence.

Given the report's focus on marketing technology tools, service providers will not be analyzed further.

Independent Software Providers	The software of these players is either **fully** or **largely** developed **in-house**.
Semi-Independent Software Providers	These players have developed **part of their software** in-house while leveraging the **infrastructure** of **independent software providers** to enhance their offerings.
Business Intelligence Extension Providers	These players create extensions for independent BI software by integrating **additional functionalities** and **designing intuitive interfaces** tailored for **Persian-speaking users**.
Customer Data Analytics Software Providers	Players focused on **visualizing and analyzing sales and marketing data** through **proprietary product development**, with **less flexibility** in creating **diverse dashboards**.

"**Independent and semi-independent software providers**" enable medium and large businesses to implement **highly customizable** business intelligence solutions by leveraging **in-house teams** and **advanced technical infrastructure**.

In contrast, "**customer data analytics software**" and "**business intelligence extension**" providers focus on delivering **pre-built management dashboards** with **limited customization** options, primarily suitable for **small and medium businesses without dedicated BI teams**.

Business Intelligence Software Providers– 2023

30 Iranian and foreign software providers are active in the Iranian market

Business Intelligence Software Providers

Independent Business Intelligence Software

Software developed in-house, allowing businesses to create customized dashboards

Foreign Software Used in the Iranian Market

- Power BI
- Qlik
- Tableau
- Looker Studio
- Dundas
- Metabase

Iranian Software

- Decom
- Tart
- Aban System
- YESNAPARS
- Farabar
- Ramix

Semi–Independent Business Intelligence Software

Partially provider-developed software leveraging independent software for tailored dashboards

- Nemoudar
- hooshayand
- SON
- Sahab
- Mohaymen
- Tosan Intelligent Data Miners
- Negah
- Sajayanegar

Customer Data Analytics Software

In-house software focused on sales, with limited customization

- Sokan
- Dashport

Business Intelligence Extensions

Extensions built on independent software with pre-built dashboards and limited customization

- Winiro
- Virakam
- Kavosh
- Nafis BI
- Vitray
- Digitaling
- Keysun
- Mabna

Focused on government institutions and organizations

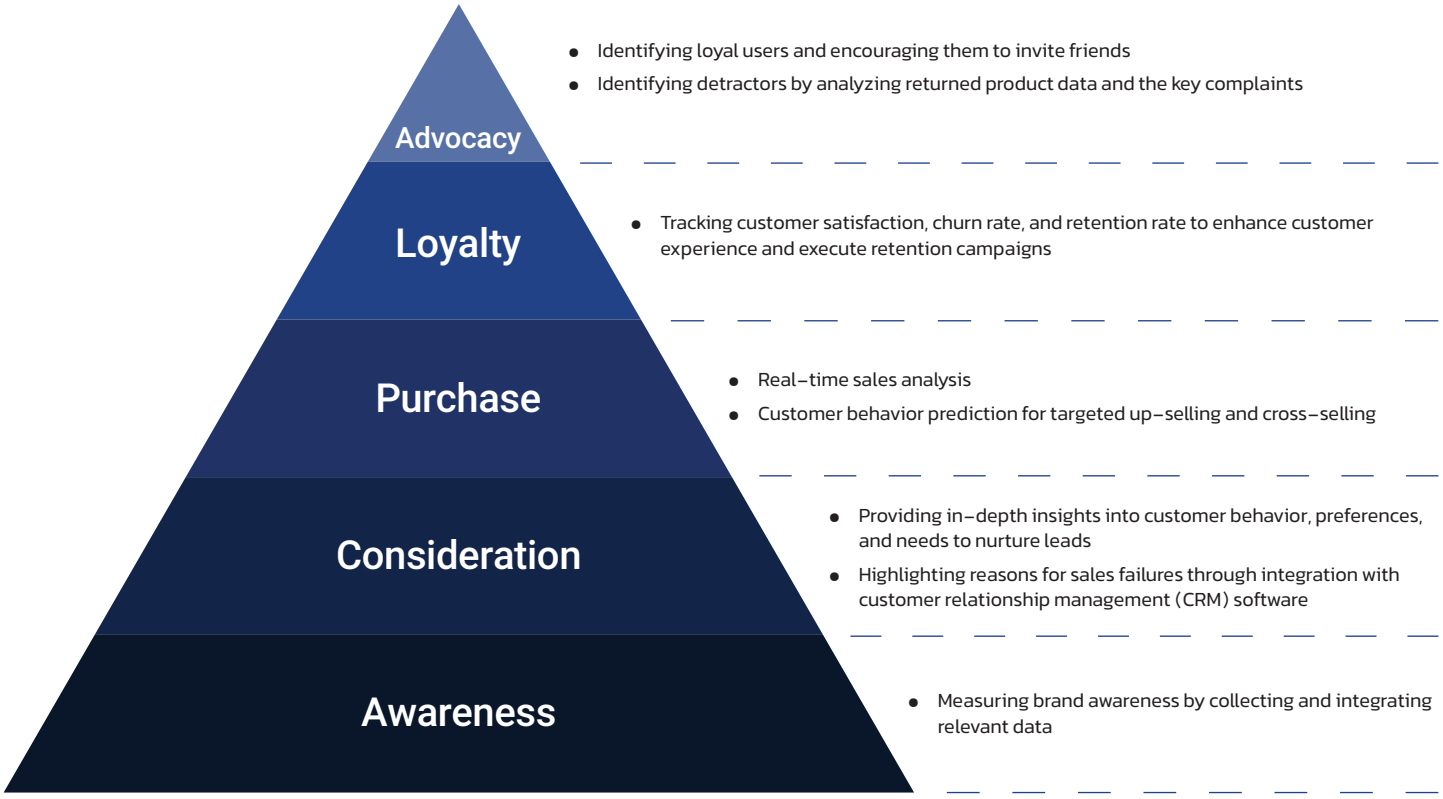
Focused on medium and large businesses

Focused on small businesses

Applications of Business Intelligence Software in the Marketing Funnel

Applicable at all stages of the marketing funnel, with a focus on consideration, purchase, and loyalty

Business intelligence software is used for **data visualization** and **analysis** across **finance**, **sales**, **marketing**, **human resources**, **production** data, and more. This section focuses solely on their **marketing applications**.



Timeline and Milestones of Business Intelligence Software in Iran and the World

Iran's first BI and data visualization companies emerged in the early 2000s

World **Iran**

Mid 1980s – Early 1990s

- The emergence of digital data visualization tools with the introduction of personal computers and graphical user interfaces (GUI)
- The first versions of business intelligence software with basic data collection and reporting functions

Early to Mid 1990s

- The emergence of advanced data visualization software with the development of computer graphics
- Integration of basic management dashboard functionalities into business intelligence software

Late 1990s

- Promotion of management dashboard integration into business intelligence software

2004

- Launch of Tableau

Early 2000s

- Establishment of the first Iranian data visualization and business intelligence companies

Mid to Late 2000s

- In-house development of data collection and reporting systems by business teams
- Adoption of Oracle BI, SharePoint, Qlik, and Excel by businesses for creating management dashboards


Mid 2000s
Early 2010s
The emergence of more advanced big data visualization and analytics software
Introduction of mobile-friendly dashboards and analytics apps
Early 2010s
Increased adoption of business intelligence software among Iranian businesses
Development of System Group's business intelligence solution
2015
Introduction of Microsoft Power BI
Mid 2010s
Migration of Iranian businesses to Power BI
Late 2010s
Rising adoption of Iranian BI software by enterprises
Growth in the number of Iranian business intelligence software providers
Emergence of the first marketing and sales data analytics software
Mid 2010s
Early 2020s
Introduction of advanced analytics tools powered by AI and machine learning
Provision of interactive and user-friendly dashboards for non-technical users to access sophisticated insights
Early 2020s
Greater focus of Iranian players on delivering analytical and specialized solutions

Products and Features of Business Intelligence Software Providers

Core products: Infrastructure for turning raw data into actionable insights

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the business intelligence software industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Products and Features of Business Intelligence Software Providers

Limited differentiation in core products among providers

Core Products and Key Features				
Data Preparation and Integration	Connecting to Various Data Sources	Extract, Transform, and Load (ETL)	Data Blending	
	Form-Based Data Collection	Data Enrichment	Data Access API	
Data Storage	Data Storage	Data Lake		
	Data Import & Export			
Management Dashboard and Reporting	KPI Definition & Custom Formula Writing	Data Visualization (Charts, Tables, etc.)	KPI Monitoring	Roll Up
	Self-Service Dashboards	Automated Reporting	Drill Down	
Data Analytics	Predictive Analytics	Natural Language Processing (NLP)	Statistical Analysis	
	Trend Analysis	Network and Relationship Analytics	User Behavior Analytics	
Data Collaboration & Sharing	Collaboration Tools	Dashboard and Report Distribution		
	Automated Alerts and Notifications			
Data Governance	Data Security	Data Quality Management		
	User Management	Metadata Management		

Insight

Minor differences among business intelligence software providers in core products

BI software providers offer **core products** either through **in-house development** or by **leveraging the infrastructure** of **independent software**. These providers have **minor differences** in their core products and key features.



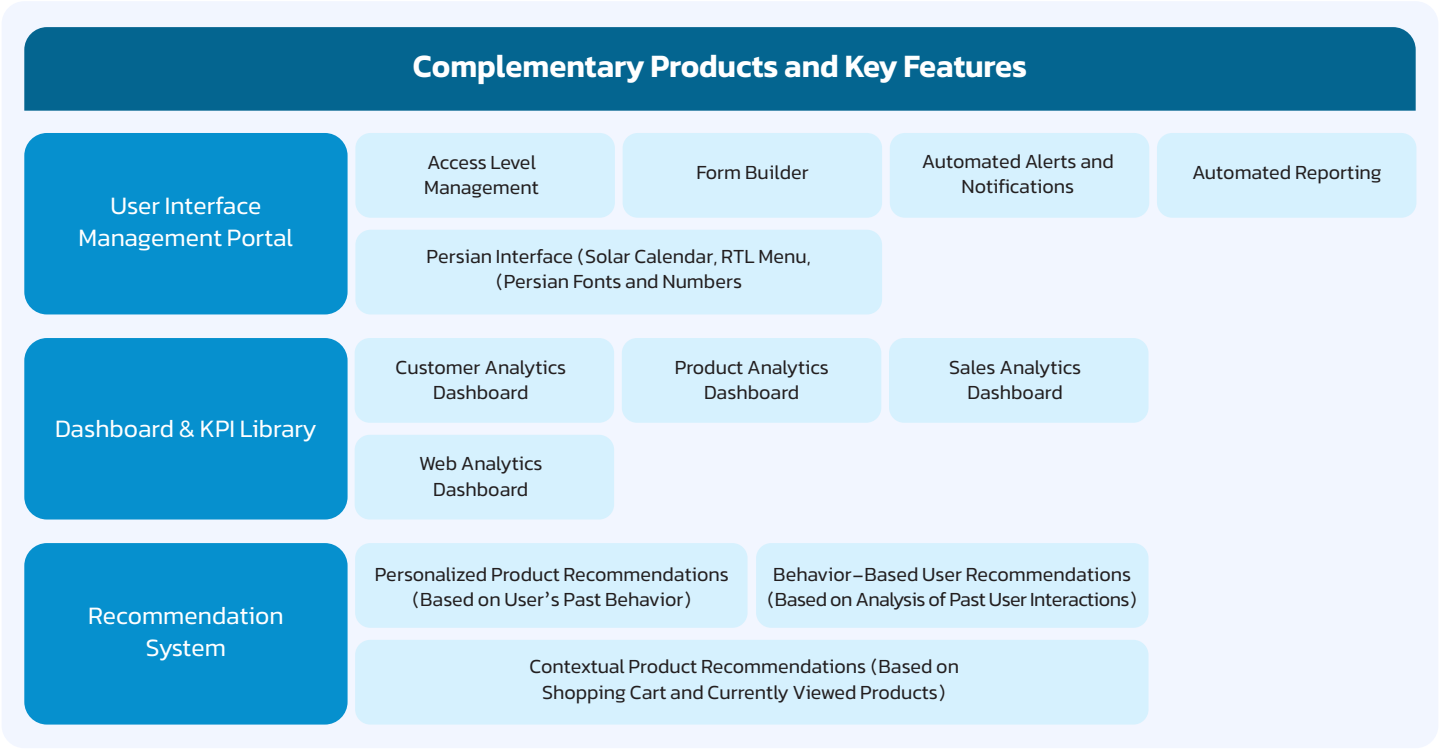
Saeid Mobedi

Co-Founder and CTO of Decom

The management dashboard and reporting product is typically not developed by "semi-independent software providers." These players usually rely on the infrastructure of "independent software providers" to offer this product.

Products and Features of Business Intelligence Software Providers

Enhancing Persian–language UI and streamline dashboard creation with complementary products



Insight

Facilitating management dashboard creation through complementary products

The "**user interface management portal**" is developed to address **compatibility challenges** of foreign software providers with the **Persian language**. Additionally, the "**dashboard & KPI library**" is offered to **streamline** and **accelerate** the **implementation** of business intelligence for **small and medium-sized businesses**.

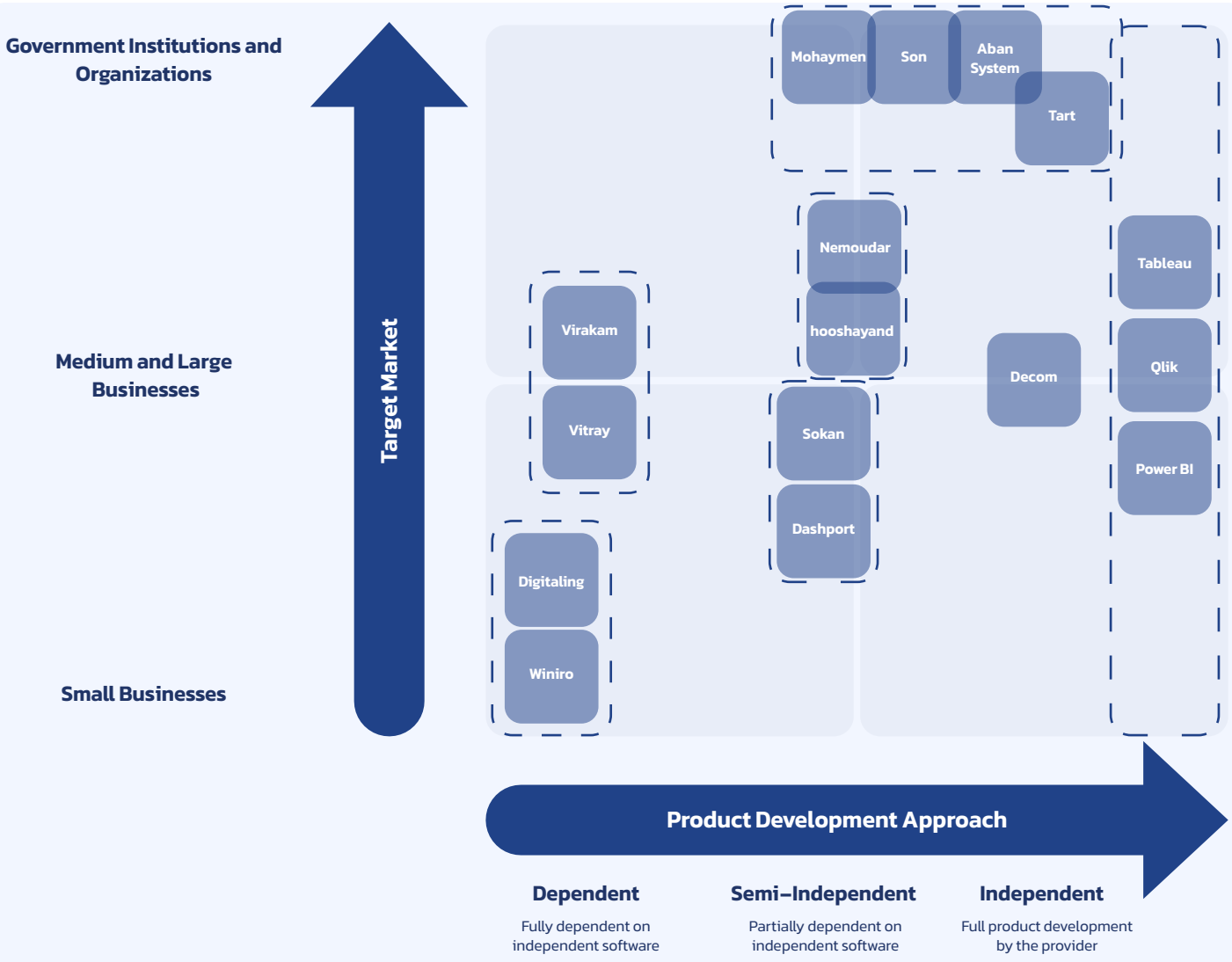
Comparison of Key Business Intelligence Software Providers

The importance of ease of use, especially for businesses without a dedicated BI team

5 Key Criteria for Choosing a Business Intelligence Software Provider from Customer's Perspective

- Ease of Use
- Level of Customization
- Scalability for Large Data Volumes
- Multi-Source Data Aggregation
- Ease of Installation and Deployment

Comparison of Key Business Intelligence Software Based on Product Development Approach and Target Market



Key players are identified by user base, product development approach, or market focus.

Insight

Suitability of independent software for all businesses

Independent software like Power BI, Tableau, and others can be used by **small**, **medium**, and **large businesses**, as well as **government institutions and organizations**.

Business Intelligence Market – 2023

The business intelligence software market in Iran is valued at 25 to 35 billion tomans

Business Intelligence Market Size (Services and Software) – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Iran	500 to 700 billion tomans	200%
Global	29 billion dollars	9%

Market Penetration Rate in Iran



1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans
1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

Insight

A **significant portion** of the business intelligence **market size** is held by **companies** and **freelancers** offering **deployment**, **implementation**, and **support services** without developing their own software.

Business Intelligence Software Market Size – 2023

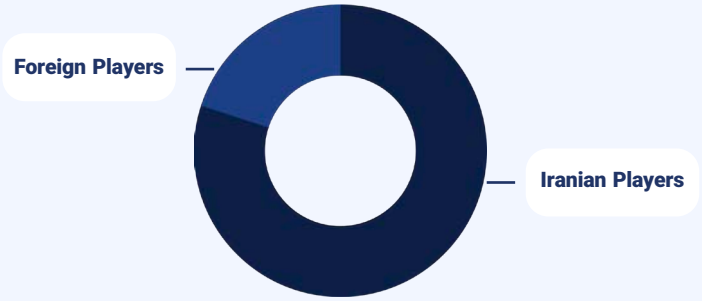
Software Expenditure Share in BI Projects

5%

Business Intelligence Software Market Size in Iran

25 to 35 billion Tomans

Market Share of Foreign Players – 2023



Insight

Due to **over 80% of Iranian businesses** relying on the **free version of Power BI** and its high user base, a significant portion of the target market does not incur software costs. As a result, the **monetary share of foreign players** is estimated to be **less than 20%**.



Hamid Yazdaninejad

Founder and CTO of Hooshayand

Enterprise software platforms like ERP and CRM integrate business intelligence as an embedded feature, offering seamless system-wide integration as a core technical strength.
However, businesses that prioritize agility, require customized BI solutions, or manage multiple databases typically opt for Independent BI providers.

Business Intelligence Market – 2023

Power BI holds over 80% of the Iranian market in terms of both free and paid users

Business Intelligence Software Market Structure – 2023

Metric: Number of Free and Paid Users

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	Power BI, with an estimated market share of over 80%
Challenger	Given the dominant market share of the leader, there are no challengers
Follower	Two foreign players, Qlik and Tableau, along with Iranian players, Nemoudar and Decom, each hold an estimated market share of less than 10%
Nicher	Mohaymen, the market leader in the government institutions and organizations target market



Arman Fallah

Founder and Managing Director of Nemoudar

No licensing fees, ease of use, exceptional data processing capabilities, diverse features, regular monthly updates, and a large community of experts and developers are the reasons why over 80% of businesses use Power BI.

Insight

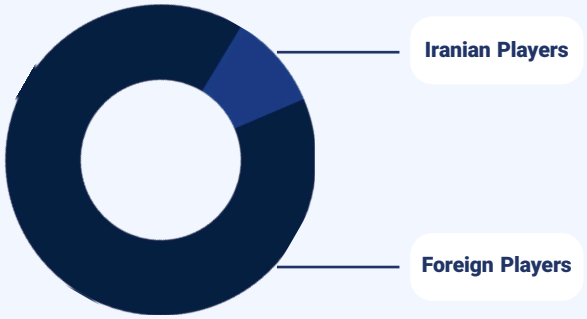
The government sector's substantial spending on **multi-billion tomans projects**, alongside **security concerns** regarding the use of foreign providers by public institutions, has created an attractive market for Iranian players to establish a notable presence.

Share of Foreign Players in Business Intelligence Software Market – 2023

Insight

The **market share of foreign players** by **user base** is estimated to be **over 95%**. According to experts, around **70% of Iranian businesses** are **direct users** of Power BI, while **10%** are **indirect users** (through semi-independent software and extentions). Other foreign players hold a market share of **over 10%**.

Market Share of Foreign Players by User Base – 2023



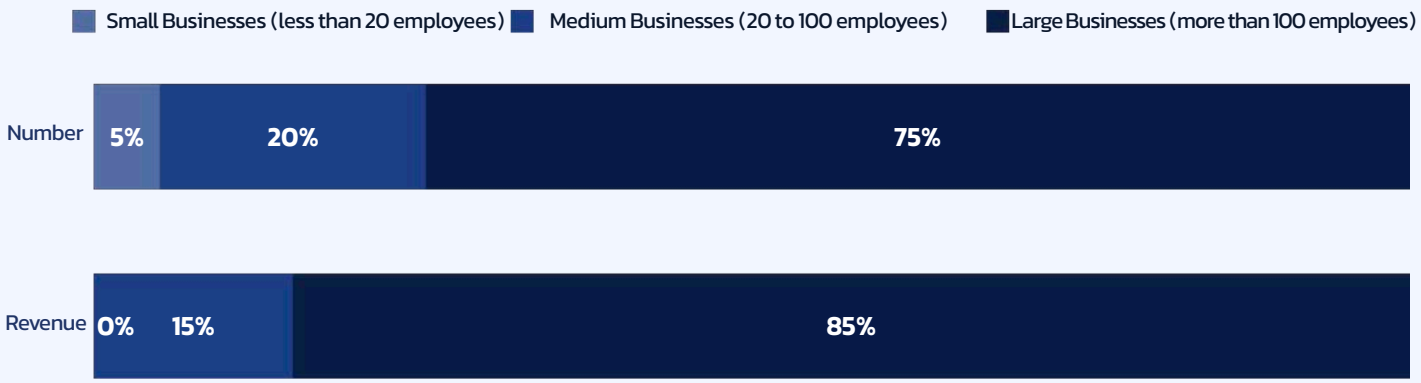
Business Intelligence Market – 2023

Over 80% of the total revenue of business intelligence software providers comes from large businesses

What Businesses Use Business Intelligence Software the Most?

- Distribution and Logistics
- Government Institutions and Organizations
- Commerce and Trade
- E-commerce
- Banking, Financial Services, and Insurance
- Retail
- Oil and Gas
- Manufacturing

Revenue and Customer Distribution of Business Intelligence Software Providers Based on Business Size – 2023



Insight

Attractive opportunity to provide business intelligence solutions to small businesses

The number of **small businesses** in Iran is estimated to **exceed 700,000**. Offering **affordable**, **ready-to-use** business intelligence solutions with the ability to **integrate with enterprise software**, especially accounting and sales systems, could activate this market.



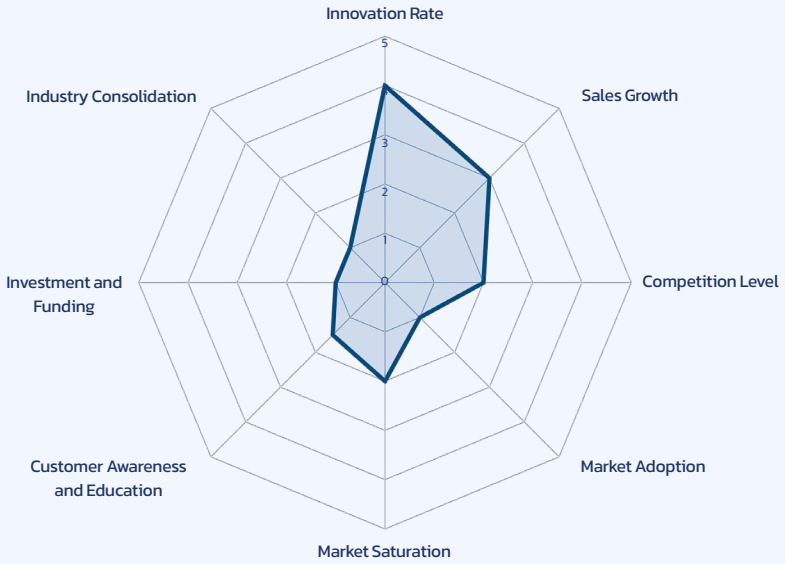
Amir Hariri
Founder of Winio

Small businesses primarily leverage business intelligence software for data visualization. However, the main application of business intelligence is in data analysis for data-driven decision-making, which small businesses are unable to fully leverage due to financial limitations in hiring data analysts. Offering ready-to-use business intelligence solutions could activate this promising market.

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Business Intelligence Software Industry – 2023

Strong but unrealized interest from large businesses in acquiring business intelligence software providers

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Business Intelligence Software Industry – 2023





Hamid Yazdaninejad

Founder and CTO of Hooshayand

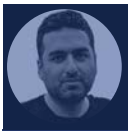
Despite high demand in the market, the cost of business intelligence solutions is higher than expected for some businesses. This is while the cost-to-revenue ratio of these solutions for companies in Iran is much lower compared to other countries. Low awareness among businesses about the capabilities of business intelligence and the ineffective performance of local players in highlighting its added value are key reasons for this issue.

Business Intelligence Software Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

The need for intelligent assistants in businesses for real-time analysis and actionable insights

Business Intelligence Software Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Automating data analysis, identifying patterns, and providing predictive insights using machine learning and AI	Providing customized dashboards tailored to business needs in the shortest time
Self-service BI enabling reporting, visualization, and data analysis for non-technical users	Providing an AI-powered intelligent assistant for real-time strategy determination and actionable insights for managers
Increased scalability, flexibility, and cost-effectiveness through cloud-based solutions	Increasing demand from government institutions and organizations for management dashboards
Increasing demand for real-time data analytics in fast-changing industries such as finance, banking, cybersecurity, and more	Rising demand driven by the growth of big data and the increasing awareness of the need for data-driven decision-making
	Integrating internal company data with market and national-level data to provide advanced insights and analytics



Saeid Mobedi

Co-Founder and CTO of Decom

In the past, businesses primarily used business intelligence for data visualization and analysis. However, with the growing understanding of the importance of data-driven decision-making, the role of business intelligence is shifting towards understanding relationships between different data points (knowledge) and receiving actionable insights (wisdom). As a result, demand for predictive and prescriptive analytics powered by machine learning and AI for sales forecasting, customer segmentation, and more is rising.

Data Partners in the Business Intelligence Software Industry

Decom: A Native Business Intelligence Software with a Proprietary Engine

Analytical capabilities
Leveraging AI and machine learning for pattern recognition and predictive analysis

Unlimited scalability
Deployable in enterprises and small to medium-sized businesses (SMEs)

Integration with operational software
Connects with databases of accounting, CRM, BPMS, and other software

Key Features and Capabilities

- Mobile and tablet data visualization
- User access control for internal and external users

Direct Link to the Website

Nemoudar: A Unified System for All Reports with a Native Data Management Platform

3,000+
Users (2023)

150%
Customer growth (2022 to 2023)

88%
Customer retention rate

150%
Revenue growth (2022 to 2023)

Notable Clients

Iran Zamin BanK
Hamrah e Aval
Saman Electronic Payment
Ministry of Petroleum

Power BI dashboard display and data alerts

Key Features and Capabilities

- Sales
- Marketing
- Finance
- Inventory
- Human Resource

Direct Link to the Website

21

Web Analytics Platform



Report Partners: SMARTECH

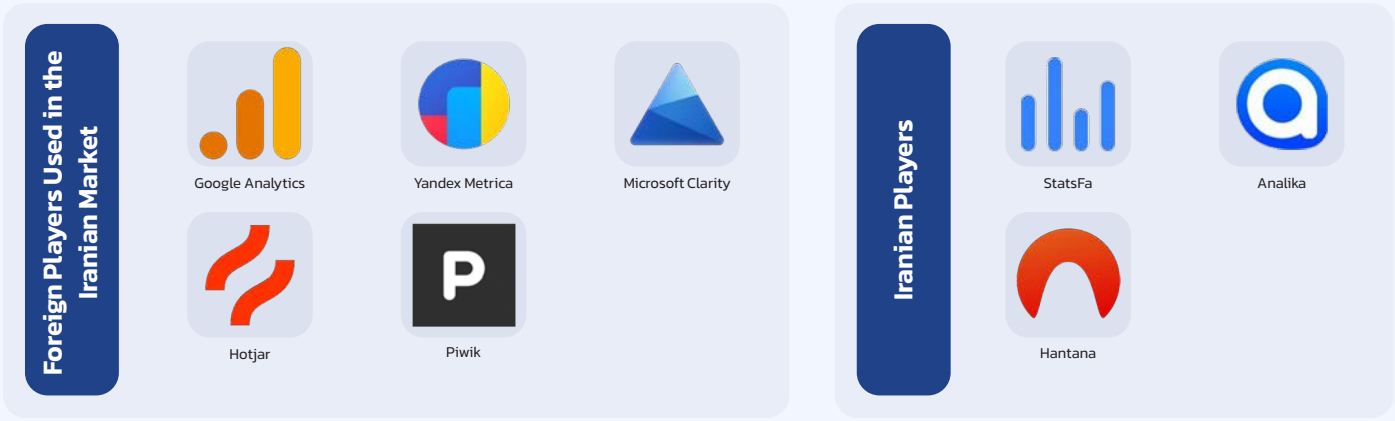
TECHRASA. Insight

Web Analytics Platforms – 2023

The dominance of Google Analytics in the Iranian market mirrors its global presence

Web analytics platforms enable businesses to **collect**, **analyze**, and **report** on **quantitative** and **qualitative** website data.

Web Analytics Platforms



Insight

Google Analytics is the undisputed market leader

Over **90% of Iranian businesses** with websites use **Google Analytics**. For qualitative website analysis needs, and given that **Google Analytics** lacks these capabilities, tools like **Hotjar** are utilized.

Insight

Emerging Iranian competitors in the market

StatsFa and **Analika**, emerging Iranian competitors, are actively **developing their products** but currently exhibit minimal market presence. **Hantana**, recognized for its innovative and **diverse products**, appears to have redirected its focus away from the Iranian market, expanding its operations **internationally**.



Afshin Zandi

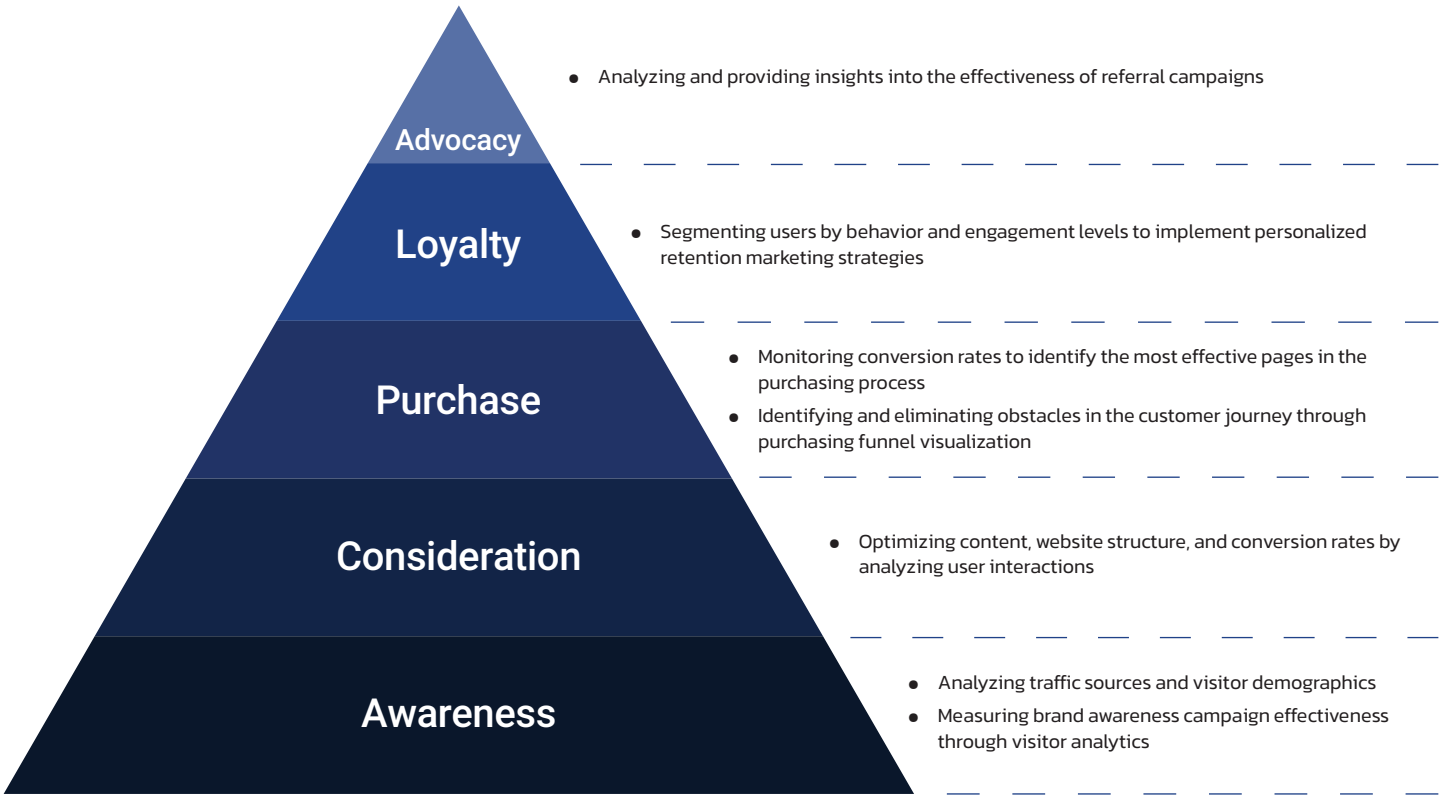
CEO of Analytips

Most Iranian businesses are adopting Google Analytics due to its extensive documentation, robust community support, and strong acceptance among other companies, including advertising networks. Nonetheless, its capabilities are more limited compared to platforms like Clarity.

Applications of Website Analytics Platforms in the Marketing Funnel

Greater impact in the first three stages by tracking and analyzing user behavior on the website

Web analytics platforms are valuable tools for **understanding user behavior** and **optimizing website performance** across the entire marketing funnel. These platforms help marketers **optimizing website performance** by **analyzing user behavior**. Ultimately, by **enhancing** the **user experience** and **conversion rates**, businesses experience **growth** in sales and **revenue**.



Products and Features of Web Analytics Platforms

Quantitative and qualitative data analysis are the core products of web analytics platforms

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the web analytics platforms industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.

Core Products	Complementary Products	Other products
Web Traffic and Behavioral Analytics		Online Form Builder
User Experience and Interaction Analytics		On–Site Messaging
Tag Management		

Core Products and Key Features

Web Traffic and Behavioral Analytics	Visitor Information	Visitor Count	Pageviews & Session
	Traffic Attribution and Source	Bounce Rate	
User Experience and Interaction Analytics	Session Recording and Playback		
	Heatmap		
Tag Management	Tag Implementation and Deployment	Event Tracking	
	Defining Triggers	Custom Variable Management	

Web Analytics Platforms Market – 2023

Google Analytics holds over 90% market share in Iran based on the number of users

Insight

Widespread free usage of web analytics platforms

Most businesses use web analytics platforms for **free**. **Subscriptions** are only required when handling **large-scale** website data.



Afshin Zandi

CEO of Analytips

The GA4 360 version costs at least $50,000 annually, making it unaffordable for many businesses. Advertising agencies address this by purchasing GA4 360 accounts and integrating multiple websites, enabling businesses to use its advanced features.

Web Analytics Platforms Market Structure – 2024

Metric: Number of Users

*Based on the Kotler-Keller Method

Leader	Google Analytics with an estimated market share of over 90%
Challenger	
Follower	Microsoft Clarity and Yandex Metrika with a combined estimated market share of less than 10%
Nicher	Hotjar is the market leader in providing user experience & interaction analytics product

Web Analytics Platforms Market – 2023

Limited adoption of web analytics platforms among Iranian digital businesses

Which Businesses Use Web Analytics Platforms the Most?

- Online Retail
- Financial Technology (FinTech)
- On-Demand Home Services
- HealthTech

Insight

Less than 50% of digital businesses use website analytics platforms

According to experts, **less than 50%** of **digital businesses in Iran** use **website analytics platforms.** However, **fewer than 10%** use these platforms **effectively** due to **insufficient understanding** of their **functionalities** and **potential applications**

Insight

Opportunity for Iranian players to enter the government and public sector

Given **Google Analytics' dominant market position** and businesses' **lack of trust** in **Iranian platforms** due to concerns over **data security** and potential **loss of access** if a platform shuts down, Iranian players face significant challenges in this field.

However, due to the public sector's **data security concerns**, there is an opportunity to enter this market by developing platforms tailored to the needs of **government institutions** and **organizations**.

22

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform



Report Partners: SMARTECH

TECHRASA. Insight

Definition of Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform

Monitoring and managing in-store and online sales

Companies that enable businesses to monitor and manage in-store and online sales channels through a single dashboard. Businesses can automate accounting tasks (inventory management, invoicing, etc.), order management, sales optimization, product pricing, and advertising.

Which Players Provide Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms?

Online Accounting Software | E-commerce Platforms | E-commerce WordPress Plugins | Marketplace Seller Assistants | Online Point-of-Sale Systems

The primary focus of this report is to analyze the key players in "Marketplace Seller Assistants" and "Online Point-of-Sale Systems," while other players are not covered.

Online Accounting Software	Some accounting software provides **plugins** or **API** to connect online stores to accounting software (e.g., Hesabfa, Sepidar System, Abrestan, Landa, etc.). Others enable **integration with Markito** to connect to the Digikala panel (marketplace), their own websites, and marketing channels (Torob and Emalls) (e.g., Abriron, Hesaban Web).
E-commerce Platforms	Some e-commerce platforms focus solely on managing sales through online channels by connecting to platforms like **Digikala**, **Torob**, and **Emalls** (e.g., Besaz E-commerce Platform). Others, such as Padro, have gone a step further by integrating in-store and online sales channels.
E-commerce WordPress Plugins	Plugins that enable connecting **WooCommerce to the Digikala seller panel**, offering management of sales on both the website and the marketplace (e.g., Digiksell).
Marketplace Seller Assistants	These players focus on marketplace sellers, with automated pricing being their key differentiator from other categories. Most players (e.g., Mobisha, Markobot, Helium) focus exclusively on **automated pricing for a single channel** (Digikala marketplace). However, others (e.g., Markito) enable **pricing across multiple channels** (Digikala and marketing channels like Torob and Emalls) and offer additional services such as integrated management of online and in-store sales, automated accounting, advertising management, and logistics support for sellers.
Online Point-of-Sale Systems	These players focus on sellers of physical goods with in-store sales. They manage both in-store and online sales through inventory management and the **ability to connect to online sales channels such as Digikala and websites**, all within a single panel.



Aria Motamedinejad
Co-founder of Zitron

Online accounting software primarily focuses on accounting. However, since their customers required integration with other sales channels, this need pushed online accounting solutions to enable connections with online sales channels.

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms – 2023

4 Iranian omnichannel retail commerce platforms have been identified in Iran's market

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms

Marketplace Seller Assistants

These players focus on marketplace sellers, with "automated pricing" as their core product. By integrating with accounting systems and online sales channels such as Digikala, e-commerce websites, and product search engines, they enable automated management of both in-store and online sales within a single panel.

Target Market: Marketplace Sellers

Markito

SellerYar

Online Point-of-Sale Systems

These players focus on sellers of physical goods conducting in-store sales. By managing inventory and integrating with online sales channels such as Digikala and e-commerce websites, they provide automated management of both in-store and online sales within a single panel.

Target Market: Brick-and-Mortar Stores

ZiTRON

Taamito

Applications of Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms in the Marketing Funnel

Omnichannel retail commerce platforms primarily focus on the purchase and post-purchase stages



Timeline and Milestones of Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms in Iran and the World

The mid-2010s mark the emergence of the first omnichannel retail commerce platforms in Iran



Products and Features of Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms

Product differentiation based on target market

By analyzing the features and functions offered by the players, products have been categorized into three groups: core, complementary, and others.

Core Products: Provided by all players, these form the foundation of the business.

Complementary Products: Offered by some players, these products add value and integrate with the core products.

Other Products: Distinct from the core, these are offered independently and do not rely on the core product. They reflect either the entry of players from other industries into the omnichannel retail commerce platforms industry or their expansion from this industry into other industries.



Insight

The players offering the "marketplace seller assistant" product focus on marketplace sellers and provide a variety of services tailored to their needs.

Insight

The players offering the "online point-of-sale system" product focus on the in-store sales market and provide various features tailored to the needs of this market.

Products and Features of Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms

Integration with online and in-store sales channels

Core Products and Key Features

Marketplace Seller Assistant	Automated Pricing	Inventory Management	Integration with Accounting Software	Integration with Marketplaces
	Integration with Marketing Channels Like Torob & Emalls	Integration with Logistics Companies	Integration with E-Commerce Platforms	Financial Reporting
	Advertising Management			
Online Point-of-Sale System	Inventory and Order Management	Customer Data Capture	Integration with Digikala & Own Websites	Running A/B Testing Campaigns
	Invoicing	Integration with Marketing Channels Like Torob, Emalls, and Pindo	Integration with POS Hardware and Barcode Scanners	Option to Send Payment Links
	WordPress Integration Plugin			



Mehdi Adeli

Co-Founder & CEO of Marketio

Pricing is especially critical for products heavily influenced by the dollar-rial exchange rate. Fluctuations in the exchange rate make the pricing process more complex and time-consuming. Automated pricing systems help overcome these challenges by continuously monitoring currency and gold rates, updating product prices in real time, minimizing human errors, and saving time.

Moreover, automated pricing enhances accuracy and consistency, allowing sellers to adapt more quickly and efficiently to rapid market changes.

Complementary Products and Key Features

E-commerce Platform	Unified Order Management	Integration with Point-of-Sale Systems	Providing Various Payment Solutions (Payment Gateways, Account Transfers, and Cash on Delivery)
International Wholesale	Product Marketing and Translation in Target Countries	Settlement in Local Currency(Rial)	Profit Sharing in USD After Order Delivery to Customers

Comparison of Key Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms

Support for various channels by platforms

Comparison of Key Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Based on Supported Sales Channels

	In-Store Sales Channel	Marketplace Sales Channel	Website Sales Channel	Social Media Sales Channel	Product Search Engine Sales Channel (e.g., Torob, Emalls)	Integration with Social Media Management Platforms
Markito	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✓
SellerYar	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
ZiTRON	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓	✗
Taamito	✓	✗	✓	✗	✓	✗

Insight

Markito enables automated posting on social media. Additionally, through integration with accounting systems, Markito facilitates in-store sales management.

Insight

Currently, none of the players can integrate with social media platforms due to sanctions. However, inventory and sales management on social media are handled through sending "invoice payment links" or "direct product links."

Comparison of Key Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms

The integration of in-store and online sales

7 Key Criteria for Choosing an Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform from the Customer's Perspective

- Technology and Innovation
- Variety of Services and Products
- Integration with Other Software
- Customer Support
- Support for Various Sales Channels
- Data Security
- Service Stability



Teymoor Sattarzadeh

Co-Founder and CEO of SellerYar

Some sellers have multiple Digikala panels, so the ability to connect to all of them is crucial.

Markito	Markito enables businesses to manage in-store and online sales through a unified system by integrating marketplaces, e-commerce platforms, and product search engines like Torob and Emalls.
SellerYar	SellerYar enables sales management on the Digikala marketplace and online stores.
ZiTRON	Zitron enables sales management across the Digikala marketplace, in-store channels, and websites. Additionally, Zitron's target market is small and medium-sized stores that sell physical goods.
Taamito	Taamito enables businesses to manage both online and in-store sales by integrating e-commerce platforms with point-of-sale systems.

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Market – 2023

The market for omnichannel solutions is in its infancy and emerging in Iran

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Market Size – 2023

	Market Size (Actual)	Annual Growth Rate
Global*	5.36 billion dollars (2023)	19%

Market Penetration Rate in Iran

Very Low	Low	Medium	High	Very High

1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans / 1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars

*Globally known as omni-channel retail commerce patforms, they enable the integration of in-store and online channels.

As the omni-channel retail commerce market in Iran is still emerging, precise figures are unavailable. More comprehensive data will be provided in future reports as the market grows and becomes more transparent.

Market Potential of Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms in Iran

Number of Active Sellers on Digikala	Number of Websites with E-Namad That Have the Potential to Use This Solution	Number of Instagram Shops
50,000	20,000	+500,000

*In addition to the above statistics, there are nearly 2.5 million small businesses and trade units in the country, some of which have the potential to become customers.

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Market Structure – 2023

Given the nascent and emerging nature of this market, it is currently not possible to discuss its structure or the market share of players.

However, experts suggest that **Markito** appears to hold the largest share among the players.

Which Businesses Use Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms the Most?

Who Are the Customers of Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms?

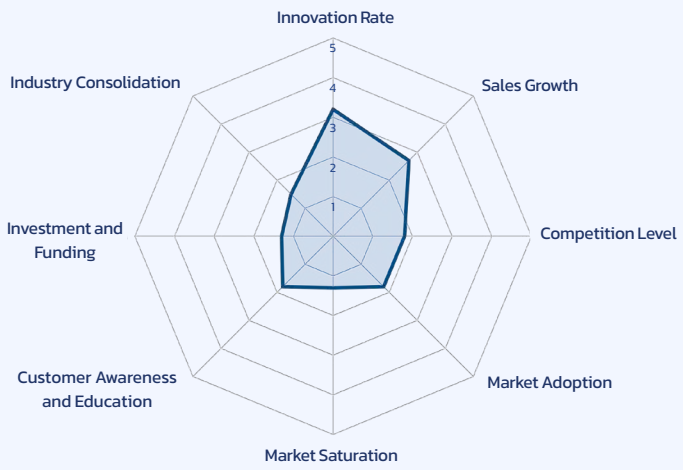
- Retailers selling both in-store and online
- Active sellers on marketplaces

- Cosmetics and Personal Care
- Books
- Digital Goods
- Home and Kitchen
- Tools and Equipment
- Clothing
- Gold Retailers
- Flower and Plant Shops

Competitive Analysis and Market Attractiveness of the Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Industry – 2023

The omnichannel retail commerce platform market is in its embryonic stage

Analysis of Key Indicators Impacting the Life Cycle of the Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Industry – 2023



The omnichannel retail commerce platform market is in its embryonic stage. Although these solutions are highly innovative and new in Iran, they still lag behind global standards.

Insight

The intensity of competition among players is very low due to the nascent nature of the omnichannel retail commerce platform market. Additionally, the complexity of integrating various sales channels poses challenges for new entrants into this market.

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Industry Trends in Iran and the World – 2023

Artificial intelligence and personalized experiences are key trends in Iran and around the world

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platforms Industry Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Personalized shopping experiences through customer data analysis	Emergence of new sales channels
Advanced inventory management using artificial intelligence and machine learning	Greater integration of retailers' sales channels
Creating a seamless shopping experience for customers across online and in-store channels	

23

Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investment Landscape in Iran and the World



Report Partners: SMARTECH

TECHRASA. Insight

Venture Capital Investments in the World and the MENA Region

Venture capital investments worldwide have been declining since 2021

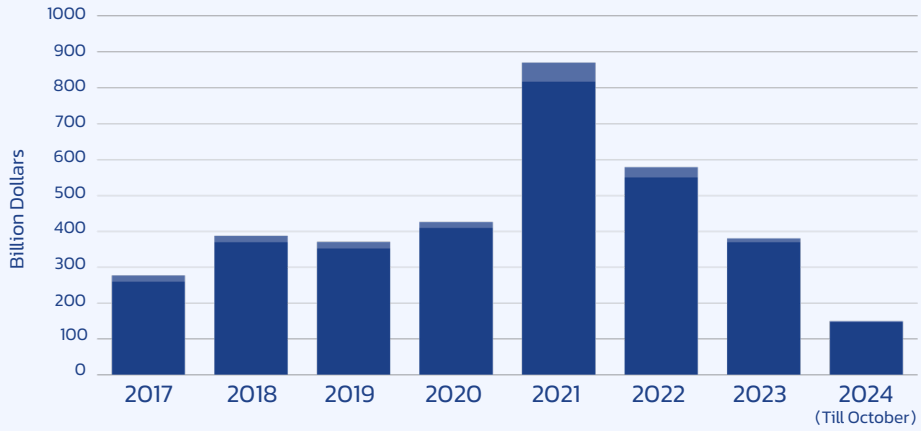
COVID–19, a driver of investment growth in certain industries

As shown in the chart, venture capital investments worldwide saw significant growth in **2021**. These investments were primarily focused on areas such as **gaming**, **digital health**, **education**, and others, which gained traction due to the COVID-19 pandemic in 2019-2020. Additionally, **more than 500 companies** became unicorns in 2021.

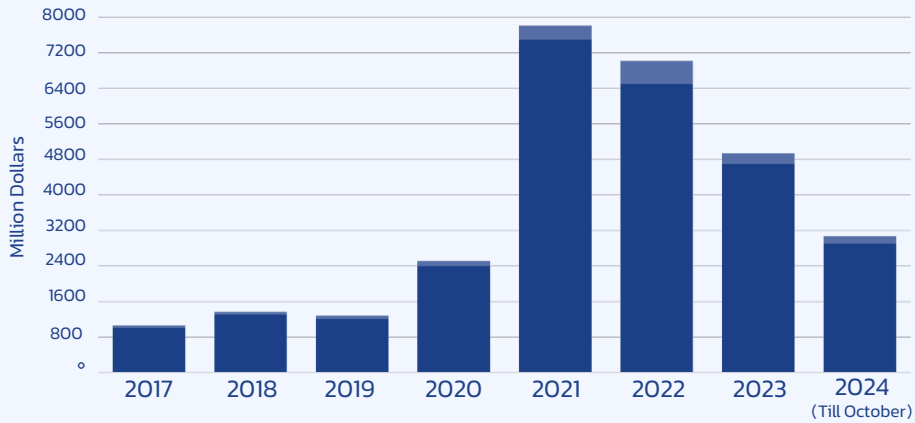
International tensions and the decline in venture capital investments

However, since then, economic factors such as **high inflation**, **rising interest rates** globally, as well as **economic and geopolitical uncertainties** like the Russia-Ukraine war, have made investors more cautious, leading to a decline in investment volumes. Nevertheless, certain areas, such as **artificial intelligence**, have experienced growth.

The Share of MarTech Investment Compared to Total VC Investments Worldwide – 2017 to 2024



The Share of MarTech Investment Compared to Total VC Investments in MENA – 2017 to 2024



Overall, 2021 marked the peak of global and MENA investments, and investment volumes have been declining since then. However, the share of investments in marketing compared to total investments was around 3% in 2023 globally, while in MENA, this figure was 5%.

Venture Capital Investment

Venture Capital Investment in MarTech

Most Active Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in the World

Some of the most important MarTech investors are MarTech players who also act as strategic investors

Notable Active Strategic Investors in the MarTech Industry Worldwide



Salesforce



Hubspot



Adobe


Oracle


Medallia

Notable Active Private Equity (PE) Investors in the MarTech Industry Worldwide


Vista Equity Partners



Accel-KKR



Alpine Investors


Thoma Bravo

Notable Active Venture Capital (VC) Investors in the MarTech Industry Worldwide


GV (Google Ventures)



Sequoia Capital



Andreessen Horowitz



Bessemer Venture Partners

Insight

Globally, **strategic investors**, those who are active in the industry themselves and typically invest to **complete their value chain**, are considered some of the most important MarTech investors.

Insight

Additionally, **private equity firms** are active in MarTech globally, though their presence in Iran is **limited**.

Most Active Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in the Region

Many of the active investors in the region are international investors

Some Notable Active MarTech Investors in Turkey

212

Revo Capital

Some Notable Active MarTech Investors in MENA

RAED Ventures

Saudi Arabia

Middle East Venture Partners

UAE

Wamda Capital

UAE

Insight

Due to the presence of **international investors** in the region, many startups and companies in the **MENA region** have been able to secure funding from global investors. For example, Insider has raised investment from Sequoia.

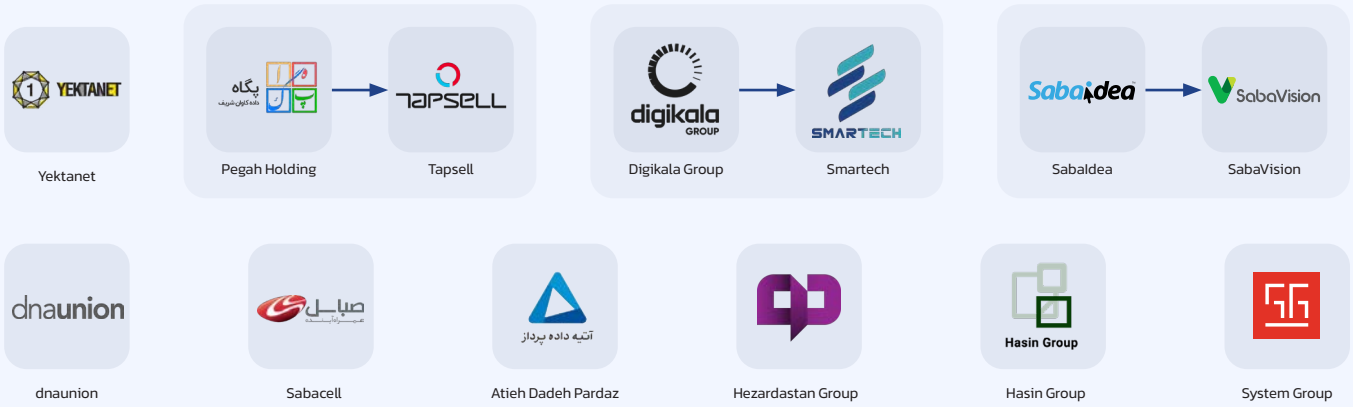
Types of Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in Iran

AdTech and MarTech companies and holdings are important MarTech investors in Iran

Types of MarTech Investors in Iran

Strategic Investors (MarTech and AdTech Companies and Holdings)

These investors are **active** in the industry themselves and make investments that complete their **value chain**, seeking **synergies**. Their investments are typically in the form of **creating subsidiaries** or **acquisitions**.



Insight

- Among strategic investors, the primary focus of "**Yektanet**" and "**Tapsell**" is **digital advertising networks**. "**Sabacell**" focuses on advertising and providing **digital publishing infrastructure**.
- "**SabaVision**," through its ownership of **media subsidiaries of Sabaldea**, such as Aparat and Filimo, focuses on advertising on these platforms.
- "**Smartech**" is the MarTech arm of the **Digikala Group**, which operates and invests in MarTech and AdTech products in this industry, with a focus on **e-commerce**.
- "**Hassin Group (Myket and Magnet)**" and "**Hezardastan Group (Cafe Bazaar and Divar)**" are significant **AdTech** investors due to their subsidiaries, but they have not been deeply explored in this report as it focuses on MarTech.
- "**System Group**" is an enterprise software solutions provider and is considered a player and investor in this industry through its **customer relationship management and sales software**.
- "**Atieh Dadeh Pardaz**" focuses on **SMS services** but has also expanded into other areas.
- "**dnaunion**" primarily operates in **advertising (AdTech)** but is also active in marketing and market research, with several subsidiaries.

Types of Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in Iran

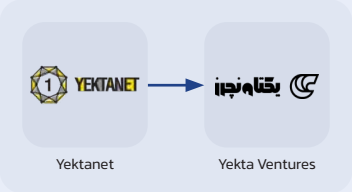
Some venture capital investors also have investments in MarTech

Types of MarTech Investors in Iran

Venture Capital Investors

Corporate Venture Capital (CVC) Investors

These are the investment arms of large enterprises, seeking investments that have **strategic synergies** and are **profitable**.



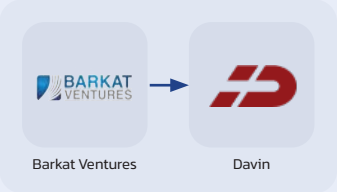


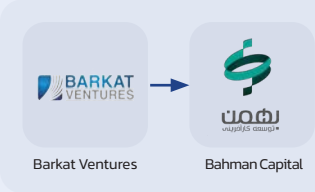
Insight

- Yekta Ventures is the **investment arm of Yektanet**, launched in 2023.
- The activities of Javane are currently **paused**.

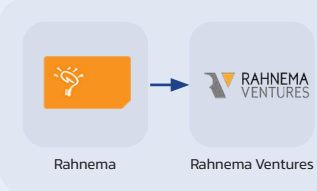
Venture Capital (VC) Investors

They invest in startups in exchange for **equity**, with the goal of generating **profits** and ultimately achieving a **successful exit** (through an IPO or acquisition).









Insight

- Among the venture capital investors introduced, **Sarava** and **Rahnema** were active investors in this field in the past, but **have not been significantly active** in recent years.

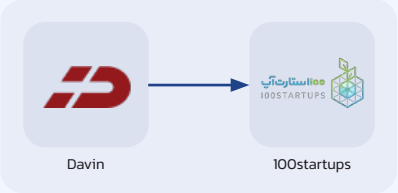
Types of Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in Iran

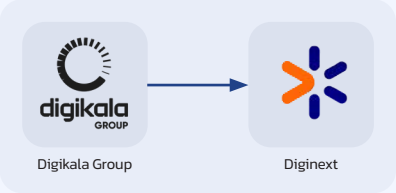
Accelerators and innovation centers, particularly those affiliated with large companies, are active in this field

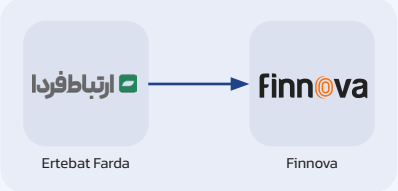
Types of MarTech Investors in Iran

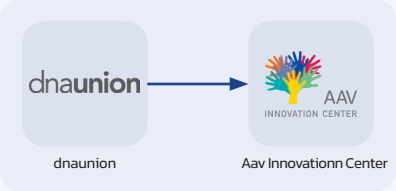
Accelerators and Innovation Centers

They invest in **early-stage startups**, providing not only capital but also **mentorship** and **necessary resources**. They focus on accelerating the growth and development of startups within a **short period** (typically 3-6 months).









Insight

- The "**100startups**" network also invests in startups through its investment funds and LPs (Limited Partners).
- **Finnova** has not been active recently and will soon **cease its operations**.

Most Active Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in Iran

Strategic investors are the most active and important MarTech investors

Most Active Investors Identified in MarTech and Their Portfolio Companies (Excluding AdTech)

Tapsell

Metrix*	Gapify	Athena	Pixy
Mobile Analytics and Marketing Automation Platform	Live Chat and Chatbot	AI-Powered Text and Image Generation	AI-Powered Content Generation

*In 2023, Pushe has been integrated into Metrix.

Tapsell, with its advertising network including Tagrow, Sanjagh, MediaAd, and **MediaHouse** (which includes Beeptunes, Salam Cinema, and others), focuses on digital advertising. The company has also ventured into **artificial intelligence**, with two additional AI products alongside Gapify and Pixy in the MarTech field.



Sobhan Foroughi

Co-Founder and CEO of Tapsell

Currently, our investment approach is such that if an area is highly strategic and sensitive, we enter it ourselves or pursue an acquisition. However, if the area is adjacent and less strategic but still beneficial to us, we act as a venture capital investor and typically enter with a small seat.

Yektanet

Yeklink	Najva	NovinHub	Iran Samaneh
Instagram Link-in-Bio	A2P SMS & Email Marketing Platform	Social Media Analytics and Management Platform	Content Management System (CMS)

Yektanet has several AdTech subsidiaries and has entered FinTech through YektaPay, Ghollak, and TadbirHesab. It also invests in education and social commerce enablers.

Most Active Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in Iran

Strategic investors are the most active and important MarTech investors

Most Active Investors Identified in MarTech and Their Portfolio Companies (Excluding AdTech)

Smartech

inTrack

Marketing Automation

Adtrace

Mobile Analytics Platform

Smartech is the MarTech arm of the Digikala Group, which, in addition to the mentioned MarTech subsidiaries, also has two AdTech subsidiaries: Affilio and Adverge.



Mazdak Pakzad

Co-Founder and CEO of Smartech

Currently, our investment criterion is to complete the value chain of our products. Additionally, a strong team is a key factor in investing in early-stage startups. For startups that have reached a certain level of maturity, traction becomes an added criterion.

Diginext

Zitron

Online Point-of-Sale System

Dezhino

Performance Marketing Platform

Khodnevis

AI-Powered Text and Image Generation

FlowChat

Live Chat and Chatbot

Prism

AI-Based Call Center Management

Since MarTech is a key focus area for Digikala, Diginext, the group's innovation and investment hub, focuses on MarTech startups and has many in its portfolio.



Hamid Mohammadi

Co-Founder and Chairman of the Board of Digikala Group

Our investment approach is to attract and invest in solutions that are external to our organization, align with our needs, and can integrate with our other products. We are not focused on developing products from scratch.

Most Active Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investors in Iran

Strategic investors are the most active and important MarTech investors

Most Active Investors Identified in MarTech and Their Portfolio Companies (Excluding AdTech)

Sabaldea

Zebline

Marketing Automation

Sabaldea, through its ownership of **Aparat** and **Filimo**, as well as its agency **Sabavision**, has a strong focus on video advertising. In this regard, Sabavision is launching a new product in digital advertising, primarily focused on **user profiling**.

Previously, Sabavision developed tools like "Tickeabi" and "Showrand" for **Instagram analytics and advertising**, but these tools were discontinued due to Instagram's filtering.



Mohammad Valipour

Deputy Managing Director at SabaVision

Sabaldea's investment approach so far has been focused, with the goal of growing its own products. However, in the future, Sabaldea plans to invest in various areas of the digital economy, with these investments being made through a VC in the near future.

Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investments in Iran (Over the Last 3 Years)

In the past three years, 23 investments have been made in MarTech through various forms

Number of Investments Made in MarTech (Excluding AdTech) in the Past 3 Years (2021–2023)

Investments	Mergers and Acquisitions	New Subsidiaries
14	3	6

Insight

- This information is based on **publicly available data** or **data from interviewees** and may not include all investments.
- In the past three years, numerous investments have been made in **AdTech**. However, these investments are not considered in this report due to its scope.
- Based on estimates and available data, total investments in MarTech (within the report's scope, excluding AdTech) over the past three years have remained **below 100 billion tomans**. (1 Dollar = 52,000 Tomans / 1 Billion Tomans = 19,200 Dollars)

MarTech Investments (Excluding AdTech) in the Past 3 Years (2021–2023)

Year	Investee	Investor	Area of Activity	Type
2021	NovinHub	Bahman Capital	Social Media Analytics and Management	Investment
2021	Landin	Smartup (Smart Fund)	Landing Page Builder	Investment
2021	Vidiwood	Smartup (Smart Fund)	Video Content Creation	Investment
2021	Viravirast	100startups (Edutech, Partian, Shenasa, 100startups)	Text and Image Generation	Investment
2022	Zitron	Diginext	Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform	Investment
2022	FlowChat	Diginext	Liva Chat and Chatbot	Investment
2022	Prism	Diginext	AI-Based Call Center Management	Investment
2022	Khodnevis	Diginext	Text and Image Generation	Investment
2022	Dezhino	Diginext	Performance Marketing	Investment

Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investments in Iran (Over the Last 3 Years)

In the past three years, 23 investments have been made in MarTech through various forms

MarTech Investments (Excluding AdTech) in the Past 3 Years (2021–2023)

Year	Investee	Investor	Area of Activity	Type
2022	Predictor	Diginext	Smart Prediction and Search Service	Investment
2022	SellerYar	Kherad Group	Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform	Investment
2022	SellerYar	Parsian Bank Data processing Group & Smartup Fund	Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform	Investment
2023	Muchat		Liva Chat and Chatbot	Investment
2022	Zebline	Sabaldea	Marketing Automation	Investment
2022	Zilink	TOSAN SOHA	Instagram Link-in-Bio	Mergers and Acquisitions
2023	Pushe	Tapsell (Metrix)	Push Notification	Mergers and Acquisitions
2023	Adtrace	Smartech	Mobile Analytics	Mergers and Acquisitions
2021	Yeklink	Yektanet	Landing Page Builder	Subsidiary
2022	InTrack	Smartech	Marketing Automation	Subsidiary
2023	Athena	Tapsell	Text and Image Generation	Subsidiary
2023	Pixy	Tapsell	Text and Image Generation	Subsidiary
2023	Gapify	Tapsell	Liva Chat and Chatbot	Subsidiary
2023	Danabot	Part	Liva Chat and Chatbot	Subsidiary

Many of the investments made in the past three years have been in **artificial intelligence**, particularly in the use of **AI for content generation** and **chatbots**.

Investment Patterns in Marketing Technology (MarTech) in Iran

Currently, the focus is on customer retention and loyalty tools

An Overview of the MarTech Investment Pattern in Iran

Shift in focus from customer acquisition to retention and loyalty

In previous years, businesses primarily focused on **customer acquisition and awareness**, with tools like email marketing attracting significant interest from both businesses and investors. In fact, it can be said that AdTech and **digital advertising** received more attention. However, in recent years, the emphasis has shifted toward **data**, **personalization**, **customer engagement**, and **customer retention** and **loyalty**. As a result, both businesses and investors have increasingly focused on these tools.

In-house development of necessary tools by large businesses

Many large businesses, due to concerns over **data protection**, do not use existing MarTech tools, especially Iranian ones. These businesses invest **internally** and develop the tools they need, which has led to the creation of **siloed and disconnected tools**.

Strategic investors are the key investors in MarTech

Currently, venture capital investment is minimal. Most investors in this field are **strategic investors**, meaning companies or holdings that are also active in the industry. Therefore, one of their key investment criteria is the ability to complete their **value chain** and offer products and services that complement their **existing offerings**.



Sobhan Foroughi

Co-Founder and CEO of Tapsell

In recent years, due to the decrease in venture capital and the lack of a clear outlook for return on investment, the investment model in this industry has become more focused and pinpointed. Most companies active in this field are investing to complete their value chain, and venture capital investment has significantly decreased.

Trends in Marketing Technology (MarTech) Investments in Iran and the World

Artificial Intelligence is one of the key trends in Iran and worldwide

MarTech Investment Trends – 2023

Global	Iran
Artificial Intelligence and Its Use in MarTech Tools*	Personalization and First Party Data
Data Analytics and Business Intelligence	Marketing Automation
Customer Experience and Success Management	Retention Marketing and Loyalty Tools
Omnichannel Marketing	Artificial Intelligence and Its Use in MarTech Tools*
	Sales Assistant

*A significant portion of MarTech investments worldwide has been related to artificial intelligence



Hamid Mohammadi

Co-Founder and Chairman of the Board of Digikala Group

One of the changes in MarTech is that performance is no longer the only focus; data, especially First Party Data, has become increasingly important.

Challenges and Risks of Investing in Marketing Technology in Iran

Lack of regulation and unclear policies are among the main challenges

Key Challenges and Risks of Investing in MarTech

Lack of skilled teams
Factors such as the migration of skilled labor have led to a shortage of strong and specialized teams, especially in the MarTech field, which requires specialized knowledge.



Keyvan Mohit Mafi

CEO at Diginext

One of the biggest challenges of venture capital investment in areas like MarTech is the limited number of capable startup teams. Even if a strong team is present, the uncertainty about securing funding in later stages and the limited exit opportunities increase the investor's risk.

Lack of regulation and unclear policies
The absence of clear regulations and policies increases investment risk, as the rules that may be introduced could either foster or hinder business growth, and their impact is unpredictable.



Mazdak Pakzad

Co-Founder and CEO of Smartech

The absence of a regulatory body, particularly the lack of data regulation laws, creates significant risks for investment in this industry. This is because regulations could be introduced at any time that may impact industry players, potentially leading to their failure or hindering their growth.

Limited growth in Iran's closed market
Brands face limited growth opportunities due to the closed market and lack of competition or international opportunities, which also restricts the potential return on investment and exit options for investors.

Investment Opportunities in Marketing Technology in Iran

The growing importance of data-driven decision-making can drive MarTech tool growth

Key Investment Opportunities in MarTech

Absence of foreign players
Due to the absence of major foreign players (due to sanctions or filtering), Iranian businesses have the opportunity to serve as replacements for them.

Customer retention and loyalty tools
Due to the economic slowdown and high customer acquisition costs, businesses are focusing more on improving customer engagement, retention, and loyalty.

Importance of data-driven decision-making
The increased focus of businesses on data-driven and optimized decision-making can lead to the growth of tools in this field.



Mohammad Valipour

Deputy Managing Director at SabaVision

The awareness and education of decision-makers and marketing managers has increased. These individuals have become more aware of the importance of data-driven decisions, which will significantly contribute to the growth of this industry.

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Research Methodology

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဆောင်းပေါ်

TECHRASA. Insight

Objective and Scope of the Report

Providing comprehensive data and insights to stakeholders in marketing technologies

Report Objective

More than a decade has passed since marketing technologies entered Iran and the first companies in this field were established. However, these companies have yet to expand their services to a wide range of businesses across different industries and sizes. In other words, while marketing technology is still in its infancy, it has significant growth potential ahead.

One of the main reasons for the slow growth of marketing technologies is the lack of access to and transparency in data and insights. Therefore, the primary objective of this report is to provide comprehensive and high-level data and insights to marketing technology customers, players, regulators, and investors, enabling them to make data-driven decisions based on this report.

This report aims to analyze marketing technologies in Iran and address the following questions:

- When did marketing technology enter Iran, and what changes have occurred over the years?
- What is the current state of marketing technology in Iran?
- What investment and business development opportunities exist in marketing technology in the short to medium term (up to the next three years)?

Report Scope

This report focuses on the quantitative and qualitative analysis and comparison of industries and players in the marketing technology. Additionally, it examines the definitions and applications of products offered by these players to establish a shared terminology in Iran, aligning with global standards.

The study was conducted in the second half of 2023 and the first half of 2024, covering 20 industries across four broad categories. Globally, the landscape created by chiefmartec includes five category and 50 subcategories, with universal agreement among stakeholders on this classification method. Consequently, this report has adopted terminology consistent with this framework wherever possible.

Two categories, Advertising & Promotion (AdTech) and management, were not included in this report. AdTech was excluded due to the publication of a series of advertising technology reports by TechRasa Farsi, while management was omitted because its applications extend across all businesses and are not specific to marketing technology. Additionally, the customer relationship management (CRM) subcategory under social & relationships was not covered, given the broad scope of this area in Iran.

Objective and Scope of the Report

Data collection from primary and secondary sources

The players introduced in each industry include companies established in Iran and foreign companies operating in the Iranian market. These players are categorized into four broad groups and 20 industries based on the similarities in the services and products they offer.

While the primary focus of this report is on marketing technology in Iran, it also provides a brief analysis and comparison of marketing technology in Iran, the MENA region, and globally. Finally, based on all collected data and insights, the report aims to outline the potential short-term outlook for marketing technology in Iran.

Project Duration

10 months

Report Scope

Content & Experience

- Text & Image Generation Tool
- Multimedia Content Creation Tool
- Website Builder Platform
- Landing Page Design Tool
- URL Shortener Tool
- SEO Tool

Social & Relationships

- Cloud-Based Call Center
- Online Form Builder and Survey Software
- A2P SMS
- Live Chat & Chatbot
- Email Marketing Platform
- Push Notification
- Media Monitoring & Social Listening Platform
- Social Media Analytics & Management
- Customer Loyalty Program Software

Data

- Business Intelligence Software
- Marketing Automation Platform
- Mobile Analytics Platform
- Web Analytics Platform

Commerce & Sales

- Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform

Data Collection

Conducting 91 semi-structured interviews

The data and information in this report were collected using a mixed methods approach, combining primary and secondary sources.

Secondary Sources

Social Media	Player Websites	News Websites
Industry Reports from Iran and Worldwide	Annual Performance Reports of Players	TechRasa Database

Primary Sources

18 Interviews with CMOs and Experts	66 Interviews with Industry Players (at least one small, medium, and large company in each industry)
7 Interviews with Investors	

Information Collected from Secondary Sources

Information Collected from Players

- Name (Persian and English)
- Website Address
- Year of Establishment
- Industry Category
- Products and Features

Information Collected for Each Industry

- Definition and Applications
- List of Players
- Products and Features
- Market Size
- Target Market

In the process of identifying players, the DMboard map titled "Comprehensive Guide to Marketing Tools in Iran" and Google searches using keywords related to the groups and subgroups of the chiefmartec landscape were utilized.

Due to project limitations, after identifying the key players in each industry, the identification of other players was limited to the second page of Google search results. Additionally, during this phase, the products and features of each player were extracted from the information available on their websites, which plays a crucial role in classification the players in the next phase.

Data Collection

Analysis of over 300 players

Number of Analyzed Players by Category

Data	Commerce & Sales	Social & Relationships	Content & Experience
50 Players	4 Players	254 Players	109 Players

Primary Sources: Conducting Over 90 Semi-Structured Interviews

After collecting secondary data and identifying existing gaps, primary data was gathered through 91 semi-structured interviews with industry players, investors, experts ,and CMOs.

Sampling from the list of identified players for selecting interviewees was done randomly and based on the size of their companies. It was ensured that at least one small, one medium, and one large company were represented among the interviewees. In all industries, a minimum of 3 and a maximum of 6 interviews were conducted, depending on the complexity and size of the market.

Interview Question List for Each Industry

History

- **Formation Path**: What events led to the formation of the industry in Iran?
- **Development Path**: How has the industry evolved from its inception to the present? What factors have contributed to these changes? (Innovative companies, product development, technological advancements, changes in consumer behavior, regulations, etc.)
- **Investment**: Which players in this field have successfully raised investment? Have there been any mergers or acquisitions in this sector?

Players

- **Iranian Players**: Which Iranian players are active in the market?
- **Foreign Players**: Which foreign players are active in the market?
- **Key Players**: Classify the key players in the Iranian market based on their market share into four categories (Leader, Challenger, Follower, Nicher).
- **Comparing Key Players**: What criteria are important to customers in this industry? Rate the players on a scale of 1 to 5 (from very low to very high) based on these criteria.

Data Collection

17 Questions in Each Interview

Market

- **Market Size**: What is the size of the industry market in Iran?
- **Foreign Players' Market Share**: What is the market share of foreign players?
- **Growth Rate**: What was the industry's revenue growth rate in the past year?
- **Number of Customers**: How many business customers did you have in the past year?
- **Customer Size**: Currently, what percentage of your customers are small, medium, and large businesses? What percentage of your revenue comes from small, medium, and large businesses?
- **Target Market**: Which industries do your customers primarily belong to?

Competitive Analysis and Attractiveness (Rating on a scale of 1 to 5, from very low to very high)

- **Rivalry Intensity**

Industry Rivalry: How intense is the direct competition among players?

Threat of New Entrants: How difficult and challenging is it for new players to enter the market?

Threat of Substitutes: What products/services substitute your offering? How significant is the threat of these substitutes to you?

Bargaining Power of Suppliers: How strong is the bargaining power of suppliers?

Bargaining Power of Customers: How strong is the bargaining power of customers?

- **Key Indicators Impacting the Industry Life Cycle**

Innovation Rate: How would you evaluate the current level of innovation?

Sales Growth: How would you evaluate the current growth rate?

Market Adoption: How would you assess the level of usage by potential customers?

Customer Awareness and Education: How aware do you think potential customers are of the benefits and applications of marketing technologies in the industry?

Market Saturation: How saturated do you think the market is?

Investment and Funding: How would you evaluate the access to capital for startups in the industry?

Industry Consolidation: To what extent are mergers and acquisitions common in this industry?

Trends and Macro Factors Influencing Market Growth or Decline

- What political, economic, social, cultural, technological, legal, and regulatory factors influence the growth or decline of the market? How significant is their impact? How uncertain are these factors?
- What do you think the future of this industry will look like? What new businesses will emerge or grow?

Data Cleaning and Analysis

Data analysis with a mixed approach of quantitative and qualitative data integration

In this project, data analysis was conducted using a mixed approach, integrating quantitative and qualitative data obtained from interviews with secondary sources. The data cleaning and analysis process was carried out in three steps:

1. **Clustering of Players**
2. **Cleaning and Analyzing Semi–Structured Interview Data**
3. **Integrating Findings from Primary and Secondary Sources**

1. Clustering of Players

After preparing the initial list of players, several players were removed for the following reasons:

- Players active in the field of advertising & promotion and customer relationship management (CRM)
- Players providing enterprise resource planning (ERP) software
- Inactive websites of players

After cleaning the initial list of players, the process of clustering the players began. The distinction of the clustering method in this report compared to the chiefmartec landscape lies in the objective behind the clustering.

The goal of chiefmartec is to provide a list of categorized players to help businesses find the necessary tools in their marketing technology stack (MarTech stack). This is why repetitions of players in different groups and subgroups are frequently observed in the chiefmartec landscape.

Since an industry refers to a group of companies engaged in similar economic activities, the clustering of players aimed to place each company in only one industry, except in exceptional cases. Therefore, the main criterion for creating industries was grouping companies that offer similar products and clustering.

Since each player uses different names for their products and services, standardization and harmonization of all product names was carried out. For example, the following names are various terms used by companies offering SMS panel services:

- Comprehensive Communication Platform
- SMS System
- SMS Sending Panel
- SMS Panel
- Short Message System
- SMS Sending Software
- SMS API
- Bulk SMS Panel
- A2P SMS

Data Cleaning and Analysis

Data cleaning and quantitative analysis with weighted averaging

By selecting a single term, "A2P SMS," it became possible to identify and compare the players offering this product. After standardizing product names, a table was created with player names and their products. A 1 was placed in the corresponding cell if a player offered a product; otherwise, a 0 was used. Hierarchical clustering was applied using binary data to cluster the players, and dendrogram inspection combined with the silhouette score was used to determine the optimal number of clusters. Data analysis GPTs in ChatGPT were used for clustering the players.

Due to the complexity of product similarities among the players, the clustering was performed in three stages. In each stage, some clusters and players were either moved to the next clustering phase or completely excluded for the following reasons, to be manually clustered at the end:

- Clusters with a large number of players and unrelated products (either a significant difference in products or an excessively large number of products) were moved to the next clustering phase.
- In clusters with similar products, the cluster with the most frequent product was selected, and in the remaining clusters, players offering similar products were excluded.
- In clusters where the presence of a single player offering all or most of the products created a cluster, they were excluded, and the corresponding cluster was split into two or more clusters.

After the third clustering phase, the excluded players were clustered as follows:

- A new cluster was created for players who were excluded due to operating in multiple areas but had enough numbers to form a new cluster.
- A few similar players, due to their small number, could not form a new cluster. Instead, they were placed in the closest cluster based on product similarity. Finally, players who didn't meet either condition were repeated across multiple clusters.

2. Data Cleaning and Analysis of Semi–Structured Interviews

The data collected from 91 interviews with industry players, CMOs, experts, and investors includes both quantitative and qualitative components, offering a comprehensive understanding of marketing technology in Iran.

Data Cleaning and Quantitative Analysis with Weighted Averaging

Quantitative data from the interviews were collected to gain measurable insights into various aspects of marketing technology, such as market size, growth rate, market potential, foreign players' market share, and more.

To ensure the accuracy of the quantitative findings, a weighted average approach was applied based on the key criterion of the interviewees' expertise level. Higher weights were assigned to interviewees with a higher level of expertise, reflecting their deeper understanding of industry trends.

It is worth noting that in the section comparing key players based on important customer criteria, each interviewee's score for their own company was weighted 0.5 compared to other interviewees.

Data Cleaning and Analysis

Validation of findings through cross-checking of primary and secondary sources

Data Cleaning and Qualitative Analysis with Thematic Analysis

To clean and analyze the qualitative data, the interview transcripts were first created verbatim. The transcripts were then coded using thematic analysis to identify patterns, insights, and recurring key data in response to each question.

3. Integration of Findings from Primary and Secondary Sources

To enhance the validity and robustness of the findings, a triangulation approach was used. By cross-checking the findings from primary and secondary sources, the consistency and comprehensiveness of the results across multiple aspects of each sub-industry were ensured.

For example, in comparing key players based on price and product and capability diversity, the interviewees' ratings were cross-checked with data collected from the players' websites and brochures to verify the accuracy and validity of the scores.

This approach helped ensure the accuracy and reliability of the findings, and in cases of contradictory data and insights, we refrained from presenting them.

Data Validation, Ethical Considerations, and Report Limitations

Maintaining interviewee privacy and preventing bias

Data Validation

To ensure the accuracy and validity of the findings, the following steps were taken at each stage of the report:

- Audio recording interviews to enhance transcription accuracy and facilitate further review of quantitative and qualitative data.
- Ensuring consistency across all interviews by following a standardized process, including trial interviews and using consistent question order, structure, and wording.
- Ensuring consistency and increasing the accuracy of the findings by cross-checking and comparing data gathered from interviews with secondary data sources.
- Ensuring the accuracy of the data and findings by sending the final version of the report and holding sessions with interviewees to gather feedback and expert opinions.

Ethical Considerations

All project stages were conducted in adherence to strict ethical guidelines to ensure the protection of interviewees' rights and privacy while avoiding any bias.

Voluntary and Informed Participation

At the invitation stage and at the beginning of each interview, clear and detailed explanations about the purpose, scope, report development and publication process, and discussion topics were provided to all interviewees to ensure they participated knowingly.

Participation in the interview was entirely voluntary, and interviewees could skip any questions or end the interview at any time without providing a reason.

Confidentiality and Data Security

If interviewees requested confidentiality and the omission of their names, all identifying information was removed from the interview files. Additionally, all data collected during the interviews was stored in an encrypted storage space, accessible only to the project team members.

Right to Review

Interviewees were given the opportunity to review and revise their responses if needed. This ensured the accuracy of the data, with the possibility to add or remove any information if necessary.

Data Validation, Ethical Considerations, and Report Limitations

Limited data and insights in some industries due to interview constraints

Limitations

While this report provides comprehensive insights into Iran marketing technology, it has the following limitations:

No Interviews Conducted in Some Industries

Despite repeated efforts to invite experts and specialists for interviews, no interviews were conducted in some industries due to the reluctance of invitees. In the website analytics and multimedia content production industries, only one interview was conducted, while no interviews took place in the URL shorteners and push notification industries. This is reflected in the limited content and insights from these industries.

Comparison of Key Players with Ratings Provided by the Players

Although the suggestion was made to collect feedback and ratings from customers in each industry through questionnaires, due to existing limitations, key players rated themselves. However, to mitigate this, a lower weight was applied to the ratings given by interviewees for their own companies. Additionally, criteria such as price and product diversity were selected, which could be verified by the project team, to address this issue as much as possible.

Team, Research Contributors, and Report Partners

Report Partners: SMARTECH ဆေးတက္ကသိုလ် TECHRASA. Insight

Report Creation Team

Individuals involved in the preparation and design of this report

Report Creation Team



Mohammadreza Azali

Project Owner



Sahar Rayzan

Project Manager



Reza Bohlouli

Analyst



Aysan Aghili

Analyst



Mohammad Ali Salehi

Designer



Hossein Azadbar

Designer



Faraz Salehi

Designer

Research Contributors

Individuals who contributed to this report with their knowledge, experience, and time

Investors



Hamid Mohammadi

Co-Founder and Chairman of the Board at Digikala Group



Farzin Fardiss

CEO at Sarava



Sobhan Foroughi

Co-Founder and CEO of Tapsell



Mazdak Pakzad

Co-Founder and CEO of Smartech



Mohammad Valipour

Deputy Managing Director at SabaVision



Ahmad Ali Farhoodi

Co-Founder and CEO of SabaCell



Kayvan Mohit Mafi

CEO at Diginext

Research Contributors

Individuals who contributed to this report with their knowledge, experience, and time

Experts and Chief Marketing Officers



Meysam Mollasharify

CMO at Snapp



Maysam Keihani

CMO at OzoneEcosystem



Mehdi Dadkhah

Senior Marketing and Growth Manager at Tapsi



Tohid Aliashrafi

Chief Executive Officer at Alibaba Travels



Alireza Borzabadi

CMO at Nobitex



Mahmoudreza Chamani

Marketing Manager at Dorsa Group



Mahbod Mortazavi

Co-founder & CMO of SnappShop



Mohamad Hasan Farazmand

VP of Marketing at Digipay



Jeiran Tabei

Head of Marketing at Danone



Ali Rasouli

CMO at Divar



Hadi Moradi

Founder of DM Board



Mahdi Habibi

CMO at Snappfood



Amir Pasha

CEO at Carmood and Former CMO at Digikala



Hirmand Lashkari

Data Marketing Consultant



Behrad Zari

Founder and Former CEO of Chabok



Ebrahin Ghane

Co-Founder and Product Manager of Paziresh24



Arman Safayi

Co-founder and CEO of Triboon



Mahdi Kafi

Co-Founder of Daart ADS

A2P SMS



Faramaz Saberi

CEO at Atieh Dadeh Pardaz



Sadegh Mohammadi

Co-Founder & CEO of Mediana



Ardavan Sharifi

Co-Founder and CEO of Kavenegar



Vahid Khosravi

Founder and CEO of SMS.ir



Amin Rabiee

Messaging Manager of SMS.ir

Research Contributors

Individuals who contributed to this report with their knowledge, experience, and time

Marketing Automation Platform and Mobile Analytics Platform



Behzad Lotfi

Founder and CEO of Zebline



Saghar Rafiee

Sales and Marketing Manager at Metrix



Fatemeh Karami

Fomer Martech Product Lead at Smartech



Hamidreza Abolhelm

Former CPO at Smartech

Business Intelligence Software



Meysam Farashi

Co-Founder & CEO of Tart



Arman Fallah

Founder and Managing Director of Nemoudar



Saeid Mobedi

Co-Founder and CTO of Decom



Amir Hariri

Founder of Winiro



Hamid Yazdaninejad

Founder and CTO of Hooshayand

Text and Image Generation Tool



Pooya Behyad

Co-Founder of Khodnevis



Muhammadreza Haghiri

CEO and CTO at Mann-E



Amir Sharifzadeh

CEO at Athena



Amirhossein Mehrdoust

Founder of Fibonacci



Ehsan Azizi

Co-Founder of Aval

Email Marketing Platform



Hadi Farnoud

Founder of Pakat



Hamid Mahmoudzadeh

Founder and CEO of Didar CRM



Majid fathi

CEO at AvangEmail



Behrooz Mahdavi

CEO at MailFa

Research Contributors

Individuals who contributed to this report with their knowledge, experience, and time

Website Builder Platform



Masoud Sabaghi

Founder and CEO of Webzi



Farshad Esmailian

CEO at Hostiran



Morteza Zarrinderafsh

CEO at Mana Andisheh



Mohsen Tabatabaei Tabar

Co-Founder & CEO of Portal



Rasool Zare

Co-Founder and CMO of SEE5



Sajad Zare

Co-Founder and CEO of SEE5

Online Form Builder and Survey Software



Hamidreza Nazari

Founder and CEO of Porsline



Javad Borujerdi

CEO at ePoll



Amirali Hosseinkhan

Founder and Product Manager of uCheck



Farokh Shahabi

Co-founder & CEO of Formaloo

Live Chat & Chatbot



Ghader Sadeghi

Co-Founder and CEO of Raychat



Ali Naderi

Founder of FlowChat



Mostafa Alahyari

Founder of Muchat & Zilink



Mohammad Javad Aboutalebi

Co-founder of Gapify



Saleh Asadi

CPO at Danabot



Saleh Ghane

CEO at Inboxino



Pooria Soluti

Co-Founder of Directam



Ali Rahimi

Founder of Goftino



Azad Bahrami

Co-Founder of NovinHub

Research Contributors

Individuals who contributed to this report with their knowledge, experience, and time

Customer Loyalty Program Software



Morteza Shojaee

Co-Founder and CMO of Philia



Amir Navazi

Co-Founder & CIPO of Smart X



Yaser Yavari

CEO at Direct



Alireza Nakhjavani

Co-Founder of Dayatek and CEO at Sobhe Omid Management Consulting Firm



Fateme Karamiyan

Head of Business at Dobare

Media Monitoring & Social Listening Platform – Social Media Analytics & Management Platform



Sina Masihpour

Co-Founder and CEO of Zelkaa



Amir Hossein Asgari

Co-Founder and CEO of Dataak



Hossein Hamzehpour

Co-Founder and Business Development Manager of Dataak



Azad Bahrami

Co-Founder of NovinHub

Cloud-Based Call Center



Sajad Sabri

Co-Founder of Nasim Telecom



Ali Dashti

Founder and CEO of DaftareShoma



Milad Razban

Founder and CEO of Workano



Eilya Amiri

Co-Founder & CEO of Hamisun



Alireza Tavousian

Senior Voip Engineer at Nasim Telecom



Hamid Forouzandeh

Founder and CEO of Navatel

Research Contributors

Individuals who contributed to this report with their knowledge, experience, and time

Omnichannel Retail Commerce Platform



Mehdi Adeli

Co-Founder and CEO of Markito



Aria Motamedinejad

Co-Founder of ZiTRON



Teymour Sattarzadeh

Co-Founder & CEO of SellerYar

Landing Page Design Tool



Mahdi Zahiri

Founder and CEO of Landin



Amir Arsalan Cham Khorram

Founder and CEO of Cartino



Mostafa Alahyari

Founder of Muchat & Zilink

SEO Tool



Esmaeil Noormohammadi

Co-Founder of Keywordchi



Reza Shirazi

Founder and CEO of Jetseo



Pouria Ariafar

Founder and CEO of Mizfa Tools



Ali Hosseini

Founder and CEO of Seolaboratory

Multimedia Content Creation Tool – Web Analytics Platform



Samira Marzban

Co-Founder & CEO of Lenoos



Afshin Zandi

CEO of Analytips

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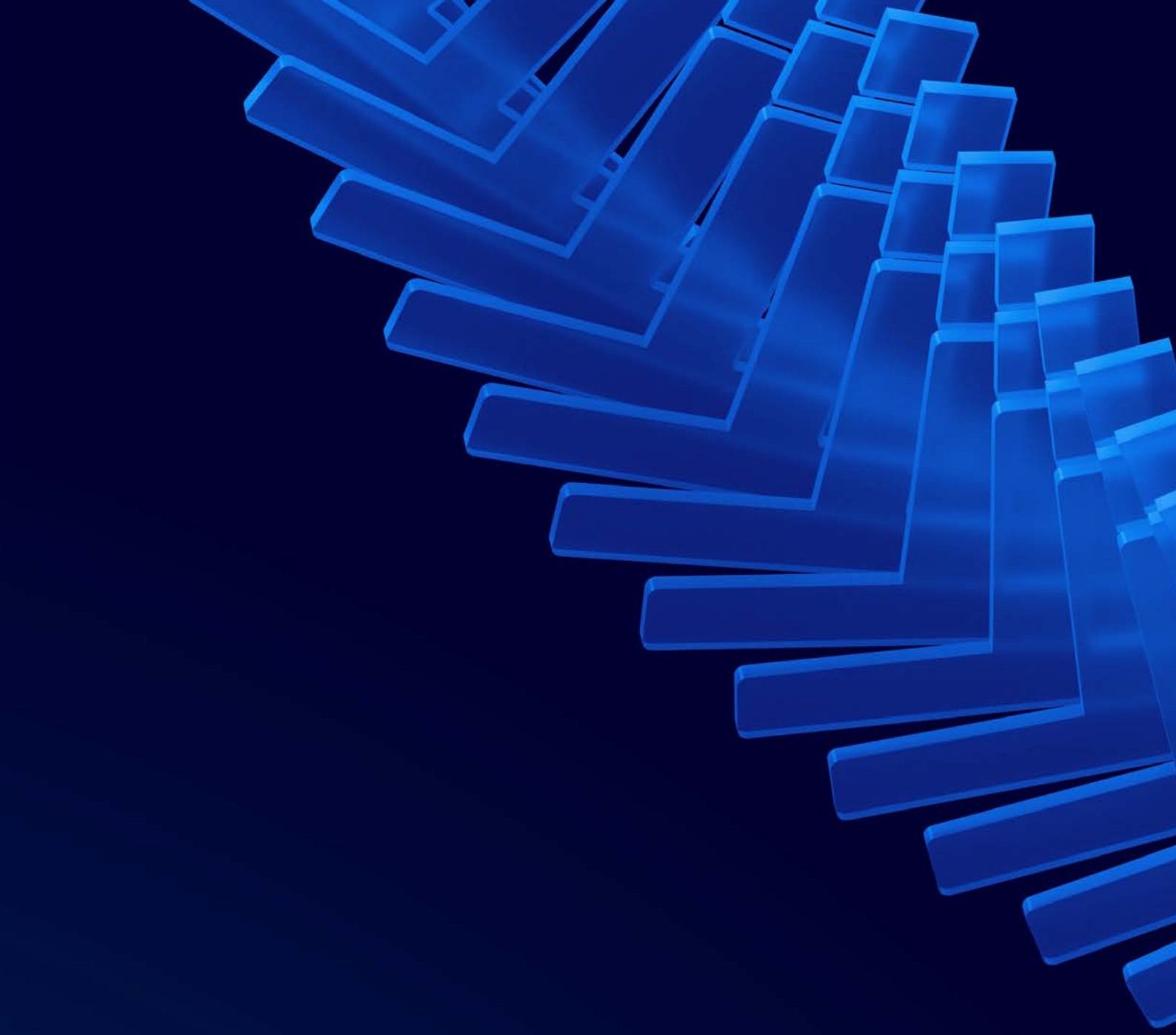
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